

ON THE GENERAL THEORY OF VALUATIONS, LOCAL FIELDS AND HENSELIAN FIELDS

A Dissertation Submitted
in Partial Fulfilment of the Requirements
for the Degree of

**MASTER OF SCIENCE
(BY RESEARCH)**

in

MATHEMATICS

by

**Daksh Dheer
(Roll No. IPHD23050)**



to

**SCHOOL OF MATHEMATICS
INDIAN INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE EDUCATION AND
RESEARCH
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - 695551, INDIA**

May 2026

DECLARATION

I, **Daksh Dheer (Roll No: 23050)**, hereby declare that, this report entitled “**On the General Theory of Valuations, Local Fields and Henselian Fields**” submitted to Indian Institute of Science Education and Research Thiruvananthapuram towards the partial fulfilment of **Master of Science (by Research) in Mathematics**, is an original work carried out by me under the supervision of **Prof Viji Z. Thomas** and has not formed the basis for the award of any degree or diploma, in this or any other institution or university. I have sincerely tried to uphold academic ethics and honesty. Whenever a piece of external information or statement or result is used then, that has been duly acknowledged and cited.

Thiruvananthapuram - 695551
May 2026

Daksh Dheer

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the work contained in this project report entitled “**On the General Theory of Valuations, Local Fields and Henselian Fields**” submitted by **Daksh Dheer (Roll No: IPHD23050)** to the Indian Institute of Science Education and Research, Thiruvananthapuram towards the partial fulfilment of **Master of Science (by Research) in Mathematics** has been carried out by him under my supervision and that it has not been submitted elsewhere for the award of any degree.

Thiruvananthapuram - 695551
May 2026

Prof. Viji Z. Thomas
Project Supervisor

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I would like to express my deepest gratitude to my supervisor, Prof. Viji Thomas, for his constant support and perennial guidance throughout the last three years. His insightful feedback and rigorous approach have consistently challenged me to improve, particularly his meticulous attention to detail in proofs, which has taught me the skillful art of writing mathematics. His absolutely splendid ideas have, on multiple occasions, turned global insurmountable mountains into local grassy fields, and I can only hope to internalize his work ethic and dedication.

I express my sincere appreciation to all the members of the School of Mathematics at IISER Thiruvananthapuram for cultivating a stimulating and supportive academic environment and for the depth of knowledge and guidance shared during my coursework and interactions, especially my junior Krishnanand for all his help with this project. I am indebted to all my friends who have continued to support me, especially Debu and Prachi, who made this final year much better than bearable, and Shakshi, who has been my harshest critic as well as my strongest supporter in all matters academic or otherwise.

I would also like to acknowledge all the privileges afforded to me by my caste, gender, and religion, which have granted me access to exclusive spaces, opportunities, and other forms of support.

Lastly, I am grateful to my family for their unwavering support; this project would not have been possible without them. This thesis is dedicated to my Papa and Maa, without whom I would never have pursued my passion, as well as to my brother Lakshay and my sister-in-law Ananya, who have always been guiding lights and pillars of support in my life.

This thesis, even when it felt like it, was not written in isolation.

*Whoever sees that Light is soon
made such that it would be
impossible for him to set that Light
aside for other sight; because the
good, the object of the will, is fully
gathered in that Light; outside that
Light, what there is perfect is
defective.*

Dante Alighieri
The Divine Comedy

Daksh Dheer
Thiruvananthapuram - 695551
May 2026

ABSTRACT

Name of the student: **Daksh Dheer**

Roll No: **23050**

Degree: **M.S. (by Research)**

Department: **School of Mathematics**

Title: *On the General Theory of Valuations, Local Fields and Henselian Fields*

Thesis supervisor: **Prof. Viji Thomas**

Date of submission: **May 4, 2026**

In this thesis, we independently develop the theory of valuations in more generality than is traditionally required for algebraic number theory. We begin by defining absolute values (which can be seen as valuations of rank one) before introducing valuations proper and discussing their properties such as the equivalence between valuations and valuation rings. After this, we construct some valuations and move on to discuss their topology – this notion closely relates to dependence of valuations and we make this precise. In the same section, we also show the correspondence among overrings, primes and a class of convex groups, and conclude by proving a general approximation theorem. The remainder of the chapter deals with extensions of valuations and results concerning them.

The second half of the thesis will deal with a study of the properties of local fields as well as more general (henselian) valued fields. We see a characterization of local fields and the precise structure of their multiplicative groups (via defining a formal natural logarithm and exponential function). In the section concerning henselian fields, we define the notion of a Newton polygon and characterize henselian fields; we also prove the fundamental identity in this context. Finally, we move onto the ramification theory of global fields, which will be deduced from that of henselian fields; this also includes the Galois theory of valuations as well. This is a generalisation of Hilbert’s ramification theory for decomposition of primes over Galois extensions of number fields. We define the decomposition, inertia and ramification groups and study their corresponding fixed fields as well, and make precise the local-to-global principle by reducing problems to the case of local (henselian/complete) extensions.

Contents

Contents	vi
1 Valuation Theory	1
1.1 Absolute Values	1
1.2 General Valuations	23
1.3 Constructing valuations	30
1.4 Dependence and Topology of Valuations	34
1.5 Extensions of Valuations	43
2 Local, Global and Henselian Fields	60
2.1 Local Fields	60
2.2 Henselian Fields	73
2.3 Extensions of Valuations	83
2.4 Galois Theory of Valuations	90
References	108

Chapter 1

Valuation Theory

We base this chapter of the report mainly on the first three chapters of [EP05], with a few excursions into [Neu99]. In this chapter, we prove theorems in the theory of valuations in more generality than required in standard algebraic number theory.

In accordance with the [views of Alfréd Rényi](#), we denote the completion of a proof with  throughout this thesis.

1.1 Absolute Values

Definition 1.1.1. Let K be a field. An *absolute value* on K is a map

$$|\cdot| : K \longrightarrow \mathbb{R}$$

satisfying, for all $x, y \in K$:

1. $|x| > 0$ for all $x \neq 0$, and $|0| = 0$,
2. $|xy| = |x||y|$,
3. $|x + y| \leq |x| + |y|$.

Note that from the above axioms, we have $|1|^2 = |1^2| = |1|$, giving $|1| = 1$. Similarly, $|-1|^2 = |(-1)(-1)| = |1| = 1$ implies $|-1| = 1$, whence it follows that $|-x| = |x|$ for all $x \in K$. Since $|\cdot|$ is a homomorphism on $K^\times$, it follows that $|x^{-1}| = |x|^{-1}$ for $x \neq 0$.

Theorem 1.1.1. *The set $S = \{|n \cdot 1| : n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ is bounded if and only if $|\cdot|$ satisfies the ultrametric triangle inequality: $|x + y| \leq \max\{|x|, |y|\}$ for all $x, y \in K$.*

Proof. If $|\cdot|$ satisfies the ultrametric triangle inequality, then for any element $|m \cdot 1| \in S$, we have $|m \cdot 1| = |1 + 1 + \cdots + 1| \leq \max\{|1|, \dots, |1|\} = 1$.

Conversely, if S is bounded by some constant M , then we have, for any $n \in \mathbb{Z}$

$$|x+y|^n = |(x+y)^n| = \left| \sum_{\nu=0}^n \binom{n}{\nu} x^\nu y^{n-\nu} \right| \leq \sum_{\nu=0}^n \binom{n}{\nu} |x|^\nu |y|^{n-\nu} \leq M(n+1) \cdot \max\{|x|, |y|\}^n$$

since $|x|^\nu |y|^{n-\nu} \leq \max\{|x|, |y|\}^n$ and $\binom{n}{\nu} \leq M$. Therefore, on taking n -th roots, we get $|x + y| \leq M^{1/n}(n+1)^{1/n} \cdot \max\{|x|, |y|\}$ and thus, as $n \rightarrow \infty$, we conclude $|x + y| \leq \max\{|x|, |y|\}$.



Definition 1.1.2. An absolute value satisfying the ultrametric triangle inequality $|x + y| \leq \max\{|x|, |y|\}$ for all $x, y \in K$ is said to be **non-Archimedean**. If not, it is said to be **Archimedean**.

Remark 1. The usual absolute value on $\mathbb{R}$, denoted by $|\cdot|_0$ is Archimedean.

We next consider some important non-Archimedean absolute values.

Example 1.1. For every rational prime p , define the p -adic absolute value $|\cdot|_p$ on $\mathbb{Q}$ by setting $|0|_p := 0$ and $\left| p^\nu \frac{m}{n} \right|_p := \frac{1}{e^\nu}$, where $m, n \in \mathbb{Z} \setminus \{0\}$ are not divisible by p . Here, $S = \{|n \cdot 1| : n \in \mathbb{Z}\} = \{e^{-\nu} : \nu \in \mathbb{N}\}$.

Example 1.2. Let k be a field and $q \in k[x]$ be an irreducible polynomial. We define $|\cdot|_q$ on the rational function field $k(x)$ as $|0|_q := 0$ and $\left| q^\nu \frac{f}{g} \right|_q := \frac{1}{e^\nu}$, where $f, g \in k[x] \setminus \{0\}$ are not divisible by q . This is known as the q -adic absolute value on $k[x]$.

An absolute value $|\cdot|$ on K defines a metric as $d(x, y) = |x - y|$, for all $x, y \in K$ and thus induces a topology on K .

Definition 1.1.3. Two absolute values are **dependent** or **equivalent** if they induce the same topology on K . If not, they are **independent**.

Theorem 1.1.2. *Let $|\cdot|_1$ and $|\cdot|_2$ be two nontrivial absolute values on K . The following are equivalent:*

1. $|\cdot|_1$ and $|\cdot|_2$ are dependent.
2. $|x|_1 < 1$ implies $|x|_2 < 1$.
3. There exists $s > 0$ such that $|x|_1 = (|x|_2)^s$ for all $x \in K$.

Proof. (1) $\implies$ (2): Suppose $|\cdot|_1$ and $|\cdot|_2$ are dependent, i.e., they induce the same topology on K . Let $x \in K$ be such that $|x|_1 < 1$, i.e., $x \in B_1(0, 1)$ — the open unit ball around 0 in the topology induced by $|\cdot|_1$. By hypothesis, there exists $\varepsilon > 0$ such that $B_1(0, \varepsilon) \subset B_2(0, 1)$. Since $|x|_1 < 1$, we may choose some positive integer $m \geq 1$ such that $|x^m|_1 = (|x|_1)^m < \varepsilon$, whence $x^m \in B_1(0, \varepsilon) \subset B_2(0, 1)$. Thus, $|x^m|_2 = (|x|_2)^m < 1$ and so $|x|_2 < 1$, since m is a positive integer.

(2) $\implies$ (3): Suppose $|x|_1 < 1$ implies $|x|_2 < 1$. Let $y \in K$ be a fixed element satisfying $|y|_1 > 1$. Let $x \in K, x \neq 0$. Then, $\exists \alpha \in \mathbb{R}$ such that $|x|_1 = |y|_1^\alpha$. Let m_i/n_i be a rational sequence converging to α from above; assume that $n_i > 0$. Now, $|x|_1 = |y|_1^\alpha < |y|_1^{m_i/n_i}$, and so $\left| \frac{x^{n_i}}{y^{m_i}} \right|_1 < 1$. By hypothesis, we get $\left| \frac{x^{n_i}}{y^{m_i}} \right|_2 < 1$, whence $|x|_2 \leq |y|_2^{m_i/n_i}$, and therefore $|x|_2 \leq |y|_2^\alpha$. We now use a rational sequence m_i/n_i converging to α from below and proceed similarly to obtain $|x|_2 \geq |y|_2^\alpha$. Thus, we have $|x|_2 = |y|_2^\alpha$. Moreover, we started with $|x|_1 = |y|_1^\alpha$.

Using these two equations, we get, for all nonzero $x \in K$,

$$\alpha = \frac{\log |x|_1}{\log |y|_1} = \frac{\log |x|_2}{\log |y|_2} \implies \frac{\log |x|_1}{\log |x|_2} = \frac{\log |y|_1}{\log |y|_2} =: s,$$

hence, $|x|_1 = |x|_2^s$ and $|y|_1 > 1 \implies |y|_2 > 1$, i.e., $s > 0$.

(3) $\implies$ (1): Suppose $\exists s > 0$ such that $|x|_1 = (|x|_2)^s$ for all $x \in K$.

It suffices to show that every open ball in the topology induced by $|x|_1$ is contained in an open ball in the topology induced by $|x|_2$, and vice versa. Consider $B_1(\alpha, r) = \{x \in K : |x - \alpha|_1 < r\}$. For any $x \in B_1(\alpha, r)$, we have, by hypothesis, $(|x - \alpha|_2)^s < r$, i.e., $|x - \alpha|_2 < r^{1/s}$, i.e., $x \in B_2(\alpha, r^{1/s})$.

Hence, $B_1(\alpha, r) \subset B_2(\alpha, r^{1/s})$. Analogously, it follows that $B_2(\alpha, r) \subset B_1(\alpha, r^s)$ and thus the topologies are the same. ▀

Lemma 1.1.1. $|\cdot|$ is a uniformly continuous map from K , with the topology given by $|\cdot|$, to $\mathbb{R}$ with the usual topology defined by $|\cdot|_0$

Proof. We have $|x| = |x - y + y| \leq |x - y| + |y|$. Thus, $|x| - |y| \leq |x - y|$. Exchanging x and y , and using $|y - x| = |x - y|$, it follows that $||x| - |y||_0 \leq |x - y|$, where $|\cdot|_0$ is again the usual absolute value on the real numbers. ▀

1.1. ABSOLUTE VALUES

The following theorem is an analogue of the Chinese Remainder Theorem in the case of absolute values.

Theorem 1.1.3 (Artin-Whaples Approximation). *Let $|\cdot|_1, |\cdot|_2, \dots, |\cdot|_n$ be pairwise-independent nontrivial absolute values on a field K . Let $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n \in K$ and $\varepsilon > 0$ be given. Then, there exists $x \in K$ such that $|x - x_i|_i < \varepsilon$ for all i .*

Proof. We will prove this in three steps.

Step 1. We shall prove that for every $1 \leq i \leq n$ there exists $a_i \in K$ such that $|a_i|_i > 1$ and $|a_i|_j < 1$ for all $j \neq i$. We show it for $i = 1$ and write $a = a_1$. The argument for every other i follows by replacing 1 with i .

We induct on n : for $n = 2$, the hypothesis states that $|\cdot|_1$ and $|\cdot|_2$ are independent. Hence, we use the earlier proposition to conclude that there exist $b, c \in K$ such that $|b|_1 < 1$ and $|b|_2 \geq 1$, $|c|_1 \geq 1$ and $|c|_2 < 1$. Now, take $a = b^{-1}c$, then $|a|_1 = |b^{-1}c|_1 = |b^{-1}|_1|c|_1 > 1$ since $|b|_1 < 1$ and $|c|_1 \geq 1$.

Similarly, $|a|_2 = |b^{-1}c|_2 = |b^{-1}|_2|c|_2 < 1$ since $|b|_2 \geq 1$ and $|c|_2 < 1$. Hence, the claim is true for $n = 2$.

Induction hypothesis: $\exists y \in K$ such that $|y|_1 > 1$ and $|y|_j < 1$ for all $j = 2, \dots, n - 1$.

Applying the $n = 2$ case to $|\cdot|_1$ and $|\cdot|_n$, we get $|z|_1 > 1$ and $|z|_n < 1$ for some $z \in K$. Therefore, if $|y|_n \leq 1$, then $|zy^\nu|_1 > 1$ and $|zy^\nu|_n < 1$ for every integer $\nu \geq 1$. Now, we choose an integer $\nu \geq 1$ such that $|zy^\nu|_j < 1$; this exists because $|y|_j < 1$ for all $j = 2, \dots, n - 1$. For example, we may take any $\nu < \min_{2 \leq j \leq n-1} \left(\frac{-\log |z|_j}{\log |y|_j} \right)$. setting $a = zy^\nu$. We have $|a|_1 = |zy^\nu|_1 > 1$ and $|a|_j = |zy^\nu|_j < 1$ for all $j \neq 1$. Hence we are done, under the assumption that $|y|_n \leq 1$.

Suppose now that $|y|_n > 1$. Consider the sequence $w_\nu = \frac{y^\nu}{1 + y^\nu}, \nu \in \mathbb{N}$.

We then have

$$\lim_{\nu \rightarrow \infty} |w_\nu|_j = \lim_{\nu \rightarrow \infty} \frac{|y^\nu|_j}{|1 + y^\nu|_j} = 0 \text{ for } j = 2, \dots, n - 1,$$

because $|y|_j < 1 \implies |y|_j^\nu < 1$ and $1 + |y^\nu|_j > |1 + y^\nu|_j > 1 - |y^\nu|_j$, i.e., the denominator is bounded by 1 (by applying the Sandwich theorem) meanwhile the numerator tends to zero.

Similarly,

$$\lim_{\nu \rightarrow \infty} |w_\nu - 1|_j = \lim_{\nu \rightarrow \infty} \left| \frac{y^\nu}{1 + y^\nu} - 1 \right|_j = \lim_{\nu \rightarrow \infty} \left| \frac{1}{1 + y^\nu} \right|_j \geq \lim_{\nu \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{1 - |y^\nu|_j} = 0 \text{ for } j = 1 \text{ and } n,$$

1.1. ABSOLUTE VALUES

since $|y|_n > 1$ and $|y|_1 > 1$. Hence,

$$\lim_{\nu \rightarrow \infty} |w_\nu|_j = 0 \text{ for } j = 2, \dots, n-1,$$

and

$$\lim_{\nu \rightarrow \infty} |w_\nu - 1|_j = 0 \text{ i.e., } \lim_{\nu \rightarrow \infty} |w_\nu|_j = 1 \text{ for } j = 1, n$$

As a result,

$$\lim_{\nu \rightarrow \infty} |zw_\nu|_j = |z|_j \lim_{\nu \rightarrow \infty} |w_\nu|_j = 0 \text{ for } j = 2, \dots, n-1,$$

and

$$\lim_{\nu \rightarrow \infty} |zw_\nu|_j = |z|_j \lim_{\nu \rightarrow \infty} |w_\nu|_j = |z|_j \text{ for } j = 1, n.$$

Hence, for sufficiently large ν , $a = zw_\nu$ is a valid choice since $|a|_1 = |zw_\nu|_1 = |z|_1 |w_\nu|_1 > 1$, as $\lim_{\nu \rightarrow \infty} |zw_\nu|_1 = |z|_1 > 1$, and $|a|_j = |zw_\nu|_j < 1$, as $\lim_{\nu \rightarrow \infty} |zw_\nu|_j = |z|_j < 1$, for all $j \neq 1$.

Step 2. Now we show that for any real $\varepsilon > 0$ and every $1 \leq i \leq n$, there exists $c_i \in K$ with $|c_i - 1|_i < \varepsilon$ and $|c_i|_j < \varepsilon$ for all $j \neq i$. We again only consider the case $i = 1$ in detail. Let $a \in K$ be as in Step 1. Then the sequence $\left| \frac{a^\nu}{1+a^\nu} \right|_j$ converges to 1 for $j = 1$, and converges to 0 if $j > 1$. This follows by observing that $|a^\nu|_1 > 1$ and $|a^\nu|_j < 1$ for $j > 1$; we then apply the same argument as for w_ν above. Thus, for sufficiently large ν , $c_1 = \frac{a^\nu}{1+a^\nu}$ has the required property.

Step 3. Proceeding inductively with step 2, there exist elements $c_1, \dots, c_n \in K$ such that c_i is close to 1 at $|\cdot|_i$, and for every $j \neq i$, c_i is close to 0 at $|\cdot|_j$. The element $x = c_1 x_1 + \dots + c_n x_n$ is then arbitrarily close to x_i at $|\cdot|_i$ for every $i = 1, \dots, n$, since

$$|x|_i = |c_1 x_1 + \dots + c_n x_n|_i \leq |c_1|_i |x_1|_i + \dots + |c_n|_i |x_n|_i \longrightarrow |c_i|_i |x_i|_i \longrightarrow |x_i|_i$$

This proves the theorem. ▣

Definition 1.1.4. A sequence $(x_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \subset K$ is **Cauchy** if for every $\varepsilon > 0$, $\exists N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $|x_n - x_m| < \varepsilon$ for all $n, m \geq N$.

K is called **complete** if every Cauchy sequence converges in K .

Note that K is always complete with respect to the trivial absolute value.

Lemma 1.1.2. Let X be a metric space and $Y \subseteq X$ be a dense subset. Assume every Cauchy sequence in Y converges to a point in X . Then, X is complete.

1.1. ABSOLUTE VALUES

Proof. Let $(a_n)_n$ be a Cauchy sequence in X . Since Y is dense, $B(a_n, \varepsilon) \cap Y \neq \emptyset$, $\forall \varepsilon > 0$. Pick $y_n \in B(a_n, \varepsilon) \cap Y$, for each n . Then, $|y_n - a_n| < \varepsilon$ and so $|y_n - y_m| \leq |y_n - a_n| + |a_n - y_m| < 2\varepsilon$, i.e., $(y_n)_n$ is also Cauchy. Since $(y_n)_n \subseteq Y$, we have $y_n \rightarrow x \in X$, by hypothesis. Hence, given $\varepsilon > 0$, $|y_n - x| < \varepsilon$, $\forall n \geq M$.

Consider $|a_n - x| \leq |a_n - y_n| + |y_n - x| < 2\varepsilon$, $\forall n$ large enough. Hence, $(a_n)_n \rightarrow x$, i.e., X is complete. $\blacksquare$

Theorem 1.1.4. *Given a field K with an absolute value $|\cdot|$, there exists a field $\widehat{K}$, complete with respect to $|\cdot|$, and an embedding $i : K \rightarrow \widehat{K}$ such that $|i(x)| = |x|$ for all $x \in K$.*

The image $i(K)$ is dense in $\widehat{K}$. If $(\widehat{K}', i')$ is another such pair, then there exists a unique continuous isomorphism $\varphi : \widehat{K} \rightarrow \widehat{K}'$, preserving the absolute value, such that the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \widehat{K} & \xrightarrow{\varphi} & \widehat{K}' \\ & \circlearrowleft & \\ i \swarrow & & \nearrow i' \\ & K & \end{array}$$

Proof. Existence of $\widehat{K}$: Let $\mathcal{C}$ be the set of Cauchy sequences of elements in K . Clearly, $\mathcal{C}$ is a commutative ring with unity.

Consider the set of null sequences $\mathcal{N} = \{(x_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}} : \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} x_n = 0\} \subset \mathcal{C}$.

$\mathcal{N}$ is an ideal of $\mathcal{C}$: take any $(a_n)_n \in \mathcal{N}$. Then, $\exists n_0 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that

$$|a_m - a_{n_0+1}| < 1 \quad \forall m > n_0.$$

Thus, $|a_m| = |a_m - a_{n_0+1} + a_{n_0+1}| < |a_m - a_{n_0+1}| + |a_{n_0+1}| < 1 + |a_{n_0+1}| \quad \forall m > n_0$, i.e., $(a_n)_n$ is bounded above. Now, let $(b_n)_n \in \mathcal{N}$ and $\varepsilon > 0$. Then, $\exists n'_1 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $|b_n| < \frac{\varepsilon}{1 + |a_{n_0+1}|}$, $\forall n > n'_1$. Thus, if $n > \max\{n_0, n'_1\}$, then $|a_n b_n| < \varepsilon$, i.e., $(a_n b_n)_n \in \mathcal{N}$.

Claim: Every sequence from $\mathcal{C} \setminus \mathcal{N}$ also admits a lower bound.

Suppose not: let $(a_n)_n \in \mathcal{C} \setminus \mathcal{N}$ be such that for all $\eta > 0$ and every $n_0 \in \mathbb{N}$, $|a_m| < \eta$ for some $m > n'_1$. Now, since $(a_n)_n$ is Cauchy, given $\varepsilon > 0$, we can pick $n'_1 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $|a_p - a_q| < \varepsilon/2$, $\forall p, q > n'_1$.

Choosing $\eta = \varepsilon/2$, we get $m > n'_1$ be such that $|a_m| < \varepsilon/2$. Then, for all $p > n'_1$, $|a_p| \leq |a_p - a_m| + |a_m| < \varepsilon$, which contradicts the fact that $(a_n)_n \notin \mathcal{N}$. This proves the claim.

Claim: $\mathcal{N}$ is a maximal ideal.

Fix an arbitrary sequence $(a_n)_n \in \mathcal{C} \setminus \mathcal{N}$. Then, there exist some $m_0 \in \mathbb{N}$ and $\eta > 0$ such that $|a_n| > \eta$ for all $n > m_0$. Define a sequence $(c_n)_n$ by $c_n := 1$ for $1 \leq n \leq M$, and $c_n := a_n^{-1}$ for $n > M$, where M will be chosen later. Let $\varepsilon > 0$ be given. Since $(a_n)_n$ is Cauchy, there exists $n_0 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $|a_p - a_q| < \varepsilon \eta^2$ for all $p, q > n_0$. Set $M = \max\{n_0, m_0\}$. Then, for all $p, q > M$, we have

$$|c_p - c_q| = |a_p^{-1} - a_q^{-1}| = \left| \frac{a_q - a_p}{a_p a_q} \right| = |a_p - a_q| \cdot |a_p^{-1}|^{-1} \cdot |a_q|^{-1} \leq \varepsilon \eta^2 \cdot \frac{1}{\eta} \cdot \frac{1}{\eta} = \varepsilon.$$

This shows that $(c_n)_n$ is Cauchy, hence $(c_n)_n \in \mathcal{C}$. Consider now $(a_n c_n)_n$. We have $|a_n c_n| = 1$ for all $n > m_0$, i.e., $(a_n c_n)_n \rightarrow 1$, i.e., $(a_n c_n)_n - 1 \in \mathcal{N}$. Thus, if we take $\mathcal{N}' = \mathcal{N} + \langle (c_n)_n \rangle$, then $\mathcal{N}' = \mathcal{C}$. Since $(a_n)_n$ was arbitrary, this means $\mathcal{N}$ is maximal. Hence, $\widehat{K} := \mathcal{C}/\mathcal{N}$ is a field. This concludes the proof of existence of $\widehat{K}$.

Existence and density of the embedding: We have an embedding $K \hookrightarrow \widehat{K}$ defined by $x \mapsto (x, x, x, \dots)$. From the previously seen uniform continuity of $|\cdot|$, we have $\|x\|_0 - \|y\|_0 \leq |x - y|$, where $\|\cdot\|_0$ denotes the usual absolute value. By definition, for all $(a_n)_n \in \mathcal{N}$, we have $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} |a_n| = 0$. Hence, for $\xi = (a_n)_n + \mathcal{N}$, the value $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} |a_n|$ does not depend on the representative $(a_n)_n$ of ξ . This follows from the observation that if $\xi = (a_n)_n + \mathcal{N} = (b_n)_n + \mathcal{N}$ then $(a_n - b_n)_n$ is a nullsequence, hence $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} |a_n - b_n| = 0$, hence $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} |a_n| = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} |b_n|$. We thus define $|\xi| := \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} |a_n|$. By the properties of limits and $|\cdot|$, it follows that this is an absolute value on $\widehat{K}$ that induces $|\cdot|$ on K .

Claim: $i(K)$ is dense in $\widehat{K}$ with respect to $|\cdot|$.

Recall that a subspace Y of a metric space X is *dense* if $\forall \varepsilon > 0, x \in X$, there exists $y \in Y$ such that $d(x, y) < \varepsilon$, i.e., $B(x, \varepsilon) \cap Y \neq \emptyset$. Fix $(x_n)_n \in \mathcal{C}$. Let $\varepsilon > 0$ be arbitrary. Choose $N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $|x_n - x_m| < \varepsilon \forall n, m \geq N$. In particular, $|x_n - x_N| < \varepsilon \forall n \geq N$. Therefore,

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} |x_n - x_m| \leq \varepsilon \implies |\widehat{(x_n)_n - (x_N)_n + \mathcal{N}}| = |\widehat{(x_n)_n - i(x_N) + \mathcal{N}}| \leq \varepsilon.$$

Hence, given any $\widehat{(x_n)_n + \mathcal{N}} \in \widehat{K}$, we have a corresponding element $i(x_N) \in i(K)$ such that $|\widehat{(x_n)_n + \mathcal{N}} - i(x_N)| \leq \varepsilon$.

Therefore, $i(K)$ is dense in $\widehat{K}$ with respect to $|\cdot|$.

We now prove the completeness of $\widehat{K}$.

1.1. ABSOLUTE VALUES

We have shown that $i(K)$ is dense in $\widehat{K}$. Hence, if we show that every Cauchy sequence in $i(K)$ converges to a point in $\widehat{K}$, then we are done (by lemma 1.1.1). Consider a Cauchy sequence $(\mathcal{Z}_n)_n \subseteq i(K)$, i.e., $\mathcal{Z}_n = \overline{(z_n, z_n, \dots, z_n)} + \mathcal{N}$. We have $|\mathcal{Z}_n - \mathcal{Z}_m| = |z_n - z_m|$, by definition. Since $(\mathcal{Z}_n)_n$ is Cauchy, $|\mathcal{Z}_n - \mathcal{Z}_m| = |z_n - z_m| < \varepsilon$ for $n, m \geq M$. Hence, $(z_n)_n = (z_1, z_2, z_3, \dots)$ is a Cauchy sequence in K . Consider $(z_n)_n + \mathcal{N} := \mathcal{Z}^*$. We will show $(\mathcal{Z}_n)_n \rightarrow \mathcal{Z}^*$. Given $\varepsilon > 0$, $\exists N \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $|z_k - z_n| < \varepsilon/2 \ \forall k, n \geq N$. Fixing $k \geq N$, we get $|z_k - z_n| < \varepsilon/2 \ \forall n \geq N \implies \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} |z_k - z_n| \leq \varepsilon/2$.

Now,

$$\begin{aligned} |\overline{\mathcal{Z}_k - \mathcal{Z}^*}| &= |\overline{(z_k, z_k, \dots) - (z_1, z_2, \dots)} + \mathcal{N}| \\ &= |\overline{(z_k - z_1, z_k - z_2, \dots)} + \mathcal{N}| \\ &= \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} |z_k - z_n| \leq \varepsilon/2 < \varepsilon \end{aligned}$$

Hence, $(\mathcal{Z}_n)_n \rightarrow \mathcal{Z}^*$.

Uniqueness of $(\widehat{K}, i)$: let $(\widehat{K}', i')$ be another pair with the same properties.

For every $\xi = (a_n)_n + \mathcal{N} \in \widehat{K}$, we have a sequence $(i'(a_n))_n$ in $\widehat{K}'$. Since $(a_n)_n$ is Cauchy in K , $(i'(a_n))_n$ is Cauchy in $\widehat{K}'$. Let its limit be $\xi' \in \widehat{K}'$.

Define $\varphi : \widehat{K} \rightarrow \widehat{K}' : \xi \mapsto \xi'$. φ is well-defined, by uniqueness of limits. Given $\eta' \in \widehat{K}'$, there exists a sequence $(i'(b_n))_n \subset i'(K)$ which converges to η' . Consider $(b_n)_n \subset K$ and let $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} i(b_n) = \eta \in \widehat{K}$. Then, $\varphi(\eta) = \eta'$ by definition. Hence, φ is surjective. Now, let $\xi_1, \xi_2 \in \widehat{K}$ with associated sequences $(i'(a'_n))_n$ and $(i'(b'_n))_n$. Then, $\xi_1 + \xi_2$ is associated to $(i'(a'_n) + i'(b'_n))_n = (i'(a'_n + b'_n))_n$, since i' is a homomorphism. Similarly, $\xi_1 \xi_2$ is associated to $(i'(a'_n))_n (i'(b'_n))_n = (i'(a'_n b'_n))_n$.

Thus,

$$\varphi(\xi_1 + \xi_2) = \lim(i'(a'_n + b'_n)) = \lim i'(a'_n) + \lim i'(b'_n) = \varphi(\xi_1) + \varphi(\xi_2).$$

Similarly, $\varphi(\xi_1 \xi_2) = \varphi(\xi_1) \varphi(\xi_2)$. Thus, φ is a homomorphism.

Since it is a nontrivial field homomorphism, φ must be injective. Therefore, φ is an isomorphism, and by its very definition, φ makes the diagram below commute.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \widehat{K} & \xrightarrow{\varphi} & \widehat{K}' \\ & \circlearrowleft & \\ & i & \nearrow i' \\ & K & \end{array}$$

□

1.1. ABSOLUTE VALUES

Remark 1.1. The pair $(\widehat{K}, \widehat{|\cdot|})$ is called a **completion** of $(K, |\cdot|)$.

Theorem 1.1.5. *Every Archimedean absolute value on $\mathbb{Q}$ is dependent on the usual one.*

Proof. Let $|\cdot|$ be an Archimedean absolute value on $\mathbb{Q}$. Let $|\cdot|_0$ denote the usual absolute value on $\mathbb{Q}$. Let $m, n \geq 2$ be arbitrary integers and let $t \geq 1$. Expand m^t in powers of n : $m^t = \sum_{i=0}^s c_i n^i$, where $0 \leq c_i < n$, $c_s \neq 0$.

Now, $|c_i| = |1 + 1 + \cdots + 1| \leq c_i |1| = c_i \leq n$ ($\because |1|^2 = |1^2| = |1| \implies |1| = 1$).

Hence, for each $0 \leq i \leq s$, depending on whether $|n| \geq 1$ or $|n| < 1$, we have

$$|m|^t \leq \sum_{i=0}^s |c_i| |n|^i \leq n \sum_{i=0}^s |n|^i \leq n(s+1) \max\{1, |n|^s\}.$$

Since $n^s \leq m^t$, we have $s \ln(n) \leq t \ln(m) \implies s \leq t \frac{\ln(m)}{\ln(n)}$.

Hence,

$$\begin{aligned} |m|^t &\leq n \left(\frac{t \ln(m)}{\ln(n)} + 1 \right) \max\{1, |n|^{\frac{t \ln(m)}{\ln(n)}}\} \\ \implies |m| &\leq n^{1/t} \left(\frac{t \ln(m)}{\ln(n)} + 1 \right)^{1/t} \max\left\{1, |n|^{\frac{\ln(m)}{\ln(n)}}\right\}. \end{aligned}$$

As $t \rightarrow \infty$, we get $|m| \leq \max\left\{1, |n|^{\frac{\ln(m)}{\ln(n)}}\right\}$. Note that we can take t -th root on both sides in the step above since all the quantities above are positive and real.

Suppose $|n| < 1$ for some n . Then by the above inequality, $|m| \leq 1$ for all $m \geq 2$. This contradicts Archimedeanity. Hence, $\forall n \geq 2$ we must have $|n| \geq 1$. Thus, $|m| \leq |n|^{\frac{\ln(m)}{\ln(n)}}$. Interchanging m, n above gives $|n| \leq |m|^{\frac{\ln(n)}{\ln(m)}}$, hence we get $|n| = |m|^{\frac{\ln(n)}{\ln(m)}}$. Hence, if $m > n \geq 2$, then $\frac{\ln(m)}{\ln(n)} > 1$, so $|m| > |n|$. By definition, $|-m| = |m|$. Therefore, $|mb| > |nb| \implies |m| > |n|$. Consequently, if $m/n \in \mathbb{Q}$ satisfies $|m/n|_0 < 1$, then $|m/n| < 1$. Thus, we have shown $|x|_0 < 1 \implies |x| < 1 \forall x \in \mathbb{Q}$, i.e., $|\cdot|$ and $|\cdot|_0$ are dependent. ☐

Up till now, we have restricted ourselves to Archimedean absolute values. Let us now consider nontrivial, non-Archimedean absolute values on a field K . For future convenience, we use the additive presentation of the absolute value: we define

$$v : K \rightarrow \mathbb{R} \cup \{\infty\} \text{ with } v(x) := -\ln|x|.$$

1.1. ABSOLUTE VALUES

Then, the axioms read as follows, for all $x, y \in K$:

1. $v(x) \in \mathbb{R}$ for all $x \neq 0$, and $v(0) = \infty$
2. $v(xy) = v(x) + v(y)$
3. $v(x + y) \geq \min\{v(x), v(y)\}$

Remark 1.2. Note that we only use the additive structure of $\mathbb{R}$ and its ordering, hence we can (and will) generalize this definition later by requiring the target of v to just be an ordered abelian group unioned with a formal symbol ∞ .

Now assuming that v is a non-Archimedean absolute value on K , the set $\mathcal{O}_v := \{x \in K \mid v(x) \geq 0\}$ is a subring of K . This is easy to check: for any $x, y \in \mathcal{O}_v$, we have $v(x \pm y) \geq \min\{v(x), v(\pm y)\} \geq 0$ and $v(xy) = v(x) + v(y) \geq 0$. Hence $x \pm y, xy \in \mathcal{O}_v$. In fact, it is an integral domain: if $xy = 0$, then $\infty = v(xy) = v(x) + v(y) \implies v(x) = \infty$ or $v(y) = \infty$, whence $x = 0$ or $y = 0$. From $v(x^{-1}) = -v(x)$ (recall $|x^{-1}| = |x|^{-1}$), we find that x is a unit in $\mathcal{O}_v$ if and only if $v(x) = 0$, and that for every $x \in K$, either x or x^{-1} or both lie in $\mathcal{O}_v$.

Definition 1.1.5. An integral domain $\mathcal{O}$ of K satisfying $x \in \mathcal{O}$ or $x^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}$ for all $x \in K^\times$ is called a **valuation ring** of K . Thus $\mathcal{O}_v$ is a valuation ring of K .

Moreover, $\mathcal{M}_v := \{x \in K \mid v(x) > 0\} \triangleleft \mathcal{O}_v$, because for any $x \in \mathcal{O}_v, t \in \mathcal{M}_v$, we have $v(xt) = v(x) + v(t) \geq v(t) > 0$, i.e., the product $xt \in \mathcal{M}_v$. Now, notice that x is a unit in $\mathcal{O}_v$ if and only if $x, x^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}_v \iff v(x) \geq 0$ and $v(x^{-1}) \geq 0 \iff v(x) \geq 0$ and $-v(x) \geq 0 \iff v(x) = 0$ (since $v(x^{-1}) = -v(x)$).

Moreover, $\mathcal{M}_v$ is the unique maximal ideal because if $\mathfrak{m} \supsetneq \mathcal{M}_v$ was another, then it must contain a unit, and so $\mathfrak{m} = \mathcal{O}_v$. In summary, $\mathcal{M}_v$ is the unique maximal ideal consisting exactly of the non-units of $\mathcal{O}_v$. Therefore, $\mathcal{O}_v$ is a local ring.

Definition 1.1.6. $\overline{\mathcal{K}}_v := \mathcal{O}_v / \mathcal{M}_v$ is called the **residue class field** of v . The residue class of $a \in \mathcal{O}_v$ is denoted by $\bar{a}$. Note that v is trivial if and only if $\mathcal{O}_v = K$, and hence also $\overline{\mathcal{K}}_v = K$. The group $v(K^\times)$ is called the **value group** of v .

Example 1.3. Consider $K = \mathbb{Q}$ and $v = v_p$, the p -adic valuation. Recall that $v_p(p^\nu \frac{m}{n}) = \nu$. We then have:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{O}_{v_p} &= \{x \in \mathbb{Q} \mid v_p(x) \geq 0\} = \left\{ \frac{a}{b} \in \mathbb{Q} \mid a, b \in \mathbb{Z}, p \nmid b \right\} \text{ and} \\ \mathcal{M}_{v_p} &= \{x \in \mathbb{Q} \mid v_p(x) > 0\} = \left\{ \frac{ap}{b} \in \mathbb{Q} \mid a, b \in \mathbb{Z}, p \nmid b, p \mid a \right\}. \end{aligned}$$

1.1. ABSOLUTE VALUES

Note that $\mathcal{O}_v = \mathbb{Z}_{(p)}$, the localisation of $\mathbb{Z}$ at $p\mathbb{Z}$ and $\mathcal{M}_v = p\mathcal{O}_v = p\mathbb{Z}_{(p)}$. Hence, $\bar{\mathcal{K}}_v = \mathcal{O}_v/\mathcal{M}_v = \mathbb{Z}_{(p)}/p\mathbb{Z}_{(p)} \cong \mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z} \equiv \mathbb{F}_p$.

Example 1.4. Take $k[x]$, where k is a field, and the absolute value is given by

$$|p^\nu f/g|_p = 1/e^\nu, \text{ where } \nu \in \mathbb{Z}, \text{ and } f, g \in k[x] \setminus \{0\} \text{ are not divisible by } p.$$

Now, $v(p^\nu f/g) = -\ln |p^\nu f/g|_p = -\ln(1/e^\nu) = \nu$. Similar to above, we get $\mathcal{O}_v = k[x]_{(p)}$, the localisation of $k[x]$ at the prime ideal $(p) = pk[x]$. The maximal ideal is $pk[x]_{(p)}$, and $\bar{\mathcal{K}}_v = k[x]_{(p)}/pk[x]_{(p)} = k[x]/pk[x]$.

Theorem 1.1.6. *For any $x, y \in K$ with $v(x) < v(y)$, we have $v(x + y) = v(x)$.*

Proof. Suppose not, i.e., there exist some $x, y \in K$ with $v(x) < v(y)$ such that $v(x+y) \neq v(x)$. Now, since $v(x+y) \geq \min\{v(x), v(y)\}$, we must have $v(x+y) > v(x)$. Then, since $v(y) > v(x)$ and $v(x+y) > v(x)$, we get

$$\begin{aligned} v(x) &= v((x+y) + (-y)) \geq \min\{v(x+y), v(-y)\} \\ &= \min\{v(x+y), v(y)\} > v(x). \end{aligned}$$

This is a contradiction. □

Remark 1.3. $b \in \mathcal{O}_v$, $\bar{b} = 0$ in $\bar{\mathcal{K}}_v$ if and only if $b \in \mathcal{M}_v$, i.e., $v(b) > 0$, and $\bar{b} \neq 0$ in $\bar{\mathcal{K}}_v$ if and only if $b \in \mathcal{O}_v$ but $b \notin \mathcal{M}_v$, i.e., $v(b) = 0$.

Lemma 1.1.3. *Given a polynomial $f(x) \in R[x]$, where R is a commutative ring with unity, there exists a polynomial $g(x, y) \in R[x, y]$ such that*

$$f(x + y) = f(x) + yf'(x) + y^2g(x, y).$$

Proof. We have $f(x) = \sum_{i=0}^n a_i x^i$, thus $f(x + y) = \sum_{i=0}^n a_i (x + y)^i$. Hence,

$$\begin{aligned} f(x + y) &= a_0 + \sum_{i=1}^n a_i (x^i + ix^{i-1}y) + \sum_{i=1}^n g_i(x, y)y^2 \text{ for } g_i \in R[x, y], \\ &= \sum_{i=0}^n a_i x^i + \sum_{i=1}^n ia_i x^{i-1}y + g(x, y)y^2, \text{ where } \sum_{i=1}^n g_i(x, y) = g(x, y) \\ &= f(x) + yf'(x) + y^2g(x, y). \end{aligned}$$

□

Theorem 1.1.7 (Hensel's Lemma). *Let K be a field complete with respect to a non-Archimedean absolute value v . Let $f \in \mathcal{O}_v[x]$ be a polynomial and $a_0 \in \mathcal{O}_v$ such that $v(f(a_0)) > 2v(f'(a_0))$. Then, there exists $a \in \mathcal{O}_v$ with $f(a) = 0$ and $v(a - a_0) > v(f'(a_0))$.*

Proof. Let $b_0 = f'(a_0)$ and choose $\varepsilon > 0$ such that $v(f(a_0)) \geq v(b_0^2) + \varepsilon$. This is possible because $v(f(a_0)) > 2v(f'(a_0)) = 2v(b_0) = v(b_0^2)$. Then, $f(a_0) = b_0^2 c_0$, where $c_0 = \frac{f(a_0)}{b_0^2} \in K$ and $v(c_0) \geq \varepsilon$. Set $a_1 := a_0 - b_0 c_0$. By the lemma above, there exists $d_0 \in K$ such that $f(a_1) = f(a_0 - b_0 c_0) = f(a_0) - b_0 c_0 f'(a_1) + (b_0 c_0)^2 d_0 = b_0^2 c_0 d_0$. Since $c_0, b_0, c_0 \in \mathcal{O}_v$, $d_0 \in \mathcal{O}_v$. Therefore,

$$v(f(a_1)) = v(b_0^2 c_0^2 d_0) = v(b_0^2) + 2v(c_0 d_0) \geq v(b_0^2) + 2\varepsilon \quad (1)$$

Applying the same procedure to f' , we get $f'(a_1) = f'(a_0 - b_0 c_0) = f'(a_0) - b_0 c_0 b = b_0 - b_0 c_0 b = b_0(1 - c_0 b) =: b_1$ for some $b \in \mathcal{O}_v$. Now, since $v(1 - c_0 b) = v(1) = 0$, as $v(1) < v(c_0 b)$, we have $v(b_1) = v(b_0) + v(1 - c_0 b) = v(b_0)$. Hence, (1) implies $v(f(a_1)) \geq v(b_1^2) + 2\varepsilon$, i.e., $f(a_1) = b_1^2 c_1$ where $v(c_1) > 2\varepsilon$.

We now repeat the above argument after replacing b_0 with b_1 , a_1 with $a_2 := a_1 - b_1 c_1$, and ε with 2ε , to obtain a b_2 with $f'(a_2) = b_2$ such that $v(b_2) = v(b_0)$ and $f(a_2) = b_2^2 c_2$ for some c_2 with $v(c_2) \geq 2^2 \varepsilon$. This goes as follows:

We have $f(a_1) = b_1^2 c_1$, where $v(c_1) > 2\varepsilon$, so by the lemma above, there exists $d_1 \in K$ with $f(a_2) = f(a_1 - b_1 c_1) = f(a_1) - b_1 c_1 f'(a_2) + (b_1 c_1)^2 d_1 = b_1^2 c_1 d_1$. Since $c_1, b_1, c_1 \in \mathcal{O}_v$, we get $d_1 \in \mathcal{O}_v$. Therefore,

$$v(f(a_2)) = v(b_1^2 c_1^2 d_1) = v(b_1^2) + 2v(c_1 d_1) \geq v(b_1^2) + 4\varepsilon \quad (2)$$

Applying the same procedure to f' , we get $f'(a_2) = f'(a_1 - b_1 c_1) = f'(a_1) - b_1 c_1 b = b_1 - b_1 c_1 b = b_1(1 - c_1 b) =: b_2$ for some $b \in \mathcal{O}_v$. Now, $v(1 - c_1 b) = v(1) = 0$, as $v(1) < v(c_1 b)$, hence we get $v(b_2) = v(b_1) + v(1 - c_1 b) = v(b_1)$. Therefore, (2) implies $v(f(a_2)) \geq v(b_2^2) + 4\varepsilon$, i.e., $f(a_2) = b_2^2 c_2$ where $v(c_2) > 4\varepsilon$. Iteratively continuing, we get a sequence $a_{n+1} = a_n - b_n c_n$, where $f'(a_{n+1}) = b_{n+1}$, $v(b_{n+1}) = v(b_0)$, $f(a_{n+1}) = b_{n+1}^2 c_{n+1}$, and $v(c_{n+1}) \geq 2^{n+1} \varepsilon$.

Claim: $(a_n)_n$ is Cauchy: For $m < n$, we have:

$$\begin{aligned} v(a_n - a_m) &= v\left(\sum_{i=m}^{n-1} (a_{i+1} - a_i)\right) \\ &\geq \min_{m \leq i < n} v(a_{i+1} - a_i) \\ &= \min_{m \leq i < n} v(b_i c_i) \geq v(b_0) + 2^m \varepsilon. \end{aligned}$$

1.1. ABSOLUTE VALUES

Hence, $\lim_{m \rightarrow \infty} v(a_n - a_m) = \infty$, i.e., $\lim_{m \rightarrow \infty} |a_n - a_m| = 0$, since $v(x) = -\ln|x| = \ln(1/|x|)$. Let $a = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} a_n$. Then, since the polynomial f is continuous, $f(a) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f(a_n)$.

Claim: $(b_n)_n \rightarrow f'(a)$: Since $a_n \rightarrow a$, we have $f'(a_n) \rightarrow f'(a)$, i.e., $b_n \rightarrow f'(a)$.

Now, $v(f(a_n)) = v(b_n^2) + v(c_n) \geq 2^n \varepsilon$ for all n . Hence, $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} v(f(a_n)) = \infty$, i.e., $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f(a_n) = 0$, i.e., $f(a) = 0$. Furthermore, $v(f'(a_n)) = v(b_n) = v(b_0) \implies v(f'(a)) = v(b_0)$. From $v(a_n - a_m) \geq v(\sum_{i=m}^{n-1} (a_{i+1} - a_i))$, we get $v(a_n - a_0) \geq v(b_0) + \varepsilon$. Hence, for n sufficiently large $v(a - a_0) = v((a - a_n) + (a_n - a_0)) \geq v(b_0) + \varepsilon > v(b_0) = v(f'(a_0))$. Therefore, our choice $a = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} a_n$ satisfies the assertions of the theorem. $\blacksquare$

Corollary 1.1.7.1. *Let K be a field complete with respect to a non-Archimedean absolute value v . Let $f \in \mathcal{O}_v[X]$ be a polynomial having a simple zero $\bar{a}_0$ in $\bar{\mathcal{K}}_v$, i.e., $\bar{f}(\bar{a}_0) = 0$ and $\bar{f}'(\bar{a}_0) \neq 0$. Then, f has a zero $a \in \mathcal{O}_v$ such that $\bar{a} = \bar{a}_0$ in $\bar{\mathcal{K}}_v$.*

Proof. Since $\bar{f}(\bar{a}_0) = 0$, we have $f(a_0) \in \mathcal{M}_v$, i.e., $v(f(a_0)) > 0$ and $f'(a_0) \notin \mathcal{M}_v$, i.e., $v(f'(a_0)) = 0$. Hence, by the theorem, $\exists a \in \mathcal{O}_v$ such that $f(a) = 0$ and $v(a - a_0) > v(f(a_0)) = 0$, i.e., $a - a_0 \in \mathcal{M}_v$, i.e., $\bar{a} = \bar{a}_0$. $\blacksquare$

Let $(\widehat{K}, \hat{v})$ denote the completion of (K, v) .

Theorem 1.1.8. *Denote by $\mathcal{O}_{\hat{v}}$, $\bar{\mathcal{K}}_{\hat{v}}$ and $\mathcal{O}_v$, $\bar{\mathcal{K}}_v$ the valuation ring and residue class field of $\hat{v}$ and v , respectively. Then, $\bar{\mathcal{K}}_v$, $\bar{\mathcal{K}}_{\hat{v}}$ and $v(K^\times)$, $\hat{v}(\widehat{K}^\times)$ are canonically isomorphic.*

Proof. Consider $\mathcal{O}_{\hat{v}} = \{x \in \widehat{K} : \hat{v}(x) \geq 0\}$.

Thus, $\mathcal{O}_{\hat{v}} \cap K = \{x \in K : \hat{v}(x) \geq 0\} = \{x \in K : v(x) \geq 0\} = \mathcal{O}_v$ since $\hat{v}|_K = v$. Similarly, $\mathcal{M}_{\hat{v}} \cap K = \mathcal{M}_v$. Consider the map $\mathcal{O}_v \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\hat{v}}/\mathcal{M}_{\hat{v}} : a \mapsto \bar{a}$. It is well-defined since $a - b = 0$ in $\mathcal{O}_v \implies a - b \in \mathcal{M}_v \subseteq \mathcal{M}_{\hat{v}}$, thus $\bar{a} = \bar{b}$. It is clear that the map is a ring morphism as well.

We now show surjectivity: $\forall \bar{x} \in \mathcal{O}_{\hat{v}}/\mathcal{M}_{\hat{v}}$, $x + \mathcal{M}_{\hat{v}}$ is an open neighbourhood of x , since it consists of all z such that $\hat{v}(x - z) > 0$, i.e., $\widehat{|x - z|} < 1$. We know that K is dense in $\widehat{K}$, thus $(x + \mathcal{M}_{\hat{v}}) \cap K \neq \emptyset$. Consider $y \in (x + \mathcal{M}_{\hat{v}}) \cap K$, then $y \mapsto \bar{x}$. Hence, given any $\bar{x} \in \mathcal{O}_{\hat{v}}/\mathcal{M}_{\hat{v}}$, $\exists y \in K$ such that $y \mapsto \bar{x}$. Thus, by the first isomorphism theorem, we obtain $\mathcal{O}_v/\mathcal{M}_v \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{O}_{\hat{v}}/\mathcal{M}_{\hat{v}}$; that is $\bar{\mathcal{K}}_v \cong \bar{\mathcal{K}}_{\hat{v}}$.

Consider $v(K^\times) \rightarrow \hat{v}(\widehat{K}^\times)$. This is a group monomorphism as $K^\times \subset \widehat{K}^\times$. To see its surjectivity, take $x \in \widehat{K}^\times$, then $\exists z \in K$ such that $\widehat{|z - x|} < |x|$, i.e.,

$$\hat{v}(z - x) > \hat{v}(x) = v(x) \implies \hat{v}(z) = \hat{v}(x), \text{ implying } \hat{v}(z) = v(x).$$

Therefore, as before, we get $v(K^\times) \xrightarrow{\sim} \hat{v}(\widehat{K}^\times)$. ▀

Definition 1.1.7. An absolute value v is called **discrete** (of rank 1) if $v(K^\times) = (\mathbb{Z}, +)$. Any $\pi \in K$ with $v(\pi) = 1$ is called a **uniformizer** or a **local parameter** for v .

Now, if $v(x) = r$, then $v(x\pi^{-r}) = v(x) - rv(\pi) = v(x) - v(x) = 0$, i.e., $x\pi^{-r} = u$, where u is a unit of $\mathcal{O}_v$. Hence, every $x \in K^\times$ can be written as $x = \pi^r u$. In particular, any $x \in \mathcal{M}_v$ can be written as $x = u\pi^r$, and thus $\mathcal{M}_v = \langle \pi \rangle$. From this it immediately follows that $(\mathcal{M}_v)^n = \langle \pi^n \rangle$. Given any other ideal $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft \mathcal{O}_v$, $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathcal{M}_v$ (every ideal is contained in a maximal ideal and $\mathcal{M}_v$ is the unique maximal ideal of $\mathcal{O}_v$). Thus, $\mathfrak{a}$ is principal. Therefore, $\mathcal{O}_v$ is a principal ideal domain, hence factorial (i.e., a unique factorisation domain).

We now briefly take a detour into [Neu99]. Note that for the rest of this section, we use the term *valuation* in place of *absolute value*. First, we restate (and provide another, more algebraic, proof of Theorem 1.1.4.), with an extra result concerning discrete valuations. We then move on to some other crucial results, including another version of Hensel's Lemma and its corollaries as well as unique extension of a given valuation to an algebraic extension.

Theorem 1.1.9. Suppose v a discrete valuation, and π is a uniformizer, then the nonzero ideals of $\mathcal{O}$ are given by $\mathfrak{p}^n = \pi^n \mathcal{O} = \{x \in K \mid v(x) \geq n\}$, $n \geq 0$. We further have $\mathfrak{p}^n / \mathfrak{p}^{n+1} \cong \mathcal{O} / \mathfrak{p}$.

Proof. Every $x \in K^\times$ can be written as $x = \pi^n u$. In particular, any $x \in \mathfrak{p}$ can be written as $x = u\pi^n$, and thus $\mathfrak{p} = \langle \pi \rangle = \pi \mathcal{O}$. Given any other ideal $\mathfrak{a}$, we have $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$ as every ideal is contained in some maximal ideal and $\mathfrak{p}$ is the unique maximal ideal. Let $x \in \mathfrak{a}$ with smallest possible value $v(x) = n$. Then, $x = \pi^n u$, $u \in \mathcal{O}^\times$. Thus, $\langle \pi^n \rangle = \pi^n \mathcal{O} \subseteq \mathfrak{a}$. Conversely, if $y = \pi^m e \in \mathfrak{a}$ is arbitrary with $e \in \mathcal{O}^\times$, then $v(y) = m \geq n$, hence $y = \pi^n (\pi^{m-n} e) \in \pi^n \mathcal{O}$. Therefore, $\mathfrak{a} = \pi^n \mathcal{O}$. Consider the map $\varphi : \mathfrak{p}^n / \mathfrak{p}^{n+1} \rightarrow \mathcal{O} / \mathfrak{p} : a\pi^n \mapsto a + \mathfrak{p}$. Then, $\ker \varphi = \{a\pi^n \mid a \in \mathcal{O}^\times, a + \mathfrak{p} = \mathfrak{p}\} = \{a\pi^n \mid a \in \mathcal{O}^\times, a \in \mathfrak{p}\}$. Now, $\mathfrak{p} = \pi \mathcal{O}$, hence $a \in \mathfrak{p} \implies a = b\pi$ for some $b \in \mathcal{O}^\times$. Thus, $\ker \varphi = \{(b\pi)\pi^n \mid b \in \mathcal{O}^\times\} = \{b\pi^{n+1} \mid b \in \mathcal{O}^\times\} = \mathfrak{p}^{n+1}$. Hence, $\mathfrak{p}^n / \mathfrak{p}^{n+1} \cong \mathcal{O} / \mathfrak{p}$. ▀

In a discretely valued field K , the chain $\mathcal{O} \supseteq \mathfrak{p}^2 \supseteq \mathfrak{p}^3 \supseteq \dots$ forms a basis of neighborhoods of the zero element. Recall that $\mathfrak{p}^n = \{x \in K : v(x) \geq n\}$. Since K is a discretely valued field, $v(x) \in \mathbb{Z}$, hence $v(x) \geq n \iff v(x) > n - 1$. Thus, $\mathfrak{p}^n = \{x \in K : v(x) \geq n\} = \{x \in K : |x| < 1/q^n\}$, and we clearly have $0 \in \mathfrak{p}^n$

1.1. ABSOLUTE VALUES

and $\mathfrak{p}^n \cap \mathfrak{p}^m = \mathfrak{p}^{\max(n,m)}$. Similarly, $U^{(n)} = 1 + \mathfrak{p}^n$ forms a basis of neighborhoods of $1 \in K^\times$, and we have the chain $\mathcal{O}^\times \supseteq U^{(1)} \supseteq U^{(2)} \supseteq \dots$. Note that $U^{(n)} = \{x \in K^\times : |1 - x| < 1/q^n\}, n > 0$.

Definition 1.1.8. We call $U^{(1)}$ the group of *principal units* and $U^{(n)}$ the *n-th higher unit group*.

Theorem 1.1.10. $\mathcal{O}^\times/U^{(n)} \cong (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n)^\times$ and $U^{(n)}/U^{(n+1)} \cong \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$ for all $n \geq 1$.

Proof. Consider the map $\varphi : \mathcal{O}^\times \rightarrow (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n)^\times : u \mapsto u \bmod \mathfrak{p}^n$. Then $\ker \varphi = \{u \in \mathcal{O}^\times : u \equiv 1 \bmod \mathfrak{p}^n\} = \{u \in \mathcal{O}^\times : u - 1 \in \mathfrak{p}^n\} = \{u \in \mathcal{O}^\times : u \in 1 + \mathfrak{p}^n\} = 1 + \mathfrak{p}^n = U^{(n)}$. To show surjectivity of φ , take an arbitrary $\bar{x} \in (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n)^\times$. Then, there exists $\bar{y} \in (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n)$ such that $xy \equiv 1 \bmod \mathfrak{p}^n$, i.e., $xy - 1 \in \mathfrak{p}^n$. Therefore, $v(xy - 1) \geq n$. Now, $v(xy) = v(xy - 1 + 1)$ and $0 = v(1) < v(xy) \implies v(xy) = v(1) = 0$. Hence, xy is a unit in $\mathcal{O}$. Therefore, $x^{-1} = (x^{-1}y^{-1})y \in \mathcal{O}$, therefore $x \in \mathcal{O}^\times$, thus giving a preimage of $\bar{x}$. By the first isomorphism theorem, $\mathcal{O}^\times/U^{(n)} \cong (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n)^\times$.

Choose a uniformizer π and write $U^{(n)} = 1 + \mathfrak{p}^n = 1 + \pi^n \mathcal{O}$. Consider the map $U^{(n)} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p} : 1 + \pi^n a \mapsto a \bmod \mathfrak{p}$. Then its kernel is $\{1 + \pi^n a \in U^{(n)} : a \in \mathfrak{p}\} = \{u \in U^{(n)} : u - 1 \in \pi^n \mathfrak{p}\} = \mathfrak{p}^{n+1}$, where we let $u = 1 + \pi^n a$. This map is surjective because given any $a \bmod \mathfrak{p}$, we take $1 + \pi^n a \in U^{(n)}$ as its preimage. Hence, $U^{(n)}/U^{(n+1)} \cong \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$. ■

Theorem 1.1.11. Let $\mathcal{O} \subset K$ and $\widehat{\mathcal{O}} \subset \widehat{K}$ be valuation rings corresponding to v and $\widehat{v}$ respectively, with maximal ideals $\mathfrak{p}$ and $\widehat{\mathfrak{p}}$. Then, we have $\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p} \cong \widehat{\mathcal{O}}/\widehat{\mathfrak{p}}$.

If v is discrete then $\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n \cong \widehat{\mathcal{O}}/\widehat{\mathfrak{p}}^n$ for all $n \geq 1$.

Proof. Consider the composite map $\varphi : \mathcal{O} \hookrightarrow \widehat{\mathcal{O}} \twoheadrightarrow \widehat{\mathcal{O}}/\widehat{\mathfrak{p}} : a \mapsto i(a) + \widehat{\mathfrak{p}}$. We first show its surjectivity: take arbitrary $\widehat{x} + \widehat{\mathfrak{p}} \in \widehat{\mathcal{O}}/\widehat{\mathfrak{p}}$ and take a representative sequence $(x_n)_n$ of $\widehat{x}$. Set $\eta := e^{-1}$. Since $i(K)$ is dense in $\widehat{K}$, $i(K) \cap B(x, \eta) \neq \emptyset$, i.e., there exists $a \in K$ such that $|\overline{(x_n)_n} - i(a)| < \eta$, i.e., $\widehat{v}(\widehat{x} - i(a)) > -\ln(\eta) = 1 > 0$, i.e., $\widehat{x} - i(a) \in \widehat{\mathcal{O}}$. Note that $\widehat{x} - i(a) \in \widehat{\mathcal{O}}$ and $\widehat{x} \in \widehat{\mathcal{O}}$ imply $i(a) \in \widehat{\mathcal{O}}$. Thus, $v(a) = \widehat{v}(i(a)) \geq 0$, therefore, $a \in \mathcal{O}$. Now, we know that by definition that $\widehat{v}(\widehat{x} - i(a)) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} v(x_n - a) > 0$, whence $\widehat{x} - i(a) \in \widehat{\mathfrak{p}}$, i.e., $\widehat{x} \equiv i(a) \bmod \widehat{\mathfrak{p}}$, thus proving surjectivity. Consider now the kernel: $\ker \varphi = \{a \in \mathcal{O} : i(a) \in \widehat{\mathfrak{p}}\} = \{a \in \mathcal{O} : \widehat{v}(i(a)) = v(a) > 0\} = \mathfrak{p}$. Hence, we get an isomorphism $\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p} \xrightarrow{\sim} \widehat{\mathcal{O}}/\widehat{\mathfrak{p}}$. We have seen that in the case when v is discrete, $\mathfrak{p} = \langle \pi \rangle = \pi \mathcal{O}$, whence $\mathfrak{p}^n = \langle \pi^n \rangle = \pi^n \mathcal{O}$, where $v(\pi) = 1$.

Claim: In $\widehat{K}$, we have $\widehat{\mathfrak{p}}^n = \langle i(\pi^n) \rangle = i(\pi^n) \widehat{\mathcal{O}}$.

The inclusion $\widehat{\mathfrak{p}^n} \supset \langle i(\pi^n) \rangle$ follows by seeing that given any $i(\pi^n)\widehat{u}$, with $\widehat{u} \in \widehat{\mathcal{O}}$, we have $\widehat{v}(i(\pi^n)\widehat{u}) = n + \widehat{v}(\widehat{u}) \geq n \implies i(\pi^n)\widehat{u} \in \widehat{\mathfrak{p}^n}$. For the converse, suppose $\widehat{u} \in \widehat{\mathfrak{p}^n}$, i.e., $\widehat{v}(\widehat{u}) = l \geq n$. Now, $\widehat{v}(i(\pi^n)) = v(\pi^n) = n$, thus

$$\widehat{v}(\widehat{u}i(\pi^{-l})) = \widehat{v}(\widehat{u}) - \widehat{v}(i(\pi^l)) = l - l = 0.$$

Therefore, $\widehat{u}i(\pi^{-l}) \in \widehat{\mathcal{O}^\times}$ and so $\widehat{u} \in i(\pi^l)\widehat{\mathcal{O}} \subset i(\pi^n)\widehat{\mathcal{O}}$ since $l \geq n$. Hence, $\widehat{\mathfrak{p}^n} \subset \langle i(\pi^n) \rangle$, hence the claim is true. As before, consider the map $\varphi : \mathcal{O} \hookrightarrow \widehat{\mathcal{O}} \twoheadrightarrow \widehat{\mathcal{O}}/\widehat{\mathfrak{p}^n} : a \mapsto i(a) + \widehat{\mathfrak{p}^n}$. The proof of surjectivity follows mutatis mutandis as before by setting $\eta := e^{-n}$. For the kernel, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \ker \varphi &= \{a \in \mathcal{O} : i(a) \in \widehat{\mathfrak{p}^n} = \langle i(\pi^n) \rangle\} \\ &= \{a \in \mathcal{O} : i(a) = \widehat{u}i(\pi^n), \widehat{u} \in \widehat{\mathcal{O}}\} \\ &= \{a \in \mathcal{O} : i(a/\pi^n) = \widehat{u} \in \widehat{\mathcal{O}}\} \\ &= \{a \in \mathcal{O} : a/\pi^n \in \mathcal{O}\} \\ &= \{a \in \mathcal{O} : a \in \pi^n \mathcal{O}\} = \mathfrak{p}^n. \end{aligned}$$

Therefore, we have $\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n \xrightarrow{\sim} \widehat{\mathcal{O}}/\widehat{\mathfrak{p}^n}$. □

Theorem 1.1.12. *Let K be complete with respect to a discrete valuation. The canonical mapping $\varphi : \widehat{\mathcal{O}} = \mathcal{O} \rightarrow \varprojlim_n \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n : x \mapsto (x \bmod \mathfrak{p}, x \bmod \mathfrak{p}^2, \dots)$ is an isomorphism and a homeomorphism (where each $\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n$ has the discrete topology and $\varprojlim \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n$ has the subspace topology induced by the product topology on $\prod_{n=1}^\infty \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n$).*

The same is true for the mapping $\mathcal{O}^\times \rightarrow \varprojlim_n \mathcal{O}^\times/U^{(n)}$, where $U^{(n)} = 1 + \mathfrak{p}^n$.

Proof. Consider $\ker \varphi = \{x \in \mathcal{O} \mid (x \bmod \mathfrak{p}, x \bmod \mathfrak{p}^2, \dots) = 0\} = \{x \in \mathcal{O} \mid x \equiv 0 \bmod \mathfrak{p}^n \forall n\} = \bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mathfrak{p}^n = \bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \pi^n \mathcal{O}$, hence if $x \in \ker \varphi$ then $x \in \pi^n \mathcal{O}$ for all n , i.e., $v(x) \geq n$ for all n , implying $v(x) = \infty \implies x = 0$. Thus, φ is injective. As an aside, the triviality of $\bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mathfrak{p}^n$ also follows from Krull's Intersection Theorem, which states the following:

Theorem. *Let I be a ideal of commutative Noetherian ring R contained in the Jacobson radical and M be a finitely generated R -module. Then, $\bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} I^n M = 0$.*

In our situation, we have a local ring $\mathcal{O}$, hence every ideal is contained in the Jacobson ideal (which is just $\mathfrak{p}$). We put $I = \mathfrak{p}$ and $M = \mathcal{O}$ to conclude $\bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} I^n M = \bigcap_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mathfrak{p}^n = 0$.

For surjectivity, let $\mathfrak{p} = \pi\mathcal{O}$ and $R \subset \mathcal{O}$ be a system of representatives for $\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$ such that $0 \in R$. Now, each $a \bmod \mathfrak{p}^n \in \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n$ can be written uniquely in the form $a = a_0 + a_1\pi + a_2\pi^2 + \dots + a_{n-1}\pi^{n-1} \bmod \mathfrak{p}^n$, $a_i \in R$. Hence, for any $s \in \lim \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n$, we have $s = (s_1, s_2, \dots)$ with $s_{n+1} \equiv s_n \bmod \mathfrak{p}^n$, thus we can write $s_n = a_0 + a_1\pi + a_2\pi^2 + \dots + a_{n-1}\pi^{n-1}$, $n = 1, 2, \dots$. Consider $x = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} a_n\pi^n \in \mathcal{O}$, then $x \equiv s_n \bmod \mathfrak{p}^n \implies \varphi(x) = s$, and so φ is surjective. Hence, φ is an isomorphism. We now show that it is also a homeomorphism; it suffices to show that φ is an open continuous map. Consider the collection $P_n = \prod_{v>n} \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^v = \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^{n+1} \times \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^{n+2} \times \dots$. We claim these form a basis of neighborhoods of the zero element in $\prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n$. To prove this, we first observe that $0 = (0, 0, \dots) \in \prod_{v>n} \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^v$ for any n . Next, suppose V is an arbitrary neighborhood of 0 in $\prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n$. Then, $V = \prod_{n=1}^{\infty} V_n$ where only finitely many $V_n \neq \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n$. Suppose $V_n = \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n$ for all $n > t$, then the basic open set $\{0\} \times \{0\} \times \dots \times \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^{t+1} \times \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^{t+2} \times \dots \cong P_t$ is contained in V . Therefore, (P_n) form a basis of neighborhoods of 0 in $\prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n$, which implies that $T_n := P_n \cap \varprojlim_n \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n$ form a basis of neighborhoods of 0 in $\varprojlim_n \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n$. Now, $\mathcal{O} \supset \mathfrak{p} \supset \mathfrak{p}^2 \supset \mathfrak{p}^3 \supset \dots$ is a basis of neighborhoods in $\mathcal{O}$, as we saw before. Consider $\varphi(\mathfrak{p}^n) = \{(x \bmod \mathfrak{p}, x \bmod \mathfrak{p}^2, \dots) : x \in \mathfrak{p}^n\} = \{(0, 0, \dots, x \bmod \mathfrak{p}^{n+1}, x \bmod \mathfrak{p}^{n+2}, \dots) : x \in \mathfrak{p}^n\} = T_n$, hence φ maps the basis of neighborhoods $\mathfrak{p}^n \in \mathcal{O}$ to the basis of neighborhoods $T_n \in \varprojlim_n \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n$, which implies it is an open map. To check continuity, consider the inverse image $\varphi^{-1}(T_n) = \{x \in \mathcal{O} \mid (x \bmod \mathfrak{p}, x \bmod \mathfrak{p}^2, \dots) \in \prod_{v>n} \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^v\} = \{x \in \mathcal{O} \mid x \equiv 0 \bmod \mathfrak{p}^n\} = \mathfrak{p}^n$. Hence, φ is an open continuous bijection and therefore it is an isomorphism.

To prove the same for $\mathcal{O}^\times \rightarrow \varprojlim_n \mathcal{O}^\times/U^{(n)}$, we simply use the fact that $(\varprojlim_i R_i)^\times = \varprojlim_i R_i^\times$. We prove this below (Lemma 1.1.5). Putting $R_i = \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^i$ and using the fact $\mathcal{O}^\times/U^{(n)} \cong (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n)^\times$, we conclude the theorem. □

Lemma 1.1.4. *Given local rings $(R, \mathfrak{m}_R)$ and $(S, \mathfrak{m}_S)$ with a surjective ring homomorphism $f : R \twoheadrightarrow S$, one obtains a surjective group homomorphism $f^\times : R^\times \twoheadrightarrow S^\times$ by restricting f to $R^\times$.*

Proof. Note that $f^\times$ is well-defined because a ring homomorphism maps units to units. For surjectivity, take an arbitrary $s \in S^\times$ and let its preimage under f be $r \in R$. Consider the inverse t of s in S , i.e., $st = 1$. Suppose the preimage of t under f is $r' \in R$, then we have $f(1) = 1 = st = f(r)f(r') = f(rr') \implies f(1 - rr') = 0 \implies 1 - rr' \in \ker f \subset \mathfrak{J}_R$, the Jacobson radical of R . Thus, r must be a unit, as desired. Hence, $f^\times = f|_{R^\times}$ is a surjection.



Lemma 1.1.5. *Given an inverse system of local rings R_i with surjective transition maps $\lambda_n : R_n \twoheadrightarrow R_{n-1}$, the units of the inverse limit are the inverse limit of the units, i.e., $(\varprojlim_i R_i)^\times = \varprojlim_i R_i^\times$, $i \in \mathbb{N}$, with respect to the transition maps $\lambda_n^\times = \lambda_n|_{R_n^\times} : R_n^\times \twoheadrightarrow R_{n-1}^\times$.*

Proof. First observe that the surjective map $\lambda_n : R_n \twoheadrightarrow R_{n-1}$ restricts to a surjective map $\lambda_n : R_n^\times \twoheadrightarrow R_{n-1}^\times$, by Lemma 1.1.4. Let $x = (x_1, x_2, \dots) \in (\varprojlim_i R_i)^\times$, i.e., there exists $y = (y_1, y_2, \dots) \in (\varprojlim_i R_i)^\times$ such that $xy = (x_1y_1, x_2y_2, \dots) = (1, 1, \dots) \in (\varprojlim_i R_i)^\times$. Therefore, we have $x_iy_i = 1 \in R_i^\times$. To show that $x \in \varprojlim_i R_i^\times$, we need to check that $\lambda_n(x_n) = x_{n-1}$ for all n , but this is clear by the definition of λ_n and the fact that $\lambda_n(R_n^\times) = R_{n-1}^\times$. Therefore, $(\varprojlim_i R_i)^\times \subseteq \varprojlim_i R_i^\times$. For the converse, suppose $x = (x_1, x_2, \dots) \in \varprojlim_i R_i^\times$, i.e., for each $x_i \in R_i$, there exists a $y_i \in R_i$ such that $x_iy_i = 1$. We need to exhibit an inverse for x in $\varprojlim_i R_i$. Consider the element $y = (y_1, y_2, \dots)$, then since $x_ny_n = 1$ for all n , we have $\lambda_n(x_ny_n) = 1 = x_{n-1}y_{n-1}$ for all n . Thus, $\lambda_n(x_ny_n) - x_{n-1}y_{n-1} = \lambda_n(x_n)\lambda_n(y_n) - \lambda_n(x_n)y_{n-1} = \lambda_n(x_n)[\lambda_n(y_n) - y_{n-1}] = 0$. Since $\lambda_n(x_n) = x_{n-1}$ is a unit in R_{n-1} , it follows that $\lambda_n(y_n) - y_{n-1} = 0$, i.e., $\lambda_n(y_n) = y_{n-1}$, yielding $y \in \varprojlim_i R_i$. Thus, y is an inverse for x , and so $x \in (\varprojlim_i R_i)^\times$, which gives $(\varprojlim_i R_i)^\times \supseteq \varprojlim_i R_i^\times$. QED

Definition 1.1.9. A polynomial $f \in \mathcal{O}[x]$ is called **primitive** if $|f| := \max |a_i| = 1$ (this absolute value is actually the Gauss valuation discussed in Corollary 1.3.1.1).

Theorem 1.1.13 (Hensel's Lemma, second version). *Let $f \in \mathcal{O}[x]$ be a primitive polynomial which admits modulo the maximal ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ a factorisation $\overline{f(x)} = \overline{g(x)} \overline{h(x)}$ into relatively prime polynomials $\overline{g(x)}, \overline{h(x)} \in (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})[x]$. Then, f admits a factorisation $f(x) = g(x)h(x)$ where $g(x), h(x) \in \mathcal{O}[x]$ such that $\deg(\overline{g}) = \deg(g)$ and $g \equiv \overline{g} \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$, $h \equiv \overline{h} \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$.*

Proof. Let $d = \deg(f)$, $m = \deg(\overline{g})$. Then, $\deg(\overline{h}) \leq d - m$. Let g_0, h_0 be degree-preserving lifts of $\overline{g(x)}, \overline{h(x)}$ to $\mathcal{O}[x]$. Since $\overline{g(x)}, \overline{h(x)} \in (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})[x]$ are relatively prime, there exist polynomials $\overline{a}, \overline{b} \in (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})[x]$ such that $\overline{a(x)} \overline{g(x)} + \overline{b(x)} \overline{h(x)} = 1$, i.e., $ag_0 + bh_0 \equiv 1 \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$, where a, b are degree-preserving lifts of $\overline{a(x)}, \overline{b(x)}$ to $\mathcal{O}[x]$. Consider now the coefficients of $f - g_0h_0$ and $ag_0 + bh_0 - 1 \in \mathfrak{p}[x]$; pick one with maximum absolute value (minimum valuation) and call it π . Then, $\pi \in \mathfrak{p} \implies |\pi| < 1 \iff v(\pi) \geq 0$.

Construct sequences of polynomials $g_n(x)$ and $h_n(x)$ of the form $g_n(x) = g_0 + p_1\pi + \dots + p_n\pi^n$ and $h_n(x) = h_0 + q_1\pi + \dots + q_n\pi^n$ where $\deg(p_i) < m$ and $\deg(q_i) \leq d - m$,

such that $f \equiv g_{n-1}h_{n-1} \pmod{\pi^n \mathcal{O}}$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$. We do this by induction on n . For $n = 1$, we need to show $f \equiv g_0h_0 \pmod{\pi \mathcal{O}}$, which is equivalent to $f - g_0h_0 \in \pi \mathcal{O} \iff |f - g_0h_0| \leq |\pi|$, which is true by the choice of π . We now assume the congruence for some $n > 1$ and show it for $n+1$. Hence, $f \equiv g_{n-1}h_{n-1} \pmod{\pi^n \mathcal{O}}$. Note that $g_n = g_{n-1} + p_n\pi^n$ and $h_n = h_{n-1} + q_n\pi^n$, therefore, $g_nh_n = g_{n-1}h_{n-1} + (p_nh_{n-1} + q_ng_{n-1})\pi^n + p_nq_n\pi^{2n} \equiv g_{n-1}h_{n-1} + (p_nh_{n-1} + q_ng_{n-1})\pi^n \pmod{\pi^{n+1}\mathcal{O}}$. Hence, $f - g_nh_n \equiv f - (g_{n-1}h_{n-1} + (p_nh_{n-1} + q_ng_{n-1})\pi^n) \pmod{\pi^{n+1}\mathcal{O}}$. We are done if we can show $f - g_{n-1}h_{n-1} \equiv (p_nh_{n-1} + q_ng_{n-1})\pi^n \pmod{\pi^{n+1}\mathcal{O}}$, which is true if we have $\pi^{-n}(f - g_{n-1}h_{n-1}) := f_n \equiv p_nh_{n-1} + q_ng_{n-1} \pmod{\pi \mathcal{O}}$. We now focus our attention on finding p_n and q_n that satisfy the above congruence. It is clear that $g_{n-1} \equiv g_0 \pmod{\pi \mathcal{O}}$ and $h_{n-1} \equiv h_0 \pmod{\pi \mathcal{O}}$, therefore we have $f_n \equiv p_nh_{n-1} + q_ng_{n-1} \equiv p_nh_0 + q_ng_0 \pmod{\pi \mathcal{O}}$. Since $a_0f_0 + b_0h_0 = 1 \pmod{\pi \mathcal{O}}$, we have $a_0g_0f_n + b_0h_0f_n \equiv f_n \pmod{\pi \mathcal{O}}$. We might try putting $p_n = bf_n$ and $q_n = af_n$, but the degrees of p_n and q_n might be larger than m and $d - m$, respectively. Therefore, we divide bf_n by g_0 and write $bf_n = qg_0 + p_n$, where $\deg(p_n) < \deg(g_0) = m$. Since $g_0 \equiv \bar{g} \pmod{p}$ and $\deg(g_0) = \deg(\bar{g})$, the highest coefficient of g_0 is not in $\mathfrak{p}$ and hence is a unit. Therefore $|g_0| = \max\{|\text{coeffs of } g_0|\} \geq 1$, i.e., $g_0 \in \mathcal{O}[x]$. Thus $a_0g_0f_n + b_0h_0f_n \equiv f_n \pmod{\pi \mathcal{O}}$ gives us $f_n \equiv a_0g_0f_n + h_0q_n + h_0p_n = g_0(af_n + h_0q) + h_0p_n \pmod{\pi \mathcal{O}}$. Let $q_n = af_n + h_0q \pmod{\pi \mathcal{O}}$, then $f_n = g_0q_n + h_0p_n \pmod{\pi \mathcal{O}}$. Since $\deg(f_n) \leq d$, $\deg(g_0) = m$ and $\deg(h_0p_n) < d - m + m = d$, we have $\deg(q_n) \leq d - m$. Hence, we have successfully constructed the sequences $g_n(x)$ and $h_n(x)$ with $\deg(p_i) < m$ and $\deg(q_i) \leq d - m$, such that $f \equiv g_{n-1}h_{n-1} \pmod{\pi^n \mathcal{O}}$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

Claim: A Cauchy sequence $(t_n(x))_n$ of bounded degree converges in $\mathcal{O}[x]$.

Let $t_n(x) = a_{n,0} + a_{n,1}x + \dots + a_{n,l}x^l$, where $a_{n,l}$ can be zero. Fix any j and consider the sequence $(a_{n,j})_n \subset \mathcal{O}$. This is Cauchy because $|a_{n+1,j} - a_{n,j}| < |t_{n+1}(x) - t_n(x)| < \varepsilon$, since $(t_n(x))_n$ is Cauchy. The inequality above holds because $|f(x)| = \max\{|a_i|\}$ for any polynomial $f(x)$. Since K is complete, $(a_{n,j})_n$ converges to some $a_j \in K$. Therefore, $|a_{n,j} - a_j| < \varepsilon \forall n \geq n_0$. Moreover, $(a_{n,j})_n \subset \mathcal{O} \implies |a_{n,j}| \leq 1 \forall n \implies \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} |a_{n,j}| \leq 1 \implies |a_j| \leq 1 \implies a_j \in \mathcal{O}$. We will show that $(t_n(x))_n \rightarrow t(x) := a_0 + a_1x + \dots + a_lx^l \in \mathcal{O}[x]$. Consider $|t_n(x) - t(x)| =$

$$|(a_{n,0} + a_{n,1}x + \dots + a_{n,l}x^l) - (a_0 + a_1x + \dots + a_lx^l)| = \max_j |a_{n,j} - a_j| < \varepsilon$$

Thus, $t_n(x) \rightarrow t(x) \in \mathcal{O}[x]$. We will show $(g_n(x))_n$ and $(h_n(x))_n$ are Cauchy and of bounded degree, then apply the claim. Recall that $g_n = g_{n-1} + p_n\pi^n$ and $h_n = h_{n-1} + q_n\pi^n$. Thus $|g_n - g_{n-1}| = |p_n\pi^n| = |\pi|^n |p_n|$. Now, $\pi \in \mathfrak{p} \implies |\pi| < 1$, hence

1.1. ABSOLUTE VALUES

there exists $m_0 \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\forall n \geq m_0$, $|g_n - g_{n-1}| = |\pi|^n |p_n| < \varepsilon$. Hence, $(g_n)_n$ is Cauchy. Similarly, $(h_n)_n$ is also Cauchy. Now, $\deg(g_n) = \deg(g_0 + p_1\pi + \cdots + p_n\pi^n)$, where $\deg(g_n) = m$, $\deg(p_i) < m \implies \deg(g_n) \leq m$. Similarly, $\deg(h_n) = \deg(h_0 + q_1\pi + \cdots + q_n\pi^n)$, where $\deg(h_n) \leq d-m$, and $\deg(q_i) \leq d-m \implies \deg(h_n) \leq d-m$. Therefore, $(g_n)_n$ and $(h_n)_n$ are Cauchy sequences of polynomials of bounded degree, hence they converge to say $g, h \in \mathcal{O}[x]$.

Now, we had proven $f \equiv g_n h_n \pmod{\pi^n \mathcal{O}} \forall n$, i.e., $f - g_n h_n \in \pi^n \mathcal{O} \implies |f - g_n h_n| \leq |\pi|^n \forall n$. Thus $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} |f - g_n h_n| \leq \lim |\pi|^n = 0$ and $|f - \lim g_n h_n| \leq 0 \implies |f - gh| \leq 0 \implies f = gh$. Therefore, we are done if we show that g, h reduce to $\bar{g}, \bar{h} \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$ respectively. Now, $g_n \equiv g_0 \pmod{\pi^n} \forall n$, i.e., $|g_n - g_0| \leq |\pi|^n \forall n$. Thus $\lim |g_n - g_0| \leq \lim (|\pi|^n) = 0 \implies |g - g_0| \leq |\pi| < 1$, i.e., $g - g_0 \in \mathfrak{p} \implies g \equiv g_0 \equiv \bar{g} \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$. Similarly, $h \equiv h_0 \equiv \bar{h} \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$. This finishes the proof of Hensel's Lemma. $\blacksquare$

Corollary 1.1.13.1. *Let K be complete with a non-archimedean valuation $|\cdot|$. Then, for every irreducible polynomial $f(x) = a_0 + a_1x + \cdots + a_nx^n \in K[x]$ with $a_n \neq 0$, we have $|f| = \max\{|a_0|, |a_n|\}$. In particular, $a_n = 1$ and $a_0 \in \mathcal{O} \implies f \in \mathcal{O}[x]$.*

Proof. We first assume $|f| = 1$ and prove the theorem. Now, if $\max\{|a_0|, |a_n|\} = 1$, then $|a_i| \leq 1 \forall i \in \mathbb{N}$, $a_i \in \mathcal{O}$ and $f \in \mathcal{O}[x]$. Let a_r be the first coefficient of f with $|a_r| = 1$. Then,

$$\begin{aligned} f(x) &= a_0 + a_1x + \cdots + a_r x^r + \cdots + a_n x^n \\ &\equiv a_r x^r + a_{r+1} x^{r+1} + \cdots + a_n x^n \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}. \end{aligned}$$

Now $|a_i| < 1 \implies a_i \in \mathfrak{p}$, and we have $a_0 + a_1x + \cdots + a_{r-1}x^{r-1} \equiv 0 \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$. Thus, $f(x) = x^r(a_r + a_{r+1}x + \cdots + a_n x^{n-r}) \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$. Note that we have $|f| = \max\{|a_i|\} = 1$. If $\max_i\{|a_0|, |a_n|\} = 1$, then we are done. Suppose not, i.e., $\max_i\{|a_0|, |a_n|\} < 1$, then $0 < r < n$ and f is reducible mod $p \implies f$ is reducible in $\mathcal{O}$ by Hensel's Lemma. This is a contradiction as f was chosen to be irreducible. Therefore, $\max\{|a_0|, |a_n|\} = 1$, i.e., $|f| = \max\{|a_0|, |a_n|\}$.

Now, for the general case, suppose $|f| = \alpha \in \mathbb{R}$, then $|\frac{1}{\alpha}f| = 1$ and so by the above argument we have $|\frac{1}{\alpha}f| = |\frac{1}{\alpha}f| = \max\{|\frac{1}{\alpha}a_0|, |\frac{1}{\alpha}a_n|\} = \frac{1}{\alpha} \max\{|a_0|, |a_n|\}$, whence it follows that $|f| = \max\{|a_0|, |a_n|\}$. $\blacksquare$

Lemma 1.1.6. *Let K be complete with respect to the non-Archimedean valuation $|\cdot|$ and L/K be an algebraic extension. Let $\mathcal{O}$ be the valuation ring and $\mathcal{O}_L$ be its integral closure in L . Then, we have $\mathcal{O}_L = \{\alpha \in L \mid N_{L/K}(\alpha) \in \mathcal{O}\}$.*

Proof. Claim: $\mathcal{O} = \mathcal{O}_L \cap K$: The containment $\mathcal{O} \subseteq \mathcal{O}_L \cap K$ is immediate. For the reverse containment, let $\alpha \in \mathcal{O}_L \cap K$, then α is integral over $\mathcal{O}$. But $\alpha \in K$ and $\mathcal{O}$ is integrally closed (in its field of fractions K), therefore $\alpha \in \mathcal{O}$. Take any $\alpha \in \mathcal{O}_L$, such that $a_0 + a_1\alpha^1 + \cdots + a_{n-1}\alpha^{n-1} + \alpha^n = 0$, where $a_i \in \mathcal{O}$. Now, $N_{L/K}(\alpha) = \prod_{\sigma} \sigma(\alpha)$, where σ varies over the distinct K -embeddings $L \hookrightarrow \overline{K}$. Since $\alpha \in \mathcal{O}_L$, $\sigma(\alpha) \in \mathcal{O}_L$ for all $\sigma L \hookrightarrow \overline{K}$. Therefore, $N_{L/K}(\alpha) \in \mathcal{O}_L$ and from definition, we know $N_{L/K}(\alpha) \in K$. Thus, by claim, $N_{L/K}(\alpha) \in \mathcal{O}$. This gives $\mathcal{O}_L \subseteq \{\alpha \in L \mid N_{L/K}(\alpha) \in \mathcal{O}\}$. Conversely, if $\alpha \in L^\times$ and $N_{L/K}(\alpha) \in \mathcal{O}$, consider the minimal polynomial of α over K , $m_K^\alpha(x) = x^d + a_{d-1}x^{d-1} + \cdots + a_0 \in K[x]$. Then, by transitivity of the norm, we have $N_{L/K}(\alpha) = N_{K(\alpha)/K} \circ N_{L/K(\alpha)}(\alpha) = N_{K(\alpha)/K}((-1)^d a_0) = ((-1)^d a_0)^m = (-1)^n a_0^m \in \mathcal{O}$, where $m = [L : K(\alpha)]$ and $md = n$. Now, $(-1)^n a_0^m \in \mathcal{O} \implies |a_0|^m \leq 1 \implies |a_0| \leq 1$, and so $\alpha \in \mathcal{O}$. By the previous corollary, this implies $f(\alpha) \in \mathcal{O}[x] \implies \alpha \in \mathcal{O}$, which gives $\{\alpha \in L \mid N_{L/K}(\alpha) \in \mathcal{O}\} \subseteq \mathcal{O}_L$. Hence, we have $\mathcal{O}_L = \{\alpha \in L \mid N_{L/K}(\alpha) \in \mathcal{O}\}$. $\blacksquare$

Corollary 1.1.13.2. *Let A be a complete DVR (discrete valuation ring) with field of fractions K and L/K be a finite extension. Any element $\alpha \in L$ is integral over A if and only if $N_{L/K}(\alpha) \in A$*

Proof. Suppose $\alpha \in L$ is integral over A , i.e., α is in the integral closure of A . Since A is a valuation ring of K , it follows from the above lemma that $N_{L/K}(\alpha) \in A$, as required. Conversely, if $N_{L/K}(\alpha) \in A$, then again by the above lemma, it follows that α is in the integral closure of A , which means $\alpha \in L$ is integral over A . $\blacksquare$

Theorem 1.1.14. *Let K be complete with respect to the valuation $|\cdot|$. Then, $|\cdot|$ may be extended uniquely to a valuation of any given algebraic extension L/K . If $[L : K] = n$, then it is given by $|\alpha|_L := |N_{L/K}(\alpha)|^{1/n}$, equivalently, in additive notation by $v_L(\alpha) := \frac{1}{n}v(N_{L/K}(\alpha))$. In this case, L is again complete.*

Proof. We only prove this for non-Archimedean valuations. For Archimedean valuations, one uses Ostrowski's Theorem and classical analysis. Since every algebraic extension is the union of its finite subextensions, we first show the theorem for a finite extension L/K .

We have to verify that $|\alpha|_L := |N_{L/K}(\alpha)|^{1/n}$ does define a valuation on L :

1. $|\alpha|_L = 0 \iff \alpha = 0$ follows from $|\alpha|_L = 0 \iff |N_{L/K}(\alpha)|^{1/n} = 0 \iff |N_{L/K}(\alpha)| = 0 \iff N_{L/K}(\alpha) = 0 \iff \prod_{\sigma} \sigma(\alpha) = 0 \implies \sigma(\alpha) = 0$ for some $\sigma \implies \alpha = 0$.

2. $|\alpha\beta|_L = |\alpha|_L|\beta|_L$ follows since $N_{L/K}$ is multiplicative.
3. $|\alpha + \beta|_L \leq \max\{|\alpha|_L, |\beta|_L\}$: we will use Lemma 1.1.4 to prove this. We first show that $|\gamma|_L \leq 1 \implies |\gamma + 1|_L \leq 1$. Consider $|\gamma|_L = |N_{L/K}(\gamma)|^{1/n} \leq 1 \iff |N_{L/K}(\gamma)| \leq 1 \iff N_{L/K}(\gamma) \in \mathcal{O} \iff \gamma \in \mathcal{O}_L$ by Lemma 1.1.4. Therefore, since $\gamma \in \mathcal{O}_L$, we also have $\gamma + 1 \in \mathcal{O}_L$, which proves $|\gamma|_L \leq 1 \implies |\gamma + 1|_L \leq 1$. This means that $|\gamma + 1|_L \leq 1 = \max\{|\gamma|_L, 1\}$. Now, assume $|\alpha|_L \leq |\beta|_L$ without loss of generality and put $\gamma = \alpha/\beta$, then by multiplicativity of $|\cdot|_L$, we have $|\gamma|_L \leq 1$; in this case, we have $|\gamma + 1|_L \leq 1 = \max\{|\gamma|_L, 1\}$, i.e., $|\alpha/\beta + 1|_L \leq \max\{|\alpha/\beta|_L, 1\}$. Multiplying throughout by $|\beta|_L$ gives $|\alpha + \beta|_L \leq \max\{|\alpha|_L, |\beta|_L\}$, as desired.

Moreover, the valuation ring associated to $|\cdot|_L$ is the set $\{x \in L : |x|_L = |N_{L/K}(x)|^{1/n} \leq 1\} = \{x \in L : |N_{L/K}(x)| \leq 1\} = \{x \in L : |N_{L/K}(x)| \in \mathcal{O}\} = \mathcal{O}_L$. For uniqueness, suppose there exists another valuation $|\cdot|'_L$ with valuation ring $\mathcal{O}'$. We need only show $\mathcal{O}' = \mathcal{O}_L$. Suppose not, i.e., there exists $\alpha \in \mathcal{O}_L \setminus \mathcal{O}'$. Let $f(x) = a_0 + a_1x + \cdots + x^d$ be the minimal polynomial of α over K , then each $a_i \in \mathcal{O}$. Note that $\alpha \notin \mathcal{O}'$ implies that $\alpha^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}'$, because $\mathcal{O}'$ is a valuation ring. Therefore, α^{-1} is a nonunit in $\mathcal{O}'$ and so belongs to the maximal ideal $\mathcal{M}'$. Now, $f(\alpha) = a_0 + a_1\alpha + \cdots + \alpha^d = 0 \implies \alpha^d = -(a_0 + a_1\alpha + \cdots + a_{d-1}\alpha^{d-1}) \implies 1 = -\alpha^{-d}(a_0 + a_1\alpha + \cdots + a_{d-1}\alpha^{d-1}) \in \mathcal{M}'$, which is a contradiction. Hence, no such $\alpha \in \mathcal{O}_L \setminus \mathcal{O}'$ exists, i.e., $\mathcal{O}_L \subseteq \mathcal{O}'$. This inclusion is equivalent to saying $|\alpha|_L \leq 1 \implies |\alpha|'_L \leq 1$, i.e., $|\cdot|'_L$ and $|\cdot|_L$ are equivalent.

Note L is complete by virtue of being a finite dimensional normed linear space over a complete field.

For the general case, we write $L = \bigcup_n L_n$ where each $[L_n : K]$ is finite. To show the valuation is well-defined, we take $\alpha \in L_n \subset L_m$ (all extensions finite) and show that $|\alpha|_{L_n} = |\alpha|_{L_m}$. Let $[L_n : K] = d$ and $[L_m : L_n] = t$, then we have $[L_m : K] = dt$. We then $|\alpha|_{L_m} = |N_{L_m/K}(\alpha)|^{1/dt} = |(N_{L_n/K}(\alpha))^t|^{1/dt} = |N_{L_n/K}(\alpha)|^{1/d} = |\alpha|_{L_n}$. Therefore, $|\cdot|_L$ is well-defined for any algebraic extension L/K . $\blacksquare$

1.2 General Valuations

Definition 1.2.1. We define an **ordered abelian group** as an abelian group $(\Gamma, +, 0)$, with a binary relation $\leq$ on Γ such that, for any δ, γ and $\lambda \in \Gamma$, we have:

- (1) $\gamma \leq \gamma$
- (2) $\gamma \leq \delta, \delta \leq \gamma \implies \gamma = \delta$
- (3) $\gamma \leq \delta, \delta \leq \lambda \implies \gamma \leq \lambda$
- (4) $\gamma \leq \delta$ or $\delta \leq \gamma$
- (5) $\gamma \leq \delta \implies \gamma + \lambda \leq \delta + \lambda$.

Definition 1.2.2. A subgroup $\Delta \subseteq \Gamma$ is **convex** if for any $\gamma \in \Gamma$ satisfying $0 \leq \gamma \leq \delta$ with $\delta \in \Delta$, we have $\gamma \in \Delta$.

Lemma 1.2.1. *The collection of all proper convex subgroups of Γ is linearly ordered by inclusion.*

Proof. Given convex subgroups $A, B \subseteq \Gamma$, if $A \subset B$ or $B \subset A$, we are done. Suppose not; pick $a \in A \setminus B$ and $b \in B \setminus A$ and assume without loss of generality that $0 \leq a, b$ (otherwise we work with $-a$ or $-b$). Now, either $a \leq b$ or $a \geq b$. If $a \leq b$, then by convexity $a \in B$, a contradiction. If $a \geq b$, then by convexity $b \in A$, again a contradiction. $\blacksquare$

The order type of this collection is called the **rank** of Γ . Hence, if there are exactly n proper convex subgroups of Γ , then Γ is of rank n . In particular, if $\{0\}$ is the only proper convex subgroup of Γ , then Γ is of rank 1.

Definition 1.2.3. An ordering $\leq$ of an ordered abelian group Γ is **Archimedean** if $\forall \gamma, \varepsilon \in \Gamma$ with $\varepsilon > 0$, $\exists n \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\gamma \leq n\varepsilon$.

Lemma 1.2.2. *An Archimedean ordered abelian group Γ has rank 1.*

Proof. We need only show that Γ admits no nontrivial proper convex subgroups. Proceeding by contradiction, suppose $\Delta \subset \Gamma$ is such a subgroup and let $\delta \in \Delta$. Given any $\gamma \in \Gamma$, $\exists n \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $\gamma \leq n\delta$, since Γ is Archimedean. Since $\delta \in \Delta$, we have $n\delta = \delta + \delta + \cdots + \delta \in \Delta$, by virtue of Δ being a subgroup. Then, by convexity of Δ , we have $\gamma \in \Delta$ i.e., $\Gamma \subseteq \Delta \implies \Gamma = \Delta$. This is the required contradiction, as Δ was assumed to be a proper subgroup. $\blacksquare$

Lemma 1.2.3. *Every nontrivial subgroup Δ of $(\mathbb{R}, +, 0)$ is Archimedean with respect to the canonical ordering $\leq$ induced from $\mathbb{R}$.*

Proof. Let $\gamma, \varepsilon \in \Delta$, $\varepsilon > 0$. Then, $\gamma, \varepsilon \in \mathbb{R}$ and $\leq$ is Archimedean over $\mathbb{R}$, since $\gamma \leq n\varepsilon$ for $n = \lfloor \gamma/\varepsilon \rfloor + 1$. Now, since Δ is a subgroup and $\varepsilon \in \Delta$, we get $n\varepsilon \in \Delta$. Hence, $\gamma \leq n\varepsilon$ in Δ and so Δ is Archimedean. Therefore, Δ has rank 1, except for $\Delta = \{0\}$. $\blacksquare$

The converse is also true:

Lemma 1.2.4. *An ordered abelian group Γ of rank 1 is order-isomorphic to a non-trivial subgroup of $(\mathbb{R}, +, 0)$ with the canonical ordering $\leq$ induced from $\mathbb{R}$.*

Proof. We first show that a rank-one ordered group Γ is Archimedean.

Given $\varepsilon \in \Gamma$, $\varepsilon > 0$, consider $\Delta := \{\gamma \in \Gamma : -n\varepsilon \leq \gamma \leq n\varepsilon \text{ for some } n \in \mathbb{N}\}$. Clearly, $0 \in \Delta$ and $-\delta \in \Delta$ whenever $\delta \in \Delta$. Suppose $\delta_1, \delta_2 \in \Delta$, then $\pm\delta_1 \leq n_1\varepsilon$ and $\pm\delta_2 \leq n_2\varepsilon$, implying $\pm(\delta_1 + \delta_2) \leq (n_1 + n_2)\varepsilon$, so $\delta_1 + \delta_2 \in \Delta$. Hence, Δ is a subgroup. Convexity follows because given any $\delta \in \Delta$ and $0 \leq \tau \leq \delta$, we have $\tau \leq \delta \leq n\varepsilon \implies \tau \in \Delta$. Now, $\varepsilon \in \Delta$ and $\varepsilon \neq 0$, but Γ has rank one, i.e., $\Gamma = \Delta$. Therefore, Γ is Archimedean since Δ is (by definition). Fix any positive $\varepsilon \in \Gamma$. For each $\alpha \in \Gamma$, let

$$L(\alpha) = \{m/n \in \mathbb{Q} \mid n > 0, m \leq n\alpha\} \text{ and } U(\alpha) = \{m/n \in \mathbb{Q} \mid n > 0, m \geq n\alpha\}.$$

Recall: A *Dedekind cut* is a subset X of $\mathbb{Q}$ such that:

- a) $\emptyset \neq X \subseteq \mathbb{Q}$, b) $q \in X, r < q \implies r \in X$, c) X has no largest member.

The real number associated to a Dedekind cut X is given by $x \in \mathbb{R}$ such that $X = \{\gamma \in \mathbb{Q} \mid \gamma \leq x\} = \{m/n \in \mathbb{Q} \mid m \leq nx\}$. In the sequel, we fix any positive $\varepsilon \in \Gamma$. For each $\alpha \in \Gamma$, let $L(\alpha) = \{m/n \in \mathbb{N} \mid n > 0, m\varepsilon \leq n\alpha\}$ and $U(\alpha) = \{m/n \in \mathbb{N} \mid n > 0, m\varepsilon \geq n\alpha\}$.

Claim: For each $\alpha \in \Gamma$, $L(\alpha)$ and $U(\alpha)$ define a Dedekind cut.

Since Γ is ordered, either $m\varepsilon \leq n\alpha$ or $m\varepsilon \geq n\alpha$, i.e., every $m/n \in \mathbb{Q}$ lies in $L(\alpha)$ or $U(\alpha)$; i.e., $L(\alpha) \cup U(\alpha) = \mathbb{Q}$. Clearly, $L(\alpha) \neq \mathbb{Q}$, otherwise $U(\alpha) = \emptyset$ and $m\varepsilon \leq \alpha$ for all $m \in \mathbb{Z}$, which contradicts the Archimedean property. Similarly, $U(\alpha) \neq \emptyset$. Now, let $m/n \in L(\alpha)$ and $m'/n' \in U(\alpha)$, then $m\varepsilon \leq n\alpha$ and $m'\varepsilon \geq n'\alpha$, hence $mn'\varepsilon \leq n'n\varepsilon = nn'\alpha \leq nm'\varepsilon$, which gives $mn' \leq m'n \implies m/n \leq m'/n'$, i.e., for all $\beta \in L(\alpha)$ and $\beta' \in U(\alpha)$, we have $\beta \leq \beta'$. Consider $q \in L(\alpha)$, i.e., $q\varepsilon \leq \alpha$, hence

for every $r < q$, we have $r\varepsilon \leq q\varepsilon \leq \alpha \implies r \in L(\alpha)$. Thus, $L(\alpha)$ is a Dedekind cut. Let its associated real number be $r(\alpha)$. Consider the map $\Gamma \rightarrow (\mathbb{R}, +, 0) : \alpha \mapsto r(\alpha)$. Clearly, $\alpha \leq \beta \implies L(\alpha) \subseteq L(\beta) \implies r(\alpha) \leq r(\beta)$.

Claim: This map is a group monomorphism.

For $\alpha, \beta \in \Gamma$, let $m/n \in L(\alpha)$ and $m'/n' \in L(\beta)$. Thus, $m/n \leq \alpha/\varepsilon$ and $m'/n' \leq \beta/\varepsilon$. Now, we have $m'/n' \leq \beta/\varepsilon$ if and only if $m'n/n' \leq \beta/\varepsilon$ and similarly, $m/n \leq \alpha/\varepsilon$ if and only if $mn'/nn' \leq \alpha/\varepsilon$. Thus, after replacing m by mn' and m' by $m'n$, we get the same denominators. Hence, we may assume $n = n'$ without loss of generality. Thus, $m\varepsilon \leq n\alpha$ and $m'\varepsilon \leq n\beta$, which implies $(m + m')\varepsilon \leq n(\alpha + \beta)$, i.e., $(m + m')/n \in L(\alpha + \beta)$. Hence, $r(\alpha + \beta) \geq r(\alpha) + r(\beta)$. Similarly, $U(\alpha) + U(\beta) \subseteq U(\alpha + \beta)$ implies $r(\alpha + \beta) \leq r(\alpha) + r(\beta)$, i.e., $r(U(\alpha + \beta)) = r(U(\alpha)) + r(U(\beta))$. Thus, r is a group homomorphism.

Now, take $\alpha \in \ker(r)$, i.e., $0 = r(\alpha) = \sup L(\alpha) = \inf U(\alpha)$. Hence, $-1/n \in L(\alpha)$ and $1/n \in U(\alpha)$ for all $n > 0$. Thus, $-\varepsilon \leq n\alpha \leq \varepsilon$ for all $n > 0$, which implies $\alpha = 0$, since Γ is Archimedean. Hence r has trivial kernel, and this proves the claim.

Since we have an order-preserving group monomorphism $\Gamma \hookrightarrow \mathbb{R}$, Γ is order-isomorphic to a nontrivial subgroup, namely its image, of $(\mathbb{R}, +, 0)$ with the canonical ordering $\leq$ induced from $\mathbb{R}$.

■

Hence, combining the previous two lemmas, we obtain:

Theorem 1.2.1. *An ordered abelian group Γ has rank 1 if and only if it is order-isomorphic to a nontrivial subgroup of $(\mathbb{R}, +, 0)$ with the canonical ordering $\leq$ induced from $\mathbb{R}$.*

■

Lemma 1.2.5. *Let Γ be an ordered abelian group and $\Delta \subseteq \Gamma$ be convex. Then, Γ/Δ can be made into ordered group by declaring $\gamma + \Delta \leq \gamma' + \Delta$ if and only if $\gamma < \gamma'$ or $\gamma \equiv \gamma' \pmod{\Delta}$.*

Proof. Note that $\Delta \triangleleft \Gamma$ (since Γ is abelian) so Γ/Δ is well-defined as a group. To check the independence of representatives, take $s \equiv \gamma \pmod{\Delta}$ and $\gamma + \Delta < \gamma' + \Delta$. We will show $s + \Delta < s' + \Delta$. Let $s - \gamma \in \Delta$ and $s' - \gamma' \in \Delta$. Now, $\gamma < \gamma'$ implies $-\gamma < -\gamma'$, so $s - \gamma < s' - \gamma' \in \Delta$. Now, $s - \gamma < s' - \gamma'$ implies $-(s - \gamma) < -(s' - \gamma') \in \Delta$, which gives $s' - \gamma' < s - \gamma \in \Delta$. From these two inequalities, we get $(s' - s) + (s' - \gamma') \in \Delta$, implying $s' - s \in \Delta$. Moreover, $s' \equiv \gamma' \pmod{\Delta}$ and $\gamma < \gamma'$, so $s + \Delta < s' + \Delta$. ■

1.2. GENERAL VALUATIONS

Given two ordered abelian groups Γ and Δ , we can order the direct product lexicographically as $(r, s) \leq (r', s')$ if and only if $r \leq r'$ or $r = r'$ and $s \leq s'$ for $r \in \Gamma$ and $s \in \Delta$. Clearly, $\{0\} \times \Delta$ is a convex subgroup, which is order isomorphic to Δ .

Definition 1.2.4. Let Γ be an ordered abelian group and ∞ be a symbol satisfying $\infty = \infty + r = r + \infty = \infty + \infty \neq r \in \Gamma$. We define a **valuation** v on a field K as a surjective map $v : K \twoheadrightarrow \Gamma \cup \{\infty\}$ such that $\forall x, y \in K$:

- i) $v(0) = \infty \iff x = 0$,
- ii) $v(xy) = v(x) + v(y)$,
- iii) $v(x + y) \geq \min\{v(x), v(y)\}$.

- If $\Gamma = \{0\}$, we call v the *trivial valuation*.
- If Γ has rank 1, we call v a *rank-1 valuation*.
- In general, the rank of v is defined as the rank of the value group $v(K^\times)$.

As earlier, we get $v(1) = 0$, $v(x^{-1}) = -v(x)$, $v(-x) = v(x)$, and $v(x) < v(y) \implies v(x + y) = v(x)$. The set $\mathcal{O}_v := \{x \in K \mid v(x) \geq 0\}$ is a valuation ring of K . The group of units is given by $\mathcal{O}_v^\times = \{x \in K \mid v(x) = 0\}$, and the set of all nonunits $M_v = \{x \in K \mid v(x) > 0\}$ is the unique maximal ideal of $\mathcal{O}_v$. We define the **residue class field** of v as $\bar{K}_v = \mathcal{O}_v/M_v$. If K is a subfield of L and w is a valuation on L , we say w **extends** v if $w|_K = v$.

Example 1.5. We define the degree valuation v_∞ on $K[x]$, K a field, as $v_\infty(0) = \infty$ and $v_\infty(f/g) = \deg(g) - \deg(f)$. (Note that we set $v_\infty(K) = 0$.)

Clearly, v_∞ is a valuation. Now, f/g is a unit if and only if $v_\infty(f/g) = 0$, i.e., $\deg(f) = \deg(g)$. Hence, if $f = \sum_{i=0}^n c_i x^i$ with $c_i \in k$ and $c_n \neq 0$, then $f(x)/x^n$ is a unit. Since $K \subseteq \mathcal{O}_{v_\infty}$ and $K \cap \mathcal{M}_{v_\infty} = \{0\}$, we can identify K with its image in the residue class field. Moreover, $\overline{f(x)/x^n} = c_n$ because

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{f(x)}{x^n} - c_n &= \frac{f(x) - c_n x^n}{x^n} = \frac{\sum_{i=0}^{n-1} c_i x^i}{x^n} \\ \implies v\left(\frac{f(x)}{x^n} - c_n\right) &= n - (n-1) = 1 > 0 \\ \implies \frac{f(x)}{x^n} - c_n &\in \mathcal{M}_v \implies \overline{\frac{f(x)}{x^n}} = \bar{c}_n = c_n. \end{aligned}$$

Therefore, $\mathcal{O}_{v_\infty} = \{f/g : \deg(g) \geq \deg(f)\}$ and $\mathcal{M}_{v_\infty} = \{f/g : \deg(g) > \deg(f)\}$. Consider $\bar{0} \neq \overline{f/g} \in \overline{\mathcal{K}_{v_\infty}} = \mathcal{O}_{v_\infty}/\mathcal{M}_{v_\infty}$, i.e., $v_\infty(f/g) = 0$, i.e., $\deg(g) = \deg(f)$. Thus, if $f = \sum_{i=0}^n a_i x^i$ and $g = \sum_{i=0}^n b_i x^i$, then $\overline{f/g} = a_0/b_0$, by the same argument as above, since $f/g = \frac{f/x^n}{g/x^n}$. Hence, we have $\overline{\mathcal{K}_{v_\infty}} = \{a/b : a \in K, b \in K^\times\} = K$.

Theorem 1.2.2. *Let $\mathcal{O} \subseteq K$ be a valuation ring of K . There exists a valuation v on K such that $\mathcal{O} = \mathcal{O}_v$.*

Proof. We have $\mathcal{O}^\times \leq K^\times$. Consider $\Gamma = K^\times/\mathcal{O}^\times$ with operation $x\mathcal{O}^\times + y\mathcal{O}^\times := xy\mathcal{O}^\times$. Define a binary relation $\leq$ on Γ by declaring $\bar{x} = x\mathcal{O}^\times \leq y\mathcal{O}^\times = \bar{y}$ if and only if $y/x \in \mathcal{O}$. This makes Γ into an abelian ordered group: for all $\bar{\gamma}, \bar{\delta}, \bar{\lambda} \in \Gamma$, we have:

1. $\bar{\gamma} \leq \bar{\gamma}$ because $\gamma/\gamma = 1 \in \mathcal{O}^\times$.
2. $\bar{\gamma} \leq \bar{\delta}$ and $\bar{\delta} \leq \bar{\gamma}$ implies $\gamma/\delta \in \mathcal{O}$ and $\delta/\gamma \in \mathcal{O} \implies \gamma$ and δ are units, i.e., $\gamma, \delta \in \mathcal{O}^\times \implies \gamma\delta \in \mathcal{O}^\times \implies \bar{\gamma} = \bar{\delta}$.
3. $\bar{\gamma} \leq \bar{\delta}, \bar{\delta} \leq \bar{\lambda} \implies \gamma/\delta \in \mathcal{O}$ and $\delta/\lambda \in \mathcal{O} \implies (\gamma/\delta)(\delta/\lambda) = \gamma/\lambda \in \mathcal{O} \implies \bar{\gamma} \leq \bar{\lambda}$.
4. $\bar{\gamma} \leq \bar{\delta}$ or $\bar{\delta} \leq \bar{\gamma}$ because either $\gamma/\delta \in \mathcal{O}$ or $\delta/\gamma \in \mathcal{O}$ (since $\mathcal{O}$ is a valuation ring).
5. $\bar{\gamma} \leq \bar{\delta} \implies \gamma/\delta \in \mathcal{O}$. Now, $\bar{\gamma} + \bar{\lambda} = \overline{\gamma\lambda}$ and $\gamma\lambda/\delta\lambda = \gamma/\delta \in \mathcal{O}$, i.e., $\overline{\gamma\lambda} \leq \overline{\delta\lambda}$, i.e., $\bar{\gamma} + \bar{\lambda} \leq \bar{\delta} + \bar{\lambda}$.

Thus, all axioms of an abelian ordered group hold. We now define a valuation $v(x) := x\mathcal{O}^\times \in \Gamma$, for $x \in K^\times$ and $v(0) := \infty$. Then $v(xy) = v(x) + v(y)$, by definition. If $v(x) \leq v(y)$, then $y/x \in \mathcal{O} \implies (x+y)/x = 1 + y/x \in \mathcal{O}$. Thus, $v(x+y) \geq v(x) = \min\{v(x), v(y)\}$. Hence, v is a well-defined valuation. Furthermore, $\mathcal{O}_v = \{x \in K : v(x) \geq 0\} = \{x \in K : x/1 \in \mathcal{O}\} = \mathcal{O}$. ▀

Now, $\mathcal{M} := \mathcal{O} \setminus \mathcal{O}^\times$ is the unique maximal ideal of $\mathcal{O}$. This is because $\mathcal{O} = \mathcal{O}_v$ and we have already seen in this case that $\mathcal{M}$ (previously called $\mathcal{M}_v$) is the unique maximal ideal of $\mathcal{O} \setminus \mathcal{O}^\times$. We define the **rank** of $\mathcal{O}$ as $\text{rank}(\Gamma)$.

Example 1.6. Let $\mathcal{O} = K$. Then, $\mathcal{O}^\times = K^\times$ and $\Gamma = \{0\}$, i.e., $v(x) = 0 \ \forall x \neq 0$, and thus v is the trivial valuation. In particular, the only valuation ring of a finite field is the trivial one.

1.2. GENERAL VALUATIONS

Definition 1.2.5. Two valuations $v_i : K \rightarrow \Gamma_i \cup \{\infty\}$ ($i = 1, 2$) are **equivalent** if $\mathcal{O}_{v_1} = \mathcal{O}_{v_2}$.

Theorem 1.2.3. Two valuations $v_i : K \rightarrow \Gamma_i \cup \{\infty\}$ ($i = 1, 2$) are equivalent if and only if there exists an order-preserving isomorphism $\rho : \Gamma_1 \rightarrow \Gamma_2$ such that $\rho \circ v_1 = v_2$.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Gamma_1 & \xrightarrow{\rho} & \Gamma_2 \\ & \circlearrowleft & \\ & K & \end{array}$$

$v_1 \swarrow \quad \searrow v_2$

Proof. $\implies$: Note that $v_i : K^\times \rightarrow \Gamma_i$ is a surjective group morphism with kernel $\mathcal{O}_{v_i}^\times$; thus it induces an isomorphism $\tau_i : K^\times / \mathcal{O}_{v_i}^\times \xrightarrow{\sim} \Gamma_i$ satisfying $\tau_i(x \mathcal{O}_{v_i}^\times) = v_i(x)$. By hypothesis, $\mathcal{O}_{v_1} = \mathcal{O}_{v_2}$, hence $K^\times / \mathcal{O}_{v_1}^\times \cong K^\times / \mathcal{O}_{v_2}^\times$ by the map $\rho = \tau_2 \circ \tau_1^{-1}$, i.e., $\Gamma_1 \cong \Gamma_2$.

$\impliedby$: If there exists an order-preserving isomorphism $\rho : \Gamma_1 \xrightarrow{\sim} \Gamma_2$, then we have: $\mathcal{O}_{v_1} = \{x \in K \mid v_1(x) \geq 0\} = \{\rho(x) \in \Gamma_2 : (\rho \circ v_1)(x) \geq 0\} = \{x \in K : v_2(x) \geq 0\} = \mathcal{O}_{v_2}$, since ρ is an isomorphism. $\blacksquare$

Hence, valuation rings of K correspond one-to-one to valuations of K up to an order-isomorphism of the value group.

Theorem 1.2.4. (a) Every nontrivial valuation on $\mathbb{Q}$ is a p -adic valuation for some rational prime p .

(b) Every nontrivial valuation on $k[x]$, trivial on k , is either the degree valuation v_∞ or a p -adic valuation for some irreducible polynomial $p \in k[x]$.

Proof. Let K be either $\mathbb{Q}$ or $k[x]$ and let v be some nontrivial valuation on K . Then, $\mathcal{O}_v \neq K$. In (b), v is trivial on k , thus $k \subseteq \mathcal{O}_v$. We will write $\mathcal{O}$ instead of $\mathcal{O}_v$ in the sequel.

(a) For any valuation v , $v(1) = v(1) + v(1) \implies v(1) = 0$, i.e., $1 \in \mathcal{O}$, so $\mathbb{Z} \subseteq \mathcal{O}$.

Since $\mathcal{O} \neq \mathbb{Q}$, there exists a prime $p \in \mathcal{M}$. Let $q \neq p$ be another prime, then by Bézout's Lemma, there exist $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $ap + bq = 1$. Now, $0 = v(ap + bq) \geq \min\{v(ap), v(bq)\}$. Thus, $v(ap) \geq v(bq)$ since $v(a) + v(b) > 0$ ($\because p \notin \mathcal{M}$ and $a \in \mathbb{Z} \subset \mathcal{O}$). Therefore, $0 \geq v(bq) \implies 0 = v(bq) = v(b) + v(q)$. Since $b \in \mathbb{Z} \subseteq \mathcal{O}$, $v(b) \geq 0$, i.e., $v(q) = -v(b) \leq 0 \implies q \notin \mathcal{M}$. Hence, all primes other than p are units in $\mathcal{O}$. Now, given a/b with $\gcd(a, b) = 1$, we will show $a/b \in \mathcal{O}$ if and only if $p \nmid b$.

Claim: $v(a/b) = v(a) - v(b) \geq 0$ if and only if $v(a) \geq v(b)$.

Suppose $b = \prod_i q_i^{t_i}$. If $p \nmid b$, then all q_i are units in $\mathcal{O}$. Thus, $v(q_i) = 0$ and so $v(b) = \sum_i t_i v(q_i) = 0$. Thus, $v(a/b) = v(a) - v(b) = v(a) \geq 0$, since $a \in \mathbb{Z}$. Conversely, if $a/b \in \mathcal{O}$, then $v(a) \geq v(b)$. Now, if $p \mid b$, then $v(b) = \sum_{q_j \neq p} t_j v(q_j) + tv(p) = tv(p) > 0$. Thus, $v(a) \geq v(b) \implies v(a) > 0$. Since $\gcd(a, b) = 1$, we have $p \nmid a$, but then, by the same argument, $v(a) = \sum t'_j v(q'_j) = 0$, which is a contradiction. Hence, $p \nmid b$. Therefore, $\mathcal{O} = \mathbb{Z}_{(p)}$ and so v is the p -adic valuation v_p .

- (b) If $x \in \mathcal{O}$, then $k[x] \subseteq \mathcal{O}$ and we proceed as in (a), replacing $\mathbb{Z}$ by $k[x]$ and get $v = v_p$ for some irreducible polynomial p . If $x \notin \mathcal{O}$, then $x^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}$ (property of a valuation ring). Consider $v(x^{-1})$. We have $x \notin \mathcal{O} \implies v(x) < 0 \implies -v(x) > 0 \implies v(x^{-1}) > 0$, i.e., $x^{-1} \in \mathcal{M}$. Now, for $0 \leq n < m$, $mv(x) = v(x^m) < v(x^n) = nv(x)$ [since $v(x) < 0$]. Since $v(a) = 0 \forall a \in k^\times$, we have $v(a_n x^n + \cdots + a_0) = v(a_n x^n)$, because $v\left(\sum_{i=0}^{n-1} a_i x^i\right) \geq \min\{v(a_i x^i)\} = \min\{v(x^i)\}_{i=1}^{n-1}$ and $v(x) < v(y) \implies v(x+y) = v(x)$, (for our case, x corresponds to $a_n x^n$ and y corresponds to $\sum_{i=0}^{n-1} a_i x^i$.) Thus, $v(a_n x^n + \cdots + a_0) = v(a_n x^n) = v(a_n) + v(x^n) = v(x^n) = nv(x)$. Hence, for any $a_n x^n + \cdots + a_0 \in k[x]$, we get $v(a_n x^n + \cdots + a_0) = nv(x)$, i.e., $v(k[x]^\times) = \mathbb{Z}v(x)$. Thus, $v(x) \mapsto -1$ gives an isomorphism $v(k[x]^\times) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathbb{Z}$.

□

Corollary 1.2.4.1. *Let (K, v) be a complete nonarchimedean real field of characteristic zero with finite residue class field of characteristic q . Then, the restriction of the valuation $v|_{\mathbb{Q}}$ to the rational integers $\mathbb{Q}$ is precisely the q -adic valuation. Moreover, $v(q) = e(K/\mathbb{Q})$, the ramification index (defined more generally in 1.5.2) of this extension.*

Proof. In this case, we provide a different, more algebraic proof of the fact that all rational primes other than q are units in $\mathcal{O}$, as seen in the preceding theorem.

By the theorem, the restriction $v|_{\mathbb{Q}}$ is an p -adic valuation for some prime p . We will show that $p = q = \text{char}(\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})$. Since the residue class field is finite and of characteristic q , we have a field extension $\mathbb{F}_q = \mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z} \subset \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$. This is an integral extension and so the maximal ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ contracts to the maximal ideal $q\mathbb{Z}$, i.e., $\mathfrak{p} \cap \mathbb{Z} = q\mathbb{Z}$. Note that since $q \in \mathfrak{p}$, we have $v(q) > 0$. Suppose there exists a rational prime $l \neq q$ which is not a unit, i.e., its extension $l^e \subset \mathfrak{p}$. We contract back to get $l^e \subset \mathfrak{p}^c = q\mathbb{Z}$. We know from commutative algebra that $l\mathbb{Z} \subset l^e$ which yields

$l\mathbb{Z} \subset q\mathbb{Z}$, i.e., $q \mid l$, which is a contradiction. Therefore, all rational primes other than q are units in $\mathcal{O}$, and hence $v(l) = 0$ for all primes $l \neq q$ and $v(q) > 0$, which is the characteristic property of the q -adic valuation. Hence, $v|_{\mathbb{Q}} = v_q$. □

1.3 Constructing valuations

Theorem 1.3.1. *Suppose K is a field, Γ is an ordered subgroup of an ordered group Γ' , and $v : K \rightarrow \Gamma \cup \{\infty\}$ is a valuation and $\gamma \in \Gamma'$. For $f = \sum_{i=0}^{\infty} a_i x^i \in K[x]$, define*

$$w(f) := \begin{cases} \infty, & \text{if } f = 0 \\ \min_{0 \leq i \leq n} \{v(a_i) + i\gamma\}, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

For $f, g \in K[x] \setminus \{0\}$, let $w(f/g) = w(f) - w(g)$.

The above equations define a valuation $w : K[x] \rightarrow \Gamma' \cup \{\infty\}$ on $K[x]$ that extends v .

Proof. For $f, g \in K[x] \setminus \{0\}$, let $n = \max\{\deg(f), \deg(g)\}$ and $f = \sum_{i=0}^n a_i x^i, g = \sum_{j=0}^n b_j x^j$. Then, $f + g = \sum_{i=0}^n (a_i + b_i) x^i$ and we get

$$\begin{aligned} w(f + g) &= v(a_i + b_i) + i\gamma \geq \min\{v(a_i), v(b_i)\} + i\gamma \\ &= \min\{v(a_i) + i\gamma, v(b_i) + i\gamma\} = \min\{w(f), w(g)\}. \end{aligned} \quad (*)$$

Now,

$$fg = \left(\sum_{i=0}^n a_i x^i \right) \left(\sum_{j=0}^m b_j x^j \right) = \sum_{k=0}^{n+m} c_k x^k \text{ where } c_k = \sum_{i+j=k} a_i b_j.$$

For every $i + j = k$, we have $v(a_i b_j) + k\gamma = v(a_i) + v(b_j) + (i + j)\gamma = v(a_i) + i\gamma + v(b_j) + j\gamma \geq w(f) + w(g)$. Hence, $v(c_k) = v\left(\sum_{i+j=k} a_i b_j\right) \geq \min_{i+j=k} \{v(a_i b_j)\}$. Hence, $v(c_k) + k\gamma \geq \min_{i+j=k} \{v(a_i b_j)\} + k\gamma = \min_{i+j=k} \{v(a_i b_j) + k\gamma\}$.

Therefore, $w(f) + w(g) \leq \min_{i \leq k} \{v(a_i b_i) + k\gamma\} = w(fg)$.

To show the other inequality, let $i_0 = \min\{i : v(a_i) + i\gamma = w(f)\}$, $j_0 = \min\{v(b_j) + j\gamma = w(g)\}$ and $k_0 = i_0 + j_0$.

Consider

$$c_{k_0} = \sum_{i+j=k_0} a_i b_j = \sum_{i \leq i_0} a_i b_i + a_{i_0} b_{j_0} + \sum_{i \geq i_0} a_i b_i.$$

1.3. CONSTRUCTING VALUATIONS

Note that whenever $i < i_0$, $v(a_i) + i\gamma \geq w(f)$, by definition of i_0 . Hence, in the **teal sum**, we have

$$\begin{aligned} v(a_i b_j) + k_0 \gamma &= v(a_i) + i\gamma + v(b_j) + j\gamma \\ &\geq v(a_i) + i\gamma + w(g) \\ &> w(f) + w(g). \end{aligned}$$

Similarly, in the **violet sum**,

$$\begin{aligned} v(a_i b_j) + k_0 \gamma &= v(a_i) + i\gamma + v(b_j) + j\gamma \\ &\geq w(f) + v(a_j) + j\gamma \\ &> w(f) + w(g) \end{aligned}$$

Hence,

$$\begin{aligned} &v\left(\sum_{i \leq i_0} a_i b_i\right) > w(f) + w(g) - k_0 \text{ and } v\left(\sum_{i \geq i_0} a_i b_i\right) > w(f) + w(g) - k_0 \\ \implies &\min\left\{v\left(\sum_{i \leq i_0} a_i b_i\right), v\left(\sum_{i \geq i_0} a_i b_i\right)\right\} > w(f) + w(g) - k_0 = v(a_{i_0} b_{i_0}). \end{aligned}$$

Recall that $v(x) < v(y) \implies v(x + y) = v(x)$ whence we deduce:

$$v(c_{k_0}) = v\left(\sum_{i \leq i_0} a_i b_i + a_{i_0} b_{i_0} + \sum_{i \geq i_0} a_i b_i\right) = v(a_{i_0} b_{i_0}).$$

Therefore, $v(c_{k_0}) + k_0 \gamma = v(a_{i_0} b_{i_0}) + k_0 \gamma = w(f) + w(g)$ Thus,

$$w(fg) \geq w(f) + w(g) \implies w(fg) = w(f) + w(g) \quad (**)$$

Note that we have proved (*) and (**) for any $f, g \in K[x] \setminus \{0\}$, the polynomial ring, but not for any $f, g \in K(x) \setminus \{0\}$, the rational function field.

The map $w : K[x] \rightarrow \Gamma' \cup \{\infty\}$ is well-defined:

If $f_1/g_1 = f_2/g_2$, then $f_1 g_2 = f_2 g_1$. Thus, $w(f_1 g_2) = w(f_2 g_1) \implies w(f_1) + w(g_2) = w(f_2) + w(g_1) \implies w(f_1) - w(g_1) = w(f_2) - w(g_2) \implies w(f_1/g_1) = w(f_2/g_2)$. To extend (*) and (**) to $K(x) \setminus \{0\}$, take $h_1, h_2 \in K(x) \setminus \{0\}$. Let g be a common denominator of h_1 and h_2 : $h_1 = f_1/g$ and $h_2 = f_2/g$ where $g, f_i \in K[x] \setminus \{0\}$.

Then,

$$\begin{aligned}
 w(h_1 + h_2) &= w\left(\frac{f_1 + f_2}{g}\right) := w(f_1 + f_2) - w(g) \\
 &\geq \min\{w(f_1), w(f_2)\} - w(g) \\
 &= \min\{w(f_1) - w(g), w(f_2) - w(g)\} \\
 &= \min\{w(f_1/g), w(f_2/g)\} \\
 &= \min\{w(h_1), w(h_2)\}.
 \end{aligned}$$

Similarly,

$$\begin{aligned}
 w(h_1 h_2) &= w\left(\frac{f_1 f_2}{g^2}\right) := w(f_1) + w(f_2) - 2w(g) \\
 &= w(f_1) + w(f_2) - 2w(g) \\
 &= w(f_1/g) + w(f_2/g) \\
 &= w(h_1) + w(h_2).
 \end{aligned}$$

■

Corollary 1.3.1.1. *Let $v : K \twoheadrightarrow \Gamma \cup \{\infty\}$ be a valuation. There is exactly one extension w of v to $K(x)$ such that $w(x) = 0$ and $\bar{x}$ is transcendental over $\bar{K}$, the residue class field of v . We have $\overline{K(x)} = \bar{K}(\bar{x})$ and $w(K(x)^\times) = \Gamma$.*

*This valuation w is called the **Gauss extension** of v .*

Proof. For uniqueness, let $f = \sum_{i=0}^n a_i x^i \in K[x] \setminus \{0\}$. Pick $k \leq n$ such that $v(a_k) = \min_{0 \leq i \leq n} v(a_i)$.

Write $f = a_k \sum_{i=0}^n b_i x^i = a_k g$ where $b_i = a_i/a_k$ and $v(b_i) \geq 0$. Thus, $w(g) = w(\sum_{i=0}^n b_i x^i) = \min\{w(b_i) + iw(x)\} = \min\{v(b_i)\} \geq 0$. Now, $\bar{g} = \sum \bar{b}_i \bar{x}^i \neq 0$ since $b_k = a_k/a_k = 1$ and $\bar{x}$ is transcendental over $\bar{K}$. Hence $g \notin \mathcal{M}_w$, i.e., $g \in \mathcal{O}_w^\times \implies w(g) = 0 \implies w(f) = w(a_k) + w(g) = v(a_k)$. Thus, $w(f) = \min_{0 \leq i \leq n} v(a_i)$.

For existence, let $f \in K[x]$ and define $w(f)$ as earlier by taking $\Gamma' = \Gamma$ and $\gamma = 0$. Then, $w(x) = \min\{v(1) + 0\} = 0$.

Claim: $\bar{x}$ is transcendental over $\bar{K}$.

Suppose, for a contradiction, that $\bar{x}$ is algebraic over $\bar{K}$. Then, $\exists a_i \in \mathcal{O}_v$ such that $\sum \bar{a}_i \bar{x}^i = \sum \overline{a_i x^i} = 0$. Thus, $\sum a_i x^i \in \mathcal{M}_w$, i.e., $w(\sum a_i x^i) = \min\{v(a_i)\} > 0$, i.e., $v(a_i) > 0 \forall i \implies a_i = 0$, so the only polynomial in $\bar{K}$ having $\bar{x}$ as a root is the zero polynomial. This proves the claim. Moreover, $w(K(x)^\times) = \Gamma$ because given

1.3. CONSTRUCTING VALUATIONS

any $f \in K(x)^\times$, $w(f) = \min\{v(a_i)\} \in \Gamma$, i.e., $w(K(x)^\times) \subseteq \Gamma$. Conversely, for any $t \in \Gamma$, $\exists a \in K^\times$ such that $v(a) = t$, by surjectivity of v . Hence, $\Gamma \subseteq w(K(x)^\times) \implies w(K(x)^\times) = \Gamma$.

Claim: $\overline{K(x)} = \overline{\mathcal{K}(\overline{x})}$.

Let $h \in \mathcal{O}_w^\times$, say $h = f_1/f_2$ with $f_i \in K[x] \setminus \{0\}$. As before, write $f_i = c_i g_i$, $c_i \in K^\times$ and $g_i \in \mathcal{O}_v^\times$. Thus, $h = c_1 g_1 / c_2 g_2 = c \cdot (g_1/g_2)$ where $c = c_1/c_2 \in K^\times$. Moreover, $h, g_1, g_2 \in \mathcal{O}_w^\times \implies c = h g_2 / g_1 \in \mathcal{O}_w^\times$, whence we conclude $\overline{h} = \overline{h g_2 / g_1} \in \overline{\mathcal{K}(\overline{x})}$. This proves the inclusion $\overline{K(x)} \subset \overline{\mathcal{K}(\overline{x})}$. Conversely, let $\overline{h}(\overline{x}) \in \overline{\mathcal{K}(\overline{x})}$ i.e., $\overline{h} \in \mathcal{O}_w / \mathcal{M}_w \implies h \in \mathcal{O}_w$. Since h is nonzero in $\overline{\mathcal{K}}$, we have $h \notin \mathcal{M}_w \implies h \in \mathcal{O}_w^\times \implies \overline{h} \in \overline{K(x)}$, which yields $\overline{K(x)} \supset \overline{\mathcal{K}(\overline{x})}$. ■

Corollary 1.3.1.2. *Let $v : K \rightarrow \Gamma \cup \{\infty\}$, Γ be an ordered subgroup of an ordered group Γ' , and $\gamma \in \Gamma'$ has the property that if $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ satisfies $n\gamma \in \Gamma$, then $n = 0$.*

Then, there is exactly one valuation w on $K(x)$ extending v , with $w(x) = \gamma$, and we have $\overline{K(x)} = \overline{\mathcal{K}}$ and $w(K(x)^\times) = \Gamma \oplus \mathbb{Z}\gamma$.

Proof. The existence of w follows from the previous theorem.

For uniqueness, consider an $f \in K[x]$, say $f = \sum_{i=0}^n a_i x^i$, $a_i \in K$. Now, for each $i \leq n$, $w(a_i x^i) = v(a_i) + i w(x) = v(a_i) + i\gamma$.

Claim: For $i \neq j$ and $a_i \neq 0 \neq a_j$, $w(a_i x^i) \neq w(a_j x^j)$:

Suppose this is not the case. Then, $w(a_i x^i) = w(a_j x^j) \implies v(a_i) + i\gamma = v(a_j) + j\gamma \implies (i - j)\gamma = v(a_j) - v(a_i)$. Since $i - j \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $(i - j)\gamma \in \Gamma$ we have $i - j = 0 \implies i = j$, a contradiction. Thus, $w(f) = \min_{0 \leq i \leq n} \{w(a_i x^i)\} = \min_{0 \leq i \leq n} \{v(a_i) + i\gamma\}$, which is uniquely determined (by the claim). Hence, w is uniquely determined on $K[x]$ and hence on $K(x)$. Moreover, $w(K(x)^\times) = \Gamma \oplus \mathbb{Z}\gamma$ because given any $f \in K(x)^\times$, $w(f) = \min\{v(a_i) + i\gamma\} \in \Gamma \oplus \mathbb{Z}\gamma$, i.e., $w(K(x)^\times) \subseteq \Gamma \oplus \mathbb{Z}\gamma$. Conversely, for any $t + i\gamma$, there exists $a \in K^\times$ such that $v(a) = t$, and hence $v(ax^i) = t + i\gamma$, so $\Gamma \oplus \mathbb{Z}\gamma \subseteq w(K(x)^\times) \implies w(K(x)^\times) = \Gamma \oplus \mathbb{Z}\gamma$.

Claim: $\overline{K(x)} = \overline{\mathcal{K}}$.

We first show that every $f \in K[x] \setminus \{0\}$ is of the form $f = ax^n(1 + u)$ where $a \in K^\times$, $u \in K(x)$, $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, and $w(u) > 0$. For this, write $f = \sum_{i=0}^n a_i x^i$, with $a_i \in K$. Now, $\exists! i_0$ such that

$$w(f) = \min_{0 \leq i \leq n} \{w(a_i x^i)\} = w(a_{i_0} x^{i_0}) = v(a_{i_0}) + i_0 \gamma.$$

Thus, $f = a_{i_0} x^{i_0} \left(\sum_{i \neq i_0}^n \frac{a_i x^i}{a_{i_0} x^{i_0}} + 1 \right) =: a_{i_0} x^{i_0} u$. Now, $w\left(\frac{a_i x^i}{a_{i_0} x^{i_0}}\right) = w(a_i x^i) -$

$w(a_{i_0}x^{i_0}) > 0$ for $i \neq i_0$, hence $w(u) = w\left(\sum_{i \neq i_0}^n \frac{a_i x^i}{a_{i_0} x^{i_0}} + 1\right) = w\left(\sum_{i \neq i_0}^n \frac{a_i x^i}{a_{i_0} x^{i_0}}\right) \geq \min_{i \neq i_0} \left\{w\left(\frac{a_i x^i}{a_{i_0} x^{i_0}}\right)\right\} > 0$, whence, $w(u) > 0$.

Second, we consider any $h \in K(x) \setminus \{0\}$, and write $h = f/g$, with $f, g \in K[x] \setminus \{0\}$. Write $f = ax^m(1+u)$ and $g = bx^n(1+u')$, with $a, b \in K^\times$, $m, n \in \mathbb{N}$, and $w(u), w(u') > 0$. Then $h = \frac{f}{g} = \frac{a}{b}(x^{m-n})\left(\frac{1+u}{1+u'}\right) = cx^r\left(1 + \frac{u-u'}{1+u'}\right)$, where $c = a/b \in K^\times$ and $r = m - n \in \mathbb{Z}$. Since $w(u') > 0$, $w(1+u') = 0$; therefore $w(u - u'/1 + u') = w(u - u') - w(1+u') = w(u - u') > 0$. By the same argument as before, there exists $u'' \in K(x)$ with $w(u'') > 0$ such that $h = cx^r(1+u'')$.

We now show that $K(x) = \overline{K}(\overline{x})$. Let $h \in \mathcal{O}_w^\times$ and write $h = cx^r(1+u'')$ as described above. We then have $0 = w(h) = w(cx^r(1+u'')) = v(c) + r\gamma$, whence $r\gamma = -v(c) \in \Gamma$. By assumption, $r = 0$. Consequently, $v(c) = 0$. Note that $\overline{u''} = 0$ since $w(u'') > 0$, hence it follows $\overline{h} = \overline{c}(1 + \overline{u''}) = \overline{c} \in \overline{K}$. □

1.4 Dependence and Topology of Valuations

Definition 1.4.1. Two valuation rings $\mathcal{O}_1, \mathcal{O}_2 \subseteq K$ are **dependent** if $\mathcal{O}_1\mathcal{O}_2 \neq K$, where $\mathcal{O}_1\mathcal{O}_2$ denotes the smallest subring of K containing both $\mathcal{O}_1, \mathcal{O}_2$.

We also define the **dependence class of $\mathcal{O}$** as

$$[\mathcal{O}] := \left\{ \mathcal{O}' \subseteq K : \mathcal{O}' \text{ is a nontrivial valuation ring dependent on } \mathcal{O} \right\}.$$

Lemma 1.4.1. *Every overring of a valuation ring is also a valuation ring.*

Proof. If $\mathcal{O} \subseteq \mathcal{O}'$ and $\mathcal{O}$ is a valuation ring, then $\forall x \in K$, $x \in \mathcal{O}$ or $x^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}$, i.e., $x \in \mathcal{O}'$ or $x^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}'$. □

Such an overring $\mathcal{O}'$ of $\mathcal{O}$ is called a **coarsening** of $\mathcal{O}$. Two dependent valuation rings $\mathcal{O}_1, \mathcal{O}_2 \subseteq K$ always have a *lowest common coarsening*, namely $\mathcal{O}_1\mathcal{O}_2$.

Lemma 1.4.2. *The set of overrings $\mathcal{O}'$ of $\mathcal{O}$ in K is linearly ordered by inclusion.*

Proof. Suppose $\mathcal{O}_1$ and $\mathcal{O}_2$ are overrings of $\mathcal{O}$ in K . If $\mathcal{O}_1 \subseteq \mathcal{O}_2$, we are done. Suppose not. Let $a \in \mathcal{O}_1 \setminus \mathcal{O}_2$ and $b \in \mathcal{O}_2$. Now, $a/b \notin \mathcal{O}$, otherwise $a/b \in \mathcal{O} \subseteq \mathcal{O}_2 \implies a = b(a/b) \in \mathcal{O}_2$, but $a \notin \mathcal{O}_2$. Since $\mathcal{O}$ is a valuation ring, $(a/b)^{-1} = b/a \in \mathcal{O} \subseteq \mathcal{O}_1$. Hence, $b = a(b/a) \in \mathcal{O}_1$, i.e., $\mathcal{O}_2 \subseteq \mathcal{O}_1$. □

Theorem 1.4.1. *Overrings $\mathcal{O}'$ of $\mathcal{O}$ correspond one-to-one with prime ideals of $\mathcal{O}$.*

Proof. Let $\mathcal{O}$ be a fixed nontrivial valuation ring of K and $\mathcal{O}' \subseteq K$ be an overring. Then, $\mathcal{O} \subseteq \mathcal{O}' \implies \mathcal{M}' \subseteq \mathcal{M}$ because if $x \in \mathcal{M}'$, then $x^{-1} \notin \mathcal{O}'$, hence $x^{-1} \notin \mathcal{O}$, and so $x \in \mathcal{M}$. Note that $\mathcal{M}$ consists exactly of non-units of $\mathcal{O}$. Now, $\mathcal{M}'$ is prime in $\mathcal{O}'$, i.e., $\mathcal{M}'\mathcal{O} \subseteq \mathcal{M}'$. Since $\mathcal{O} \subseteq \mathcal{O}'$, we have $\mathcal{M}'\mathcal{O} \subseteq \mathcal{M}'$, i.e., $\mathcal{M}'$ is also prime in $\mathcal{O}$. Here, given an overring $\mathcal{O}' \supseteq \mathcal{O}$, we have a prime ideal $\mathcal{M}' \triangleleft \mathcal{O}$.

Conversely, if $\mathfrak{p}$ is a prime ideal of $\mathcal{O}$, then $\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}} = \{a/b : a \in \mathcal{O}, b \notin \mathfrak{p}\}$ is an overring of $\mathcal{O}$ with maximal ideal $\mathfrak{p}\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}$.

Claim: The correspondence is one-to-one, i.e., $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{M}'} = \mathcal{O}'$ and $\mathfrak{p}\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}} = \mathfrak{p}$.

We need to show that every $x \in \mathcal{O}'$ is of the form a/b , $a \in \mathcal{O}$ and $b \notin \mathcal{M}'$. If $x \in \mathcal{O}$, then $x = x/1$ and we are done. Suppose not. Then, $x^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}$ so $x^{-1} \in \mathcal{M} - \mathcal{M}'$ (since $\mathcal{M}'$ consists of non-units of $\mathcal{O}'$). Thus, $x = 1/x^{-1}$ and we are done. Hence, $\mathcal{O}' \subseteq \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{M}'}$. Now, let $a/b \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{M}'}$, i.e., $a \in \mathcal{O}$ and $b \notin \mathcal{M}'$, so b is a unit in $\mathcal{O}'$, i.e., $b^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}'$. Hence, $a/b = ab^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}' \implies \mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{M}'} \subseteq \mathcal{O}'$. Therefore, $\mathcal{O}_{\mathcal{M}'} = \mathcal{O}'$. Now, given $a/b \in \mathfrak{p}\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}$, we have $a \in \mathfrak{p}$ and $b \notin \mathfrak{p}$. Since $\mathfrak{p} \subseteq \mathcal{M}$, $b \notin \mathcal{M}$, i.e., b is a unit in $\mathcal{O}$. Hence, $b^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}$, so $a/b = ab^{-1} \in \mathfrak{p}$ ($\mathfrak{p}$ is prime and $a \in \mathfrak{p}$). Thus, $\mathfrak{p}\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$. Given $a \in \mathfrak{p}$, $a = a/1 \in \mathfrak{p}\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}$, so $\mathfrak{p} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}$. Hence, $\mathfrak{p}\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}} = \mathfrak{p}$. Therefore, the correspondence is one-to-one. $\blacksquare$

Remark 1.4. If $\mathcal{O}' = K$, then $\mathcal{M}'$ is trivial and we have $K = \mathcal{O}_{(0)} = \{a/b : a \in \mathcal{O}, b \neq 0\}$, which is the quotient field of $\mathcal{O}$. Therefore, K is the quotient field for every valuation ring of K .

Lemma 1.4.3. *Let $\mathcal{O}$ be a nontrivial valuation ring of K corresponding to the valuation $v : K \rightarrow \Gamma \cup \{\infty\}$. Then, there is a one-to-one correspondence of convex subgroups $\Delta \subseteq \Gamma$ with prime ideals $\mathfrak{p}$ of $\mathcal{O}$, and hence with overrings $\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}} \supseteq \mathcal{O}$.*

This correspondence is given by

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta &\mapsto \mathfrak{p}_{\Delta} := \{x \in \mathcal{O} : v(x) \notin \Delta\}, \\ \mathfrak{p} &\mapsto \Delta_{\mathfrak{p}} := \{\gamma \in \Gamma : \gamma = v(x) \text{ or } v(x^{-1}) \text{ for some } x \in \mathcal{O} \setminus \mathfrak{p}\}. \end{aligned}$$

In particular, if $\mathcal{O}$ has finite rank, then this rank coincides with the Krull dimension of $\mathcal{O}$.

Proof. Consider $\Delta \mapsto \mathfrak{p}_{\Delta}$. Now, $\mathfrak{p}_{\Delta} \triangleleft \mathcal{O}$ since $\forall t \in \mathcal{O}$ and $x \in \mathfrak{p}_{\Delta}$, we have $v(xt) = v(x) + v(t) \geq v(x) \notin \Delta \implies v(xt) \notin \Delta$ (by convexity of Δ). To show $\mathfrak{p}_{\Delta}$ is prime, consider $xy \in \mathfrak{p}_{\Delta}$, i.e. $v(xy) = v(x) + v(y) \notin \Delta$. If $x \in \mathfrak{p}_{\Delta}$ or $y \in \mathfrak{p}_{\Delta}$, we are done. Suppose not. Then $v(x) \in \Delta$ and $v(y) \in \Delta$. Thus, $v(xy) = v(x) + v(y) \in \Delta$.

Δ (by convexity), a contradiction. Hence, $\mathfrak{p}_\Delta$ is a prime ideal. To show that $\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is convex, we take $0 \leq \gamma \leq \delta$ with $\delta \in \Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}$. Since v is surjective, we have $\gamma = v(y)$ for some $y \in K$ but since $0 \leq \gamma$, it must be the case that $y \in \mathcal{O}$. This already gives that $\gamma \in \Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}$. Hence, convexity of $\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}$ follows. Moreover, by definition, we have $\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}} = -\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}$, hence we need only prove closure under addition to ensure that $\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is a subgroup. Let $\gamma, \delta \in \Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}$. We may assume without loss of generality that $0 \leq \gamma \leq \delta$, otherwise we work with $-\gamma$ or $-\delta$ as required. Then, we have $\gamma = v(x)$ and $\delta = v(y)$ for some $x, y \in \mathcal{O} \setminus \mathfrak{p}$. Consider now $\gamma + \delta = v(x) + v(y) = v(xy)$. Since $\mathfrak{p}$ is prime in $\mathcal{O}$, we have $x, y \in \mathcal{O} \setminus \mathfrak{p} \implies xy \in \mathcal{O} \setminus \mathfrak{p}$. Hence, $\gamma + \delta = v(xy) \in \Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}$, and thus $\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is a convex subgroup of Γ . We now show that the two mappings are mutually inverse, i.e., $\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}_\Delta} = \Delta$ and $\mathfrak{p}_{\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}} = \mathfrak{p}$.

- $\mathfrak{p}_{\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$: Let $x \in \mathfrak{p}_{\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}}$ and suppose $x \notin \mathfrak{p}$. Then, $v(x) \in \Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}$, which contradicts $x \in \mathfrak{p}_{\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}}$.
- $\mathfrak{p} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}_{\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}}$: Let $x \in \mathfrak{p}$ and suppose $x \notin \mathfrak{p}_{\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}}$. Then, $v(x) \in \Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}$ and so $v(x) = v(y)$ or $v(y^{-1})$ for some $y \in \mathcal{O} \setminus \mathfrak{p}$. Since $x \in \mathfrak{p} \subset \mathcal{O}, v(x) \geq 0 \implies v(x) = v(y)$. Then, $v(xy^{-1}) = 0 \implies xy^{-1} \notin \mathcal{M} \implies x^{-1}y \in \mathcal{O}$. Since $x \in \mathfrak{p}$ and $x^{-1}y \in \mathcal{O}$, $x(x^{-1}y) = y \in \mathfrak{p}$, a contradiction.
- $\Delta \subseteq \Delta_{\mathfrak{p}_\Delta}$: Let $\lambda \in \Delta$. Since v is surjective, we have $\lambda = v(x)$ for some $x \in K$. Now, since Δ is a subgroup, $-\lambda \in \Delta$, thus both $v(x)$ and $v(x^{-1}) \in \Delta$. Moreover, since $\mathcal{O} \subset K$ is a valuation ring, we have x or $x^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}$. Suppose first that $x \in \mathcal{O}$ i.e., $\lambda = v(x) \geq 0$. Further, $\lambda \in \Delta \implies x \notin \mathfrak{p}_\Delta$. Hence, we get $x \in \mathcal{O} \setminus \mathfrak{p}_\Delta \implies \lambda = v(x) \in \Delta_{\mathfrak{p}_\Delta}$. Now, suppose $x^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}$ i.e., $\lambda = v(x) \leq 0$. Since $v(x^{-1}) = -\lambda \in \Delta \implies x^{-1} \notin \mathfrak{p}_\Delta$. Hence, we get $x^{-1} \in \mathcal{O} \setminus \mathfrak{p}_\Delta \implies -\lambda = v(x^{-1}) \in \Delta_{\mathfrak{p}_\Delta} \implies \lambda \in \Delta_{\mathfrak{p}_\Delta}$.
- $\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}_\Delta} \subseteq \Delta$: Let $\lambda \in \Delta_{\mathfrak{p}_\Delta}$, i.e., $\lambda = v(t)$ or $v(t^{-1})$, $t \in \mathcal{O} \setminus \mathfrak{p}_\Delta$. Now $t \notin \mathfrak{p}_\Delta$ gives $v(t) \in \Delta$. Since Δ is a subgroup, $-v(t) = v(t^{-1}) \in \Delta$. Thus, $\lambda \in \Delta$.

This concludes the proof. ▀

Corollary 1.4.1.1. *Let $\mathcal{O} \subseteq K$ be a nontrivial valuation ring. Then $\text{rank}(\mathcal{O}) = 1$ if and only if $\mathcal{O}$ is a maximal subring of K .*

Proof. $\text{rank}(\mathcal{O}) = 1$ if and only if $\mathcal{O}$ has one convex subgroup; this is equivalent to having one prime ideal, which in turn implies that $\mathcal{O}$ has a single overring. Since K

is an overring, it must be the only one; i.e., $\mathcal{O} \subseteq S \subseteq K \implies S = K$ or $S = \mathcal{O}$. Thus, $\mathcal{O}$ is a maximal subring of K . $\blacksquare$

Now, let $\mathcal{O}$ be a nontrivial valuation ring of K corresponding to the valuation $v : K \rightarrow \Gamma \cup \{\infty\}$. Assume $\mathfrak{p} \triangleleft \mathcal{O}$ is prie with corresponding convex subgroup $\Delta \subseteq \Gamma$. The canonical valuation $v_{\mathfrak{p}}$ corresponding to $\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}$ induces an order-preserving group homomorphism

$$\begin{aligned} \phi : K^{\times}/\mathcal{O}^{\times} &\rightarrow K^{\times}/\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}^{\times}, \\ x\mathcal{O}^{\times} &\mapsto x\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}^{\times}. \end{aligned}$$

It is well-defined because $\mathcal{O} \subseteq \mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}} \implies \mathcal{O}^{\times} \subseteq \mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}^{\times}$. Now, $\ker \phi = \{x\mathcal{O}^{\times} : x\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}^{\times} = \mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}^{\times}\} = \{x\mathcal{O}^{\times} : x \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}^{\times}\} = \mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}^{\times}/\mathcal{O}^{\times}$. We want to show that $v_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is obtained from v by dividing Γ by Δ , i.e.

$$w : K \rightarrow \Gamma \cup \{\infty\} \rightarrow \Gamma/\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}} \cup \{\infty\} : x \mapsto v(x) + \Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}$$

is the same as

$$v_{\mathfrak{p}} : K \rightarrow \Gamma_{\mathfrak{p}} \cup \{\infty\}, \quad \text{where } \Gamma_{\mathfrak{p}} = K^{\times}/\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}^{\times}.$$

We first consider $\mathcal{O}_w$:

$\mathcal{O}_w = \{x \in K : w(x) \geq 0\} = \{x \in K : v(x) + \Delta \geq \Delta\} = \{x \in K : v(x) > 0 \text{ or } v(x) \in \Delta\}$. Let $x \in \mathcal{O}_w$. Then, $v(x) > 0$ or $v(x) \in \Delta$. If $v(x) > 0$, then $x \in \mathcal{M}_v \subseteq \mathcal{O}_v \subseteq \mathcal{O}_{v_{\mathfrak{p}}}$. Suppose not, i.e., $v(x) \leq 0$. Then since $x \in \mathcal{O}_w$, we must have $v(x) \in \Delta$, i.e., there exists $t \in \mathcal{O} \setminus \mathfrak{p}$ such that $v(x) = v(t^{-1})$ ($\because v(x) \leq 0$). Hence, $v(x)t \geq 0 \implies xt \notin \mathcal{M}_v \implies xt$ and $x^{-1}t^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}_v$. Thus, $x = xt/t \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}$, hence $\mathcal{O}_w \subseteq \mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}$.

Conversely, given $x = a/b \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}$, i.e., $a \in \mathcal{O}$ and $b \in \mathcal{O} \setminus \mathfrak{p}$, we have $v(x) = v(a) - v(b) = v(a) + v(b^{-1}) = v(a) + \delta$ where $\delta \in \Delta$ thus $v(x) + \Delta = v(a) + \Delta \geq \Delta$, since $v(a) \geq 0$ as $a \in \mathcal{O}$. Therefore, $x \in \mathcal{O}_w$, i.e., $\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}} \subseteq \mathcal{O}_w$, whence $\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}} = \mathcal{O}_w$, i.e., $v_{\mathfrak{p}} = w$. Therefore, $\Gamma/\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}} = (K^{\times}/\mathcal{O}^{\times})/\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}} \cong \Gamma_{\mathfrak{p}} = K^{\times}/\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}^{\times}$.

Lemma 1.4.4. *The residue homomorphism $\varphi_{\mathfrak{p}} : \mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{p} = \overline{\mathcal{K}}_{\mathfrak{p}}$ maps the valuation ring $\mathcal{O}$ to a valuation ring $\overline{\mathcal{O}} = \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$ in $\overline{\mathcal{K}}_{\mathfrak{p}}$.*

Proof. Let $\overline{x} \in \overline{\mathcal{K}}_{\mathfrak{p}}$, i.e., $\overline{x} = x + \mathfrak{p}$, $x \in \mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}$. Now, either $x \in \mathcal{O}$ or $x^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}$. If $x \in \mathcal{O}$, then $\overline{x} \in \overline{\mathcal{O}}$. Otherwise, if $x^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}$, then $\overline{x^{-1}} = \overline{x}^{-1} \in \overline{\mathcal{O}}$ and we are done. $\blacksquare$

Defining $\bar{v} : \bar{\mathcal{K}}_{\mathfrak{p}} \rightarrow \Delta \cup \{\infty\} : \bar{v}(\bar{x}) := v(x)$ yields a valuation on $\bar{\mathcal{K}}_{\mathfrak{p}}$ corresponding to $\bar{\mathcal{O}}$, with residue class field $\bar{\mathcal{O}}/\bar{\mathcal{M}} = \bar{\mathcal{K}}$ since $\bar{\mathcal{O}}/\bar{\mathcal{M}} = (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})/(\mathcal{M}/\mathfrak{p}) = \mathcal{O}/\mathcal{M}$.

Hence, passing from $\mathcal{O}$ to a coarsening $\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}$ yields two valuations, namely

$$v_{\mathfrak{p}} : K \rightarrow \Gamma/\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}} \cup \{\infty\} \text{ with valuation ring } \mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}, \text{ and}$$

$$\bar{v}_{\mathfrak{p}} : \bar{\mathcal{K}}_{\mathfrak{p}} \rightarrow \Delta_{\mathfrak{p}} \cup \{\infty\} \text{ on the residue class field of } v_{\mathfrak{p}}.$$

The last process can be reversed, i.e., given a valuation $v' : K \rightarrow \Gamma' \cup \{\infty\}$ and another valuation on the residue class field of v' , say $\bar{v} : \bar{\mathcal{K}}_{v'} \rightarrow \Delta' \cup \{\infty\}$, we can define a ‘composition’ of v' with $\bar{v}$.

Lemma 1.4.5. *Let $\mathcal{O} = \varphi^{-1}(\mathcal{O}_{\bar{v}})$ where $\mathcal{O}_{v'} \xrightarrow{\varphi} \bar{\mathcal{K}}_{v'}$ is the canonical residue homomorphism. Then, $\mathcal{O}$ is a valuation ring of K and $\mathcal{O}_{v'}$ is a coarsening of $\mathcal{O}$.*

Proof. $\mathcal{O} = \varphi^{-1}(\mathcal{O}_{\bar{v}}) = \{x \in \mathcal{O}_{v'} : \varphi(x) = x\mathcal{M}_{v'} \in \mathcal{O}_{\bar{v}}\} = \{x \in \mathcal{O}_{v'} : \bar{v}(x\mathcal{M}_{v'}) \geq 0\}$. Let $x \in K$. If $x \in \mathcal{O}$, then we are done. Otherwise, $x \notin \mathcal{O}$, i.e., $\bar{v}(x\mathcal{M}_{v'}) < 0$ i.e., $x\mathcal{M}_{v'}$ is a unit in $\mathcal{O}_{\bar{v}}$, i.e., $x^{-1}\mathcal{M}_{v'} \in \mathcal{O}_{\bar{v}}$. Hence, $\bar{v}(x^{-1}\mathcal{M}_{v'}) \geq 0 \implies x^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}$. Thus, $\mathcal{O}$ is a valuation ring of K and it follows that $\mathcal{O} \subseteq \mathcal{O}_{v'}$. $\blacksquare$

Let $v : K \rightarrow \Gamma \cup \{\infty\}$ be the canonical valuation corresponding to $\mathcal{O}$. Since $\mathcal{O}_{v'}$ is a coarsening, there exists a prime $\mathfrak{p} \triangleleft \mathcal{O}$ such that $\mathcal{O}_{v'} = \mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}$. Hence, $v' = v_{\mathfrak{p}}$, $\mathcal{M}_{v'} = \mathfrak{p}\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}$ and $\bar{\mathcal{K}}_{v'} = \mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}}/\mathfrak{p}\mathcal{O}_{\mathfrak{p}} = \bar{\mathcal{K}}_{\mathfrak{p}}$. As before, $v_{\mathfrak{p}} : K \rightarrow \Gamma/\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}} \cup \{\infty\}$, and $\Gamma' \cong \Gamma/\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}$. Again, as before, we have $\bar{v}_{\mathfrak{p}} : \bar{\mathcal{K}}_{\mathfrak{p}} \rightarrow \Delta_{\mathfrak{p}} \cup \{\infty\}$ with valuation ring $\mathcal{O}_{\bar{v}_{\mathfrak{p}}}$. Note that $\bar{v}_{\mathfrak{p}}(x\mathcal{M}_{v'}) := v(x)$, and so $\bar{v}_{\mathfrak{p}}(x\mathcal{M}_{v'}) \geq 0 \implies v(x) \geq 0$, i.e., $\varphi(\mathcal{O}_{\bar{v}_{\mathfrak{p}}}) \subseteq \mathcal{O}$. If $v(x) \geq 0$, then $\bar{v}_{\mathfrak{p}}(x\mathcal{M}_{v'}) \geq 0$, so $\mathcal{O} \subseteq \varphi^{-1}(\mathcal{O}_{\bar{v}_{\mathfrak{p}}})$, i.e., $\varphi^{-1}(\mathcal{O}_{\bar{v}_{\mathfrak{p}}}) = \mathcal{O} = \varphi(\mathcal{O}_{v'})$. Hence, $\mathcal{O}_{\bar{v}_{\mathfrak{p}}} = \mathcal{O}_{v'}$. Note that we have used the following fact:

If $f : A \rightarrow B$ is surjective and $f^{-1}(B_1) = f^{-1}(B_2)$, then $B_1 = B_2$. Hence, $\bar{v}_{\mathfrak{p}} = \bar{v}$; so Δ' is isomorphic to a convex subgroup $\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}} \subset \Gamma$, and $\Gamma' \cong \Gamma/\Delta_{\mathfrak{p}}$, where $\Gamma = K^{\times}/\mathcal{O}^{\times}$. We call this v the **composition** of v' with $\bar{v}$.

We now consider the topology induced by a valuation on a field K . We begin by showing that two valuations are dependent if and only if they induce the same topology.

Given a valuation $v : K \rightarrow \Gamma \cup \{\infty\}$, for any $\gamma \in \Gamma$ and each $a \in K$, we define $\mathcal{U}_{\gamma}(a) := \{x \in K : v(x - a) > \gamma\} = \{x \in K : |x - a| < e^{-\gamma}\}$.

These sets form a basis of open neighborhoods of a , i.e.,

$$(i) \ a \in \mathcal{U}_{\gamma}(a)$$

$$(ii) \ \forall \mathcal{U}_{\gamma}, \mathcal{U}_{\alpha}, \exists \mathcal{U}_{\delta} \text{ such that } \mathcal{U}_{\delta} \subset \mathcal{U}_{\gamma} \cap \mathcal{U}_{\alpha}$$

In fact, we have the following properties:

- (i) $a \in \mathcal{U}_\gamma(a)$
- (ii) $\mathcal{U}_\gamma(a) \cap \mathcal{U}_\alpha(a) = \mathcal{U}_\delta(a)$ where $\delta = \max\{\gamma, \alpha\}$
- (iii) For any $b \in \mathcal{U}_\gamma(a)$ with $b \neq a$, $v(b - a) = \gamma' > \gamma$ implies $\mathcal{U}_{\gamma'}(b) \subset \mathcal{U}_\gamma(a)$

The first two follow directly from the definition. The third holds since $v(x - b) > \gamma' = v(b - a)$ implies $v(x - a) = v((x - b) + (b - a)) = \min\{v(x - b), v(b - a)\} = v(b - a) = \gamma' > \gamma$ i.e., $\forall x \in \mathcal{U}_{\gamma'}(b)$, we get $x \in \mathcal{U}_\gamma(a)$. We consider the topology defined by this basis of neighborhoods, i.e., a set $\mathcal{U}$ is open if $\forall x \in \mathcal{U}, \exists \mathcal{U}_\gamma(x)$ such that $x \in \mathcal{U}_\gamma(x) \subset \mathcal{U}$.

Lemma 1.4.6. *The topology constructed above is Hausdorff.*

Proof. Let $a \neq b$. Let $v(b - a) = \gamma'$. Consider $\mathcal{U}_{\gamma'}(a) = \{x \in K : v(x - a) > \gamma'\}$. Clearly, $b \notin \mathcal{U}_{\gamma'}(a)$. Pick some $\gamma > \gamma'$ and consider $\mathcal{U}_\gamma(b)$.

Claim: $\mathcal{U}_{\gamma'}(a) \cap \mathcal{U}_\gamma(b) = \emptyset$.

Suppose not, i.e., $\exists x \in K$ such that $v(x - a) > \gamma'$ and $v(x - b) > \gamma$.

Then, $\gamma' = v(b - a) = v((x - b) - (x - a)) = \min\{v(x - b), v(x - a)\}$. Since $v(x - a) > \gamma'$, we have $v(x - b) = \gamma'$, but $v(x - b) > \gamma$ and $\gamma' < \gamma$ — a contradiction. $\blacksquare$

Lemma 1.4.7. $\Gamma = \{0\}$ if and only if $\mathcal{U}_\gamma(a) = \{a\}$ for all $a \in K$ and all $\gamma \in \Gamma$.

Proof. ($\implies$): if $\Gamma = \{0\}$, then $v(x) = 0$ for all x , i.e., $x \in \mathcal{O}^\times$ for all x , i.e., $K = \mathcal{O}^\times$. Let $x \in \mathcal{U}_\gamma(a) = \{x \in K : v(x - a) > \gamma\}$ where $x \neq a$. Let $\gamma = t\mathcal{O}^\times$. Since $K = \mathcal{O}^\times$, $t \in \mathcal{O}^\times$, i.e., $\gamma = 0$, which is a contradiction. Hence, $\mathcal{U}_\gamma(a) = \{a\}$.

($\impliedby$): Let $\mathcal{U}_\gamma(a) = \{a\}$ for all $a \in K$ and all $\gamma \in \Gamma$. Thus, any $x \in K$ satisfying $v(x - a) > \gamma$ must be a itself. Suppose $v(x) \neq 0$ for some x . Let $v(x) = \gamma$. Then, $\mathcal{U}_\gamma(0) = \{y \in K \mid v(y) > 0\} = \{0\}$. Since $v(x) \neq 0$, either $v(x) > 0$ or $v(x) < 0$. If $v(x) > 0$, then $x \in \mathcal{U}_\gamma(0)$, i.e., $x = 0$. Otherwise, $v(x) < 0$, i.e., $0 < -v(x)$, i.e., $0 < v(x^{-1})$, i.e., $x^{-1} \in \mathcal{U}_\gamma(0)$, i.e., $x^{-1} = 0$, i.e., $x = \infty$. Hence, $v(x) \neq 0$ implies $x = 0$ or ∞ . Thus, $\Gamma = \{0\}$. $\blacksquare$

Therefore, v is trivial if and only if the induced topology is discrete.

Remark 1.5. The field operations are continuous with respect to this topology.

Theorem 1.4.2. *Two nontrivial valuation rings $\mathcal{O}_1, \mathcal{O}_2$ of K are dependent if and only if they induce the same topology on K .*

Proof. Since two dependent valuation rings have a common nontrivial coarsening $\mathcal{O}_1\mathcal{O}_2$, to show they induce the same topology, it suffices to consider only the case $\mathcal{O}_1 \subseteq \mathcal{O}_2$. Let $v : K \rightarrow \Gamma \cup \{\infty\}$ be a valuation on $\mathcal{O}_1$. Then by Lemma 1.2.5, there exists a convex subgroup $\Delta \subseteq \Gamma$ connected with $\mathcal{O}_2$ such that $v_2 : K^\times \rightarrow \Gamma \twoheadrightarrow \Gamma/\Delta = \Gamma_2$ is a valuation on $\mathcal{O}_2$. Since $\mathcal{O}_1 \neq K$, $\Gamma_2 \neq \{0\}$. Write $\mathcal{U}_\gamma(0) = \{a \in K \mid v(a) > \gamma\}$ and $\mathcal{U}_{\gamma+\Delta}(0) = \{a \in K \mid v_2(a) > \gamma + \Delta\} = \{a \in K \mid v(a) > d \ \forall d \equiv \gamma \pmod{\Delta}\}$. We have $\mathcal{U}_{\gamma+\Delta}(0) \subseteq \mathcal{U}_\gamma(0)$ since $v(a) > \gamma \implies a \in \mathcal{U}_{\gamma+\Delta}(0)$.

On the other hand, $v(a) > 2\gamma$ implies $v_2(a) \geq 2\gamma + \Delta$. Hence for $\gamma > 0$, if $v_2(a) \leq \gamma + \Delta$, then $\gamma + \Delta \geq 2\gamma + \Delta$, i.e., $\gamma \in \Delta$. Contrapositively, this implies, $0 < \gamma \notin \Delta \implies v(a) \leq 2\gamma$, i.e., $\mathcal{U}_\gamma(0) \subseteq \mathcal{U}_{\gamma+\Delta}(0)$. Therefore, the topologies are equivalent.

Conversely, if $\mathcal{O}_1, \mathcal{O}_2$ induce the same topology on K , then $\mathcal{M}_2$ is an open neighborhood of zero in the topology induced by $\mathcal{O}_1$. Thus, $\mathcal{M}_2$ contains an open set around 0, i.e., $\exists a \in K^\times$ such that $\{x \in K \mid v(x) > \gamma\} = a\mathcal{M}_1 \subseteq \mathcal{M}_2$, where $\gamma = v(a^{-1})$.

Claim: $\mathcal{O}_1 \setminus \mathcal{M}_2$ is multiplicatively closed in $\mathcal{O}_1$:

Suppose $y_1, y_2 \in \mathcal{O}_1 \setminus \mathcal{M}_2$ and $y_1 y_2 \notin \mathcal{O}_1 \setminus \mathcal{M}_2 \implies y_1 y_2 \in \mathcal{M}_2$. Thus, $v_2(y_1 y_2) > 0 \implies v_2(y_1) > v_2(y_2^{-1})$. Since $y_1, y_2 \notin \mathcal{M}_2$, $v_2(y_1) \leq 0$ and $v_2(y_2) \leq 0$. Thus, $v_2(y_1^{-1}) \geq 0$ but $v_2(y_1) > v_2(y_2^{-1}) \geq 0$, i.e., $v_2(y_1) > 0$. This is a contradiction. Hence, $\mathcal{O}_1 \setminus \mathcal{M}_2$ is multiplicatively closed. Thus, we may form the ring $\mathcal{O}_3 := \left\{ \frac{x}{y} : x \in \mathcal{O}_1, y \in \mathcal{O}_1 \setminus \mathcal{M}_2 \right\}$. Clearly, $\mathcal{O}_1 \subset \mathcal{O}_3$, hence $\mathcal{O}_3$ is a valuation ring. Now, for $x \in \mathcal{O}_2 \setminus \{0\}$, $x^{-1} \notin \mathcal{M}_2$ (since x^{-1} is invertible in $\mathcal{O}_2$). Thus, $x = 1/x^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}_3$, if $x^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}_1$. If $x^{-1} \notin \mathcal{O}_1$, then $x \in \mathcal{O}_1$, and so $x \in \mathcal{O}_3$ ($\because \mathcal{O}_1 \subseteq \mathcal{O}_3$). Hence, in any case, $x \in \mathcal{O}_3$. Thus, $\mathcal{O}_3$ contains $\mathcal{O}_2$ as well. Therefore, $\mathcal{O}_3 \supseteq \mathcal{O}_1\mathcal{O}_2$. We need only show $\mathcal{O}_3 \neq K$ to conclude that $\mathcal{O}_1, \mathcal{O}_2$ are dependent. Take $z \in \mathcal{M}_1 \setminus \{0\}$. Then, $1/az \notin \mathcal{O}_3$ because if $1/az \in \mathcal{O}_3$, then $1/az = x/y$, for some $x \in \mathcal{O}_1$, $y \in \mathcal{O}_1 \setminus \mathcal{M}_1$, implying $y = a(zx) \in a\mathcal{M}_1 \subseteq \mathcal{M}_2$ — contradiction. Thus, $1/ax \in K \setminus \mathcal{O}_3$, and hence $\mathcal{O}_3 \neq K$. ▀

Theorem 1.4.3 (Approximation Theorem). *Suppose $\mathcal{O}_1, \mathcal{O}_2, \dots, \mathcal{O}_n$ are pairwise independent valuation rings of K . For every $1 \leq i \leq n$, let $v_i : K \rightarrow \Gamma_i \cup \{\infty\}$ be a valuation on $\mathcal{O}_i$.*

Then, for any $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \in K$ and $\gamma_1 \in \Gamma_1, \gamma_2 \in \Gamma_2, \dots, \gamma_n \in \Gamma_n$, there exists $x \in K$ such that $v_i(x - a_i) > \gamma_i$ for all $i \in \{1, 2, \dots, n\}$.

Proof. For every i , pick positive $\delta_i \in \Gamma_i$ satisfying $\delta_i \geq \gamma_i$ and $-\delta_i \leq v_i(a_1), v_i(a_2), \dots, v_i(a_n)$.

Some new restrictions will be imposed on each δ_i during the proof.

Consider the open sets

$$M_i = \{x \in K : 2\delta_i < v_i(x)\} \text{ and}$$

$$A_i = \{x \in K : -2\delta_i \leq v_i(x)\}.$$

Note that $\gamma \leq v(x)$ and $\gamma \leq v(y) \implies \gamma \leq \min\{v(x), v(y)\} < v(x \pm y)$, hence M_i and A_i are closed under addition and subtraction.

Claim: We may choose δ_i such that $M_1 \cap \bigcap_{j=2}^n (K \setminus A_j) \neq \emptyset$.

We induct on n . For $n = 2$, suppose $M_1 \cap (K \setminus A_2) = \emptyset$, then $M_1 \subseteq A_2$. Now, choosing $c_i \in M_i$ ($i = 1, 2$), we have $c_i A_i \subseteq \mathcal{M}_i$ and $c_i \mathcal{M}_i \subseteq M_i$. Thus, $M_1 \subseteq A_2 \implies c_2 c_1 \mathcal{M}_1 \subseteq c_2 M_2 \subseteq c_2 A_2 \subseteq \mathcal{M}_2$. Taking $a = c_2 c_1$ gives $a M_1 \subseteq \mathcal{M}_2$. Proceeding as in Theorem 1.4.2, we get $\mathcal{O}_1$ and $\mathcal{O}_2$ are dependent — contradiction. For $n > 2$, by induction hypothesis, $\exists r \in M_1 \cap (K \setminus A_j)$. We choose $\delta_3, \delta_4, \dots, \delta_n$ large enough for $r \in A_j \forall j = 3, 4, \dots, n$, i.e.

$$\delta_i \geq \gamma_i, \delta_i \leq v_i(a_1), v_i(a_2), \dots, v_i(a_n), \text{ and } -2\delta_i \leq v_i(x) \forall j = 3, 4, \dots, n.$$

Thus, r has the following properties:

$$2\delta_i < v_1(r), -2\delta_2 \leq v_2(r) \text{ and } -2\delta_i \leq v_i(r) \forall j = 3, 4, \dots, n.$$

By induction hypothesis, $\exists s \in M_1 \cap \bigcap_{3 \leq j \leq n} (K \setminus A_j)$. If $s \notin A_2$, then $s \in M_1 \cap \bigcap_{j=2}^n (K \setminus A_j)$ and the claim is proved. Suppose not. Then, $s \in A_2$ and $r \notin A_2 \implies s + r \notin A_2$. Further, $s \notin A_j$ and $r \in A_j \forall j = 3, 4, \dots, n \implies s + r \notin A_j \forall j = 3, 4, \dots, n$. Therefore, $s + r \in M_1 \cap \bigcap_{j=2}^n (K \setminus A_j)$ and the claim is proved. Analogously, by replacing

M_1 with M_i and $\bigcap_{j=2}^n (K \setminus A_j)$ with $\bigcap_{j \neq i} (K \setminus A_j)$ and repeating the argument, we get $M_i \cap \bigcap_{j \neq i} (K \setminus A_j) \neq \emptyset$. Now, for any $x \in K \setminus A_j$, we have $v_j(1+x) = v_j(x)$ since $v_j(1) = 0 > -2\delta_j > v_j(x)$. Thus, $-2\delta_j > v_j(1+x) \implies 2\delta_j < v_j(1/(1+x)) \implies 1/(1+x) \in M_j$. Further, if $x \in M_i$, then $v_i\left(\frac{x}{1+x}\right) = v_i(x) - v_i(1+x) = v_i(x)$, since $v_i(1) = 0 < v_i(x) \implies v_i(1+x) = v_i(1) = 0$. Thus, $\frac{x}{1+x} \in M_i$. Hence, $\frac{1}{1+x} = 1 - \frac{x}{1+x} \in (1 + M_i)$.

Therefore,

$$\frac{1}{1+x} \in (1+M_i) \cap \bigcap_{j \neq i} M_j \text{ for any } x \in M_i \cap \bigcap_{j \neq i} (K \setminus A_j)$$

Hence, $(1+M_i) \cap \bigcap_{j \neq i} M_j \neq \emptyset$. We now choose $d_i \in (1+M_i) \cap \bigcap_{j \neq i} M_j$ and set $x := a_1 d_1 + \cdots + a_n d_n$. Since $d_i - 1 \in M_i$ and $d_j \in M_j \forall j \neq i$, $v_i(d_i - 1) > 2\delta_i$ and $v_i(d_j) > 2\delta_i$. Therefore,

$$\begin{aligned} v_i(x - a_i) &= v_i(a_1 d_1 + \cdots + a_i(d_i - 1) + \cdots + a_n d_n) \\ &> \min_{1 \leq j \leq n} \{v_i(a_j) + 2\delta_i\} \geq -\delta_i + 2\delta_i = \delta_i \geq \gamma_i. \end{aligned}$$

■

We now list and prove some properties of nonarchimedean complete real fields (in the multiplicative notation).

Lemma 1.4.8. *In a nonarchimedean complete real field, all triangles are isocetes, i.e., $|x| > |y| \implies |y - x| = |x|$.*

Proof. This is simply a restatement of Proposition 1.1.6, but we provide a proof again: if $|x| > |y|$, then $|x - y| = \max\{|x|, |y|\} = |x|$, whence it follows $|x| = |y + (x - y)| \leq \max\{|y|, |x - y|\} \leq \max\{|y|, |x|, |y|\} = |x|$, so the inequalities are equalities, implying $|x - y| = |x|$. Similarly, if $|y| > |x|$ then $|x - y| = |y|$, thus in general two of the numbers $|x|, |y|, |x - y|$ have to be equal. ■

Lemma 1.4.9. *In a nonarchimedean complete real field, two balls are either disjoint or concentric, i.e., $B(a, r) = B(b, r)$ for all $b \in B(a, r)$. In particular, every point in the open unit ball is a center.*

Proof. Consider an open ball $B(a, r) = \{x \in K : |x - a| < r\}$ and let $b \in B(a, r)$, i.e. $|b - a| < r$. If $c \in K$, then consider the triangle with vertices a, b, c . The above lemma shows that $|c - a| \geq r$ if and only if $|c - b| \geq r$, showing $B(a, r) = B(b, r)$. ■

Lemma 1.4.10. *The open ball $B(a, r) = \{x \in K : |x - a| < r\}$, the closed ball $\overline{B}(a, r) = \{x \in K : |x - a| \leq r\}$, and the sphere $S(a, r) = \{x \in K : |x - a| = r\}$ are both open and closed for $r > 0$. In particular, the valuation ring $\mathcal{O} = \{x \in K : |x| \leq 1\} \subseteq K$ is both closed and open.*

Proof. The open ball $B(a, r)$ is open by definition. We first show that the sphere $S(0, r)$ is open. Let $a \in S(0, r)$ and consider $x \in B(a, r)$. We have $|x| = |a + (x - a)|$ and $|x - a| < r = |a| \implies |x| = |a| = r$, i.e., $|x| = r \implies x \in S(0, r)$. Hence, $B(a, r)$ is an open ball around a contained in $S(0, r)$. Given any sphere $S(a, r)$, we have the translation homeomorphism $S(0, r) \rightarrow S(a, r) : x \mapsto a + x$ and so $S(a, r)$ is open as well. Therefore, $\overline{B}(a, r) = B(a, r) \cup S(a, r)$ is also open. Now, consider $X := K \setminus B(0, r)$ and let $x \in X$, i.e., $|x| \geq r$. Let $y \in B(x, r/2)$ then $|x - y| < r/2 \implies |y| = |x - (x - y)| = |x| \geq r$. Hence, $y \in X \implies B(x, r/2) \subset X$, i.e., X is open, whence we get that $B(0, r)$ is closed. Therefore, $B(a, r)$ is closed as well, since it is homeomorphic to $B(0, r)$ via the translation map. ▀

Lemma 1.4.11. *A nonarchimedean complete real field K is totally disconnected, i.e., the only connected components are singletons.*

Proof. Suppose $S \subset K$ is a connected component having at least two distinct points $a, b \in S$ with $|a - b| = r > 0$. We may then write S as

$$\begin{aligned} S &= (S \cap B(a, r/2)) \cup (S \cap K \setminus B(a, r/2)) \\ &= (S \cap \{|x - a| < r/2\}) \cup (S \cap \{|x - a| \geq r/2\}) \end{aligned}$$

Hence, S can be expressed as a union of two disjoint nonempty open sets, which contradicts the fact that S is connected. ▀

1.5 Extensions of Valuations

We now show that for every extension L/K , a valuation on K may be extended to L .

Theorem 1.5.1 (Chevalley). *For a field K , let $R \subseteq K$ be a subring and let $\mathfrak{p} \triangleleft R$ be prime. Then, there exists a valuation ring $\mathcal{O} \subseteq K$ such that $R \subseteq \mathcal{O}$ and $\mathcal{M} \cap R = \mathfrak{p}$.*

Proof. Consider

$$\Sigma := \{(A, I) : \mathfrak{p}R_{\mathfrak{p}} \subseteq A \subseteq K, \text{ and } \mathfrak{p}R_{\mathfrak{p}} \subseteq I \subset A, \text{ where } A \text{ is a ring and } I \triangleleft A\}.$$

Since $(R_{\mathfrak{p}}, \mathfrak{p}R_{\mathfrak{p}}) \in \Sigma$, it is nonempty. We partially order Σ as

$$(A_1, I_1) \leq (A_2, I_2) \iff A_1 \subseteq A_2 \text{ and } I_1 \subseteq I_2.$$

Claim: For any chain $\{(A_i, I_i)\}_{i \in J}$ of such pairs, then $\left(\bigcup_i A_i, \bigcup_i I_i\right)$ gives an upper bound. For any $i \neq j$, assume without loss of generality that $A_i \subseteq A_j$ which implies $A_i \cup A_j = A_j$. Hence $\bigcup_i A_i = A_{i'}$ for some $i' \in J$, so $\bigcup_i A_i$ is a ring. To see that $I = \bigcup_j I_j$ is an ideal of A , let $x, y \in I$. Say $x \in I_n$ and $y \in I_m$, and suppose $I_m \subseteq I_n$. Then $x, y \in I_n$ and so $x + y, xy \in I_n \subseteq I$. Hence closure under addition and multiplication follows. Clearly, $-x \in I_n \subseteq I$, hence I contains additive inverses. It also contains 0 and 1. Now, to show $IR \subseteq I$, let $r \in R$ and $i \in I$. Then $i \in I_n$ for some n . Thus $ri \in I_n \subseteq I \implies IR \subseteq I$. We have $R \subseteq R_{\mathfrak{p}} \subseteq \mathcal{O}$ and $\mathfrak{p}R_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is the unique maximal ideal of $R_{\mathfrak{p}}$. Hence $\mathcal{M} \cap R_{\mathfrak{p}} \subseteq \mathfrak{p}R_{\mathfrak{p}}$.

Conversely, since $\mathfrak{p}R_{\mathfrak{p}} \subseteq \mathcal{M}$, we get $\mathcal{M} \cap R_{\mathfrak{p}} \supseteq \mathfrak{p}R_{\mathfrak{p}}$, thus $\mathfrak{p}R_{\mathfrak{p}} = \mathcal{M} \cap R_{\mathfrak{p}}$.

Claim: $\mathfrak{p} = \mathcal{M} \cap R$: Let $x \in \mathfrak{p}$, then $x \in \mathfrak{p}R_{\mathfrak{p}} \implies x \in \mathcal{M} \cap R_{\mathfrak{p}} \implies x \in \mathcal{M} \implies x \in \mathcal{M} \cap R$. Hence, $\mathfrak{p} \subseteq \mathcal{M} \cap R$. Let $x \in \mathcal{M} \cap R$, $x \in R \subseteq R_{\mathfrak{p}}$, and $x \in \mathcal{M} \implies x \in \mathfrak{p}R_{\mathfrak{p}}$. But $\mathfrak{p}R_{\mathfrak{p}} \cap R = \mathfrak{p} \implies x \in \mathfrak{p}$. Hence, $\mathcal{M} \cap R \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$. Thus, we need only show that $\mathcal{O}$ is a valuation ring. Now, $(\mathcal{O}, \mathcal{M})$ is a local ring because if there is another maximal ideal $\mathcal{M}'$ of $\mathcal{O}$, then $\mathcal{M}' \subseteq \mathcal{M}$ or $\mathcal{M} \subseteq \mathcal{M}'$. By maximality in Σ , $\mathcal{M}' \subseteq \mathcal{M}$, but since $\mathcal{M}'$ is a maximal ideal, $\mathcal{M}' = \mathcal{M}$. Suppose $\mathcal{O}$ is not a valuation ring, then $\exists x \in K^\times$ with $x, x^{-1} \notin \mathcal{O}$. Thus, $\mathcal{O} \subsetneq \mathcal{O}[x]$ and $\mathcal{O} \subsetneq \mathcal{O}[x^{-1}]$. The maximality of $(\mathcal{O}, \mathcal{M})$ implies $\mathcal{M}\mathcal{O}[x] = \mathcal{O}[x]$ (otherwise $(\mathcal{O}, \mathcal{M}) \leq (\mathcal{O}[x], \mathcal{M}\mathcal{O}[x])$). Similarly, $\mathcal{M}\mathcal{O}[x^{-1}] = \mathcal{O}[x^{-1}]$, and hence there exist $a_0, \dots, a_n, b_0, \dots, b_m \in \mathcal{M}$ such that

$$1 = \sum_{i=0}^n a_i x^i = \sum_{j=0}^m b_j x^{-j},$$

with n, m minimal. Without loss of generality, assume $m \leq n$. Now, $b_0 \in \mathcal{M} \implies \sum_{j=1}^m b_j x^{-j} = 1 - b_0 \in \mathcal{O}^\times$ (since R is a local ring $\implies$ for all $r \in R$, either r or $1 - r$ is invertible, so $1 - b_0 \in \mathcal{O}^\times$). Put $c_i = b_i(1 - b_0)^{-1}$ to get

$$1 = \left(\sum_{j=1}^m b_j x^{-j} \right) (1 - b_0)^{-1} = \sum_{j=1}^m c_j x^{-j}.$$

Hence, $x^n = \sum_{j=1}^m c_j x^{n-j}$. Using $1 = \sum_{i=0}^n a_i x^i$, we get

$$1 = \sum_{i=0}^n a_i x^i + \sum_{j=1}^m a_n c_j x^{n-j}.$$

But $m \leq n$, so $n - j \geq 0$, for all $j \leq m$. Also $n - j < n$, hence we have an expression for 1 with exponent of x being at most $n - 1$, which contradicts the minimality of n . Therefore, $\mathcal{O}$ is a valuation ring. $\blacksquare$

Definition 1.5.1. Let K_2/K_1 be a field extension and $\mathcal{O}_i \subseteq K_i$ be valuation rings. We say $\mathcal{O}_2$ is a **prolongation** or **extension** of $\mathcal{O}_1$ (or $\mathcal{O}_2$ lies over $\mathcal{O}_1$) if $\mathcal{O}_2 \cap K_1 = \mathcal{O}_1$, denoted as $(K_1, \mathcal{O}_1) \subseteq (K_2, \mathcal{O}_2)$.

In this case, we have $\mathcal{M}_2 \cap K_1 = \mathcal{M}_1$, $\mathcal{O}_2 \cap K_1 = \mathcal{O}_1$, and $\mathcal{O}_2^\times \cap K_1 = \mathcal{O}_1^\times \implies \mathcal{O}_1 = \mathcal{O}_2 \cap K_1$. Given a field extension K_2/K_1 and a valuation ring $\mathcal{O}_1 \subseteq K_1$, we see that $\mathcal{O}_1 := \mathcal{O}_2 \cap K_1$ is a valuation ring of K_1 such that $(K_1, \mathcal{O}_1) \subseteq (K_2, \mathcal{O}_2)$.

Theorem 1.5.2. Let K_2/K_1 be a field extension and $\mathcal{O}_1 \subseteq K_1$ be a valuation ring. Then, there is a prolongation $\mathcal{O}_2 \subseteq K_2$ of $\mathcal{O}_1$.

Proof. We have $\mathcal{O}_1$ is a subring of K_1 and $\mathcal{M}_1 \triangleleft \mathcal{O}_1$ is maximal, hence prime. Thus, by Chevalley's Theorem, there exists a valuation ring $\mathcal{O}_2 \subseteq K_2$ with $\mathcal{O}_2 \cap K_1 = \mathcal{O}_1$ and $\mathcal{M}_2 \cap K_1 = \mathcal{M}_1$.

Claim: The maximal ideal of $\mathcal{O}_2 \cap K_1$ is $\mathcal{M}_2 \cap K_1 = \mathcal{M}_1$.

Let $x \in \mathcal{M}_2 \cap K_1$ and $a \in \mathcal{O}_2 \cap K_1$ be arbitrary. We will show that $ax \in \mathcal{M}_2 \cap K_1 = \mathcal{M}_1$. Now, $a \in K_1 \implies a \in \mathcal{O}_1$ or $a^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}_1$. If $a \in \mathcal{O}_1$, then $ax \in \mathcal{M}_1$, and we are done. Otherwise, $a^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}_1$. We already have $ax \in \mathcal{M}_2$, since $a \in \mathcal{O}_2$, $x \in \mathcal{M}_2$, and $\mathcal{M}_2 \subset \mathcal{O}_2$. Thus, we need only show that $ax \in \mathcal{O}_1$. Suppose not, i.e., $ax \notin \mathcal{O}_1$. Then, $(ax)^{-1} = a^{-1}x^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}_1$, since $\mathcal{O}_1 \subseteq K_1$ is a valuation ring. Now, $x \in \mathcal{M}_1 \subset \mathcal{O}_1 \implies (a^{-1}x^{-1})x = a^{-1} \in \mathcal{M}_1 = \mathcal{M}_2 \cap K_1 \implies a^{-1} \in \mathcal{M}_2$. So a^{-1} is not invertible in $\mathcal{O}_2$, i.e., $(a^{-1})^{-1} = a \notin \mathcal{O}_2$ — contradiction.. Hence the claim is true. Since local rings with the same maximal ideal must coincide, we have $\mathcal{O}_2 \cap K_1 = \mathcal{O}_1$, and we are done. ▣

Theorem 1.5.3. 1. Every valuation ring $\mathcal{O}$ of a field K is integrally closed in K .

2. Let $D \subseteq K$ be a subring and $\mathbb{V} = \{\mathcal{O} : D \subseteq \mathcal{O} \text{ and } \mathcal{M} \cap D \text{ is a maximal ideal of } D\}$, where $\mathcal{O}$ is a valuation ring. The integral closure R of D in K equals

$$R_1 := \bigcap_{\mathcal{O} \in \mathbb{V}} \mathcal{O}.$$

Proof. 1. Let $x \in K$ with $a_0 + a_1x + \cdots + a_{n-1}x^{n-1} + x^n = 0$ for some $a_0, \dots, a_{n-1} \in \mathcal{O}$. If $x \in \mathcal{O}$, we are done. Suppose not. Then $x \notin \mathcal{O}$, i.e., $x^{-1} \in \mathcal{M}$, so
 $-x^n = a_0 + a_1x + \cdots + a_{n-1}x^{n-1}$
 $\implies -1 = a_0x^{-n} + \cdots + a_{n-1}x^{-1} \in \mathcal{M}$,

but $\mathcal{M}$ is a proper ideal — contradiction.

2. Let $x \in K$ be integral over D , i.e., $x^n + \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} a_i x^i = 0$ for some $a_i \in D$. Now, $D \subseteq \mathcal{O} \implies a_i \in \mathcal{O} \implies D \subseteq \mathcal{O}$ for all $\mathcal{O} \in \mathbb{V}$, so $D \subseteq R_1$. Hence, each $a_i \in R_1$, and so x is integral over R_1 . By (1), each $\mathcal{O} \in \mathbb{V}$ is integrally closed in K . Thus, $x \in \mathcal{O}$ for all $\mathcal{O} \in \mathbb{V}$, so $x \in R_1$. Thus, $R \subseteq R_1$. Conversely, let $x \notin R$. We will show $x \notin R_1$. First, observe $x \notin R[x^{-1}]$, otherwise $x = \sum_{i=0}^m b_i x^{-i}$, $b_i \in R$, then $x^{m+1} = \sum_{i=0}^m b_i x^{m-i} = b_0 x^m + b_1 x^{m-1} + \cdots + b_m$, $b_i \in R$. i.e., x is integral over R , and so integral over D — contradiction. Hence, $x \notin R[x^{-1}]$. Since x^{-1} is not invertible in $R[x^{-1}]$, we have $x^{-1} \in \mathfrak{m}$ for some maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}$ of $R[x^{-1}]$. By Chevalley's Theorem, there exists a valuation ring $\mathcal{O} \subseteq K$ such that $R[x^{-1}] \subseteq \mathcal{O}$ and $\mathcal{M} \cap R[x^{-1}] = \mathfrak{m}$. Since $x \in \mathfrak{m} = \mathcal{M} \cap R[x^{-1}]$, we get $x \in \mathcal{M} \implies x \notin \mathcal{O}$. Finally, we have $\mathcal{O} \in \mathbb{V}$, i.e., $\mathcal{M} \cap D \triangleleft D$ is maximal. This follows easily as contraction from an integral extension preserves maximality. Since $x \notin \mathcal{O}$, it follows that $x \notin R_1$, and we are done. ▀

Corollary 1.5.3.1. *Let L/K be any field extension and $\mathcal{O}$ be a valuation ring of K . Let R be the integral closure of $\mathcal{O}$ in L . Then, letting $\mathcal{O}'$ range over the set of prolongations of $\mathcal{O}$ to L , we have*

$$R = \bigcap_{\mathcal{O}' \supseteq \mathcal{O}} \mathcal{O}'.$$

Proof. For each prolongation $\mathcal{O}'$, let $\mathcal{M}'$ be its maximal ideal. Then, by definition, $\mathcal{M} \cap \mathcal{O} = \mathcal{M}$. Conversely, if $\mathcal{O}' \supseteq \mathcal{O}$ has maximal ideal $\mathcal{M}'$ satisfying $\mathcal{M} \cap \mathcal{O} = \mathcal{M}$, then $\mathcal{O}' \cap K = \mathcal{O}$. Hence, the set $\mathbb{V}$ is exactly the set of prolongations of $\mathcal{O}$ to L . The result thus follows from the theorem. ▀

Let $(K_1, \mathcal{O}_1) \subset (K_2, \mathcal{O}_2)$ be an arbitrary extension of valued fields. For each $\mathcal{O}_i$, let $v_i : K \rightarrow \Gamma_i \cup \{\infty\}$ be a valuation and recall that its restriction $v_i : K_i^\times \rightarrow \Gamma_i$ is a group homomorphism with kernel $\mathcal{O}_i^\times$ and so $K_i^\times / \mathcal{O}_i^\times \cong \Gamma_i$. Further, the composite map

$$K_1^\times \hookrightarrow K_2^\times \twoheadrightarrow K_2^\times / \mathcal{O}_2^\times \cong \Gamma_2$$

has kernel $K_1^\times \cap \mathcal{O}_2^\times = \mathcal{O}_1^\times$. Thus, $\Gamma_1 \cong K_1^\times / \mathcal{O}_1^\times \hookrightarrow K_2^\times / \mathcal{O}_2^\times \cong \Gamma_2$ is a well-defined group homomorphism. Hence, we may regard Γ_1 as an ordered subgroup of Γ_2 .

Definition 1.5.2. Define the **ramification index** of this extension as

$$e := e(\mathcal{O}_2 / \mathcal{O}_1) := [\Gamma_2 : \Gamma_1].$$

1.5. EXTENSIONS OF VALUATIONS

As before, considering $\mathcal{O}_1 \hookrightarrow \mathcal{O}_2 \twoheadrightarrow \mathcal{O}_2/\mathcal{M}_2 = \mathcal{K}_2$ has kernel $\mathcal{O}_1/\mathcal{M}_2 = \mathcal{M}_1$, we get a well-defined map $\mathcal{K}_1 \hookrightarrow \mathcal{K}_2$.

Definition 1.5.3. Define the *residue degree* of this extension as

$$f := f(\mathcal{O}_2/\mathcal{O}_1) = [\mathcal{K}_2 : \mathcal{K}_1].$$

Now, if $e(\mathcal{O}_2/\mathcal{O}_1) = f(\mathcal{O}_2/\mathcal{O}_1) = 1$, then the extension $\mathcal{O}_2/\mathcal{O}_1$ is called *immediate*.

Example 1.7. A completion $(\widehat{K}, \widehat{\mathcal{O}})$ of a rank-one valued field $(K, \mathcal{O})$ is an immediate extension, as seen previously.

Remark 1.6. e and f are multiplicative: if $(K_1, \mathcal{O}_1) \subseteq (K_2, \mathcal{O}_2) \subseteq (K_3, \mathcal{O}_3)$, then

$$e(\mathcal{O}_3/\mathcal{O}_1) = e(\mathcal{O}_3/\mathcal{O}_2) e(\mathcal{O}_2/\mathcal{O}_1)$$

and

$$f(\mathcal{O}_3/\mathcal{O}_1) = f(\mathcal{O}_3/\mathcal{O}_2) f(\mathcal{O}_2/\mathcal{O}_1),$$

because degrees of extensions are multiplicative.

Lemma 1.5.1. Suppose $(K_1, \mathcal{O}_1) \subseteq (K_2, \mathcal{O}_2)$, and for $i = 1, 2$, let v_i be the valuation corresponding to $\mathcal{O}_i$. Choose $\omega_1, \dots, \omega_f \in \mathcal{O}_2$ and $\pi_1, \dots, \pi_e \in K_2^\times$ so that:

1. the residues $\bar{\omega}_1, \dots, \bar{\omega}_f \in \bar{\mathcal{K}}_2$ are linearly independent over $\bar{\mathcal{K}}_1$;
 2. the values $v_2(\pi_1), \dots, v_2(\pi_e)$ are representatives of the distinct cosets of Γ_2/Γ_1 .
- Then for all $a_{ij} \in K_1$,

$$v_2\left(\sum_{i=1}^f \sum_{j=1}^e a_{ij} \omega_i \pi_j\right) = \min\{v_2(a_{ij} \omega_i \pi_j) \mid 1 \leq i \leq f, 1 \leq j \leq e\}.$$

In particular, the products

$$\{\omega_i \pi_j \mid i = 1, \dots, f, j = 1, \dots, e\}$$

are linearly independent over K_1 .

Proof. Let $a_{ij} \in K_1$ not all zero, and pick $1 \leq I \leq f$ and $1 \leq J \leq e$ such that

$$v_2(a_{IJ} \omega_I \pi_J) = \min_{i,j} \{v_2(a_{ij} \omega_i \pi_j)\}.$$

Claim: $v_2(a_{IJ}\pi_J) < v_2(a_{ij}\pi_j)$ for all $j \neq J$.

If not, then there exist $j \neq J$ with $v_2(a_{ij}\pi_j) = v_2(a_{IJ}\pi_J)$; i.e. $v_2(a_{IJ}) + v_2(\pi_J) = v_2(a_{IJ}) + v_2(\pi_j)$. Now, $v_2(\pi_j) - v_2(\pi_J) = v_2(a_{IJ}) - v_2(a_{ij}) \in \Gamma_1$ implying $v_2(\pi_j) \equiv v_2(\pi_J) \pmod{\Gamma_1}$, which contradicts the second hypothesis. This proves the claim.

Let $z = \sum_{i=1}^f \sum_{j=1}^e a_{ij}\omega_i\pi_j$. We know by the strong triangle inequality that $v_2(z) \geq \min_{i,j} v_2(a_{ij}\omega_i\pi_j)$. If equality holds, we are done. Suppose not, i.e. $v_2(z) > \min_{i,j} v_2(a_{ij}\omega_i\pi_j)$. Note that

$$v_2(a_{ij}\omega_i\pi_j) = v_2(a_{ij}\pi_j) + v_2(\omega_i) \geq v_2(a_{ij}\pi_j) \quad (\text{since } \omega_i \in \mathcal{O}_2).$$

Hence $v_2(z) \geq v_2(a_{ij}\pi_j) \geq v_2(a_{IJ}\pi_J)$. Therefore $z(a_{IJ}\pi_J)^{-1} \in \mathcal{M}_2$.

Moreover, by the earlier claim, $a_{ij}\pi_j\omega_i(a_{IJ}\pi_J)^{-1} \in \mathcal{M}_2$ for all $j \neq J$.

Thus

$$z(a_{IJ}\pi_J)^{-1} - \sum_{i=1}^f \sum_{j \neq J} a_{ij}\pi_j\omega_i(a_{IJ}\pi_J)^{-1} \in \mathcal{M}_2,$$

and this expression equals $\sum_{i=1}^f a_{iJ}(a_{IJ})^{-1}\omega_i$, because

$$z - \sum_{j \neq J} \sum_{i=1}^f a_{ij}\pi_j\omega_i = \sum_{i=1}^f a_{iJ}\omega_i\pi_J.$$

Hence, $\sum_{i=1}^f a_{iJ}(a_{IJ})^{-1}\omega_i \in \mathcal{M}_2$, thus its image in $\mathcal{K}_2$ is zero, i.e., $\sum_{i=1}^f \overline{a_{iJ}(a_{IJ})^{-1}\omega_i} = \bar{0}$, which contradicts hypothesis 1. ▀

Theorem 1.5.4. Suppose $(K_1, \mathcal{O}_1) \subseteq (K_2, \mathcal{O}_2)$ and $n = [K_2 : K_1] < \infty$. Then, $e, f < \infty$ and $ef < n$.

Proof. This follows because $\{\omega_i\pi_j \mid i = 1, \dots, f, j = 1, \dots, e\}$ is a linearly independent set of cardinality ef . ▀

Theorem 1.5.5. Let $(K_1, \mathcal{O}_1) \subseteq (K_2, \mathcal{O}_2)$ with K_2 algebraic over K_1 . Then

1. For every $\gamma \in \Gamma_2$, there exists $n \in \mathbb{N}$ such that $n\gamma \in \Gamma_1$, i.e. Γ_2/Γ_1 is a torsion group.
2. $\overline{K_2}$ is an algebraic extension of $\overline{K_1}$.

Proof. 1. Let $\gamma \in \Gamma_2$ be arbitrary. Since v_2 is surjective, choose $x \in K_2^\times$ with $v_2(x) = \gamma$. Let $L = K_1(x) \subseteq K_2$. Because x is algebraic over K_1 , the extension L/K_1 is finite. Let $\Gamma = v(L^\times) \subseteq \Gamma_2$. Clearly, we have $(L, \mathcal{O}) \subset (K_2, \mathcal{O}_2)$.

Claim: $(K_1, \mathcal{O}_1) \subset (L, \mathcal{O})$.

Consider $\mathcal{O} \cap K_1 = \mathcal{O}_2 \cap K_1(x) \cap K_1 = (\mathcal{O}_2 \cap K_1) \cap K_1(x) = \mathcal{O}_1 \cap K_1(x) = \mathcal{O}_1$, because $\mathcal{O}_2 \cap K_1 = \mathcal{O}_1$ and $\mathcal{O}_1 \subseteq K_1 \subseteq K_1(x)$. Therefore, we have $(K_1, \mathcal{O}_1) \subseteq (L, \mathcal{O}) \subseteq (K_1, \mathcal{O}_2)$. Now, $L = K_1(x)$ and x is algebraic over K_1 , hence $[L : K_1] < \infty$. Thus, from the previous corollary, we have $[\Gamma_L : \Gamma_1] < \infty$. Clearly, $\Gamma_1 = v(K_1^\times) \subset v(L^\times) = \Gamma$ and both are abelian groups. Thus $\Gamma_1 \triangleleft \Gamma$. Therefore Γ/Γ_1 is a group and it is finite. Therefore, $\exists n \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for all $\gamma \in \Gamma$ we have $n\gamma \in \Gamma_1$, showing that Γ_2/Γ_1 is torsion.

2. Take any $x \in \mathcal{O}_2^\times$ and define L as before, then proceeding similarly as before, we obtain $\overline{L}/\overline{K_1}$ is finite (by the previous corollary) and hence $\overline{x}$ is algebraic over $\overline{K_1}$.

■

Lemma 1.5.2. *Suppose $\mathcal{O}_1, \mathcal{O}_2, \dots, \mathcal{O}_n$ are valuation rings of a field K with maximal ideals $\mathcal{M}_1, \mathcal{M}_2, \dots, \mathcal{M}_n$. Let $R = \bigcap_{i=1}^n \mathcal{O}_i$ and $\mathfrak{p}_i = R \cap \mathcal{M}_i$. Then $\forall i, R_{\mathfrak{p}_i} = \mathcal{O}_i$.*

Proof. We first show that $R_{\mathfrak{p}_i} \subseteq \mathcal{O}_i$. Let $a/b \in R_{\mathfrak{p}_i}$ with $a, b \in R$ and $b \notin \mathfrak{p}_i$. Then $b \notin \mathcal{M}_i$, so $b^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}_i^\times$. Since $a \in R \subseteq \mathcal{O}_i$, we have $ab^{-1} = a/b \in \mathcal{O}_i$.

Conversely, let $a \in \mathcal{O}_i$ and set $I_a = \{j \mid a \in \mathcal{O}_j\}$. Write $\alpha_j = a + \mathcal{M}_j \in \overline{K_j}$ for each $j \in I_a$. Choose a prime $p \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for all $j \in I_a$ we have $p > \text{char}(\overline{K_j})$ and α_j is not a primitive p th root of unity. Set $b = 1 + a + \dots + a^{p-1}$. Observe that

$$\alpha_j = \overline{a} = 1 \text{ implies } \overline{b} = 1 + 1 + \dots + 1 = p \neq 0 \text{ in } \overline{K_j}$$

$$\alpha_j = \overline{a} \neq 1 \text{ implies } \overline{b} = \frac{1 - \alpha_j^p}{1 - \alpha_j} \neq 0 \text{ in } \overline{K_j}.$$

Thus, $b \notin \mathcal{M}_j$ in both cases, hence $b \in \mathcal{O}_j^\times \forall j \in I_a$. For $j \in \{1, 2, \dots, n\} \setminus I_a$, $a \notin \mathcal{O}_j \implies a^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}_j$ and $a^{-1} \in \mathcal{M}_j$, since a^{-1} is a nonunit of $\mathcal{O}_j$. Thus, $1 + a^{-1} + \dots + a^{-(p-1)} \in \mathcal{O}_j^\times$, implying $b^{-1} = a^{-(p-1)}(1 + a^{-1} + \dots + a^{-(p-1)})^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}_j$, and so $ab^{-1} = a^{-(p-2)}(1 + a^{-1} + \dots + a^{-(p-1)})^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}_j$.

Thus for all $j = 1, \dots, n$ we have $b^{-1}, ab^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}_j$. Therefore $b^{-1}, ab^{-1} \in R$, and $b^{-1} \notin \mathcal{M}_i \cap R = \mathfrak{p}_i$, since $b \in \mathcal{O}_i^\times$. Hence $a = \frac{ab^{-1}}{b^{-1}} \in R_{\mathfrak{p}_i}$.

■

Theorem 1.5.6. *Suppose $\mathcal{O}_1, \mathcal{O}_2, \dots, \mathcal{O}_n$ are valuation rings of a field K with maximal ideals $\mathcal{M}_1, \mathcal{M}_2, \dots, \mathcal{M}_n$. Let $R = \bigcap_{i=1}^n \mathcal{O}_i$ and $\mathfrak{p}_i = R \cap \mathcal{M}_i$. Further, suppose that $\mathcal{O}_i \not\subseteq \mathcal{O}_j$ for all $i \neq j$. Then*

1. *for all $i \neq j$, $\mathfrak{p}_i \not\subseteq \mathfrak{p}_j$;*
2. *$\mathfrak{p}_1, \dots, \mathfrak{p}_n$ is the set of all maximal ideals of R ;*
3. *for each n -tuple $(a_1, \dots, a_n) \in \mathcal{O}_1 \times \dots \times \mathcal{O}_n$, there exists an $a \in R$ with $a - a_i \in \mathcal{M}_i$.*

Proof. 1. Suppose not, i.e., $\exists i \neq j$ with $\mathfrak{p}_i \subseteq \mathfrak{p}_j$. By the previous lemma, $\mathcal{O}_j = R_{\mathfrak{p}_j} \subseteq R_{\mathfrak{p}_i} = \mathcal{O}_i$, but this contradicts the hypothesis.

2. **Claim: every ideal $\mathfrak{a} \neq R$ is contained in some $\mathfrak{p}_i$, $i = 1, \dots, n$.**

Suppose not, i.e., there exists an ideal $\mathfrak{a} \neq R$ such that for each $i = 1, \dots, n$, there exists $a_i \in \mathfrak{a} \setminus \mathfrak{p}_i$. For each $i \neq j$, use (1) to pick $b_{ij} \in \mathfrak{p}_i \setminus \mathfrak{p}_j$. Then

$$c_j := \prod_{i \neq j} b_{ij} \in \mathfrak{p}_i \setminus \mathfrak{p}_j, \text{ for every } j = 1, \dots, n.$$

Consequently, $a_j c_j \in \mathfrak{p}_i$ for all $i \neq j$ and $a_j c_j \notin \mathfrak{p}_j$. This is because $\mathfrak{p}_j$ is prime, since it is the contraction of the prime ideal $\mathcal{M}_j$ to R .

Consider $d := \sum_{j=1}^n a_j c_j \notin \mathfrak{p}_i$ for all $i = 1, \dots, n$. Now, $d \in \mathfrak{a} \subset R$ but $d \notin \mathfrak{p}_i = R \cap \mathcal{M}_i \implies d \notin \mathcal{M}_i$, implying $d^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}_i$, for every i such that $1 \leq i \leq n$. Hence $d^{-1} \in R$, yielding $1 = dd^{-1} \in \mathfrak{a}$, a contradiction, since $\mathfrak{a} \neq R$. This proves the claim. Now, note that the above claim holds for any ideal. In particular, it holds for maximal ideals, whence we conclude that every maximal ideal is equal to some $\mathfrak{p}_i$, $i = 1, \dots, n$. Thus, the set of maximal ideals in a subset of $\{\mathfrak{p}_1, \dots, \mathfrak{p}_n\}$. But by (1.), all the $\mathfrak{p}_i$ are distinct, hence the set of maximal ideals must be exactly equal to $\{\mathfrak{p}_1, \dots, \mathfrak{p}_n\}$.

3. For $i \neq j$, $\mathfrak{p}_i + \mathfrak{p}_j = R$, since the only maximal ideals are $\mathfrak{p}_i$ and $\mathfrak{p}_i \not\subseteq \mathfrak{p}_j$. Therefore, by the Chinese Remainder Theorem, the canonical map

$$R \longrightarrow R/\mathfrak{p}_1 \times \dots \times R/\mathfrak{p}_n$$

is surjective. We know, for each i , $R_{\mathfrak{p}_i}/\mathfrak{p}_i R_{\mathfrak{p}_i} \cong R/\mathfrak{p}_i$, and $R_{\mathfrak{p}_i} = \mathcal{O}_i$, it follows that

$$R \longrightarrow \mathcal{O}_1/\mathcal{M}_1 \times \dots \times \mathcal{O}_n/\mathcal{M}_n$$

is surjective. Hence, given any $(\bar{a}_1, \bar{a}_2, \dots, \bar{a}_n) \in \prod_i \mathcal{O}_i / \mathcal{M}_i$, there exists $a \in R$ such that $a \equiv a_i \pmod{\mathcal{M}_i}$ for all $i \implies a - a_i \in \mathcal{M}_i$. ▀

Lemma 1.5.3. *Suppose K_2/K_1 is an algebraic extension of fields and $\mathcal{O} \subset K_1$ is a valuation ring. Let $\mathcal{O}', \mathcal{O}'' \subset K_2$ be valuation rings lying over $\mathcal{O}$. If $\mathcal{O}' \subset \mathcal{O}''$, then $\mathcal{O}' = \mathcal{O}''$.*

Proof. We have $\mathcal{O}' \cap K_1 = \mathcal{O}'' \cap K_1 = \mathcal{O}$ and $\mathcal{O}' \subset \mathcal{O}''$, which implies $\mathcal{M}'' \subset \mathcal{M}'$. Hence, we have $\mathcal{O}'/\mathcal{M}'' = \overline{\mathcal{O}'} \subset \mathcal{O}''/\mathcal{M}'' = \overline{\mathcal{O}''}$. Consider the natural order-preserving homomorphism $\mathcal{O}'' \twoheadrightarrow \overline{\mathcal{O}''}$. The image of $\mathcal{O}'$ under this map is $\mathcal{O}'/\mathcal{M}'' = \overline{\mathcal{O}'}$.

Claim: $\overline{\mathcal{O}'}$ is a valuation ring of $\overline{\mathcal{O}''}$: let $\bar{x} \in \overline{\mathcal{O}''}$ be arbitrary; look at its preimage $x \in \mathcal{O}''$. If $x \in \mathcal{O}'$, then $\bar{x} \in \overline{\mathcal{O}'}$ and we are done. If not, then we must have $x^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}'$, as $\mathcal{O}'$ is a valuation ring. Then, $\overline{x^{-1}} = \bar{x}^{-1} \in \overline{\mathcal{O}'}$. Thus, given any $\bar{x} \in \overline{\mathcal{O}''}$, we must have either $\bar{x} \in \overline{\mathcal{O}'}$ or $\bar{x}^{-1} \in \overline{\mathcal{O}'}$ — this proves the claim.

We will now show that $\overline{\mathcal{O}'} = \overline{\mathcal{O}''}$. First, to see that $\overline{\mathcal{O}'}$ is a field, take any nonzero $x \in \overline{\mathcal{O}'}$. We have seen previously that the extension $\overline{\mathcal{O}''}/\overline{\mathcal{O}}$ of residue class fields is algebraic, hence there exist $a_0, a_1, \dots, a_r \in \overline{\mathcal{O}}$ such that $a_0 + a_1x + \dots + a_rx^r = 0$ in $\overline{\mathcal{O}'}$. Assume without loss of generality that $a_0 \neq 0$. Note that since $a_0 \in \overline{\mathcal{O}} = \mathcal{O}'/\mathcal{M}'$, which is a field, hence its inverse a_0^{-1} is also in $\mathcal{O}'/\mathcal{M}' \subset \mathcal{O}'/\mathcal{M}'' = \overline{\mathcal{O}'}$. Thus, the element $y = -a_0^{-1}(a_1 + \dots + a_rx^{r-1}) \in \overline{\mathcal{O}'}$. It is clear that $xy = 1$, hence $\overline{\mathcal{O}'}$ is a field so it must equal its field of fractions $\overline{\mathcal{O}''}$. We then have $\mathcal{M}''$ is a maximal ideal of $\mathcal{O}'$, but $\mathcal{O}'$ is a local ring so $\mathcal{M}' = \mathcal{M}''$ whence it follows that $\mathcal{O}' = \mathcal{O}''$. ▀

Given an algebraic extension K_2 of K_1 and a valuation ring $\mathcal{O}_1$ of K_1 , there may exist infinitely many valuation rings of K_2 lying over $\mathcal{O}_1$. In certain cases, there is a natural bound. Let $K_2 \cap K_1^s = \{x \in K_2 \mid x \text{ is separable over } K_1\}$. The field $K_2 \cap K_1^s$ is a separable extension of K_1 .

Definition 1.5.4. $[K_2 \cap K_1^s : K_1]$ is called the **degree of separability** of K_2 over K_1 . Moreover, $[K_2 : K_2 \cap K_1^s]$ is called the **degree of inseparability** of K_2 over K_1 .

Every $x \in K_2 \setminus (K_2 \cap K_1^s)$ is purely inseparable over $K_2 \cap K_1^s$.

We use the following notations: $[K_2 : K_1]_s = [K_2 \cap K_1^s : K_1]$, $[K_2 : K_1]_i = [K_2 : K_2 \cap K_1^s]$.

Theorem 1.5.7. *Let K_2 be algebraic over K_1 , and $[K_2 : K_1]_s < \infty$. Let $\mathcal{O}$ be a valuation ring of K_1 . Then the number n of all prolongations of $\mathcal{O}$ to K_2 is finite, and $n \leq [K_2 : K_1]_s$.*

Proof. Let $\mathcal{O}_1, \dots, \mathcal{O}_m$ be distinct prolongations of $\mathcal{O}$ to K_2 , with maximal ideals $\mathcal{M}_1, \dots, \mathcal{M}_m$, respectively. Since they are distinct, they must be pairwise incomparable, by the previous lemma. Consider now the elements $e_j := (0, \dots, 1, \dots, 0) \in \prod_{i=1}^m \mathcal{O}_i$. For every j , using Theorem 1.5.5 (3), we conclude the existence of a c_j such that $c_j - 1 \in \mathcal{M}_j$ and $c_i \in \mathcal{M}_j$ for $i \neq j$. Hence, we obtain $c_1, \dots, c_m$ such that for all $i, j \in \{1, \dots, m\}$, $c_j - 1 \in \mathcal{M}_j$ and $c_i \in \mathcal{M}_j$ for $i \neq j$.

We consider two cases:

- (i) $\text{char } K_1 = p > 0$: we pick $k \in \mathbb{N}$ large enough to ensure the separability of $c_1^{p^k}, \dots, c_m^{p^k}$ over K_1 .
- (ii) $\text{char } K_1 = 0$: we proceed as above and simply take $k = 0$.

Claim: These m elements are linearly independent over K_1

Suppose not. Then there exist a_i , not all zero, such that $\sum_{i=1}^m a_i c_i^{p^k} = 0$. Pick $j \leq m$ such that $v(a_j) = \min_{i \leq m} v(a_i)$. Note that $a_j \neq 0$, otherwise $v(a_j) = \infty \implies v(a_i) = \infty \implies a_i = 0$ for all i . Thus, $c_j^{p^k} = -\sum_{i \neq j} a_i c_i^{p^k} \in \mathcal{M}_j$. Hence, $v_j(c_j^{p^k}) = p^k v_j(c_j) > 0 \implies v_j(c_j) > 0 \implies c_j \in \mathcal{M}_j$. In particular, we have both $c_j - 1 \in \mathcal{M}_j$ and $c_j \in \mathcal{M}_j \implies 1 \in \mathcal{M}_j$, which is a contradiction. This proves the claim and hence $m \leq [K_2 : K_1]_s$.

Note that we may repeat the above argument with $m+1$ distinct valuations and thus similarly show that $m+1 \leq [K_2 : K_1]_s$. Proceeding inductively, we can conclude that there can only be finitely many extensions of $\mathcal{O}$ to K_2 since $[K_2 : K_1]_s < \infty$. Moreover, this number must be bounded above by $[K_2 : K_1]_s$ as seen above. This concludes the proof. ▀

Corollary 1.5.7.1. *Suppose K_2 is a purely inseparable algebraic extension of K_1 . Then every valuation ring $\mathcal{O}$ of K_1 has exactly one prolongation to K_2 .*

Lemma 1.5.4. *Suppose K is a field with a non-trivial valuation v . For every polynomial*

$$g(x) = a_0 + a_1x + \dots + a_{n-1}x^{n-1} + x^n \in K[x]$$

and every γ in the value group Γ of v , there exists a separable polynomial

$$h(x) = b_0 + b_1x + \dots + b_{n-1}x^{n-1} + x^n \in K[x]$$

such that $v(a_i - b_i) > \gamma$ for every i with $0 \leq i < n$.

1.5. EXTENSIONS OF VALUATIONS

Proof. Let $y_0, y_1, \dots, y_{n-1}$ be indeterminates over K . Construct

$$f_y(x) = f_{y_0, y_1, \dots, y_{n-1}}(x) = \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} (a_i + y_i)x^i + x^n \in K(y_0, y_1, \dots, y_{n-1})[x].$$

Consider the resultant $\text{Res}(f_y, f'_y) = \text{disc}(f)$. By the algebraic independence of $y_0, y_1, \dots, y_{n-1}$ over K , it follows that $\text{Res}(f_y, f'_y)$ is a nontrivial polynomial R in $K[y_0, y_1, \dots, y_{n-1}]$. Since v is nontrivial, $\exists x \in K$ such that $v(x) = \alpha \neq 0$. Then, $v(x^n) = n\alpha \neq 0 \forall n \in \mathbb{N}$. Hence, $v(K) = \Gamma$ is infinite. Therefore, K cannot be a finite field. Hence $\forall \delta \in \Gamma, \{x \in K \mid v(x) > \delta\}$ is an infinite set, otherwise it would be a closed set.

Claim: For a nonconstant polynomial $g(x_1, \dots, x_n)$ in $K[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ and an infinite subset $M \subseteq K$, $\exists(m_1, \dots, m_n) \in M^n$ such that $g(m_1, \dots, m_n) \neq 0$.

We prove this by induction on n . For $n = 1$, we have a polynomial $g(x) \in K[x]$. Suppose $g(x) = 0 \forall x \in M$, since M is infinite, g has infinite roots, i.e. $g \equiv 0$, a contradiction. Thus, there exists $y \in M$ such that $g(y) \neq 0$.

We now assume the claim for $n = k - 1$ and prove it for $n = k$. We have $g(x_1, \dots, x_n)$. Fix some $y_n \in M$ and look at $g(x_1, x_2, \dots, y_n) \in K[x_1, x_2, \dots, x_{n-1}]$. By induction hypothesis, we have $(y_1, \dots, y_{n-1}) \in M^{n-1}$ such that $g(y_1, y_2, \dots, y_n) \neq 0$. Thus, we have a $(y_1, y_2, \dots, y_n) \in M^n$ such that $g(y_1, \dots, y_n) \neq 0$.

Applying the claim with $M = \{x \in K \mid v(x) > \delta\}$ and $g = R$, we get $c_0, c_1, \dots, c_n \in M$ such that $R(c_0, c_1, \dots, c_n) \neq 0$. Now, $c_i \in M \implies v(c_i) > \delta$.

Set $h(x) := x^n + \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} (a_i + c_i)x^i = (a_0 + c_0) + (a_1 + c_1)x + \dots + x^n$. It follows that $\text{Res}(h, h') = \text{disc}(h) \neq 0$, i.e., h and h' have no common roots, i.e., $h(x)$ has no repeated roots, i.e., h is a separable polynomial. □

We shall use this lemma to prove the following theorem:

Theorem 1.5.8. *Suppose K is a separably closed field and $\mathcal{O}$ is a proper valuation ring of K . Let $\widetilde{K}$ be an algebraic closure of K and let $\widetilde{\mathcal{O}}$ be the unique extension of $\mathcal{O}$ to $\widetilde{K}$. Then $\widetilde{\mathcal{O}}/\mathcal{O}$ is an immediate extension. In particular, the residue class field $\overline{K}$ of $\mathcal{O}$ is algebraically closed, and the value group Γ of $\mathcal{O}$ is divisible, i.e., for every $\gamma \in \Gamma$ and any $n \in \mathbb{N} \setminus \{0\}$, there exists $\delta \in \Gamma$ such that $n\delta = \gamma$.*

Proof. Let $\widetilde{\Gamma}$ and $\widetilde{K}$ denote the value group and residue class field of $\widetilde{\mathcal{O}}$.

Note that the multiplicative group $\widetilde{K}^\times$ of $\widetilde{K}$ is divisible. To see this, let $a \in \widetilde{K}^\times$ and $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Consider $g(x) = x^n - a$. Since $\widetilde{K}$ is an algebraic closure of K , $g(x)$ has a root in $\widetilde{K}$, say b . Then, $b^n = a$, whence we conclude that $\widetilde{K}^\times$ is divisible.

Now, $\tilde{\Gamma} = \tilde{K}^\times / \tilde{\mathcal{O}}^\times$ is a quotient of a divisible group, hence it is also divisible. Similarly, for $a_0, a_1, \dots, a_n \in \tilde{\mathcal{O}}$, $n > 0$, $a_n \in \tilde{\mathcal{O}}^\times$, the polynomial $\bar{f}(x) = a_0 + a_1x + \dots + a_nx^n \in \tilde{\mathcal{K}}[x]$ has a root in $\tilde{K}$ since $f(x) = a_0 + a_1x + \dots + a_nx^n$ has a root in $\tilde{\mathcal{O}}$ because $\tilde{\mathcal{O}}$ is integrally closed in $\tilde{K}$.

Claim: $\bar{K} = \tilde{\mathcal{K}}$.

Take $x \in \tilde{\mathcal{O}}^\times$ and let g be the minimal polynomial of $\bar{x}$ over $\bar{K}$. Consider $g \in \mathcal{O}[x]$, say $g = a_0 + a_1x + \dots + a_{n-1}x^{n-1} + x^n$. By the previous lemma, pick a separable polynomial $h(x) = x^n + \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} b_ix^i$ such that $v(a_i - b_i) > 0 \ \forall 1 \leq i < n$, then $g(x) - h(x) \in \mathcal{O}[x]$. Hence, $h(x) = g(x) - (g(x) - h(x)) \in \mathcal{O}[x]$. Further, note that $v(a_i - b_i) > 0 \implies g - h \in \mathcal{M}[x]$. Now, h is separable, hence it has a root z in K . We know that $\mathcal{O}$ is integrally closed in K , hence $z \in \mathcal{O}$. Now, $\bar{g}(\bar{z}) = \overline{g(z)} = \overline{g(z) - h(z)} = \overline{\sum_{i=0}^{n-1} (a_i - b_i)z^i} = 0$. As $\bar{g}$ is the minimal polynomial of $\bar{x}$ over $\bar{K}$, it follows that $\bar{g}$ has degree one and hence $\bar{x} \in \bar{K}$. This gives $\tilde{\mathcal{K}} \subseteq \bar{K}$.

Conversely, $\mathcal{O} \subseteq \tilde{\mathcal{O}}$ and $\mathcal{M} \subseteq \tilde{\mathcal{M}} \implies \mathcal{O}/\mathcal{M} \subseteq \tilde{\mathcal{O}}/\tilde{\mathcal{M}} \implies \bar{K} \subseteq \tilde{\mathcal{K}}$. Hence, $\bar{K} = \tilde{\mathcal{K}}$.

Now, we will show $\Gamma = \tilde{\Gamma}$. Let $\delta \in \tilde{\Gamma}$, then by Theorem 1.5.4, $\exists n > 1$ and $a \in K$ such that $n\delta = v(a) \in \Gamma$ where v is a valuation corresponding to $\mathcal{O}$. Take $\delta > 0$ without loss of generality and so $v(a) = n\delta > 0 \implies a \in \mathcal{O}$.

Let $g(x) = x^n - a$. By the previous lemma, there exists a separable polynomial $h(x) = x^n + \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} b_ix^i$ with $v(a_i - b_i) > n\delta \ \forall i = 1, 2, \dots, n$. Note that the a_i here are all zero except $a_0 = -a$. As before, h has a root $z \in \mathcal{O}$ and we have $v(g(z)) = v(g(z) - h(z)) \geq \min_{0 \leq i < n} \{v(a_i - b_i) + iv(z)\} > n\delta + \min_{0 \leq i < n} \{iv(z)\} = n\delta = v(a)$, because $v(z) \geq 0 \implies z \in \mathcal{O}$. Hence, $v(g(z)) > v(a) \implies v(z^n - a) > v(a) \implies v(z^n) = v(z^n - a + a) = v(a) = n\delta \implies v(z) = \delta \in \Gamma$. Hence, $\tilde{\Gamma} \subseteq \Gamma$. As before, $\Gamma \subseteq \tilde{\Gamma}$ follows trivially. Therefore $\tilde{\mathcal{O}}/\mathcal{O}$ is an immediate extension and we are done. $\blacksquare$

We now show that the integral closure of a valuation ring in an algebraic extension of its field of fractions has a localisation property in the following sense:

Theorem 1.5.9. *Let L be an algebraic extension of a field K , and let $\mathcal{O}$ be a valuation ring of K . Denote by R the integral closure of $\mathcal{O}$ in L and let $\mathcal{O}'$ be a prolongation of $\mathcal{O}$ to L . If $\mathcal{M}'$ is the maximal ideal of $\mathcal{O}'$ and $\mathfrak{m} = \mathcal{M}' \cap R$, then $R_{\mathfrak{m}} = \mathcal{O}'$.*

Proof. The containment $R_{\mathfrak{m}} \subset \mathcal{O}'$ is easy: take any $a/b \in R_{\mathfrak{m}}$ i.e., $a \in R, b \in R \setminus \mathfrak{m} \subset$

$\mathcal{M}$. Since $b \notin \mathcal{M}$, it follows that $b^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}'$. Now, $a \in R$ and $\mathcal{O}'$ is integrally closed in L , whence we get $a \in \mathcal{O}' \implies ab^{-1} = a/b \in \mathcal{O}'$.

For the converse, let $x \in \mathcal{O}'$. Set $K_2 := K(x)$, $R_2 := R \cap K_2$, $\mathfrak{m}_2 := \mathfrak{m} \cap K_2$, $\mathcal{O}'_2 := \mathcal{O}' \cap K_2$, and $\mathcal{M}_2 := \mathcal{M} \cap K_2$. Since R is the integral closure of $\mathcal{O}$ in L and $K_2 \subset L$, it follows that R_2 is the integral closure of $\mathcal{O}$ in K_2 . Hence, via Corollary 1.5.3.1, we obtain $R_2 = \bigcap \mathcal{O}''$ where $\mathcal{O}''$ ranges over all prolongations of $\mathcal{O}$ to K_2 . Note that since x is algebraic over K , we have $[K_2 : K] < \infty \implies [K_2 : K]_s < \infty$. We have seen before that in this case $n < [K_2 : K]_s$, i.e., n is finite. Hence, applying Lemma 1.5.2. with $\mathfrak{p}_2 = R_2 \cap \mathcal{M}_2 = (R \cap K_2) \cap (\mathcal{M} \cap K_2) = (R \cap \mathcal{M}) \cap K_2 = \mathfrak{m} \cap K_2 = \mathfrak{m}_2$, we get $\mathcal{O}_2 = (R_2)_{\mathfrak{m}_2}$. Therefore, there exist $a, b \in R_2$ with $b \notin \mathfrak{m}_2$ such that $x = ab^{-1}$. Clearly, $ab^{-1} \in R_{\mathfrak{m}} \implies x \in R_{\mathfrak{m}}$, yielding $\mathcal{O}' \subset R_{\mathfrak{m}}$. ▀

We now focus on normal extensions and prove some results on prolongations of a fixed valuation ring.

Theorem 1.5.10. *Suppose L/K is a finite normal extension of fields, with $G = \text{Aut}(L/K)$. Suppose $\mathcal{O}$ is a valuation ring of K , and $\mathcal{O}'$ and $\mathcal{O}''$ are valuation rings in L extending $\mathcal{O}$. Then $\mathcal{O}'$ and $\mathcal{O}''$ are conjugate over K , i.e., there exists $\sigma \in G$ with $\sigma\mathcal{O}' = \mathcal{O}''$.*

Proof. We have $K \subset L \cap K^s \subset L$. Set $L^s := L \cap K^s$. By Corollary 1.5.6.1., every prolongation of $\mathcal{O}$ to L^s can be uniquely extended to L . We also know from Galois theory that there is a canonical isomorphism $\text{Aut}(L/K) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Aut}(L^s/K)$. Hence, it suffices to consider the case where L/K is separable. Let

$$H' = \{\sigma \in G : \sigma\mathcal{O}' = \mathcal{O}'\} \leq G$$

$$H'' = \{\sigma \in G : \sigma\mathcal{O}'' = \mathcal{O}''\} \leq G$$

Claim: For every $\sigma \in H'$, we have $\sigma\mathcal{M}' = \mathcal{M}'$.

This follows because $\sigma\mathcal{O}' = \mathcal{O}'$ and if $\sigma(x) \in \mathcal{O}' \setminus \mathcal{M}'$ for some $x \in \mathcal{M}'$ then $\sigma(x)$ is a unit in $\mathcal{O}'$, i.e., $\sigma(x)^{-1} = \sigma(x^{-1}) \in \mathcal{O}' = \sigma\mathcal{O}' \implies x^{-1} \in \mathcal{O}'$ which contradicts the fact that $x \in \mathcal{M}'$. Now, $\sigma\mathcal{O}'$ is a valuation ring of L since $\sigma\mathcal{O}' = \mathcal{O}'$. By the above argument, it also follows that its maximal ideal is $\sigma\mathcal{M}'$. Similarly, for every $\tau \in H''$, we have $\tau\mathcal{O}''$ is a valuation ring of L with maximal ideal $\tau\mathcal{M}''$. We next write G as the following disjoint unions:

$$G = \coprod_{i=1}^n H' \sigma_i^{-1} = \coprod_{j=1}^m H'' \tau_j^{-1}$$

It then suffices to simply show that there exist i, j such that $\sigma_i \mathcal{O}' \subseteq \tau_j \mathcal{O}''$ or $\sigma_i \mathcal{O}' \supseteq \tau_j \mathcal{O}''$, since this implies $\sigma_i \mathcal{O}' = \tau_j \mathcal{O}''$, by Lemma 1.5.3. We then have $\tau_j^{-1} \sigma_i \mathcal{O}' = \mathcal{O}''$, thus finishing the proof. Thus, we need only show the existence of such i, j . Proceeding by contradiction, we assume no such i, j exist. Since $\{\sigma_i^{-1}\}_{i=1}^n$ is a transversal for G/H' , we must have $\sigma_k \mathcal{O}' \not\subseteq \sigma_t \mathcal{O}'$ for all $k \neq t$ otherwise we would obtain $\sigma_k \mathcal{O}' = \sigma_t \mathcal{O}'$ using Lemma 1.5.3. Similarly $\tau_k \mathcal{O}'' \not\subseteq \tau_t \mathcal{O}''$ for all $k \neq t$. Set

$$R = \left(\bigcap_{i=1}^n \sigma_i \mathcal{O}' \right) \cap \left(\bigcap_{j=1}^m \tau_j \mathcal{O}'' \right)$$

Using Theorem 1.5.5.(3) with the tuple $(1, \dots, 1, 0, \dots, 0) \in \prod_{i=1}^n \sigma_i \mathcal{O}' \times \prod_{j=1}^m \tau_j \mathcal{O}''$, we obtain $a \in R$ such that

$$a - 1 \in \sigma_i(\mathcal{M}') \text{ for } i = 1, \dots, n \text{ and}$$

$$a \in \tau_j(\mathcal{M}') \text{ for } j = 1, \dots, m.$$

Hence, for $\sigma \in G_1$, write $\sigma = \rho \sigma_i^{-1} \in H' \sigma_i \implies \rho \in H'$. This yields $\sigma(a - 1) = \rho \sigma_i^{-1}(a - 1) \in \rho \sigma_i^{-1}(\sigma_i(\mathcal{M}')) = \rho(\mathcal{M}') = \mathcal{M}'$. Similarly, $\sigma(a) \in \mathcal{M}''$ for all $\sigma \in G$. Now, $N_{L/K}(a) = \prod_{\sigma \in G_1} \sigma(a) \in (\mathcal{M}'' + 1) \cap K = \mathcal{M} + 1$, where the last equality follows by observing that $1 + m' \in K \implies m' \in K \cap \mathcal{M}' = \mathcal{M}$ for any $m' \in \mathcal{M}'$. Furthermore, we also have $N_{L/K}(a) = \prod_{\sigma \in G_1} \sigma(a) \in \mathcal{M}'' \cap K = \mathcal{M}$. This is a contradiction, and we are done. □

Theorem 1.5.11 (Conjugation Theorem). *Suppose L/K is an arbitrary normal extension of fields, $\mathcal{O}$ is a valuation ring of K , and $\mathcal{O}'$ and $\mathcal{O}''$ are valuation rings in L extending $\mathcal{O}$. Then there exists $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(L/K)$ with $\sigma(\mathcal{O}') = \mathcal{O}''$.*

Proof. Consider Σ , the set of ordered pairs (K_1, σ_1) where K_1 is a normal extension of L/K , i.e. $L/K_1/K$ with K_1/K normal, $\mathcal{O}'_1 := \mathcal{O}' \cap K_1$, $\mathcal{O}''_1 := \mathcal{O}'' \cap K_1$ and $\sigma_i \in \text{Aut}(K_1/K)$ such that $\sigma_1(\mathcal{O}'_1) = \mathcal{O}''_1$.

Clearly, $\Sigma \neq \emptyset$ since $(K, \text{id}) \in \Sigma$. We may partially order Σ as

$$(K_1, \sigma_1) \leq (K_2, \sigma_2) \iff K_1 \subseteq K_2 \text{ and } \sigma_2|_{K_1} = \sigma_1.$$

Take a chain $(K_i, \sigma_i)_{i \in \mathbb{N}}$ in Σ . Consider (K, σ) where $K := \bigcup K_i$ and $\sigma|_{K_i} := \sigma_i$. Since K_m is a composition of countably many normal extensions contained in L , K_m is also a normal extension of L/K . Thus, $(K, \sigma) \in \Sigma$ and we have an upper

bound, whence, by Zorn's Lemma, Σ has a maximal element, say (K_m, σ_m) . We have $K \subseteq K_m \subseteq L$ and $\sigma_m(\mathcal{O}'_m) = \mathcal{O}''_m$, where $\mathcal{O}'_m = \mathcal{O}' \cap K_m$ and $\mathcal{O}''_m = \mathcal{O}'' \cap K_m$.

Claim: $K_m = L$.

Suppose not. Pick $\alpha \in L \setminus K_m$. Let f be the minimal polynomial of α over K_m and $N = SF_L(f) \cdot K_m = SF_{K_m}(f) \subseteq L$, where $SF_L(f)$ denotes the splitting field of f over L . We extend σ_m to an algebraic closure $\bar{K}/K$. Then, since N and L are normal, $\sigma_m(L) = L$ and $\sigma_m(N) = N$. Let $\mathcal{O}^* := \mathcal{O}' \cap N$ and $\mathcal{O}^{**} := \sigma_m^{-1}(\mathcal{O}'' \cap N)$. Consider $\mathcal{O}^* \cap K_m = \mathcal{O}' \cap N \cap K_m = \mathcal{O}' \cap (SF_{K_m}(f) \cap K_m) = \mathcal{O}' \cap K_m = \mathcal{O}'_m$. Similarly,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{O}^{**} \cap K_m &= \sigma_m^{-1}(\mathcal{O}'' \cap N) \cap K_m \\ &= \sigma_m^{-1}(\mathcal{O}'' \cap N) \cap \sigma_m^{-1}(\sigma_m(K_m)) \\ &= \sigma_m^{-1}(\mathcal{O}'' \cap N \cap \sigma_m(K_m)) \\ &= \sigma_m^{-1}(\mathcal{O}'' \cap (SF_{K_m}(f) \cap K_m)) \\ &= \sigma_m^{-1}(\mathcal{O}'' \cap K_m) = \sigma_m^{-1}(\mathcal{O}''_m) = \mathcal{O}'_m \end{aligned}$$

We now apply the previous theorem with $L \mapsto N$, $K \mapsto K_m$, $\mathcal{O}' \mapsto \mathcal{O}^*$ and $\mathcal{O}'' \mapsto \mathcal{O}^{**}$. Note that N is a splitting field, hence normal. We then get an automorphism $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(N/K_m)$ with $\sigma(\mathcal{O}^*) = \mathcal{O}^{**}$. Then, $(\sigma_m \circ \sigma)(\mathcal{O}' \cap N) = \sigma_m(\sigma(\mathcal{O}^*)) = \sigma_m(\mathcal{O}^{**}) = \mathcal{O}'' \cap N$. Thus, $(N, \sigma_m \circ \sigma) > (K_m, \sigma_m)$ and $(N, \sigma_m \circ \sigma) \in \Sigma$. This contradiction proves the claim. ▀

Finally, we conclude this section by collecting some useful properties of normal extensions:

Theorem 1.5.12. *Let N be a normal extension of a field K , $\mathcal{O}$ a valuation ring of K , and $\mathcal{O}'$ a valuation ring of N lying over $\mathcal{O}$. Let $v : K \twoheadrightarrow \Gamma \cup \{\infty\}$ and $v' : N \twoheadrightarrow \Gamma' \cup \{\infty\}$ be valuations corresponding to $\mathcal{O}$ and $\mathcal{O}'$, respectively, and assume that $v'|_K = v$. Denote the residue class field of $\mathcal{O}'$ by $\bar{N}$.*

1. *For $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(N/K)$, the map $v' \circ \sigma$ is the unique valuation of N corresponding to $\sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}')$ and Γ' . In particular, if $\sigma(\mathcal{O}') = \mathcal{O}'$, then $v' \circ \sigma = v'$.*
2. *$\bar{N}/\bar{K}$ is a normal extension.*
3. *The map $\sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}') \rightarrow \bar{N} : x \mapsto \sigma(x)$ is a ring homomorphism which induces a $\bar{K}$ -isomorphism from $\sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}')/\sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{M}') \rightarrow \bar{N}$ satisfying $\bar{\sigma}(u + \sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{M}')) = \bar{\sigma}(u)$ for every $u \in \sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}')$. In particular, if $\sigma(\mathcal{O}') = \mathcal{O}'$, then $\bar{\sigma} \in \text{Aut}(\bar{N}/\bar{K})$.*

4. $e(\sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}')/\mathcal{O}) = e(\mathcal{O}'/\mathcal{O})$ and $f(\sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}')/\mathcal{O}) = f(\mathcal{O}'/\mathcal{O})$, for every $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(N/K)$.

Proof. 1. Clearly, $v' \circ \sigma : N \rightarrow \Gamma' \cup \{\infty\}$ is a valuation on N such that

$$\sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}') = \{x \in N : \sigma(x) \in \mathcal{O}'\} = \{x \in N : (v' \circ \sigma)(x) \geq 0\}.$$

Let w be a valuation with valuation ring $\sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}')$, then $v' \circ \sigma$ and w are equivalent. Therefore, there exists an order-preserving isomorphism

$$\rho : \Gamma' \xrightarrow{\sim} \Gamma' \text{ such that } \rho \circ w = v' \circ \sigma.$$

Claim: $\rho(\gamma) = \gamma$ for all $\gamma \in \Gamma = v(K^\times)$.

Let $\gamma \in \Gamma$ be arbitrary, i.e., $\gamma = v(t)$ for some $t \in K^\times$. Then $\rho^{-1}(\gamma) = \rho^{-1}(v(t)) = \rho^{-1}(v'(t)) = \rho^{-1}(v'(\sigma(t))) = \rho^{-1}(\rho(w(t))) = w(t)$. Now we know that $\sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}')$ lies over $\mathcal{O}$, hence $w|_K = v$, whence we conclude $w(t) = v(t)$. Therefore, the claim follows. For any $\delta \in \Gamma'$, we apply Theorem 1.5.4. to get an $n > 1$ such that $n\delta \in \Gamma$. Hence, $n\rho(\delta) = \rho(n\delta) = n\delta$ gives $\rho(\delta) = \delta$, since Γ' is torsion-free. Hence, ρ is the identity map on Γ' and so $w = v' \circ \sigma$.

2. Let $\bar{f}$ be an irreducible polynomial over $\bar{K}$ with a root $\alpha \in N$. Let R denote the integral closure of $\mathcal{O}$ in N and $\mathfrak{m} := \mathcal{M}' \cap R$. From Theorem 1.5.8., we have $\mathcal{O}' = R_{\mathfrak{m}}$, hence the residue class field map $\mathcal{O}' \twoheadrightarrow \bar{N}$ induces a map $R \twoheadrightarrow \bar{N}$, since any $\bar{x} \in \bar{N}$ has preimage $x \in \mathcal{O}' = R_{\mathfrak{m}}$, i.e., $x/1 \in R_{\mathfrak{m}} \implies x \in R$.

Now for any $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(N/K)$, we must have $\sigma(R) = R$, because $\sigma(\mathcal{O}') \subset N$ is a valuation ring lying over $\mathcal{O}$ whenever $\mathcal{O}' \subset N$ is. Further, if $x \in R$, then x is integral over $\mathcal{O}$ if and only if $\sigma(x)$ is also integral over $\mathcal{O}$, i.e., $\sigma(x) \in R \iff x \in R$. Take a preimage $x \in R$ of $\alpha \in \bar{N}$, so $\bar{x} = \alpha$ in $\bar{N}$. Let g be the minimal polynomial of x over K , then $g(x) \in \mathcal{O}[x]$. By the normality of N/K , $g(x) = (x - x_1)(x - x_2) \dots (x - x_n)$ where $x_i \in R$ and $n = \deg(g)$. Consider then its image $\bar{g}$ in $(\bar{N})$. We have $\bar{g}(\alpha) = 0$, but $\bar{f}$ is the minimal polynomial of α over $\bar{N}$, whence we conclude $\bar{f} \mid (x - \bar{x}_1)(x - \bar{x}_2) \dots (x - \bar{x}_n)$. Thus, $\bar{f}$ splits in $\bar{N}$ and we are done.

3. Consider the map $\eta : \sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}') \xrightarrow{\sigma} \mathcal{O}' \twoheadrightarrow \bar{N}$. This map is clearly surjective since $\sigma|_{\mathcal{O}'} = \text{id}|_{\mathcal{O}'}$ and the residue class field map $\mathcal{O}' \twoheadrightarrow \bar{N}$ is by definition surjective. Consider its kernel $\ker \eta = \{x \in \sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}') : \sigma(x) \in \mathcal{M}'\} = \sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{M}')$. Therefore, η induces an isomorphism $\tilde{\eta} : \sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}')/\sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{M}') \xrightarrow{\sim} \bar{N}$. Let $\bar{x} \in \bar{K}$, then $x \in \mathcal{O} \subset \sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}')$ and $x \notin \mathcal{M}$ whence $\sigma(x) \notin \mathcal{M}$, i.e., $\bar{x} \in \sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}')/\sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{M}')$.

Therefore, $\bar{\mathcal{K}} \subset \sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}')/\sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{M}')$, hence we may consider $\bar{\mathcal{K}}$ as a subfield of $\sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}')/\sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{M}')$. Now, by definition, $\tilde{\eta}(\bar{x}) = \overline{\sigma(x)} = \bar{x}$, since $\sigma|_K = \text{id}|_K$. Therefore, $\tilde{\eta}|_{\bar{\mathcal{K}}} = \text{id}|_{\bar{\mathcal{K}}}$, hence $\tilde{\eta}$ is a $\bar{\mathcal{K}}$ -isomorphism.

Claim: $\bar{\sigma}(u + \sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{M}')) = \overline{\sigma(u)}$ for every $u \in \sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}')$.

Let $u \in \sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}')$ and $t \in \sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{M}')$, i.e., $\sigma(u) \in \mathcal{O}'$ and $\sigma(t) \in \mathcal{M}'$. Consider $\bar{\sigma}(u + t) = \bar{\sigma}(u) + \bar{\sigma}(t) = \overline{\sigma(u)} + \overline{\sigma(t)} = \overline{\sigma(u)}$, since $\sigma(t) \in \mathcal{M}'$, which proves the claim.

4. Let Δ denote the value group corresponding to the valuation ring $\sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}')$. By part 1, its valuation is given by $v' \circ \sigma$. Therefore, we have $(v' \circ \sigma)(N^\times) = \Delta$. But $\sigma(N^\times) = N^\times$, since $\sigma \in \text{Aut}(N/K)$, hence $(v' \circ \sigma)(N^\times) = v'(N^\times) = \Gamma'$, i.e., $\Delta = \Gamma'$, therefore $e(\sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}')/\mathcal{O}) = [\Delta : \Gamma] = e(\mathcal{O}'/\mathcal{O})$. Similarly, the residue class field of $\sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}')$ is $\bar{N}$ by part 3, and so $f(\sigma^{-1}(\mathcal{O}')/\mathcal{O}) = [\bar{N} : \bar{\mathcal{K}}] = f(\mathcal{O}'/\mathcal{O})$.

■

Chapter 2

Local, Global and Henselian Fields

For this chapter, we refer mostly to [Neu99] (particularly the second half of chapter II), and fill in relevant lemmas as well as other interesting theorems wherever possible, with the aim of attaining as wide a coverage as possible of the material studied.

2.1 Local Fields

Definition 2.1.1. All fields which are complete with respect to a discrete valuation and have a finite residue class field are called *local fields*.

For such a local field, the normalized exponential valuation is denoted by $v_{\mathfrak{p}}$, and $|\cdot|_{\mathfrak{p}}$ denotes the absolute value normalized by $|x|_{\mathfrak{p}} = q^{-v_{\mathfrak{p}}(x)}$, where q is the cardinality of the residue class field.

Definition 2.1.2. A topological space X is said to be *locally compact* if for every point $x \in X$, there exists a compact set T and an open set U such that $x \in U \subseteq T$.

Theorem 2.1.1. A local field K is locally compact and its valuation ring $\mathcal{O}$ is compact.

Proof. We have seen before that there is a topological and algebraic isomorphism $\widehat{\mathcal{O}} = \mathcal{O} \xrightarrow{\sim} \varprojlim \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n$ and $\mathfrak{p}^n/\mathfrak{p}^{n+1} \cong \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$. Consider the map $\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n \rightarrow \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$ sending $x + \mathfrak{p}^n \mapsto x + \mathfrak{p}$, this is well defined as $\mathfrak{p}^n \subseteq \mathfrak{p}$ and its kernel is $\mathfrak{p}/\mathfrak{p}^n$, which is finite since $\mathfrak{p}^n/\mathfrak{p}^{n+1} \cong \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$ is finite. The map is surjective as well since given any $x + \mathfrak{p} \in \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$, we have a preimage $x + \mathfrak{p}^n \in \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n$. Therefore, $\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n$ is finite, hence compact. Therefore, the product $\prod_{n=1}^{\infty} \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n$ is compact by Tychonoff and hence the

closed subset $\varprojlim \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}^n$ is also compact. Therefore, $\widehat{\mathcal{O}} = \mathcal{O}$ is compact. To show that K is locally compact, we consider an arbitrary point $a \in K$. Then, by Lemma 1.4.10, we know $\overline{B}(a, 1)$ is an open set containing a and it is in fact homeomorphic to $\mathcal{O}$ as $\overline{B}(a, 1) = a + \mathcal{O}$, making it compact as well. Therefore, a has a compact neighborhood around it, whence it follows that K is locally compact. $\blacksquare$

Corollary 2.1.1.1. *The valuation ring of a local field is compact.*

Proof. The valuation ring $\mathcal{O}$ is a closed set of a complete metric space K and hence it is complete as well. $\blacksquare$

Theorem 2.1.2 (Teichmüller Lift). *Let K be a local field. There is a uniquely determined map $\omega : \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}$ such that $\omega(a) \equiv a \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$ and $\omega(ab) = \omega(a)\omega(b)$.*

Proof. **Claim:** If $a, b \in \mathcal{O}$ and $a \equiv b \pmod{\mathfrak{p}^m}$, then $a^p \equiv b^p \pmod{\mathfrak{p}^{m+1}}$, where $p = \text{char}(\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})$.

For $p = 2$, we have $a - b \in \mathfrak{p}^m = \pi^m \mathcal{O}$, i.e., $a = b + x\pi^m$, $x \in \mathcal{O}$, and $a^2 = b^2 + x^2\pi^{2m} + 2xb\pi^m \equiv b^2 + x^2\pi^{2m} \equiv b^2 \pmod{\pi^{m+1}\mathcal{O}} = \mathfrak{p}^{m+1}$, since $\text{char}(\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}) = 2$.

For odd p , we have $a = b + x\pi^m$, $x \in \mathcal{O}$, and so $a^p = (b + x\pi^m)^p = b^p + p(\cdots) + x^p\pi^{mp} \equiv b^p + x^p\pi^{mp} \equiv b^p \pmod{\pi^{m+1}\mathcal{O}}$, since $\text{char}(\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}) = p$.

We construct ω as follows: for $a \in \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$, choose any lift $\tilde{a} \in \mathcal{O}$. Define the sequence $a_0 = a$, $a_{n+1} = (a_n)^{1/p}$ in $\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$. This is well-defined because the Frobenius $x \mapsto x^p$ is an automorphism of $\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$, which is a finite, hence perfect, field.

Consider the lifted sequence $(b_n)_n = (\tilde{a}_n^{p^n})_n \subseteq \mathcal{O}$. We have by construction $\tilde{a}_{n+1} \equiv \tilde{a}_n^{1/p} \implies \tilde{a}_{n+1}^p \equiv \tilde{a}_n \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$, i.e., $(\tilde{a}_{n+1}^p)^p \equiv (\tilde{a}_n)^p \pmod{\mathfrak{p}^2}$, by applying the claim for $m = 1$. Thus, $\tilde{a}_{n+1}^{p^2} \equiv \tilde{a}_n^p \pmod{\mathfrak{p}^2}$. Similarly, applying the claim for $m = 2$, we get $\tilde{a}_{n+1}^{p^3} \equiv \tilde{a}_n^{p^2} \pmod{\mathfrak{p}^3}$. Proceeding this way, it follows that $\tilde{a}_{n+1}^{p^{n+1}} \equiv \tilde{a}_n^{p^n} \pmod{\mathfrak{p}^{n+1}}$. Thus, $b_{n+1} - b_n = \tilde{a}_{n+1}^{p^{n+1}} - \tilde{a}_n^{p^n} \in \mathfrak{p}^{n+1} = \pi^{n+1}\mathcal{O} \implies |b_{n+1} - b_n| < \frac{1}{q^n}$, and as $n \rightarrow \infty$, $1/q^n \rightarrow 0$. Therefore, this sequence is Cauchy and hence it converges in $\mathcal{O}$, because $\mathcal{O}$ is complete. Let its limit be $\omega(a) \in \mathcal{O}$, i.e., $\omega(a) := \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \tilde{a}_n^{p^n}$. Then $\omega(a)$ is uniquely determined by uniqueness of limits. Moreover, if $\tilde{c}_n$ is another lift of a_n , then we have $\tilde{c}_n \equiv \tilde{a}_n \pmod{\mathfrak{p}} \implies \tilde{c}_n^{p^n} \equiv \tilde{a}_n^{p^n} \pmod{\mathfrak{p}^n}$ by the claim, and so $|\tilde{c}_n^{p^n} - \tilde{a}_n^{p^n}| < \frac{1}{p^n} \rightarrow 0$ as $n \rightarrow \infty$, i.e., $\lim \tilde{c}_n^{p^n} = \lim \tilde{a}_n^{p^n}$. Therefore, we have a well-defined map $\omega : \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}$ as $\omega(a) := \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \tilde{a}_n^{p^n}$, where $\tilde{a}_0 \equiv a$, $\tilde{a}_{n+1} \equiv (\tilde{a}_n)^{1/p} \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$, so $\tilde{a}_n \equiv (\tilde{a}_0)^{p^{-n}} \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$.

It remains to check the two properties of this map. To check reduction modulo $\mathfrak{p}$, we consider again the sequence b_n and reduce it modulo $\mathfrak{p}$. Then, $b_0 \equiv a_0^{p^0} = a \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$, $b_1 \equiv a_1^{p^1} = (a^{1/p})^p = a \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$, $\dots$, $b_n \equiv a_n^{p^n} = a \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$ for

2.1. LOCAL FIELDS

all $n \geq 0$. This means that $v(b_n - a) > 0$, and since v is continuous, we may take limit on both sides as $n \rightarrow \infty$ to get $\lim v(b_n - a) = v(\omega(a) - a) > 0$, i.e., $\omega(a) - a \in \mathfrak{p}$ and thus $\omega(a) \equiv a \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$. To show $\omega(ab) = \omega(a)\omega(b)$, we need to show that $\lim \tilde{x}_n^{p^n} = \lim \tilde{a}_n^{p^n} \lim \tilde{b}_n^{p^n} = \lim (\tilde{a}_n \tilde{b}_n)^{p^n}$, where $\tilde{x}_n$ is a lift of the sequence corresponding to $ab \in \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$, i.e., $x_0 = ab$, $x_{n+1} = (x_n)^{1/p} = (x_0)^{1/p^n} = (ab)^{1/p^n}$. Now, to see that $\tilde{x}_n \equiv \tilde{a}_n \tilde{b}_n \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$, consider $\tilde{x}_n + \mathfrak{p} = (ab)^{1/p^n} + \mathfrak{p}$. With all maps below being Frobenius, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p} &\leftarrow \cdots \leftarrow \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p} \leftarrow \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p} \leftarrow \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p} \\ y^{1/p^n} &\leftarrow \cdots \leftarrow y^{1/p^2} \leftarrow y^{1/p} \leftarrow y \end{aligned}$$

In particular, the map $\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$ sending $y \mapsto y^{1/p^n}$ is a composition of homomorphisms and hence is itself a homomorphism, therefore, $(y^{1/p^n})(z^{1/p^n}) = (yz)^{1/p^n}$. Hence, we have $\tilde{x}_n + \mathfrak{p} = (ab)^{1/p^n} + \mathfrak{p} = a^{1/p^n} b^{1/p^n} + \mathfrak{p} = (a^{1/p^n} + \mathfrak{p})(b^{1/p^n} + \mathfrak{p}) = (\tilde{a}_n + \mathfrak{p})(\tilde{b}_n + \mathfrak{p})$, i.e., $\tilde{x}_n \equiv \tilde{a}_n \tilde{b}_n \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$. Applying now the claim as before yields $\tilde{x}_n^{p^n} \equiv (\tilde{a}_n \tilde{b}_n)^{p^n} \pmod{\mathfrak{p}^n}$, i.e., $|\tilde{x}_n^{p^n} - (\tilde{a}_n \tilde{b}_n)^{p^n}| < 1/q^{n-1} \rightarrow 0$ as $n \rightarrow \infty$. Hence, $\lim \tilde{x}_n^{p^n} = \lim (\tilde{a}_n \tilde{b}_n)^{p^n} = \lim \tilde{a}_n^{p^n} \lim \tilde{b}_n^{p^n}$ and thus $\omega(ab) = \omega(a)\omega(b)$. From the discussion so far, it also follows that $\omega(1) = 1$, because otherwise any preimage $x \neq 1 \in \mathcal{O}$ of $1 \in \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$ under the Frobenius must necessarily be a generator of $(\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times$ and therefore must satisfy $x^{q-1} = 1$. But since it is a preimage of 1, it must also satisfy $x^p = 1$, which implies $p \mid q-1$, a contradiction since $q = p^f$. Hence, $x = 1$. Further, note that for any $a \in (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times$, we have $\omega(a)^{q-1} = \omega(a^{q-1}) = \omega(1) = 1$, i.e., $\omega(a)$ is a $(q-1)$ -th root of unity lifting a , which gives us a homomorphism $\omega|_{(\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times} : (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times \rightarrow \mu_{q-1}$, which we call the **Teichmüller lift**. □

Lemma 2.1.1. *The Teichmüller lift $\omega : (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times \rightarrow \mu_{q-1} \subseteq \mathcal{O}^\times$ is an isomorphism.*

Proof. It is easy to see that $\mu_{q-1} \subseteq \mathcal{O}^\times$ because for any $\zeta \in \mu_{q-1}$, $\zeta^{q-1} = 1 \implies v(\zeta^{q-1}) = (q-1)v(\zeta) = 0 \implies v(\zeta) = 0 \implies \zeta \in \mathcal{O}^\times$. The Teichmüller lift homomorphism is injective because $\omega(a) = \omega(b) \implies a + \mathfrak{p} = b + \mathfrak{p}$, as seen in the last theorem. Moreover, the map is surjective, since given any $\zeta \in \mu_{q-1} \subseteq \mathcal{O}^\times$, we reduce modulo $\mathfrak{p}$ to get $\zeta + \mathfrak{p}$ whose image is ζ . It only needs to be shown that $\zeta + \mathfrak{p}$ is a unit in $\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$, but this follows from the fact that reduction modulo $\mathfrak{p}$ maps $\mathcal{O}^\times$ onto $(\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times$, as seen in Theorem 1.1.10. Therefore, $\omega : (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times \xrightarrow{\sim} \mu_{q-1}$. □

Theorem 2.1.3. *The local fields are precisely the finite extensions of the fields $\mathbb{Q}_p$ and $\mathbb{F}_p((t))$.*

2.1. LOCAL FIELDS

Proof. It follows by definition that $\mathbb{Q}_p$ and $\mathbb{F}_p((t))$ are local fields: both are complete with respect to their respective discrete valuations and the residue field for both is $\mathbb{F}_p$, as seen earlier. A finite extension of K of F (where $F = \mathbb{Q}_p$) or $F = \mathbb{F}_p((t))$ must be complete: this follows from a result in functional analysis which states that every finite dimensional normed vector space is complete. Moreover, the unique extended valuation given by $|\alpha|_K := (|N_{K/F}(\alpha)|_F)^{1/n}$, which is also discrete since $|\cdot|_F$ is discrete.

Claim: The extension of residue class fields $\bar{K}/\mathbb{F}_p$ is finite. To see this, it suffices to show that every linearly independent set in $\bar{K} = \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$ has finite cardinality. Let $\bar{x}_1, \bar{x}_2, \dots, \bar{x}_n \in \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$ be linearly independent over $\mathbb{F}_p$. Consider their lifts $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n \in \mathcal{O} \subseteq K$. We wish to show these are linearly independent over F : suppose not, then there is a nontrivial relation $\sum_{i=1}^n a_i x_i = 0$, not all $a_i = 0$. Take the coefficient a_j such that $v(a_j) = \min_i \{v(a_i)\}$ and divide the equation by a_j to obtain a nontrivial relation $\sum_{i=1}^n (a_i a_j^{-1}) x_i = 0$, i.e., $(a_1 a_j^{-1}) x_1 + \dots + 1 x_j + \dots + (a_n a_j^{-1}) x_n = 0$. Reducing modulo $\mathfrak{p}$, we get $\sum_{i=1}^n (\bar{a}_i \bar{a}_j^{-1}) \bar{x}_i = 0$, and note that the j^{th} term in this equation is $\bar{1} \bar{x}_j$, which is nonzero in $\bar{K} = \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$, since $1 \notin \mathfrak{p}$, i.e., we have nontrivial linear relation among $\bar{x}_1, \bar{x}_2, \dots, \bar{x}_n \in \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$. This gives the required contradiction, and so $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n \in \mathcal{O} \subseteq K$ are linearly independent over F . Since the extension K/F is finite, we have $n \leq [K : F] < \infty$, which proves the claim. Therefore, we have shown that K is a complete discretely valued field with a finite residue class field, i.e., K is a local field.

Conversely, let K be a local field of positive characteristic with valuation v and $p = \text{char}(\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})$. Let π be a uniformizer. Denote the ring of formal power series with coefficients in $\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p} = \bar{K}$ by $\bar{K}[[t]]$ and consider the map $\phi : \bar{K}[[t]] \rightarrow \mathcal{O}$ sending $\sum_{n \geq 0} a_n T^n \mapsto \sum_{n \geq 0} \omega(a_n) \pi^n$, where ω is the Teichmüller lift. Consider $\phi(\sum_{n \geq 0} a_n T^n + \sum_{n \geq 0} b_n T^n) = \phi(\sum_{n \geq 0} (a_n + b_n) T^n) = \sum_{n \geq 0} \omega(a_n + b_n) \pi^n = \sum_{n \geq 0} \omega(a_n) \pi^n + \sum_{n \geq 0} \omega(b_n) \pi^n = \phi(\sum_{n \geq 0} a_n T^n) + \phi(\sum_{n \geq 0} b_n T^n)$, i.e., ϕ is a homomorphism. To prove surjectivity of ϕ , we recall that every $x \neq 0$ in K admits a unique representation as a convergent series $x = \pi^m (a_0 + a_1 \pi + a_2 \pi^2 + \dots)$, where $a_i \in \bar{K}$, $a_0 \neq 0$, and $m \in \mathbb{Z}$. For injectivity, consider the kernel $\ker \phi = \{\sum_{n \geq 0} a_n T^n \mid \sum_{n \geq 0} \omega(a_n) \pi^n = 0\} = \{\sum_{n \geq 0} a_n T^n \mid \omega(a_n) = 0, \forall n \geq 0\} = \{\sum_{n \geq 0} a_n T^n \mid a_n = 0, \forall n \geq 0\} = 0$, since $\omega(a_n) = a_n \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$. Therefore, $\bar{K}[[t]] \cong \mathcal{O}$, and therefore, their fields of fractions must be isomorphic, yielding $\bar{K}((t)) \cong K$. Since $p = \text{char}(\bar{K})$, we get that K is a finite extension of $\mathbb{F}_p((t))$. This also shows that if K has positive characteristic, then $p = \text{char}(\bar{K}) = \text{char}(K)$. Suppose now that $\text{char}(K) = 0$, then we have $v|_{\mathbb{Q}} = v_p$, by 1.2.4.1. Since K has zero characteristic, it contains $\mathbb{Q}$, i.e., $\mathbb{Q} \subseteq K$.

2.1. LOCAL FIELDS

Taking closure on both sides with respect to v , we obtain $\overline{\mathbb{Q}} = \mathbb{Q}_p \subseteq \overline{K} = K$, since K is complete and $v|_{\mathbb{Q}} = v_p$. From the theory of topological vector spaces, we recall that a locally compact topological vector space over a nondiscrete locally compact field has finite dimension, yielding $[K : \mathbb{Q}_p] < \infty$. ■

Definition 2.1.3. A local field K is of *equal characteristic* if $\text{char}(K) = \text{char}(\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})$. Otherwise, it is of *mixed characteristic*.

Theorem 2.1.4. *The multiplicative group of a local field K admits the decomposition $K^\times = (\pi) \times \mu_{q-1} \times U^{(1)}$, where q is the number of elements in the residue field $\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$, and $U^{(1)} = 1 + \mathfrak{p}$ is the group of principal units.*

Proof. We first show that $K^\times = (\pi) \times \mathcal{O}^\times$. For this, recall that any $x \in K^\times$ can be uniquely written as $\pi^{v(x)}u$ for some unit $u \in \mathcal{O}^\times$, i.e., $K^\times = (\pi)\mathcal{O}^\times$. Further, the intersection $(\pi) \cap \mathcal{O}^\times$ is trivial because elements in (π) have valuation 1 and elements in $\mathcal{O}^\times$ have valuation 0. Moreover, since all the groups are abelian we have $(\pi)\mathcal{O}^\times = \mathcal{O}^\times(\pi)$, and hence $K^\times = (\pi) \times \mathcal{O}^\times$. It remains to show that $\mathcal{O}^\times = \mu_{q-1} \times U^{(1)}$. Consider the sequence $1 \rightarrow U^{(1)} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}^\times \xrightarrow{\varphi} (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times \rightarrow 1$, which is exact by Theorem 1.1.10. We have $\omega : (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times \xrightarrow{\sim} \mu_{q-1} \subseteq \mathcal{O}^\times$, and composing this with the map $\varphi : \mathcal{O}^\times \rightarrow (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times$ given by $\varphi(u) = u + \mathfrak{p}$, we get a map $(\varphi \circ \omega) : (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times \rightarrow (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times$. Consider $(\varphi \circ \omega)(a + \mathfrak{p}) = \varphi(\omega(a)) = \omega(a) + \mathfrak{p} = a + \mathfrak{p}$, i.e., $\varphi \circ \omega \equiv \text{id}_{(\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times}$. Therefore, the exact sequence splits and hence we obtain $\mathcal{O}^\times \cong U^{(1)} \times (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times \cong \mu_{q-1} \times U^{(1)}$, where the last isomorphism results from the Teichmüller lift. ■

Remark 2.1. Alternatively, to see that $1 \rightarrow U^{(1)} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}^\times \xrightarrow{\varphi} (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times \rightarrow 1$ splits, one may observe that $U^{(1)} = \varprojlim_n U^{(1)}/U^{(n)}$ is a pro- p group, and the order of every $U^{(1)}/U^{(n)}$ is coprime to $|(\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times| = q - 1$, thus by the Schur-Zassenhaus Theorem on finite groups the exact sequence $1 \rightarrow \varprojlim_n U^{(1)}/U^{(n)} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}^\times \xrightarrow{\varphi} (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times \rightarrow 1$ splits.

Theorem (Schur-Zassenhaus). *If G is a finite group and $N \trianglelefteq G$ is a normal subgroup such that $\gcd(|N|, |G/N|) = 1$, then G is a semidirect product (i.e., a split extension) of N and G/N . In particular, the exact sequence $1 \rightarrow N \rightarrow G \rightarrow G/N \rightarrow 1$ splits.*

We give another proof for the Teichmüller lift, using the basic version of Hensel's lemma, which we state now.

Theorem 2.1.5. *Let $(R, \mathfrak{p})$ be a complete DVR (discrete valuation ring) and $F(x) \in R[x]$ such that there exists $\alpha_1 \in \mathcal{O}$ with $F(\alpha_1) \equiv 0 \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$ and $F'(\alpha_1) \not\equiv 0 \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$. Then there exists a unique $\alpha \in R$ such that $\alpha \equiv \alpha_1 \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$ and $F(\alpha) = 0$.*

Theorem 2.1.6 (Teichmüller lift, second proof). *Let K be a local field. There is a uniquely determined map $\omega : (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times \rightarrow \mu_{q-1}$ such that $\omega(a) \equiv a \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$ and $\omega(ab) = \omega(a)\omega(b)$.*

Proof. Consider the polynomial $F(x) = x^q - x$, whence $\overline{F}(x) = \overline{x}^q - \overline{x} \in (\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})[x] = \mathbb{F}_q[x]$, where $q = p^f$. Moreover, $\overline{F}'(x) = q\overline{x}^{q-1} - 1$, which is a separable polynomial, i.e., all its roots are simple. Moreover, since $(\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times = \mathbb{F}_q$, every element of $(\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})^\times$ satisfies $\overline{\alpha}^{q-1} = \overline{\alpha}$ and thus is a root of $\overline{F}(x)$. Let $\overline{\alpha}_1$ be any root of $\overline{F}(x)$. Then, by the version of Hensel's Lemma stated above, there is a unique lift $\alpha \in R$ with $F(\alpha) = 0$, i.e., $\alpha \in \mu_{q-1}$. Define $\omega(\alpha_1) := \alpha$, which is unique and reduces to α_1 modulo $\mathfrak{p}$ as seen above. We next show that $\omega(\overline{st}) = \omega(\overline{s})\omega(\overline{t})$, where $\overline{s}, \overline{t}$ are two arbitrary roots of $\overline{F}(x)$. Note that this implies $\overline{st}$ is also a root since we have $\overline{s}^q = \overline{s}$ and $\overline{t}^q = \overline{t}$, which together imply $\overline{st}^q = \overline{st}$, yielding $\overline{st}^q - \overline{st} = 0$. Now, let s, t, r be the unique lifts of $\overline{s}, \overline{t}, \overline{st}$ respectively, i.e., $\omega(\overline{s}) = s$, $\omega(\overline{t}) = t$, $\omega(\overline{st}) = r$. Since reduction modulo $\mathfrak{p}$ is a homomorphism, we also have $\overline{st} = \overline{s} \cdot \overline{t}$, i.e., st is also a lift of $\overline{st}$. Therefore, by uniqueness, we have $r = st$, i.e., $\omega(\overline{st}) = \omega(\overline{s})\omega(\overline{t})$. $\blacksquare$

Definition 2.1.4. The local fields of mixed characteristic, i.e., the finite extensions $K \supseteq \mathbb{Q}_p$ of the fields of p -adic numbers $\mathbb{Q}_p$, are called **p -adic number fields**.

Lemma 2.1.2. *For a p -adic number field K , the extended p -adic valuation v_p has image $v_p(K^\times) = \frac{1}{e}\mathbb{Z}$, where e is a divisor of $n = [K : \mathbb{Q}_p]$*

Proof. We already know that the image is contained in $\frac{1}{n}\mathbb{Z}$, since $v_p(\alpha) = \frac{1}{n}v_p(N_{L/K}(\alpha))$. Moreover, the image contains all of $\mathbb{Z}$, since $v_p(\mathbb{Q}_p^\times) = \mathbb{Z}$. Now, $v_p(K^\times)$ is a subgroup of $(\mathbb{Q}, +)$ and hence its elements are rational integers. Suppose $\frac{d}{e} \in v_p(K^\times)$ is such that e is the largest denominator possible for a rational integer to be in $v_p(K^\times)$, and without loss of generality, we may assume that $\gcd(d, e) = 1$. By Bézout, there exist integers r, s such that $rd + se = 1$, whence we obtain $r\left(\frac{d}{e}\right) = \frac{1}{e} - s \in v_p(K^\times)$, since $\frac{d}{e} \in v_p(K^\times)$. Note that since the image contains all of $\mathbb{Z}$, $s \in v_p(K^\times)$, which in turn implies $\frac{1}{e} \in v_p(K^\times)$. By definition, e was the largest denominator possible

for a rational integer to be in $v_p(K^\times)$, and so $\frac{1}{e}$ is a minimal value in $v_p(K^\times)$, i.e., $v_p(K^\times) = \frac{1}{e}\mathbb{Z}$. ■

Remark 2.2. It turns out that the integer e above is the ramification index of this extension $K \supset \mathbb{Q}_p$ (defined in 1.5.2) as we have $v_p(\mathbb{Q}_p^\times) = \mathbb{Z}$ and $v_p(K^\times) = \frac{1}{e}\mathbb{Z}$, giving the ramification index equal to $[v_p(K^\times) : v_p(\mathbb{Q}_p^\times)] = [\frac{1}{e}\mathbb{Z} : \mathbb{Z}] = e$.

Definition 2.1.5. Given a $\mathfrak{p}$ -adic number field K , we have $v_p(K^\times) = \frac{1}{e}\mathbb{Z}$. The valuation $v_p(\alpha) := ev_p(\alpha)$ is the **normalized extended valuation** on K .

Theorem 2.1.7. For a $\mathfrak{p}$ -adic number field K , there is a uniquely determined continuous homomorphism $\log : K^\times \rightarrow K$ such that $\log p = 0$, which on principal units $(1+x) \in U^{(1)}$ is given by the series

$$\log(1+x) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^{n+1}x^n}{n} = x - \frac{x^2}{2} + \frac{x^3}{3} - \frac{x^4}{4} + \dots$$

Proof. We first define $\log$ on $U^{(1)}$ and then extend it to the whole of $K^\times$. Recall that in a nonarchimedean absolute value, convergence of a series $\sum a_n$ is equivalent to $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} |a_n| = 0 \iff \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} v(a_n) = \infty$. Let $1+x \in U^{(1)}$, i.e., $x \in \mathfrak{p}$. Let $n = p^t m$, then $v_p(n) = t \leq t + \log_p(m) = \log_p(p^t m)$, i.e., $v_p(n) \leq \log_p(p^t m) = \log_p(n) = \ln n / \ln p$. Moreover, since $x \in \mathfrak{p}$, we have $v_p(x) > 0 \implies p^{v_p(x)} := c > 1 \implies v_p(x) > \ln c / \ln p$. Consider now $v_p(\frac{x^n}{n}) = nv_p(x) - v_p(n) \geq \ln c / \ln p - \ln n / \ln p = \ln(c^n n) / \ln p$. Now, as $n \rightarrow \infty$, we get $\ln(c^n n) / \ln p \rightarrow \infty$, i.e., $v_p(\frac{x^n}{n}) \rightarrow \infty$. Therefore, the series $\log(1+x) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^{n+1}x^n}{n}$ converges for any $1+x \in U^{(1)}$. To verify the homomorphism property, we define two formal functions $H(x, y) := \log(1+x) + \log(1+y)$ and $G(x, y) = \log((1+x)(1+y))$. It is clear that $\frac{d}{dx}(\log(1+x)) = \frac{d}{dx} \left(\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^{n+1}x^n}{n} \right) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} (-1)^{n+1}x^{n-1} = \frac{1}{1+x}$. Therefore, we have

$$\frac{\partial G}{\partial x} = \frac{1}{(1+x)(1+y)} \cdot \frac{\partial}{\partial x}(1+x+y+xy) = \frac{1+y}{(1+x)(1+y)} = \frac{1}{1+x} = \frac{\partial H}{\partial x}$$

Therefore, $\frac{\partial}{\partial x}(G-H) = 0$. Since G, H are symmetric functions in x, y , it follows mutatis mutandis that $\frac{\partial}{\partial y}(G-H) = 0$, which implies that $G \equiv H$, as desired.

2.1. LOCAL FIELDS

Hence, we have defined the log homomorphism on $U^{(1)}$; we now extend this to $K^\times$. We have seen earlier that $K^\times$ admits a decomposition as an internal direct product as $K^\times = (\pi) \times \mu_{q-1} \times U^{(1)}$, therefore, any $\alpha \in K^\times$ may be expressed as $\alpha = \pi_p^v(\alpha)\omega(\alpha)\langle\alpha\rangle$, where $v_p = ev_p$ is the normalized valuation on K , $\langle\alpha\rangle \in U^{(1)}$ and ω is the Teichmüller lift. In particular, $p = \pi^e\omega(p)\langle p\rangle$. We define $\log \pi := (-1/e)\log\langle p\rangle$ to obtain the homomorphism $\log : K^\times \rightarrow K$ mapping $\alpha \mapsto v_p(\alpha)\log \pi + \log\langle\alpha\rangle$. This map is continuous as v_p and $\log|_{U^{(1)}}$ are both continuous. It also follows that $\log p = v_p(p)\log \pi + \log\langle p\rangle = e(-1/e)\log\langle p\rangle + \log\langle p\rangle = 0$. It remains to show uniqueness; suppose $\lambda : K^\times \rightarrow K$ is another continuation of $\log : U^{(1)} \rightarrow K$ with $\lambda(p) = 0$. Then, for any $\zeta \in \mu_{q-1}$, one has $\lambda(\zeta) = \frac{1}{q-1}\lambda(\zeta^{q-1}) = \frac{1}{q-1}\lambda(1) = 0$. Now, $0 = \lambda(p) = \lambda(\pi^e\omega(p)\langle p\rangle) = l\lambda(\pi) + \lambda(\omega(p)) + \lambda(\langle p\rangle) = l\lambda(\pi) + \lambda(\langle p\rangle) = l\lambda(\pi) + \log(\langle p\rangle)$, since λ is a continuation of $\log : U^{(1)} \rightarrow K$. Therefore, it follows that $\lambda(\pi) = (-1/l)\log(\langle p\rangle) = \log \pi$. Therefore, $\lambda(\alpha) = \lambda(\pi_p^v(\alpha)\omega(\alpha)\langle\alpha\rangle) = v_p(\alpha)\lambda(\pi) + \lambda(\omega(\alpha)) + \lambda(\langle\alpha\rangle) = v_p(\alpha)\log \pi + \log(\langle\alpha\rangle) = \log(\alpha)$, whence we obtain $\lambda \equiv \log$. Hence, $\log$ is a uniquely determined continuous homomorphism independent of the choice of π . $\blacksquare$

Lemma 2.1.3. *Let $n = \sum_{i=0}^r a_i p^i$ be the p -adic expansion of $n \in \mathbb{N}$, i.e., $0 \leq a_i < p$. Then, $v_p(n!) = \frac{1}{p-1} \sum_{i=0}^r a_i(p^i - 1)$.*

Proof. Consider the floor function $[\cdot]$. We have $[n/p] = \sum_{i=0}^r a_i p^{i-1} = [a_0/p + a_1 + \cdots + a_r p^{r-1}] = a_1 + \cdots + a_r p^{r-1}$. Similarly, we have $[n/p^2] = a_2 + \cdots + a_r p^{r-2}$ and so on until $[n/p^r] = a_r$. Observe that $[n/p]$ counts the number of positive integers from 1 to n which are divisible by p . Similarly, $[n/p^i]$ counts the number of positive integers from 1 to n which are divisible by p^i , for any $1 \leq i \leq r$. Hence, the sum $[n/p] + [n/p^2] + [n/p^3] + \cdots + [n/p^r]$ counts the number of positive integers from 1 to n which are divisible by p , with multiplicity. On the other hand, $v_p(n!) = v_p(n) + v_p(n-1) + \cdots + v_p(2) + v_p(1)$ and $v_p(t)$ counts the highest power of p dividing t and any positive integer coprime to p contributes zero to the above sum. Therefore, $v_p(n!)$ also counts the number of positive integers from 1 to n which are divisible by p , with multiplicity. Hence, we have $v_p(n!) = [n/p] + [n/p^2] + [n/p^3] + \cdots + [n/p^r] = a_1 + \cdots + a_r p^{r-1} + a_2 + \cdots + a_r p^{r-2} + \cdots + a_r = \sum_{i=1}^r a_i(p^i + p^{i-1} + \cdots + p + 1)$. Multiplying both sides by $p-1$, we obtain $(p-1)v_p(n!) = \sum_{i=1}^r a_i(p^{i-1} + p^{i-2} + \cdots + p + 1)(p-1) = \sum_{i=0}^r a_i(p^i - 1)$, as desired. $\blacksquare$

We now define the p -adic exponential function and use the lemma above to show its convergence in an appropriate domain. In the succeeding theorem, we show it

2.1. LOCAL FIELDS

is the inverse to the p -adic logarithm, yielding isomorphisms $\mathfrak{p}^n \cong U^{(n)}$ for all large enough n .

Lemma 2.1.4. *For a $\mathfrak{p}$ -adic number field K , there is a continuous homomorphism $\exp : \mathfrak{p}^n \rightarrow U^{(n)}$, given by $\exp(x) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{x^n}{n!} = 1 + x + \frac{x^2}{2!} + \frac{x^3}{3!} + \dots$ for all $n > \frac{e}{p-1}$.*

Proof. Let $x \in \mathfrak{p}^n$ i.e., $v_{\mathfrak{p}}(x) \geq n > \frac{e}{p-1}$. For any $n > 0$, we write the base- p expansion of $n = a_0 + a_1p + \dots + a_rp^r$. From the previous lemma, we have $v_p(n!) = \frac{1}{p-1} \sum_{i=0}^r a_i(p^i - 1) = \frac{1}{p-1} (\sum_{i=0}^r a_i p^i - \sum_{i=0}^r a_i) = \frac{1}{p-1} (n - \sum_{i=0}^r a_i)$. Let $s_n = \sum_{i=0}^r a_i$, then $v_p(n!) = \frac{n - s_n}{p-1}$, whence we get $v_p\left(\frac{x^n}{n!}\right) = nv_p(x) - \left(\frac{n - s_n}{p-1}\right) = n\left(v_p(x) - \frac{1}{p-1}\right) + \frac{s_n}{p-1} > \frac{s_n}{p-1}$, i.e., $v_p\left(\frac{x^n}{n!}\right) \rightarrow \infty$ as $n \rightarrow \infty$, implying the convergence of $\exp(x) = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{x^n}{n!}$. Note that $\exp$ satisfies the property that $\frac{d}{dx} \exp(x) = \exp(x)$ since $\frac{d}{dx} \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{x^n}{n!} = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{x^{n-1}}{(n-1)!} = \exp(x)$. Further, since $\exp$ is a power series, it is also a continuous map. $\square$

Theorem 2.1.8. *Let $K/\mathbb{Q}_p$ be a $\mathfrak{p}$ -adic number field with valuation ring $\mathcal{O}$ and maximal ideal $\mathfrak{p}$. Let $p\mathcal{O} = \mathfrak{p}^e$ where $p = \text{char}(\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p})$ and e is the ramification index. For $n > \frac{e}{p-1}$, the power series $\exp : \mathfrak{p}^n \rightarrow U^{(n)}$ and $\log : U^{(n)} \rightarrow \mathfrak{p}^n$, given by*

$$\exp(x) = 1 + x + \frac{x^2}{2!} + \frac{x^3}{3!} + \dots \text{ and } \log(1+x) = x - \frac{x^2}{2} + \frac{x^3}{3} - \frac{x^4}{4} + \dots$$

yield two mutually inverse isomorphisms (and homeomorphisms).

Proof. As before, $v_{\mathfrak{p}}(\alpha) := ev_p(\alpha)$ denotes the normalized extended valuation on K , and we assume $n > \frac{e}{p-1}$ throughout the proof. We first show that for every natural $s > 1$, $\frac{v_p(s)}{s-1} \leq \frac{1}{p-1}$. For this, write $s = p^a s_0$ where $\gcd(s_0, p) = 1$. Note that if $a = 0$, then $v_p(s) = v_p(s_0) = 0$ and the inequality follows trivially, hence we may assume $a > 0$. Further, we have $p^a + \dots + p + 1 \geq 1 + 1 + \dots + 1 = a$. It then follows that

$$\frac{v_p(s)}{s-1} = \frac{a}{p^a s_0 - 1} \leq \frac{a}{p^a - 1} = \frac{1}{p-1} \left(\frac{a}{p^a + \dots + p + 1} \leq \frac{1}{p-1} \right)$$

We now prove that $\log$, as defined above, maps $U^{(n)} \rightarrow \mathfrak{p}^n$ for $n > \frac{e}{p-1}$. Let $1+z \in U^{(n)}$, i.e., $z \in \mathfrak{p}^n \implies v_{\mathfrak{p}}(z) \geq n$. Consider $v_p(z^s/s) - v_p(z) = (s-1)v_p(z) + v_p(s) >$

$(s-1)\frac{1}{p-1} - \left(\frac{s-1}{p-1} = 0\right)$, i.e., $v_p(z^s/s) > v_p(z) \implies v_{\mathfrak{p}}(z^s/s) > v_{\mathfrak{p}}(z)$, whence it follows that $v_{\mathfrak{p}}(\log(1+z)) = v_{\mathfrak{p}}(z - \frac{z^2}{2} + \frac{z^3}{3} - \frac{z^4}{4} + \dots) = v_{\mathfrak{p}}(z) \geq n$. Hence, $\log(1+z) \in \mathfrak{p}^n$, as desired.

To see that $\exp$ maps $\mathfrak{p}^n \rightarrow U^{(n)}$, we take some $0 \neq x \in \mathfrak{p}^n$ i.e., $v_{\mathfrak{p}}(x) \geq n > \frac{e}{p-1}$. Now, for $i > 1$, we have

$$\begin{aligned}
 v_p\left(\frac{x^i}{i!}\right) - v_p(x) &= (i-1)v_p(x) - v_p(i!) \\
 &= (i-1)v_p(x) - \left(\frac{i-s_i}{p-1}\right) \\
 &= \left((i-1)v_p(x) - \frac{i-1}{p-1}\right) + \left(\frac{s_i-1}{p-1}\right) \\
 &= (i-1)\left(v_p(x) - \frac{1}{p-1}\right) + \frac{s_i-1}{p-1} > \frac{s_i-1}{p-1} \geq 0
 \end{aligned}$$

Therefore, $v_p\left(\sum_{i=1}^{\infty} \frac{x^i}{i!}\right) > v_p(x) = v_p(\exp(x) - 1) = v_p(x) \geq n$, i.e., $\exp(x) - 1 \in \mathfrak{p}^n \implies \exp(x) \in U^{(n)}$. Therefore, $\exp$ maps $\mathfrak{p}^n \rightarrow U^{(n)}$, as required.

Now, let $F := (\exp \circ \log) : U^{(n)} \rightarrow U^{(n)}$ and $G := (\log \circ \exp) : \mathfrak{p}^n \rightarrow \mathfrak{p}^n$. Consider $G'(x) = \frac{1}{\exp(x)} \exp(x) = 1$, implying $G(x) = a_0 + x$. Putting $x = 0$ gives $a_0 = G(0) = \log(\exp(0)) = \log(1+0) = 0$, therefore, $G(x) = x$. In particular, $G \equiv \text{id}_{\mathfrak{p}^n}$ and similarly, $F \equiv \text{id}_{U^{(n)}}$. Hence, $\exp : \mathfrak{p}^n \rightarrow U^{(n)}$ and $\log : U^{(n)} \rightarrow \mathfrak{p}^n$ are mutually inverse isomorphisms. They are homeomorphisms as well since both functions are continuous.



We next describe the $\mathbb{Z}_p$ -module structure on $U^{(1)}$, for which we require the three facts stated below:

Lemma 2.1.5. *For an arbitrary local field K , with $q = p^f = |\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}|$, we have*

1. *The order of $U^{(1)}/U^{(n+1)}$ is q^n , i.e., $U^{(1)}/U^{(n+1)}$ is a $\mathbb{Z}/q^n\mathbb{Z}$ -module*
2. $U^{(1)} = \varprojlim_n U^{(1)}/U^{(n+1)}$
3. $\mathbb{Z}_p = \varprojlim_n \mathbb{Z}/q^n\mathbb{Z}$

2.1. LOCAL FIELDS

- Proof.* 1. We have seen earlier that $U^{(i)}/U^{(i+1)} \cong \mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$, which has order q . Hence, $|U^{(1)}/U^{(n+1)}| = \prod_{i=1}^n |U^{(i)}/U^{(i+1)}| = q^n$.
2. To see this, we restrict the canonical isomorphism (cf. Prop 1.1.12) $\varphi^\times : \mathcal{O}^\times \xrightarrow{\sim} \varprojlim_n \mathcal{O}^\times/U^{(n)}$ to $U^{(1)}$. Then, $\varphi^\times(U^{(1)}) = \{(yU^{(n)})_n : y \in U^{(1)}\} = \varprojlim_n U^{(1)}/U^{(n+1)}$.
3. We have seen this earlier but it also follows from Prop 1.1.12 in the special case where $K = \mathbb{Q}_p$, $\mathcal{O} = \mathbb{Z}_p$, $\mathfrak{p} = p\mathbb{Z}_p$ and $\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p} = \mathbb{Z}_p/p\mathbb{Z}_p \cong \mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z}$. ■

We now define the $\mathbb{Z}_p$ -module structure on $U^{(1)}$ as $z \cdot y = y^z \in U^{(1)}$ in the following way. Let $y = (y_n)_n \in U^{(1)}$ and $z = (z_n)_n \in \mathbb{Z}_p$. Then, since $U^{(1)}/U^{(n+1)}$ is a $\mathbb{Z}/q^n\mathbb{Z}$ -module, each $y_n \cdot y_n \cdots y_n = y_n^{z_n} \in U^{(1)}/U^{(n+1)}$. It remains to show that the infinite tuple $(y_n^{z_n})_n$ is an element in $\varprojlim_n U^{(1)}/U^{(n+1)}$. Let $y_n^{z_n} = t_n^{z_n} U^{(n+1)}$, where $t_n \in U^{(1)}$. We need to show that $y_n^{z_n} (y_{n-1}^{z_{n-1}})^{-1} = (t_n^{z_n} U^{(n+1)}) (t_{n-1}^{z_{n-1}} U^{(n)})^{-1} = t_n^{z_n} (t_{n-1}^{z_{n-1}})^{-1} U^{(n)} = U^{(n)}$, i.e., $t_n^{z_n} (t_{n-1}^{z_{n-1}})^{-1} \in U^{(n)}$. Now, since $(z_n)_n \in \mathbb{Z}_p$, we have $z_n = z_{n-1} + \alpha$, where $\alpha \in q^{n+1}\mathbb{Z}$. Hence, $t_n^{z_n} (t_{n-1}^{z_{n-1}})^{-1} = t_n^{z_{n-1}} t_n^\alpha (t_{n-1}^{z_{n-1}})^{-1} = t_n^\alpha (t_n t_{n-1}^{-1})^{z_{n-1}}$. Now, since $\alpha \in q^{n+1}\mathbb{Z}$, $t_n^\alpha \in U^{(n)}$ and since $(y_n^{z_n})_n = (t_n^{z_n} U^{(n+1)})_n \in \varprojlim_n U^{(1)}/U^{(n+1)}$, we have $t_n t_{n-1}^{-1} \in U^{(n)} \implies (t_n t_{n-1}^{-1})^{z_{n-1}} \in U^{(n)}$. Hence, the product $t_n^{z_n} (t_{n-1}^{z_{n-1}})^{-1} = t_n^\alpha (t_n t_{n-1}^{-1})^{z_{n-1}} \in U^{(n)}$, as desired. Therefore, we have a well defined map $\mathbb{Z}_p \times U^{(1)} \rightarrow U^{(1)}$ where $z \cdot y = y^z := (y_n^{z_n})_n \in \varprojlim_n U^{(1)}/U^{(n+1)} = U^{(1)}$. To prove it is an action, we must further check that $1 \cdot y = y$ and $z' \cdot (z \cdot y) = (z'z) \cdot y$ for all $y \in U^{(1)}$ and $z, z' \in \mathbb{Z}_p$. We have $1 \cdot y = y^1 = (y_n^1)_n = (y_n)_n = y$. Now, $z' \cdot (z \cdot y) = z' \cdot (y^z) = z' \cdot (y_n^{z_n})_n = ((y_n^{z_n})^{z'_n})_n = (y_n^{z_n z'_n})_n = y^{z z'} = y^{z' z} = (z'z) \cdot y$, as desired. Finally, we check that $(z + z') \cdot y = (z \cdot y)(z' \cdot y)$ and $z \cdot (yy') = (z \cdot y)(z \cdot y')$. For the former, we have $(z + z') \cdot y = y^{z+z'} = (y_n^{z_n+z'_n})_n = (y_n^{z_n} y_n^{z'_n})_n = (y_n^{z_n})_n (y_n^{z'_n})_n = (z \cdot y)(z' \cdot y)$. The latter follows in a similar fashion by observing $(yy')^z = y^z y'^z$.

Lemma 2.1.6. *Let M be a module over the integral domain R such that M contains a submodule N that is free of rank d and M/N is a torsion R -module. Then M has rank n .*

Proof. Let $y_1, y_2, \dots, y_{d+1}$ be elements of M and let $\overline{y_i}$ denote the coset $y_i + N \in M/N$. Since M/N is torsion, for each i there exists a nonzero $a_i \in R$ such that $a_i \overline{y_i} = 0 \in N$, i.e., $a_i y_i \in N$. Now, since N is free of rank n , there exists a nontrivial R -linear dependence relation $a_1 y_1 e_1 + \dots, a_{n+1} y_{n+1} e_{n+1}$, where $\{e_i\}_{i=1}^n$ is an R -basis of N . This gives a nontrivial R -linear dependence relation among the y_i as the a_i are

nonzero and hence not zero divisors, because R is an integral domain. Hence the rank of M is at most d . However, the rank of M is at least d since $\{e_i\}_{i=1}^n$ is an R -linearly independent set in M . Therefore, the rank of M is precisely d . $\square$

Lemma 2.1.7. *Let K/F be a finite separable extension of local fields. The ring $\mathcal{O}_K$ is a finitely generated, free $\mathcal{O}_F$ -module of rank $d = [K : F]$.*

Proof. Let v be the normalized valuation of F with uniformizer π and $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_d$ be an F -basis of K . If $v(a_i) = d_i \geq 0$, we keep it as it is, otherwise if $d_i < 0$, we replace a_i by $a'_i = \pi^{-d_i} a_i$ to ensure $v(a'_i) \geq 0$. In this way, we may assume without loss of generality that each $a_i \in \mathcal{O}_K$. Let M be the $\mathcal{O}_F$ -module spanned by $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$, so that $M \subseteq \mathcal{O}_K$. By construction, M is a free $\mathcal{O}_F$ -module of rank n . For each $x \in \mathcal{O}_K$, we can find an integer k such that $\pi^k x \in M$, by clearing denominators of the coefficients of x written in the basis.

Claim: There exists $d \in \mathcal{O}_F$ such that $d\mathcal{O}_K \subseteq M$.

Pick $x \in \mathcal{O}_K$ and write $x = \sum_{j=1}^n f_j a_j$, with $f_j \in F$. For any fixed a_i , we then have $a_i x = \sum_j a_i a_j f_j$, whence $\text{Tr}_{K/F}(a_i x) = \sum_j \text{Tr}_{K/F}(a_i a_j) f_j$, where Tr denotes the trace map. We write all these equalities (when i varies) as $AC_1 = C_2$, where A is the $n \times n$ matrix given by $(\text{Tr}_{K/F}(a_i a_j))_{i,j}$, C_1 is the column containing $f_1, \dots, f_n$, and C_2 is another column containing $\text{Tr}_{K/F}(a_1 x), \dots, \text{Tr}_{K/F}(a_n x)$. We know that $\text{Tr}_{K/F}(a_i x) \in \mathcal{O}_F$. Let $d = \det(A)$, which is the discriminant $d(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_d)$. To see that $d \neq 0$, observe that A is the matrix associated with the trace bilinear form $K \times K \rightarrow F$ given by $(x, y) \mapsto \text{Tr}_{K/F}(xy)$. If $\det(A) = 0$, then there exists $y \neq 0$ such that $\text{Tr}_{K/F}(xy) \equiv 0$, since a bilinear form is degenerate if and only if the determinant of the associated matrix is zero. But for $x = 1/y$, we have $\text{Tr}_{K/F}(xy) = \text{Tr}_{K/F}(1) = n \neq 0$, a contradiction. Hence, $d \neq 0$ and we may write $C_1 = A^{-1}C_2$, implying $df_i \in \mathcal{O}_F$ for each i , so that $dx \in \mathcal{O}_F$, as desired. Now, since $d\mathcal{O}_K$ is a submodule of a free-module over a PID (which, in our case, is $\mathcal{O}_F$), $d\mathcal{O}_K$ must also be free of rank $m \leq d$, as an $\mathcal{O}_F$ -module. But as modules over $\mathcal{O}_F$, we have $\mathcal{O}_K \cong d\mathcal{O}_K$. The inclusion $M \subseteq \mathcal{O}_K$ similarly gives $d \leq m$. Therefore, $\mathcal{O}_K$ is a free $\mathcal{O}_F$ -module of rank $d = [K : F]$. $\square$

Corollary 2.1.8.1. *Let $K/\mathbb{Q}_p$ be a $\mathfrak{p}$ -adic number field, then $\mathcal{O}_K \cong \mathbb{Z}_p^d$, as $\mathbb{Z}_p$ -modules, where $d := [K : \mathbb{Q}_p]$.*

We now describe the structure of the multiplicative group of a local field in full generality. For this, let us recall that we started initially with the decomposition

$K^\times = (\pi) \times \mathcal{O}^\times$, using which we showed $K^\times = (\pi) \times \mu_{q-1} \times U^{(1)}$ in 2.1.4. Hence, we have $K^\times \cong \mathbb{Z} \oplus \mathbb{Z}/(q-1)\mathbb{Z} \oplus U^{(1)}$. It now remains to compute the $\mathbb{Z}_p$ -module $U^{(1)}$; this is the content of the next theorem.

Theorem 2.1.9. *Let K be a local field and $q = p^f = |\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}|$.*

1. *if $\text{char}(K) = 0$, then $K^\times \cong \mathbb{Z} \oplus \mathbb{Z}/(q-1)\mathbb{Z} \oplus \mathbb{Z}/p^a\mathbb{Z} \oplus \mathbb{Z}_p^d$, where $a \geq 0$ and $d = [K : \mathbb{Q}_p]$.*
2. *if $\text{char}(K) = p$, then $K^\times \cong \mathbb{Z} \oplus \mathbb{Z}/(q-1)\mathbb{Z} \oplus \mathbb{Z}_p^\mathbb{N}$.*

Proof. 1. If $\text{char}(K) = 0$, then we have the (algebraic and topological) isomorphism $\log : U^{(n)} \rightarrow \mathfrak{p}^n$ for $n > \frac{e}{p-1}$. Now, $\mathfrak{p}^n \cong \pi^n \mathcal{O} \cong \mathcal{O} \cong \mathbb{Z}_p^d$, as $\mathbb{Z}_p$ -modules. Composing these, we get a $\mathbb{Z}_p$ -module isomorphism $U^{(n)} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathbb{Z}_p^d$. Note that $[U^{(1)} : U^{(n)}] = q^n$ is finite (hence torsion) and $U^{(n)}$ is a free $\mathbb{Z}_p$ -module of rank d . Therefore, by Lemma 2.1, $U^{(1)}$ is also has rank d . From the structure theorem for finitely generated modules over PIDs, we obtain $U^{(1)} \cong \mathbb{Z}_p^d \oplus T$, where T denotes the torsion subgroup of $U^{(1)}$.

Claim: $T = \mu_{p^a}(K)$, the group of p -power roots of unity in K : Let $y \in T$, then there exists $z \in \mathbb{Z}_p$ such that $y^z = 1$. We write $z = p^a u$ where $u \in \mathbb{Z}_p^\times$ and pick $v \in \mathbb{Z}_p$ such that $uv = 1$ in $\mathbb{Z}_p$. Then, $y^z = y^{p^a u} = 1 \implies y^{p^a uv} = 1 \implies y^{p^a} = 1 \implies y \in \mu_{p^a}(K)$. Conversely, if $y \in \mu_{p^a}(K)$, then we already have $y^{p^a} = 1$, i.e., y is a torsion element, i.e., $y \in T$. This proves the claim. Hence, we finally obtain $U^{(1)} \cong \mathbb{Z}_p^d \oplus T = \mathbb{Z}_p^d \oplus \mu_{p^a}(K) \cong \mathbb{Z}_p^d \oplus \mathbb{Z}/p^a\mathbb{Z}$, as desired.

2. If $\text{char}(K) = p$, then $K \cong \mathbb{F}_q((t))$ and $U^{(1)} \cong 1 + t\mathbb{F}_q[[t]]$. Let $\omega_1, \omega_2, \dots, \omega_f$ be an $\mathbb{F}_p$ basis of $\mathbb{F}_q$. For every $n \in \mathbb{N}$ with $\gcd(n, p) = 1$, consider the map $g_n : \mathbb{Z}_p^f \rightarrow U^{(n)}$, $g_n(a_1, \dots, a_f) = \prod_{i=1}^f (1 + \omega_i t^n)^{a_i}$. This map is continuous since it is a composite of continuous maps. Moreover, it is homomorphic as well, since

$$\begin{aligned} g_n((a_1, \dots, a_f) + (b_1, \dots, b_f)) &= g_n(a_1 + b_1, \dots, a_f + b_f) \\ &= \prod_{i=1}^f (1 + \omega_i t^n)^{a_i + b_i} \\ &= \prod_{i=1}^f (1 + \omega_i t^n)^{a_i} \prod_{i=1}^f (1 + \omega_i t^n)^{b_i} \\ &= g_n(a_1, \dots, a_f) g_n(b_1, \dots, b_f). \end{aligned}$$

2.1. LOCAL FIELDS

Let $m = np^s$, $\gcd(n, p) = 1$, $s \geq 0$ and $\alpha = (a_1, \dots, a_f) \in \mathbb{Z}_p^f$, then the function g_n has the following properties:

$$1) U^{(m)} = g_n(p^s \mathbb{Z}_p^f) U^{(m+1)} \quad 2) \alpha \notin p \mathbb{Z}_p^f \iff g_n(p^s \alpha) \notin U^{(m+1)}$$

We prove these properties now. Suppose $\omega = \sum b_i \omega_i \in \mathbb{F}_q$ where $b_i \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $b_i \equiv a_i \pmod{p \mathbb{Z}_p}$. Recall that $\mathfrak{p}^{n+1} = t^{n+1} \mathbb{F}_q[[t]]$, then, $g_n(\alpha) = \prod_{i=1}^f (1 + \omega_i t^n)^{b_i} = \prod_{i=1}^f (1 + b_i \omega_i t^n + t^{n+1} \gamma) \equiv \prod_{i=1}^f (1 + b_i \omega_i t^n) \equiv 1 + \sum_{i=1}^f b_i \omega_i t^n + t^{n+1} \gamma' \equiv 1 + \sum_{i=1}^f b_i \omega_i t^n \pmod{\mathfrak{p}^{n+1}}$.

Further, since $\text{char}(K) = p$, $g_n(p^s \alpha) = \prod_{i=1}^f (1 + \omega_i t^n)^{b_i p^s} = (g_n(\alpha))^{p^s} \equiv 1 + \omega^{p^s} t^n \pmod{\mathfrak{p}^{n+1}}$, whence $\frac{g_n(p^s \alpha)}{1 + \omega^{p^s} t^n} \equiv 1 \pmod{\mathfrak{p}^{n+1}} \implies \frac{g_n(p^s \alpha)}{1 + \omega^{p^s} t^n} \in U^{(m+1)} \implies g_n(p^s \alpha) U^{(m+1)} = 1 + \omega^{p^s} t^n U^{(m+1)} \in U^{(m)} U^{(m+1)} = U^{(m)}$. In particular, $U^{(m)} \supseteq g_n(p^s \mathbb{Z}_p^f) U^{(m+1)}$, but as α varies over $\mathbb{Z}_p^f$, ω varies over $\mathbb{F}_q$ and hence so does ω^{p^s} , giving $U^{(m)} = g_n(p^s \mathbb{Z}_p^f) U^{(m+1)}$, as desired.

To prove 2, observe that $g_n(p^s \alpha) \in U^{(m+1)} \iff g_n(p^s \alpha) \equiv 1 \pmod{\mathfrak{p}^{m+1}} \iff 1 + \omega^{p^s} t^m \equiv 1 \pmod{\mathfrak{p}^{m+1}} \iff \omega^{p^s} t^m \in \mathfrak{p}^{m+1} \iff \omega^{p^s} \in \mathfrak{p} = t \mathcal{O} \iff \omega = 0 \iff b_i \equiv a_i \equiv 0 \pmod{p} \iff \alpha \in p \mathbb{Z}_p^f$, whence the claim follows. We consider now the continuous homomorphism of $\mathbb{Z}_p$ -modules $g : A \rightarrow U^{(1)}$, where $A := \prod_{(n,p)=1} \mathbb{Z}_p^f$, i.e., the product is taken over all $n \geq 1$ coprime to p , with each factor being a copy of $\mathbb{Z}_p^f$, and $g = \prod_{(n,p)=1} g_n$.

The product $g(\xi) = \prod g_n(\alpha_n)$ converges, since $g_n(\alpha_n) \in U^{(n)}$. Let $m = np^s$, $(n, p) = 1$, be any natural number. As $g_n(\mathbb{Z}_p^f) \subseteq g(A)$, it follows from (1) that each coset of $U^{(m)} / U^{(m+1)}$ is represented by an element of $g(A)$, so $g(A)$ is dense in $U^{(1)}$. Moreover, A is compact and g is continuous, therefore g must be surjective. On the other hand, let $0 \neq \xi = (\dots, \alpha_n, \dots) \in A$, where $\alpha_n = p^s \beta_n$ with $s(\alpha_n) \geq 0$ and $\beta_n \in \mathbb{Z}_p^f \setminus p \mathbb{Z}_p^f$. From (2), we get $g_n(\alpha_n) \in U^{(m)}$ and $g_n(\alpha_n) \notin U^{(m+1)}$ for $m = m(\alpha_n) = np^s$. Since the n are prime to p , all the $m(\alpha_n)$ have to be distinct, for all $\alpha_n \neq 0$. Let n be the natural number, prime to p and such that $\alpha_n \neq 0$, which satisfies $m(\alpha_n) < m(\alpha_{n'})$, for all $n' \neq n$ such that $\alpha_{n'} \neq 0$. Then one has, for all $n' \neq n$, that $g_{n'}(\alpha_{n'}) \in U^{(m+1)}$ where $m = m(\alpha_n) < m(\alpha_{n'})$. Consequently $g(\xi) \equiv g_n(\alpha_n) \not\equiv 1 \pmod{U^{(m+1)}}$, and so $g(\xi) \neq 1$. This shows the injectivity of g . Since $A = \mathbb{Z}_p^{\mathbb{N}}$, this finishes the proof. $\blacksquare$

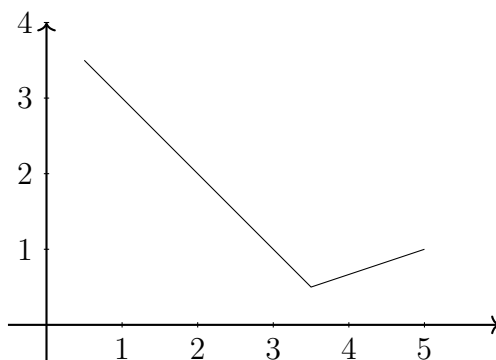
2.2 Henselian Fields

Definition 2.2.1. A nonarchimedean valued field $(K, |\cdot|)$ (resp., (K, v)) is called ***henselian*** if its valuation ring $\mathcal{O}$ satisfies Hensel's lemma 1.1.13. Further, the separable closure K_v of K in its completion $\widehat{K}$ is called the ***henselization*** of K with respect to v .

Theorem 2.2.1. Let $(K, |\cdot|)$ be henselian, then $|\cdot|$ may be extended uniquely to any algebraic extension L/K , given by $|\alpha|_L := |N_{L/K}(\alpha)|^{1/n}$, equivalently, in additive notation by $v_L(\alpha) := \frac{1}{n}v(N_{L/K}(\alpha))$, when $[L : K] = n$. Moreover, the valuation ring of the extended valuation is the integral closure of $\mathcal{O}$ in L .

The proof follows verbatim as Theorem 1.1.14, which made use of Lemma 1.1.6, a corollary of Hensel's lemma that did not require the hypothesis of a complete valued field. Note that in that case, we used the completeness of (K, v) to prove Hensel's lemma, i.e., we showed that $(\widehat{K}, \widehat{v})$ is a henselian field. However, as we will see in this section, a nonarchimedean valued field may be henselian without being complete.

Definition 2.2.2. Let (K, v) be a valued field and $f(x) = a_0 + a_1x + \cdots + a_nx^n \in K[x]$ with $a_0a_n \neq 0$. We define the ***Newton polygon*** of f , denoted by $\text{NP}(f)$ as the polygonal chain produced by the lower convex envelope of the set $\{(i, v(a_i))\}_{i=1}^n = \{(0, v(a_0)), (1, v(a_1)), \dots, (n, v(a_n))\} \subseteq \mathbb{R}^2$.



Theorem 2.2.2. Let $f(x) = a_0 + a_1x + \cdots + a_nx^n$, $a_0a_n \neq 0$, be a polynomial over the field K , v an exponential valuation of K , and w an extension to the splitting field L of f . If $(r, v(a_r)) \longleftrightarrow (s, v(a_s))$ is a line segment of slope $-m$ occurring in the Newton polygon of f , then $f(x)$ has precisely $s - r$ roots $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_{s-r}$ of value $w(\alpha_1) = \cdots = w(\alpha_{s-r}) = m$.

Proof. Given $f(x) = \sum a_i x^i$, if we divide by a_n to get $g(x) = \sum a_i a_n^{-1} x^i$, then

$$\begin{aligned} \text{NP}(g) &= \{ (i, v(a_i a_n^{-1})) \}_i = \{ (i, v(a_i) - v(a_n)) \}_i \\ &= \{ (i, v(a_i)) - (0, v(a_n)) \}_i \\ &= \{ (i, v(a_i)) \}_i - \{ (0, v(a_n)) \}_i. \end{aligned}$$

Thus, it shifts $\text{NP}(f)$ up or down without changing the shape or slopes. Hence, we assume without loss of generality that $a_n = 1$. We order the roots $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n \in L$ of f such that

$$\begin{aligned} w(\alpha_1) &= w(\alpha_2) = \dots = w(\alpha_{s_1}) = m_1, \\ w(\alpha_{s_1+1}) &= \dots = w(\alpha_{s_2}) = m_2, \\ &\vdots \\ w(\alpha_{s_t+1}) &= \dots = w(\alpha_n) = m_{t+1}, \end{aligned}$$

where $m_1 < m_2 < \dots < m_{t+1}$.

We recall that the coefficients a_i are elementary symmetric function of the roots α_j , i.e., $a_i = \sum_{1 \leq j_1 < \dots < j_i} \alpha_{j_1} \alpha_{j_2} \dots \alpha_{j_i}$. Now, $v(a_n) = v(1) = 0$, since f is monic.

$$\begin{aligned} v(a_{n-1}) &= w\left(-\sum_i \alpha_i\right) = w\left(\sum_i \alpha_i\right) \\ &\geq \min_i \{w(\alpha_i)\} = m_1, \\ v(a_{n-2}) &= w\left(-\sum_{i < j} \alpha_i \alpha_j\right) \\ &\geq \min_{i,j} \{w(\alpha_i \alpha_j)\} = m_1 + m_1 = 2m_1 \\ v(a_{n-s_1}) &= w\left(\sum_{1 \leq j_1 < \dots < j_{s_1} \leq n} \alpha_{j_1} \dots \alpha_{j_{s_1}}\right) \\ &= \min_{1 \leq j_1 < \dots < j_{s_1} \leq n} w(\alpha_{j_1} \dots \alpha_{j_{s_1}}) \\ &= w(\alpha_1 \alpha_2 \dots \alpha_{s_1}) \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^{s_1} w(\alpha_i) \\ &= s_1 m_1. \end{aligned}$$

Similarly,

$$\begin{aligned}
 v(a_{n-s_1-1}) &\geq \min_{j_1, \dots, j_{s_1+1}} \{w(\alpha_{j_1} \cdots \alpha_{j_{s_1+1}})\} \\
 &= s_1 m_1 + m_2, \\
 v(a_{n-s_1-2}) &\geq \min_{j_1, \dots, j_{s_1+2}} \{w(\alpha_{j_1} \cdots \alpha_{j_{s_1+2}})\} \\
 &= s_1 m_1 + 2m_2. \\
 v(a_{n-s_2}) &= v\left(\sum_{1 \leq j_1 < \dots < j_{s_2}} \alpha_{j_1} \cdots \alpha_{j_{s_2}}\right) \\
 &= \min_{j_1, \dots, j_{s_2}} \{w(\alpha_{j_1} \cdots \alpha_{j_{s_2}})\} \\
 &= w(\alpha_1 \alpha_2 \cdots \alpha_{s_2}) = \sum_{i=1}^{s_2} w(\alpha_i) \\
 &= s_1 m_1 + \sum_{i=s_1+1}^{s_2} w(\alpha_i) \\
 &= s_1 m_1 + (s_2 - s_1) m_2.
 \end{aligned}$$

In general, $v(a_{n-s_k}) = s_1 m_1 + (s_2 - s_1) m_2 + \cdots + (s_k - s_{k-1}) m_k$.
 Therefore, the vertices of NP (f) are, from right to left, given by

$$(n, 0), (n - s_1, s_1 m_1), (n - s_2, s_1 m_1 + (s_2 - s_1) m_2), \dots$$

The slope of the extreme right-hand segment is given by $\frac{0 - s_1 m_1}{n - (n - s_1)} = \frac{-s_1 m_1}{s_1} = -m_1$, and proceeding further to the left:

$$\frac{(s_1 m_1 + \cdots + (s_j - s_{j-1}) m_j) - (s_1 m_1 + \cdots + (s_{j+1} - s_j) m_{j+1})}{(n - s_j) - (n - s_{j+1})} = -m_{j+1}.$$

□

Remark 2.3. Observe that the Newton polygon consists of precisely one segment if and only if the roots $\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_n$ of f all have the same value. In general, $f(x)$ factors into a product according to the slopes $-m_r < \cdots < -m_1$, $f(x) = a_n \prod_{j=1}^r f_j(x)$, where $f_j(x) = \prod_{w(\alpha_i)=m_j} (x - \alpha_i)$. Here the factor f_j corresponds to the $(r - j + 1)$ -th segment of the Newton polygon, whose slope equals minus the value of the roots of f_j .

Theorem 2.2.3. *If the valuation v admits a unique extension w to the splitting field L of f , then the factorisation $f(x) = a_n \prod_{j=1}^r f_j(x)$ is defined already over K , i.e., $f_j(x) = \prod_{w(\alpha_i)=m_j} (x - \alpha_i) \in K[x]$.*

Proof. We assume $a_n = 1$ without loss of generality otherwise we may replace the polynomial $f(x)$ by $a_n^{-1}f(x)$ and proceed. If f is irreducible, then we have $\alpha_i = \sigma_i \alpha_1$ for some $\sigma_i \in \text{Gal}(L/K)$ and the uniqueness of w implies $w \circ \sigma_i^{-1} = w$, since $w \circ \sigma_i^{-1}|_K = w_K = v$, i.e., $w \circ \sigma_i^{-1}$ is another extension of v to L . Therefore, $w(\alpha_i) = w(\sigma_i^{-1} \alpha_1) = w(\alpha_1) = m_1$, i.e., all roots have the same valuation so $f_1(x) = f(x)$ and $f(x) \in K[x]$.

For the general case, we induct on $n = \deg(f)$. For $n = 1$, f is linear and there is nothing to prove. Suppose the theorem holds for all polynomials of degree $\leq n$. Consider the min. polynomial of α_1 over K , $b(x)$, and define $g(x) = f(x)/b(x)$. Now, $b(x) \mid f(x)$ hence $g(x) \in K[x]$. Since $b(x)$ is the minimal polynomial of α_1 , it is irreducible and hence all its roots have the same valuation m_1 as seen above. Therefore, $b(x) \mid f_1(x)$. Let $t(x) = f_1(x)/b(x)$. Now, $g(x) = f(x)/b(x) = \prod_{j=1}^r f_j(x)/b(x) = t(x) \prod_{j=2}^r f_j(x)$. Since $\deg(\prod_{j=2}^r f_j(x)) < \deg(f) = n$, we conclude that $f_j \in K[x]$ for $j = 2, 3, \dots, r$ by the induction hypothesis. Hence, $g_1(x) \in K[x]$ and $f_j(x) \in K[x]$ for $j = 2, 3, \dots, r$. This also implies $t(x) \in K[x]$ because $g(x) \in K[x]$ and $g(x) = t(x) \prod_{j=2}^r f_j(x)$. Hence, $f_1(x) = b(x)t(x) \in K[x]$. Therefore, we have shown $f_j(x) \in K[x]$ for $j = 1, 2, \dots, r$ and we are done. ▀

Corollary 2.2.3.1. *Let $f(x) = a_0 + a_1x + \dots + a_nx^n \in K[x]$ be an irreducible polynomial with $a_n \neq 0$. Then, if $|\cdot|$ is a nonarchimedean valuation of K with a unique extension to the splitting field L of f , then we have $|f| = \max\{|a_0|, |a_n|\}$.*

Proof. If f is irreducible, then $f(x) = a_nf_1(x)$ and $\text{NP}f$ has only one slope $-m_1$, i.e., it consists of a single line segment, $(0, v(a_0)) \longleftrightarrow (n, v(a_n))$, and valuations of all the coefficients lie on or above this line segment. This means that $v(a_i) \geq \min\{v(a_0), v(a_n)\}$ for all i . Hence, $v(f) = \min\{v(a_i)\} = \min\{v(a_0), v(a_n)\}$, i.e., $|f| = \max\{|a_0|, |a_n|\}$. ▀

Theorem 2.2.4. *A nonarchimedean valued field $(K, |\cdot|)$ is henselian if and only if the valuation $|\cdot|$ can be uniquely extended to any algebraic extension.*

Proof. The forward direction has been proven in Theorem 2.2.1, so we will assume that the valuation $|\cdot|$ can be uniquely extended to any algebraic extension and then

prove that $(K, |\cdot|)$ is henselian. We denote the residue field $\mathcal{O}/\mathfrak{p}$ by $\bar{\mathcal{K}}$. We begin by proving the following claim:

Claim: Let $f(x) = a_0 + a_1x + \cdots + a_nx^n \in \mathcal{O}[x]$ be a primitive irreducible polynomial with $a_0a_n \neq 0$ and $\bar{f}(x)$ denote its reduction modulo p . Then, $\deg(\bar{f}) = 0$ or $\deg(\bar{f}) = \deg(f)$ and $\bar{f}(x) = \bar{a}(\bar{\varphi}(x))^m$ for some irreducible polynomial $\bar{\varphi} \in \bar{\mathcal{K}}[x]$ and a constant $\bar{a} \in \bar{\mathcal{K}}$.

Since f is irreducible, we have, by the previous corollary, $|f| = \max\{|a_0|, |a_n|\}$, equivalently, $v(f) = \min\{v(a_0), v(a_n)\}$. Suppose first that a_n is not a unit, then $a_n \in \mathfrak{p} \implies v(a_n) > 0$. Therefore, $v(f) = \min\{v(a_0), v(a_n)\} = v(a_0)$. By primitivity of f , we have $|f| = 1 \implies v(f) = v(a_0) = 0$. Further $v(f) = \min_i v(a_i) = v(a_0) = 0 \implies v(a_i) > 0$ for all $i \neq 0$ and hence $a_i \in \mathfrak{p}$ for all $i \neq 0$. Therefore, $\bar{f}(x) = \bar{a}_0$ and we obtain $\deg(\bar{f}) = 0$. We now assume that a_n is a unit. Let L denote the splitting field of f and $\mathcal{O}_L$ be the valuation ring of the unique extension $|\cdot|_L$ of $|\cdot|$ to L . Let its maximal ideal be $\mathfrak{p}_L$ and G denote the Galois group of L/K . For any $\sigma \in G$, the composite $|\cdot|_L \circ \sigma$ is also an extension of $|\cdot|$ to L , but by hypothesis, the extension is unique. Hence, we must have $|\sigma\alpha|_L = |\alpha|_L$ for all $\alpha \in L$. Therefore, $\sigma\mathcal{O}_L = \mathcal{O}_L$ and $\sigma\mathfrak{p}_L = \mathfrak{p}_L$. We now show that if α is a root of $f(x)$ with multiplicity μ , then we must have $\sigma\alpha \in \mathcal{O}_L$ for all $\sigma \in G$. Suppose not, then there exists $\sigma \in G$ with $\sigma\alpha \notin \mathcal{O}_L \implies \alpha \notin \mathcal{O}_L$, i.e., $|\alpha|_L > 1 \implies |N_{L/K}(\alpha)|^{1/n} > 1 \implies |N_{L/K}(\alpha)| > 1$. We also know that $N_{L/K}(\alpha) = \prod_{\sigma} |\sigma\alpha|^\mu$, whence $\prod_{\sigma} |\sigma\alpha|^\mu = |\prod_{\sigma} \sigma\alpha|^\mu > 1 \implies |a_0| > 1$, i.e., $a_0 \notin \mathcal{O}$, a contradiction. We denote the residue field $\mathcal{O}_L/\mathfrak{p}_L$ by $\bar{\mathcal{L}}$. Given $\sigma \in G$, we define a homomorphism $\bar{\sigma} : \bar{\mathcal{L}} \rightarrow \bar{\mathcal{L}}$ as $\bar{\sigma}(x + \mathfrak{p}_L) = \sigma x + \mathfrak{p}_L$. Being a field homomorphism, it is injective. It is also surjective since given any $x + \mathfrak{p}_L \in \bar{\mathcal{L}}$, we have a preimage $\sigma^{-1}x + \mathfrak{p}_L \in \bar{\mathcal{L}}$. We further claim it is a $\bar{\mathcal{K}}$ -automorphism, and to see this, we identify $\bar{\mathcal{K}}$ with its image in $\bar{\mathcal{L}}$ via the natural inclusion $\iota : \bar{\mathcal{K}} \hookrightarrow \bar{\mathcal{L}}$ where $\iota(x + \mathfrak{p}) = x + \mathfrak{p}_L$. Let $x + \mathfrak{p} \in \bar{\mathcal{K}}$, we consider $\bar{\sigma}(\iota(x + \mathfrak{p})) = \bar{\sigma}(x + \mathfrak{p}_L) = \sigma x + \mathfrak{p}_L = x + \mathfrak{p}_L = \iota(x + \mathfrak{p})$, where $\sigma x = x$ follows since $x \in \mathcal{O} \subseteq K$ and $\sigma|_K = \text{id}|_K$. Therefore, every $\sigma \in G$ induces a $\bar{\sigma} \in \text{Gal}(\bar{\mathcal{L}}/\bar{\mathcal{K}})$. This gives a homomorphism of groups $\text{Gal}(L/K) \rightarrow \text{Gal}(\bar{\mathcal{L}}/\bar{\mathcal{K}})$, whose kernel is equal to $\{\sigma \in G : \bar{\sigma} = \text{id}|_{\bar{\mathcal{L}}}\} = \{\sigma \in G : \sigma x + \mathfrak{p}_L = x + \mathfrak{p}_L\} = \{\sigma \in G : \sigma x \equiv x \pmod{\mathfrak{p}_L}\} := I_w$. We shall define I_w as the inertia group of w and study it in more detail later. Note that since L/K is a finite extension, all the groups we are working with are finite. Now, since the zeroes of $f(x)$ are given by $\sigma\alpha$ with σ varying over G , we see the zeroes of $\bar{f}(x)$ are given by $\bar{\sigma}\bar{\alpha} = \bar{\sigma}(\bar{\alpha})$. Observe that for any $\bar{\sigma} \in I_w$, we have $\bar{\sigma}(\bar{\alpha}) = \bar{\alpha}$, i.e., $\bar{\alpha}$ has multiplicity $|I_w| = m$. This means that if $\bar{\varphi}(x)$ is the minimal polynomial of $\bar{\alpha}$ over $\bar{\mathcal{K}}$, then $\bar{\varphi}^m$ divides $\bar{f}$ and so we may write

$\bar{f}(x) = \bar{a}(x)(\bar{\varphi}(x))^m$. We wish to show that $\bar{a}(x)$ is a constant polynomial. To see this, observe first that $\deg(\bar{f}) = \deg(f) = n$ because a_n is a unit. Suppose now that $\bar{\beta}$ is a root of $\bar{a}(x)$, then it is also a root of $\bar{f}$, but all roots of $\bar{f}$ are of the form $\bar{\sigma}(\bar{\alpha})$ and hence are also roots of $\bar{\varphi}$. Therefore, $\bar{a}(x)$ is a constant polynomial and the claim is proven.

To prove the theorem now, we consider a primitive polynomial $f(x) \in \mathcal{O}[x]$ and let $f(x) = f_1(x)f_2(x) \cdots f_r(x)$ be its factorisation into irreducibles. We may assume without loss of generality that $|f_i| = 1$ otherwise we replace f_i by $\frac{f_i}{|f_i|} \in \mathcal{O}[x]$.

Consider the reduction $\bar{f}(x) = \bar{f}_1(x)\bar{f}_2(x) \cdots \bar{f}_r(x)$, then by the previous claim we conclude that $\deg(\bar{f}_i) = 0$ or $\deg(\bar{f}_i) = \deg(f_i)$ and $\bar{f}_i$ is, up to a constant, the power of an irreducible polynomial. Now, assume $\bar{f} = \bar{g} \bar{h}$ is a factorisation in $\bar{K}[x]$ where $\bar{g}, \bar{h}$ are coprime, then $\bar{g} = \bar{a} \prod_{i \in I} \bar{f}_i$ and $\bar{h} = \bar{b} \prod_{j \in J} \bar{f}_j$, where $\bar{a}, \bar{b} \in \bar{K}$ and I, J are disjoint subsets of $\{1, 2, \dots, r\}$ with $I \cup J = \{1, \dots, r\}$. Note that it cannot be the case that $\deg(\bar{f}_i) = 0$ for all $i = 1, 2, \dots, r$, hence it must be the case that there exists i with $\deg(\bar{f}_i) = \deg(f_i)$ and so we assume without loss of generality that $\deg(f_i) = \deg(\bar{f}_i)$ for all $i \in I$. Consider now the lifts a, b of $\bar{a}, \bar{b}$ to $\mathcal{O}^\times$ and put $g := a \prod_{i \in I} f_i \in \mathcal{O}[x]$, and $h := b \prod_{j \in J} f_j \in \mathcal{O}[x]$. Then we have $f = gh$ otherwise $\bar{f} \neq \bar{g} \bar{h}$. Further, since $\deg(f_i) = \deg(\bar{f}_i)$ for all $i \in I$, we get $\deg(g) = \deg(\prod_i f_i) = \deg(\prod_i \bar{f}_i) = \deg(\bar{g})$. By the definition of g, h , it is clear that $g \equiv \bar{g} \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$, and $h \equiv \bar{h} \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$. Hence, we have shown that $(K, |\cdot|)$ is henselian, as desired.



Recall the fundamental inequality (1.5.4) we proved in the general case of an extension of valued fields. We now prove a stronger statement in the current context under certain assumptions, namely, the fundamental *equality* for an extension of henselian fields.

First, we state, without proof, a version of Nakayama's Lemma:

Theorem 2.2.5 (Nakayama). *Let A be a finitely generated R -module, where R is a commutative ring with unity, $B \subseteq A$ be a submodule and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft R$ be an ideal contained in the Jacobson radical $\mathcal{J}_R$ of R . Then, $\mathfrak{a}A + B = A \implies A = B$.*

Theorem 2.2.6. *Let (K, v) be a discretely valued henselian field and L/K a finite separable extension. Then, $[L : K] = ef$, where e denotes the ramification index and f denotes the inertia degree.*

Proof. Let Π be a uniformizer of $\mathcal{O}_w$, where w denotes the extension of v to L . Consider the $\mathcal{O}_v$ -module $M = \sum_{i=0}^{e-1} \sum_{j=0}^f \mathcal{O}_v \omega_j \pi_i$, where $\omega_1, \omega_2, \dots, \omega_f$ are representatives of a basis of $\overline{\mathcal{L}}/\overline{\mathcal{K}}$ and $\pi_i = \Pi^i$. As seen in the proof of the fundamental inequality (1.5.4), we have $ef \leq [L : K] = n$.

Claim: $M = \mathcal{O}_w$.

Consider the $\mathcal{O}_v$ -module $N = \sum_{j=0}^f \mathcal{O}_v \omega_j$, whence it follows that $M = \sum_{i=0}^{e-1} N \Pi^i$. Now, $\mathcal{O}_w = N + \Pi \mathcal{O}_w$ because for any $\alpha \in \mathcal{O}_w$, we may write $\alpha \equiv a_1 \omega_1 + a_2 \omega_2 + \dots + a_f \omega_f \pmod{\Pi \mathcal{O}_w}$. This follows since $\{\omega_i + \Pi \mathcal{O}_w\}_i$ is a basis of $\overline{\mathcal{L}}/\overline{\mathcal{K}}$. Hence,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{O}_w &= N + \Pi \mathcal{O}_w = N + \Pi(N + \Pi \mathcal{O}_w) \\ &= N + \Pi(N + \Pi(N + \Pi \mathcal{O}_w)) \\ &\vdots \\ &= N + \Pi N + \Pi^2 N + \dots + \Pi^{e-1} N + \Pi^e \mathcal{O}_w \\ &= \sum_{i=0}^{e-1} N \Pi^i + \Pi^e \mathcal{O}_w \\ &= M + \Pi^e \mathcal{O}_w = M + \mathfrak{p} \mathcal{O}_w \end{aligned}$$

Since L/K is separable, $\mathcal{O}_w$ is a finitely generated $\mathcal{O}_v$ -module (by Lemma 2.1.7, which did not require the completeness of the extensions, and hence, the proof is valid for henselian fields). We apply Nakayama's lemma by putting $R = \mathcal{O}_v$, $\mathfrak{a} = \mathfrak{p}$, $A = \mathcal{O}_w$, and $B = M$. Then, $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathcal{J}_R = \mathfrak{p}$ and $\mathfrak{a}A + B = \mathfrak{p} \mathcal{O}_w + M = \mathcal{O}_w = A$, which gives $\mathcal{O}_w = M$, as desired. Therefore, $\{\omega_i \pi_j \mid i = 1, \dots, f, j = 1, \dots, e\}$ is an integral basis of $\mathcal{O}_w$ over $\mathcal{O}_v$. Again, from Lemma 2.1.7 that the rank of $\mathcal{O}_w$ over $\mathcal{O}_v$ is $[L : K]$, since L/K is separable. Hence, we obtain $[L : K] = ef$, as desired. $\blacksquare$

Note that if K is complete with respect to the discrete valuation v , then the separability condition may be dropped and we obtain:

Theorem 2.2.7. *Let (K, v) be a complete discretely valued field and L/K a finite extension. Then, $[L : K] = ef$.*

Proof. As in the above proof, we have $ef \leq [L : K] = n$ and $\mathcal{O}_w = M + \mathfrak{p} \mathcal{O}_w$. To obtain $M = \mathcal{O}_w$, we use the fact that $\mathfrak{p}^i M \subseteq M$ successively to obtain $\mathcal{O}_w = M + \mathfrak{p} \mathcal{O}_w = M + \mathfrak{p}(M + \mathfrak{p} \mathcal{O}_w) = M + \mathfrak{p}^2 \mathcal{O}_w = \dots = M + \mathfrak{p}^\nu \mathcal{O}_w$ for all $\nu \geq 1$. Now, $(\mathfrak{p}^\nu \mathcal{O}_w)_{\nu \in \mathbb{N}}$ is a basis of neighborhoods of zero in $\mathcal{O}_w$. Let $x \in \mathcal{O}_w$ and $x + N$, with

$N \in (\mathfrak{p}^\nu \mathcal{O}_w)_{\nu \in \mathbb{N}}$, be a basic neighborhood around x . Since $x = m + p^\nu t$ for some $p \in \mathfrak{p}, \nu \in \mathbb{N}$ and $t \in \mathcal{O}_w$, we see that $m + p^\nu t \in x + N \implies m \in x + N$, i.e., $x + N$ intersects M . Since basic neighborhoods around an arbitrary point intersect M , we see that M is dense in $\mathcal{O}_w$, i.e., $\overline{M} = \mathcal{O}_w$. Now, $\mathcal{O}_v$ is closed in K and $M = \sum_{i=0}^{e-1} \sum_{j=0}^f \mathcal{O}_v \omega_j \pi_i$ is a finitely generated module over $\mathcal{O}_v$ hence, M is closed in $\mathcal{O}_w$, giving $M = \overline{M} = \mathcal{O}_w$, as desired. $\blacksquare$

Definition 2.2.3. A finite extension $L|K$ of henselian valued fields is called **unramified** if the residue field extension $l|k$ is separable and $[L : K] = [l : k]$. An arbitrary algebraic extension $L|K$ is called unramified if it is a union of finite unramified subextensions. We denote the maximal unramified subextension of $L|K$ by $T|K$.

Definition 2.2.4. An algebraic extension $L|K$ of henselian valued fields is called **tamely ramified** if the extension $l|k$ of the residue class fields is separable, with $p = \text{char } k > 0$ and $([L : T], p) = 1$. In the infinite case, the latter condition is taken to mean that the degree of all finite subextensions of $L|T$ is prime to p . We denote the maximal tamely ramified subextension of $L|K$ by $V|K$.

Definition 2.2.5. An algebraic extension $L|K$ of henselian valued fields is called **totally ramified** if $T = K$, and **wildly ramified** if $V \neq L$.

We now look at some further results proven in [Kum20].

In the sequel, we fix a complete discrete valued field (K, v) ; this ensures that v extends uniquely to any algebraic extension by Theorem 2.2.4. We prove some preliminary lemmas first.

Definition 2.2.6. Two finite extensions L_1, L_2 of K are **linearly disjoint** over K if $[L_1 L_2 : K] = [L_1 : K][L_2 : K]$.

We stick to the following notation: $e(L_1 L_2 / K) = e, e(L_1 / K) = e_1, e(L_2 / K) = e_2$ and $f(L_1 L_2 / K) = f, f(L_1 / K) = f_1, f(L_2 / K) = f_2$.

Lemma 2.2.1. *Let L_1, L_2 be linearly disjoint extensions of a complete discrete valued field K . Then, $e = e_1 e_2 \iff f = f_1 f_2$.*

Proof. We have $[L_1 L_2 : K] = [L_1 : K][L_2 : K]$. Since all extensions involved are henselian (in fact, complete), we apply the fundamental identity to obtain $ef = e_1 e_2 f_1 f_2$, hence $e = e_1 e_2 \iff f = f_1 f_2$. $\blacksquare$

Lemma 2.2.2. *Let L_1, L_2 be finite linearly disjoint extensions of a complete discrete valued field K . If $e \geq e_1 e_2$ and $f \geq f_1 f_2$, then $e = e_1 e_2$ and $f = f_1 f_2$.*

Proof. As before, $ef = e_1 e_2 f_1 f_2$, and since $e \geq e_1 e_2$ and $f \geq f_1 f_2$, the result immediately follows. $\blacksquare$

Lemma 2.2.3. *Let L/K be a finite extension of complete discrete valued fields such that the residue field extension l/k is separable. Then, there is an extension M/K such that M/K is unramified and L/M is totally ramified.*

Proof. Since l/k is finite separable (as L/K is finite), we may write $l = k(\bar{\alpha})$ by the primitive element theorem. Consider the minimal polynomial $\bar{g}(x)$ of $\bar{\alpha}$ over k and its lift $g(x) \in \mathcal{O}_K[x]$. Since $\bar{g}(x)$ is irreducible, so is $g(x)$. We apply Hensel's lemma to lift the root $\bar{\alpha} \in l$ to $\alpha \in \mathcal{O}_L$ and set $M = K(\alpha)$. Then, $[M : K] = \deg(g) = \deg(\bar{g}) = [l : k] = [l : m][m : k]$, which implies $e(M/K) = [l : m]$ by the fundamental equality. But by construction, we have $m[\bar{\alpha}] = k[\bar{\alpha}]$, i.e., $l = m$ so $[M : K] = [m : k]$. This shows that M/K is unramified. Further, since $l = m$, we obtain by the fundamental equality $[L : M] = e(L/M)f(L/M) = e(L/M)$, proving L/M is totally ramified. $\blacksquare$

Lemma 2.2.4. *Let L_1, L_2 be finite linearly disjoint extensions of a complete discrete valued field K . If one of $l_1/k, l_2/k$ is separable, then $f \geq f_1 f_2$.*

Proof. We assume without loss of generality that l_1/k is separable and apply the hitherto proven lemma to obtain $M_1 \subset L_1$ such that M_1/K is unramified and L_1/M_1 is totally ramified. Then, by a standard theorem in [Neu99], $M_1 L_2/L_2$ is unramified as well. Thus, $e(M_1 L_2/K) = e(M_1 L_2/L_2)e(L_2/K) = e(L_2/K) = e(M_1/K)e(L_2/K)$, since both $e(M_1 L_2/L_2) = e(M_1/K) = 1$. Now, $e(M_1 L_2/K) = e(M_1/K)e(L_2/K)$ implies $f(M_1 L_2/K) = f(M_1/K)f(L_2/K)$ by the first lemma, which further yields $f(M_1 L_2/M_1)f(M_1/K) = f(M_1/K)f(L_2/K)$, i.e., $f(M_1 L_2/M_1) = f(L_2/K)$. Consider now $f(L_1 L_2/K) = f(M_1 L_2/M_1 L_2)f(M_1 L_2/M_1)f(M_1/K)$, implying $f(L_1 L_2/K) = f(M_1 L_2/M_1 L_2)f(L_2/K)f(L_1/K)$, i.e., $f \geq f_1 f_2$. $\blacksquare$

With these in hand, we can now prove two theorems which ensure $e = e_1 e_2$ and $f = f_1 f_2$.

Theorem 2.2.8. *Let L_1, L_2 be finite linearly disjoint extensions of a henselian discrete valued field K . If one of $l_1/k, l_2/k$ is separable and e_1, e_2 are coprime, then $e = e_1 e_2$ and $f = f_1 f_2$.*

2.3. EXTENSIONS OF VALUATIONS

Proof. Since e_1 and e_2 both divide e , so does their least common multiple, which is e_1e_2 by virtue of their coprimality. Hence e_1e_2 divides e , i.e., $e \geq e_1e_2$. Further, we also have $f \geq f_1f_2$, as seen in the last lemma. These together imply $e = e_1e_2$ and $f = f_1f_2$, as we proved earlier. $\square$

Theorem 2.2.9. *Let L_1, L_2 be finite linearly disjoint extensions of a henselian discrete valued field K . If one of $l_1/k, l_2/k$ is separable and $\mathcal{O}_{L_1L_2} = \mathcal{O}_{L_1}\mathcal{O}_{L_2}$, then $e = e_1e_2$ and $f = f_1f_2$.*

Proof. Let $\mathfrak{P}_1, \mathfrak{P}_2, \mathfrak{P}$, and $\mathfrak{p}$ denote the maximal ideals of $\mathcal{O}_{L_1}, \mathcal{O}_{L_2}, \mathcal{O}_{L_1L_2}$ and $\mathcal{O}_K$, respectively. We show there exists a surjective homomorphism between the $\mathcal{O}_K/\mathfrak{p}$ vector spaces $\mathcal{O}_{L_1}/\mathfrak{P}_1 \otimes \mathcal{O}_{L_2}/\mathfrak{P}_2$ and $\mathcal{O}_{L_1L_2}/\mathfrak{P}$. Consider the map

$$\phi : \mathcal{O}_{L_1}/\mathfrak{P}_1 \times \mathcal{O}_{L_2}/\mathfrak{P}_2 \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{L_1L_2}/\mathfrak{P}$$

$$x + \mathfrak{P}_1, y + \mathfrak{P}_2 \mapsto xy + \mathfrak{P}$$

Since ϕ is bilinear, there exists a homomorphism $\psi : \mathcal{O}_{L_1}/\mathfrak{P}_1 \otimes \mathcal{O}_{L_2}/\mathfrak{P}_2 \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{L_1L_2}/\mathfrak{P}$, which is surjective, as $\mathcal{O}_{L_1L_2} = \mathcal{O}_{L_1}\mathcal{O}_{L_2}$. This implies that $f(L_1L_2/K) \leq f(L_1/K)f(L_2/K)$. Since we already have $f(L_1L_2/K) \geq f(L_1/K)f(L_2/K)$, this gives $f(L_1L_2/K) = f(L_1/K)f(L_2/K)$, and therefore, we also conclude that $e(L_1L_2/K) = e(L_1/K)e(L_2/K)$, finishing the proof. $\square$

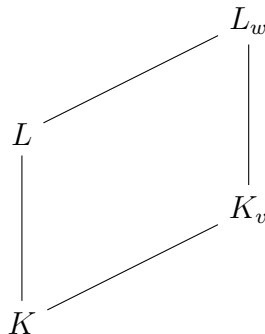
2.3 Extensions of Valuations

Let v be an arbitrary archimedean or nonarchimedean valuation on a field K . We denote the corresponding multiplicative valuation by $|\cdot|_v$ and the completion by K_v . Let $\overline{K_v}$ be an algebraic closure of K_v and L/K be an algebraic extension and $\bar{v}$ denote the canonical extension of v to $\overline{K_v}$. Choosing a K -embedding $\tau : L \hookrightarrow \overline{K_v}$, we obtain an extension w of v to L by restricting $\bar{v}$ to $\tau(L)$, i.e., $w = \bar{v} \circ \tau : L \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$. In multiplicative notation, $|x|_w = |\tau(x)|_{\bar{v}}$. We recall the following fact from the theory of metric spaces:

Theorem 2.3.1. *Let $A \subset X$ be a subset of a metric space X and Y be a complete metric space. A uniformly continuous map $f : A \rightarrow Y$ then admits a unique extension $\hat{f} : \overline{A} \rightarrow Y$, given by $\hat{f}(a) = \lim f(a_n)$, where $(a_n)_n \subset A$ is a representative sequence of $a \in \overline{A}$.*

2.3. EXTENSIONS OF VALUATIONS

Note that τ is Lipschitz (and hence uniformly continuous) with respect to this valuation, since $|\tau(x) - \tau(y)|_{\bar{v}} = |\tau(x - y)|_{\bar{v}} = |x - y|_w$. Hence, τ extends uniquely to a continuous embedding $\tau : \bar{L} = L_w \hookrightarrow \bar{K}_v$, since $\bar{K}_v$ is a complete metric space by the result quoted above. Note that here L_w denotes the completion of L with respect to w when L/K is finite and $L_w = \cup_i L_{iw}$, the union of the completions L_{iw} of all finite subextensions L_i/K of L/K when L/K is infinite.



Definition 2.3.1. We call L_w , as defined above, the **localisation** of L with respect to w .

To understand the extended map τ in the case when L/K is finite, let us take an arbitrary $x \in L_w$. Then, x is the w -limit of a Cauchy sequence $(x_n)_n \subseteq L$ and the image of every element of this sequence under τ gives a sequence $(\tau x_n)_n \subseteq \bar{K}_v$. Since τ is Lipschitz, this sequence is $\bar{v}$ -Cauchy. We define the image of x under τ as the $\bar{v}$ -limit of this sequence, i.e., $\tau x := \bar{v} - \lim(\tau x_n) \in \bar{K}_v$. Note that K_v is complete and $\tau L \cdot K_v$ is a finite extension of K_v , since L/K was finite and hence so is $\tau L/K$. Therefore $\tau L \cdot K_v$ must be complete as well (cf. Theorem 1.1.14). Since $(\tau x_n)_n \subseteq \tau L \cdot K_v$, we obtain the convergence $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \tau x_n = \tau x \in \tau L \cdot K_v$.

Theorem 2.3.2. *The canonical extension of w from L to L_w is precisely the unique extension of $\hat{v}$ from K_v to L_w .*

Proof. Let the canonical extension of w from L to L_w be denoted by w_1 and the unique extension of $\hat{v}$ from K_v to L_w be denoted by w_2 . It suffices to consider all the field extensions involved as finite. More concretely, for any $x \in L_w$, we have a Cauchy sequence representation of $x = (x_n)_n \subseteq L$. Then, $w_1(x) = \lim w(x_n) \in L_w$ and $w_2(x) = \frac{1}{n}v(N_{L_w/K_v}(x))$, where $n = [L_w : K_v]$. Now, we have seen that the extension of v from K to K_v is unique and since w_2 is the unique extension of this

2.3. EXTENSIONS OF VALUATIONS

to L_w , we conclude that there is a unique valuation of L_w which extends v on K . Therefore, it suffices to show that $w_1|_K = w_2|_K = v$. For this, let $x \in K$ be an arbitrary element. We first view x as an element of L and evaluate its image under w_1 . Since $x \in L$, it is represented by the constant sequence $(x)_n \subseteq L$ and hence $w_1(x) = \lim w(x) = w(x) \in L$. But w was the extension of v from K to L , hence $w(x) = v(x)$, giving us $w_1(x) = v(x)$. Similarly, we now view $x \in K$ an element of K_v and evaluate its image under w_2 . We have $w_2(x) = \frac{1}{n}v(N_{L_w/K_v}(x)) = \frac{1}{n}v(x^n) = \frac{1}{n}nv(x) = v(x)$, yielding $w_2(x) = v(x)$. Therefore, $w_1|_K = w_2|_K = v$, as desired. $\blacksquare$

Observe that $L_w = LK_v$ because if $[L : K] < \infty$, then LK_v is complete (by Theorem 1.1.14), and $L_w \supset LK_v$, but by definition of completion, L_w is the smallest complete field containing L , giving $L_w = LK_v$. In the infinite case, we write $L_w = \cup_i L_{iw}$, where for each L_i/K , we have $L_{iw} = L_iK_v$, whence it follows that $\cup_i L_{iw} = \cup_i L_iK_v$. Now, observe that $\cup_i L_iK_v \subset LK_v$, since each $L_i \subset L \implies L_iK_v \subset LK_v$. Conversely, $K_v \subset L_iK_v \subset \cup_i L_iK_v$ and $L = \cup_i L_i \subset \cup_i L_iK_v$, giving $\cup_i L_iK_v \supset LK_v$. Therefore, we obtain $\cup_i L_{iw} = \cup_i L_iK_v = LK_v$.

Definition 2.3.2. Two K -embeddings τ and τ' are said to be **conjugate over K_v** if there exists $\sigma \in \text{Gal}(\overline{K_v}/K_v)$ such that $\tau' = \sigma \circ \tau$.

We have seen that every K -embedding $\tau : L \hookrightarrow \overline{K_v}$ gives a valuation on L extending v ; the converse holds as well – this is the content of the next theorem.

Theorem 2.3.3 (Extension Theorem). *Let L/K be an algebraic extension of a valued field (K, v) . Then,*

1. *Every extension w of v arises as the composite $w = \bar{v} \circ \tau$ for some K -embedding $\tau : L \hookrightarrow \overline{K_v}$.*
2. *Two extensions $\bar{v} \circ \tau$ and $\bar{v} \circ \tau'$ are equal if and only if τ and τ' are conjugate over K_v .*

Proof. 1. Let w be an extension of v to L . We denote the canonical extension of w to the localisation L_w by $\tilde{w}$. Instead of working directly with L/K , we pass to the localisation L_w/K_v . Choose any K_v -embedding $\tau : L_w \hookrightarrow \overline{K_v}$, then $\bar{v} \circ \tau$ is a valuation on $\overline{K_v}$ which extends v , since for any $x \in K$, $\bar{v} \circ \tau(x) = \bar{v}(\tau x) = \bar{v}(x) = v(x)$ and it is clearly a valuation since τ respects multiplication, addition and the ordering on L . But the extension of v in the local extension

2.3. EXTENSIONS OF VALUATIONS

L_w/K_v is unique, so we obtain $\bar{v} \circ \tau = \tilde{w}$. Now, restricting this to L , we get $\bar{v} \circ \tau|_L = \tilde{w}|_L = w$ and since τ is a K_v -embedding, $\tau|_L$ is a K -embedding, whence the result follows: we have expressed w as the composite $\bar{v} \circ \tau|_L$.

2. Let $\tau, \tau' : L \hookrightarrow \overline{K_v}$ be two K -embeddings that are conjugate over K_v , i.e., there exists $\sigma \in \text{Gal}(\overline{K_v}/K_v)$ such that $\tau' = \sigma \circ \tau$. Now, since $\bar{v}$ is the unique extension of v from K_v to $\overline{K_v}$, we must have $\bar{v} \circ \sigma = \bar{v} \implies \bar{v} \circ \sigma \circ \tau = \bar{v} \circ \tau$, i.e., $\bar{v} \circ \tau = \bar{v} \circ \tau'$.

Conversely, let $\tau, \tau' : L \hookrightarrow \overline{K_v}$ be two K -embeddings such that $\bar{v} \circ \tau = \bar{v} \circ \tau'$. Consider the K -isomorphism $\sigma := \tau' \circ \tau^{-1} : \tau L \rightarrow \tau' L$.

Claim: τL is dense in $\tau L \cdot K_v$: we have $K \subseteq \tau L \subseteq \tau L \cdot K_v$, which implies an inclusion of closures $\overline{K} \subseteq \overline{\tau L} \subseteq \overline{\tau L \cdot K_v} = \tau L \cdot K_v$, since $\tau L \cdot K_v$ is complete. Now, the closure of K in a complete space must be its completion, since a closed subspace of a metric space is complete and the completion of K is the smallest complete space containing K . Hence, $\overline{K} = K_v$, giving $K_v \subseteq \overline{\tau L}$. Further, we also have $\tau L \subseteq \overline{\tau L}$, implying the composite $\tau L \cdot K_v \subseteq \overline{\tau L}$; this precisely means that τL is dense in $\tau L \cdot K_v$. We now extend σ to a continuous bijection of complete spaces $\sigma : \tau L \cdot K_v \xrightarrow{\sim} \tau' L \cdot K_v$ in the canonical way, i.e., $\sigma(x) := \lim \sigma(\tau(x_n)) \in \tau' L \cdot K_v$, where $x = \lim \tau(x_n) \in \tau L \cdot K_v$. Note that the inverse map given by $y \mapsto \sigma^{-1}\tau(y_n)$ is also a continuous bijection by the same argument, hence the map $\sigma : \tau L \cdot K_v \xrightarrow{\sim} \tau' L \cdot K_v$ is a homeomorphism. In fact, it is a K_v -isomorphism since for any $x \in K_v$, we have $x = \lim \tau(x_n)$ for $(x_n)_n \subseteq K_v$ and so $\sigma(x) = \lim(\sigma \circ \tau)(x_n) = \lim x_n = x$, since $\sigma \circ \tau$ is a K_v -embedding. We now extend this σ to a K_v -automorphism $\tilde{\sigma} : \overline{K_v} \rightarrow \overline{K_v}$ satisfying $\tau' = \tilde{\sigma} \circ \tau$, thence proving that τ, τ' are conjugate over K_v . ▀

Corollary 2.3.3.1. *If $L = K(\alpha)$ is generated by the zero α of an irreducible polynomial $f(x) \in K[x]$ and $f(x) = f_1(x)^{m_1} \cdots f_r(x)^{m_r}$ is the decomposition of $f(x)$ into irreducibles over K_v , then the valuations $w_1, \dots, w_r$ extending v correspond one-one to the factors $f_1, \dots, f_r$.*

Proof. Note that the K -embeddings $\tau : L \hookrightarrow \overline{K_v}$ are given by the distinct zeroes of $f(x)$ lying in $\overline{K_v}$ as $\tau(\alpha) = \beta$. Now, to count the number of extensions of v , it suffices to count conjugacy classes over K_v , by the previous theorem. Note that if τ, τ' are conjugate over K_v via σ , then $\tau\alpha$ and $\tau'\alpha$ are roots of the same irreducible factor f_i : suppose $\tau'\alpha$ is a root of f_i , then $0 = f_i(\tau'\alpha) = f_i(\sigma(\tau\alpha)) = \sigma(f_i(\tau\alpha))$, since

2.3. EXTENSIONS OF VALUATIONS

σ preserves all coefficients of f_i . Hence, $\sigma(f_i(\tau\alpha)) = 0 \implies f_i(\tau\alpha) = 0$, as desired. Conversely, suppose $\tau\alpha$ and $\tau'\alpha$ are roots of f_i in $\overline{K_v}$, then these are Galois-conjugate to each other as $\overline{K_v}/K_v$ is a Galois extension. Therefore, there exists $\sigma \in G(\overline{K_v}/K_v)$ such that $\tau'\alpha = \sigma(\tau\alpha)$, i.e., $\tau'\alpha = (\sigma \circ \tau)(\alpha)$. Since $L = K(\alpha)$ is generated by α , we have $\tau'x = (\sigma \circ \tau)(x) \forall x \in L$, i.e., $\tau' = \sigma \circ \tau$. Therefore, we have shown that τ, τ' are conjugate over K_v if and only if $\tau\alpha$ and $\tau'\alpha$ are roots of the same irreducible factor f_i . In particular, the conjugacy classes over K_v correspond one-one to the distinct factors $f_1, \dots, f_r$, and hence, so do the valuations $w_1, \dots, w_r$ extending v . $\blacksquare$

Remark 2.4. Explicitly, the valuation w_i is obtained from the irreducible factor f_i as follows: let $\alpha_i \in \overline{K_v}$ be a zero of f_i and define the K -embedding $\tau_i : L \hookrightarrow \overline{K_v}$ by $\tau_i(\alpha) = \alpha_i$. Then, we have $w_i = \bar{v} \circ \tau_i$. Similarly, given an extension $w_i = \bar{v} \circ \tau_i$, f_i is the factor having $\tau_i(\alpha)$ as a root.

Observe that, for every w extending v (hereafter denoted as $w|v$), the canonical inclusion $i_w : L \hookrightarrow L_w$ induces a map $\phi_w : L \otimes_K K_v \rightarrow L_w$ by extension of scalars, sending $a \otimes_K b \mapsto i_w(a)b$. For notational ease, we shall write $a_w b \in L_w$ instead of $i_w(a)b$. This map is K_v -linear since $\phi_w(a \otimes_K cb) = a_w cb = c(a_w b) = c\phi_w(a \otimes_K b)$. In fact, more is true, $\phi_w : L \otimes_K K_v \rightarrow L_w$ is a homomorphism of K_v -algebras where the product on the left side is given as $(a \otimes_K b)(a' \otimes_K b') = aa' \otimes_K bb'$. It is clear that ϕ_w respects multiplication since $\phi_w((a \otimes_K b)(a' \otimes_K b')) = \phi_w(aa' \otimes_K bb') = i_w(aa')bb' = i_w(a)i_w(a')bb' = i_w(a)bi_w(a')b' = \phi_w(a \otimes_K b)\phi_w(a' \otimes_K b')$. Therefore, these maps induce a canonical K_v -algebra homomorphism $\phi : L \otimes_K K_v \rightarrow \prod_{w|v} L_w$. It turns out that this map, in fact, is an isomorphism when L/K is finite separable, which we shall prove via the following two general lemmas.

Lemma 2.3.1. *Let B be an A -algebra. Then, $A[x] \otimes_A B \cong B[x]$.*

Proof. We define a pair of A -algebra morphisms $\phi : A[x] \otimes_A B \rightarrow B[x] : (\sum_i a_i x^i) \otimes b \mapsto \sum_i ba_i x^i$ and $\varphi : B[x] \rightarrow A[x] \otimes_A B : \sum_i b_i x^i \mapsto \sum_i b_i \otimes x^i$. Consider the composite $\phi \circ \varphi : B[x] \rightarrow B[x]$; we have $(\phi \circ \varphi)(\sum_i b_i x^i) = \phi(\varphi(\sum_i b_i x^i)) = \phi(\sum_i b_i \otimes x^i) = \sum_i b_i x^i$, i.e., $\phi \circ \varphi = \text{id}_{B[x]}$. Similarly, we have $\varphi \circ \phi : A[x] \otimes_A B \rightarrow A[x] \otimes_A B$ and $(\varphi \circ \phi)((\sum_i a_i x^i) \otimes b) = \varphi(\phi((\sum_i a_i x^i) \otimes b)) = \varphi(\sum_i ba_i x^i) = \sum_i ba_i \otimes x^i = (\sum_i a_i x^i) \otimes b$, i.e., $\varphi \circ \phi = \text{Id}_{A[x] \otimes_A B}$. This proves the result. $\blacksquare$

Lemma 2.3.2. *Let B be an A -algebra and $\mathfrak{a} \triangleleft A[x]$ be an ideal. Then, there is an isomorphism $\frac{A[x]}{\mathfrak{a}} \otimes_A B \cong \frac{B[x]}{\mathfrak{a}B[x]}$.*

2.3. EXTENSIONS OF VALUATIONS

Proof. We have the exact sequence $0 \longrightarrow \mathfrak{a} \xrightarrow{i} A[x] \xrightarrow{\pi} A[x]/\mathfrak{a} \longrightarrow 0$, which gives an exact sequence $\mathfrak{a} \otimes_A B \xrightarrow{i \otimes \text{id}} A[x] \otimes_A B \xrightarrow{\pi \otimes \text{id}} (A[x]/\mathfrak{a}) \otimes_A B \longrightarrow 0$. The exactness implies that $(A[x]/\mathfrak{a}) \otimes_A B \cong (A[x] \otimes_A B)/\text{Im}(i \otimes \text{id}) \cong B[x]/\text{Im}(i \otimes \text{id})$, and hence the result then follows if we show $\text{Im}(i \otimes \text{id}) = i(\mathfrak{a}) \otimes_A B \cong \mathfrak{a}B[x]$. As in the previous lemma, we define a pair of A -algebra morphisms

$$\phi : i(\mathfrak{a}) \otimes_A B \rightarrow \mathfrak{a}B[x] : i\left(\sum_k a_k x^k\right) \otimes b \mapsto \sum_k b a_k x^k, \text{ and}$$

$$\varphi : \mathfrak{a}B[x] \rightarrow i(\mathfrak{a}) \otimes_A B : \left(\sum_k a_k x^k\right) \left(\sum_j b_j x^j\right) \mapsto \sum_{k,j} (i(a_k x^{k+j}) \otimes b_j).$$

Then, as before, $\varphi \circ \phi : i(\mathfrak{a}) \otimes_A B \rightarrow i(\mathfrak{a}) \otimes_A B$ gives us $(\varphi \circ \phi)(i(\sum_k a_k x^k) \otimes b) = \varphi(\sum_k b a_k x^k) = i(\sum_k a_k x^k) \otimes b$ and $\phi \circ \varphi : \mathfrak{a}B[x] \rightarrow \mathfrak{a}B[x]$ gives $(\phi \circ \varphi)((\sum_k a_k x^k)(\sum_j b_j x^j)) = \phi(\sum_{k,j} (i(a_k x^{k+j}) \otimes b_j)) = \sum_{k,j} (a_k b_j x^{k+j}) = (\sum_k a_k x^k)(\sum_j b_j x^j)$; this finishes the proof. □

Theorem 2.3.4. *Let L/K be a finite separable extension, then $L \otimes_K K_v \cong \prod_{w|v} L_w$ as K_v -algebras.*

Proof. We may write $L = K(\alpha)$, for some $\alpha \in L$, by the primitive element theorem. Let $f(x)$ denote the minimal polynomial of α over K . Consider its decomposition into irreducibles $f(x) = \prod_{w|v} f_w(x)$ in $K_v[x]$. Note that here each irreducible factor f_w occurs only once by virtue of f being separable. Now, consider $L \otimes_K K_v = K(\alpha) \otimes_K K_v \cong K[x]/(f) \otimes_K K_v \cong K_v[x]/(f K_v[x])$, by the lemma above. We further have $(f K_v[x]) = (\prod f_w)$, hence $L \otimes_K K_v \cong K_v[x]/\prod f_w$, which, by the Chinese Remainder Theorem, is isomorphic to $\prod_{w|v} K_v[x]/(f_w)$. Fix an extension $w|v$, and complete L with respect to w to get L_w . Let α_w denote the image of α in L_w . Now, α_w determines the K -embedding $\tau : L \hookrightarrow \overline{K_v} : \alpha \mapsto \alpha_w$, which by Remark 2.4, implies that α_w is a root of f_w . Since f_w is an irreducible polynomial having α_w as a root, it must be the minimal polynomial of α_w over K_v , i.e., $K_v[x]/(f_w) \cong K_v(\alpha_w)$. We shall now show $L_w = K_v(\alpha_w)$. Trivially, we have $K_v(\alpha_w) \subseteq L_w$ since $K_v \subseteq L_w$ and $\alpha_w \in L_w$. Conversely, since $K_v(\alpha_w)$ is a finite dimensional vector space over the complete field K_v , it must be complete as well. Now, $L \subseteq K_v(\alpha_w)$ implies $L_w \subseteq K_v(\alpha_w)$, since L_w is the smallest complete field containing L , hence $L_w = K_v(\alpha_w)$. Note that the valuation on both sides is the same by virtue of Theorem

2.3. EXTENSIONS OF VALUATIONS

2.3.2. Therefore, we finally obtain $K_v[x]/(f_w) \cong K_v(\alpha_w) = L_w$ and we originally had $L \otimes_K K_v \cong K_v[x]/\prod f_w = \prod_{w|v} K_v[x]/(f_w)$. Combining these isomorphisms, we conclude $L \otimes_K K_v \cong \prod_{w|v} L_w$. $\blacksquare$

Lemma 2.3.3. *Let V_1, V_2 be finite dimensional K -vector spaces and $T : V_1 \times V_2 \rightarrow V_1 \times V_2$ be a linear map such that $T(V_1) \subseteq V_1$ and $T(V_2) \subseteq V_2$. Let $T_i : V_i \rightarrow V_i$ denote the restrictions of T to each V_i . Then, $\text{char}_{V_1 \times V_2}^T = \text{char}_{V_1 \times V_2}^{T_1} \text{char}_{V_1 \times V_2}^{T_2}$.*

Proof. Under the hypothesis, we can represent the matrix of T as a block diagonal matrix consisting of T_1 and T_2 , i.e., $T = \begin{pmatrix} T_1 & 0 \\ 0 & T_2 \end{pmatrix}$. Then, we have

$$\text{char}_{V_1 \times V_2}^T(x) = \det(xI - T) = \det \begin{pmatrix} xI - T_1 & 0 \\ 0 & xI - T_2 \end{pmatrix} = \det(xI - T_1) \det(xI - T_2)$$

Since $= \text{char}_{V_1 \times V_2}^{T_1}(x) \text{char}_{V_1 \times V_2}^{T_2}(x) = \det(xI - T_1) \det(xI - T_2)$, we are done. In fact, proceeding inductively, it follows that $\text{char}_{V_1 \times \dots \times V_n}^T = \prod_{i=1}^n \text{char}_{V_1 \times \dots \times V_n}^{T_i}$. $\blacksquare$

Lemma 2.3.4. *Let f, g be monic polynomials of degree n and m respectively over a commutative ring R . Then, the coefficient of x^{m+n-1} in fg is the sum of the coefficient of x^{n-1} in f and that of x^{m-1} in g .*

Proof. Let $f(x) = a_0 + a_1x + \dots + a_{n-1}x^{n-1} + x^n$ and $g(x) = b_0 + b_1x + \dots + b_{m-1}x^{m-1} + x^m$. Then, the coefficient of x^{m+n-1} in fg is precisely $a_{n-1} + b_{m-1}$. $\blacksquare$

Corollary 2.3.4.1. *Let L/K be a finite separable extension, then*

1. $[L : K] = \sum_{w|v} [L_w : K_v]$
2. $N_{L/K}(\alpha) = \prod_{w|v} (N_{L_w/K_v}(\alpha))$
3. $\text{Tr}_{L/K}(\alpha) = \sum_{w|v} (\text{Tr}_{L_w/K_v}(\alpha))$

Proof. For the first assertion, observe that $[L : K] = \dim_K(L) = \dim_{K_v}(L \otimes_K K_v)$, since extension of scalars preserves dimension. By the theorem, we have $\dim_{K_v}(L \otimes_K K_v) = \dim_{K_v}(\prod_{w|v} L_w) = \sum_{w|v} \dim_{K_v} L_w = \sum_{w|v} [L_w : K_v]$. For the latter two, let $T_\alpha : L \rightarrow L$ be the endomorphism of multiplication by $\alpha \in L$. Then, the characteristic polynomial of T_α over the K_v -vector space $L \otimes_K K_v$ is the same as that over the K -vector space L . Thus, $\text{char}_{L/K}^{T_\alpha} = \text{char}_{L \otimes_K K_v/K_v}^{T_\alpha} = \text{char}_{\prod_{w|v} L_w/K_v}^{T_\alpha} = \prod_{w|v} \text{char}_{L_w/K_v}^{T_\alpha}$,

by Lemma 2.3.3. Now, $N_{L/K}(\alpha)$ is the constant term in $\text{char}_{L/K}^{T_\alpha}$ which is equal to the product of the constant terms of $\text{char}_{L_w/K_v}^{T_\alpha}$, i.e., $\prod_{w|v}(N_{L_w/K_v}(\alpha))$. Similarly, $\text{Tr}_{L/K}(\alpha)$ corresponds to the second-leading term which, by Lemma 2.3.4, equals the sum of the second-leading terms of $\text{char}_{L_w/K_v}^{T_\alpha}$, i.e., $\sum_{w|v}(\text{Tr}_{L_w/K_v}(\alpha))$. This finishes the proof. ▀

Definition 2.3.3. If v is a nonarchimedean valuation then we define, as in the henselian case, the **ramification index** of an extension $w|v$ as $e_w := (w(L^\times) : v(K^\times))$ and the **inertia degree** as $f_w := [l_w : k]$.

We now state and prove the fundamental identity of valuation theory.

Theorem 2.3.5. *Let (K, v) be a nonarchimedean valued field and L/K a finite extension. If v is discrete and L/K is separable, then $[L : K] = \sum_{w|v} e_w f_w$.*

Proof. From the previous corollary, we know $[L : K] = \sum_{w|v} [L_w : K_v]$. Note that L_w/K_v is a finite extension of henselian fields, hence by the fundamental equality 2.2.6, we have $[L_w : K_v] = e_w f_w$. Combining these, we obtain $[L : K] = \sum_{w|v} e_w f_w$, as desired. ▀

Note that this theorem allows us to drop the assumption of henselianity from Theorem 2.2.6.

2.4 Galois Theory of Valuations

We now look at Galois extensions L/K and study the action of $G(L/K)$ on the set of extended valuations $w|v$. In the case of infinite extensions, we recall the canonical Krull topology on $G(L/K)$, given by defining a basis of neighbourhoods $\mathcal{N}_\sigma = \{\sigma G(L/M) : M/K \text{ varies over the finite Galois subextensions of } L/K\}$ around every $\sigma \in G(L/K)$.

This topology makes $G(L/K)$ into a compact, Hausdorff topological group.

We also recall the following definition and theorem from topology.

Definition 2.4.1. Given a topological space X , a family of subsets $\{X_\lambda\}_{\lambda \in \Lambda} \subseteq X$ is said to have **finite intersection property** if the intersection of any finite subfamily is nonempty.

2.4. GALOIS THEORY OF VALUATIONS

Theorem 2.4.1. *A topological space X is compact if and only if any family of closed subsets having finite intersection property has nonempty intersection.*

Lemma 2.4.1. *Let $L|K$ be an arbitrary Galois extension with Galois group $G = G(L|K)$ and w, w' be two extensions of v . If $w \circ \sigma \neq w' \circ \sigma'$ for some $\sigma \in G$, then the valuations $|\cdot|_{w \circ \sigma}$ and $|\cdot|_{w' \circ \sigma'}$ are not equivalent.*

Proof. Suppose not, i.e., $|\cdot|_{w \circ \sigma}$ and $|\cdot|_{w' \circ \sigma'}$ are equivalent. Then $|\cdot|_{w \circ \sigma} = |\cdot|_{w' \circ \sigma'}^s$ for some fixed $s > 0$ (cf. Theorem 1.1.2). Now, for any $x \in K$, we have $\sigma x = \sigma'(x) = x$ and $w(x) = w'(x) = v(x)$, hence $|x|_{w \circ \sigma} = |x|_{w' \circ \sigma'}$, i.e., $s = 1$, implying $w \circ \sigma = w' \circ \sigma'$, a contradiction. $\square$

Theorem 2.4.2. *Let $L|K$ be an arbitrary Galois extension with Galois group $G = G(L|K)$ and X be the set of extensions w of v to L . The group G acts transitively on X , i.e., every two extensions are conjugate.*

Proof. If v is an (archimedean or nonarchimedean) valuation of K and w is an extension of v to L , then, for every $\sigma \in G$, $w \circ \sigma$ also extends v , since for any $x \in K$, we have $(w \circ \sigma)(x) = w(\sigma x) = w(x) = v(x)$. Therefore, $w \circ \sigma \in X$ for all $w \in X$, i.e., the group G acts on the set X as $\sigma \cdot w := w \circ \sigma$. We now need to show that this action is transitive.

We first consider the case when L/K is finite. Let w and w' be two non-conjugate extensions. Then, by the lemma proved above, the orbits of w and w' do not intersect, i.e., $X_1 := \{w \circ \sigma : \sigma \in G\}$ and $X_2 := \{w' \circ \sigma' : \sigma' \in G\}$ are disjoint. Hence, there exists $x \in L$ such that $|x|_{w \circ \sigma} < 1$ and $|x|_{w' \circ \sigma'} > 1 \ \forall \sigma \in G$ (cf. Theorem 1.1.2). Consider $\alpha = N_{L/K}(x) = \prod_{\sigma \in G} \sigma x \in K$. We have $|\alpha|_v = |\alpha|_w = \prod_{\sigma} |\sigma x|_w = \prod_{\sigma} |x|_{w \circ \sigma} < 1$, while on the other hand, $|\alpha|_v = |\alpha|_{w'} = \prod_{\sigma'} |\sigma' x|_{w'} = \prod_{\sigma'} |x|_{w' \circ \sigma'} > 1$, a contradiction. This proves the theorem in the finite case.

Suppose now that L/K is infinite and let M/K vary over all finite Galois subextensions of L/K . Consider the sets $X_M := \{\sigma \in G : w \circ \sigma|_M = w'|_M\} \subseteq G$. By the proof for finite extensions, it follows that X_M is nonempty for every M/K . It is the case that these sets are closed in G , i.e., $G \setminus X_M$ is open: if not, then one can find a $\sigma \in G \setminus X_M$ and a basic open set $\sigma G(L/M)$ such that $\sigma G(L/M) \not\subseteq G \setminus X_M$, i.e., $\sigma G(L/M) \cap X_M \neq \emptyset$. Suppose $\sigma \circ \tau \in \sigma G(L/M) \cap X_M$, i.e., $\tau \in G(L/M)$ and $w \circ \sigma \circ \tau|_M = w'|_M$. But $\tau|_M = \text{id}_M$, giving $w \circ \sigma|_M = w'|_M$, i.e., $\sigma \in X_M$, a contradiction. Therefore, X_M is a nonempty closed set for every finite Galois subextension M/K of L/K . Note that L/K is the directed union of M/K and so to check $w \circ \sigma = w'$ on L , it suffices to check $w \circ \sigma|_M = w'|_M$ for every M . Hence, if we show

$\exists \sigma \in \cap_M X_M$, then we are done, therefore the proof reduces to showing $\cap_M X_M \neq \emptyset$. Suppose not, i.e., $\cap_M X_M = \emptyset$. By compactness of G and the theorem recalled above, there must exist a finite subfamily $\{X_{M_1}, X_{M_2}, \dots, X_{M_r}\}$ having empty intersection, i.e., $\cap_{i=1}^r X_{M_i} = \emptyset$. Consider now the composite $M' = M_1 M_2 \cdots M_r$; this is also a finite Galois subextension of L/K . Hence, $X_{M'} \neq \emptyset$. On the other hand, $X_{M'} = \{\sigma \in G : w \circ \sigma|_{M'} = w'|_{M'}\} = \{\sigma \in G : w \circ \sigma|_{M_i} = w'|_{M_i} \forall i = 1, 2, \dots, r\} = \cap_{i=1}^r X_{M_i} = \emptyset$, which is a contradiction. Hence, it must be the case that $\cap_M X_M \neq \emptyset$ and we are done. $\blacksquare$

Definition 2.4.2. The *decomposition group* of an extension $w|v$ is defined as $G_w = G_w(L/K) := \{\sigma \in G : w \circ \sigma = w\}$.

If v is nonarchimedean we further define the *inertia group* as $I_w = I_w(L/K) := \{\sigma \in G_w : \sigma x \equiv x \pmod{\mathfrak{p}_L} \text{ for all } x \in \mathcal{O}_L\}$ and the *ramification group* as $R_w = R_w(L/K) := \{\sigma \in G_w : \sigma x/x \equiv 1 \pmod{\mathfrak{p}_L} \text{ for all } x \in L^\times\}$.

We then have $R_w \subseteq I_w \subseteq G_w \subseteq G$. In fact, all these subgroups are closed in G , which is the content of the next lemma.

Lemma 2.4.2. G_w, I_w and R_w are closed subgroups of G .

Proof. 1. We first show that G_w is closed in G , i.e., $G_w = \overline{G_w}$. It suffices to show $\overline{G_w} \subseteq G_w$, so we take an arbitrary $\sigma \in \overline{G_w}$. Then, every neighborhood $\sigma G(L/M)$ intersects G_w , i.e., $\exists \sigma_M \in \sigma G(L/M) \cap G_w$, which means that $\sigma_M|_M = \sigma|_M$ and $w \circ \sigma_M = w$. These together imply that $w \circ \sigma|_M = w \circ \sigma_M|_M = w|_M$ for every M/K , i.e., $w \circ \sigma = w$ on L .

2. For $I_w = \overline{I_w}$, we proceed exactly as above and obtain a $\sigma_M \in \sigma G(L/M) \cap I_w$, whence $\sigma_M|_M = \sigma|_M$ and $\sigma_M(x) - x \in \mathfrak{p}_L$ for all $x \in \mathcal{O}_L$. Therefore, given any $x \in \mathcal{O}_L$, pick an M/K such that $x \in M$, then consider $(\sigma x - x)|_M = \sigma|_M(x) - x = \sigma_M|_M(x) - x = \sigma_M(x) - x \in \mathfrak{p}_L$, as desired.

3. For $R_w = \overline{R_w}$, similarly we have $\sigma_M \in \sigma G(L/M) \cap I_w$, whence $\sigma_M|_M = \sigma|_M$ and $\sigma_M(x)/x \equiv 1 \pmod{\mathfrak{p}_L}$ for all $x \in L^\times$. Given any $x \in L^\times$, pick an M/K such that $x \in M$, then $\sigma|_M(x)/x = \sigma_M|_M(x)/x = \sigma_M(x)/x \equiv 1 \pmod{\mathfrak{p}_L}$ and we are done. $\blacksquare$

Consider now two Galois extensions related by a map $\tau : L/K \rightarrow L'/K'$:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} L & \xrightarrow{\tau} & L' \\ | & \circ & | \\ K & \xrightarrow{\tau} & K' \end{array}$$

There is a group homomorphism $\tau^* : G(L'/K') \rightarrow G(L/K) : \sigma' \mapsto \tau^{-1}\sigma'\tau$. We fix some notation now: let w' be a valuation on L' , set $v' = w'|_{K'}$, $w = w' \circ \tau$ and $v = w|_K$. Then we have,

Theorem 2.4.3. $\tau^* : G(L'/K') \rightarrow G(L/K)$ induces homomorphisms:

$$\begin{aligned} G'_w(L'/K') &\rightarrow G_w(L/K) \\ I'_w(L'/K') &\rightarrow I_w(L/K) \\ R'_w(L'/K') &\rightarrow R_w(L/K) \end{aligned}$$

In the latter two cases, v is assumed to be nonarchimedean.

Proof. We prove the first homomorphism, the proof for the other two follows along similar lines. Let $\sigma' \in G'_w(L'/K')$, then $\sigma := \tau^*(\sigma') = \tau^{-1}\sigma'\tau \in G(L/K)$. We wish to show that $\tau^{-1}\sigma'\tau \in G'_w(L/K)$, i.e., $w \circ \sigma = w$. Consider $x \in L$, we then have $(w \circ \sigma)(x) = (w \circ \tau^{-1}\sigma'\tau)(x) = (w \circ \tau^{-1})(\sigma'(\tau x)) = w'(\sigma'(\tau x)) = w'((\tau x))$, since $\sigma' \in G'_w(L'/K')$. Further, $w'((\tau x)) = w(x)$, hence $w \circ \sigma = w$, as desired. ▀

If the two homomorphisms $\tau : L \rightarrow L'$ and $\tau : K \rightarrow K'$ are isomorphisms, then the above homomorphisms are isomorphisms. In particular, in the case $K = K', L = L'$, we find for each $\tau \in G(L|K)$: $G_{w\sigma\tau} = \tau^{-1}G_w\tau, I_{w\sigma\tau} = \tau^{-1}I_w\tau, R_{w\sigma\tau} = \tau^{-1}R_w\tau$, i.e., the decomposition, inertia, and ramification groups of conjugate valuations are conjugate.

Another special case arises as follows: let $K \subseteq M \subseteq L$ be a tower of fields; take $L' = L$ and $K' = K$ to get the following diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} L & \xrightarrow{\text{id}} & L \\ | & \circ & | \\ K & \hookrightarrow & M \end{array}$$

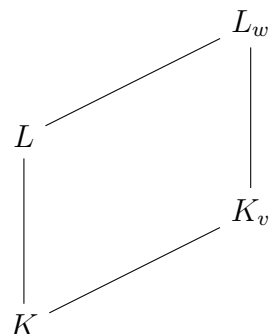
τ^* then becomes the inclusion $G(L|M) \hookrightarrow G(L|K)$, and we have

Theorem 2.4.4. *For the extensions $K \subseteq M \subseteq L$, one has*

$$\begin{aligned} G_w(L|M) &= G_w(L|K) \cap G(L|M), \\ I_w(L|M) &= I_w(L|K) \cap G(L|M), \\ R_w(L|M) &= R_w(L|K) \cap G(L|M). \end{aligned}$$

Proof. As earlier, we only prove the first equality; the others follow similarly. The inclusion $G_w(L|M) \subseteq G_w(L|K) \cap G(L|M)$ follows by definition. Conversely, let $\sigma \in G_w(L|K) \cap G(L|M)$. Since $\sigma \in G_w(L|K)$, it is the case that $\sigma \in G(L|K)$ such that $w \circ \sigma = w$ on L . However, since $\sigma \in G(L|M)$ we must have $w \circ \sigma = w$ on M , where w is now the restricted valuation on M . Hence, $\sigma \in G_w(L|M)$. $\blacksquare$

We also have the particularly important case of passing to the localisation.



In the local extension L_w/K_v , the extended valuation is unique, hence we denote the corresponding decomposition, inertia and ramification groups simply by $G(L_w/K_v)$, $I(L_w/K_v)$ and $R(L_w/K_v)$. In this case, the map $\tau^* : G(L_w/K_v) \rightarrow G(L/K)$ is simply the restriction map $\sigma \mapsto \sigma|_L$.

Lemma 2.4.3. *The decomposition group $G_w(L/K)$ consists of precisely those $\sigma \in G(L/K)$ which are continuous with respect to w .*

Proof. Suppose $\sigma \in G(L/K)$ is continuous with respect to w . Then, for any $x \in L$, we have $|x|_w < 1 \implies |x|_{w \circ \sigma} < 1$, because the σ maps the w -nullsequence $(x, x^2, x^3, \dots)$ to another w -nullsequence $(\sigma x, \sigma x^2, \sigma x^3, \dots)$ by continuity, which means that $(x, x^2, x^3, \dots)$ is a $(w \circ \sigma)$ -nullsequence. Therefore, the valuations $|\cdot|_w$ and $|\cdot|_{w \circ \sigma}$ are equivalent, hence by Lemma 2.4.1, we conclude $w = w \circ \sigma$, i.e., $\sigma \in G_w(L/K)$. Conversely, if $\sigma \in G_w(L/K)$, then $|x|_w = |x|_{w \circ \sigma} = |\sigma x|_w$, hence $|x - y|_w = |\sigma(x - y)|_w = |\sigma x - \sigma y|_w$ i.e., σ is Lipschitz, and in particular, continuous, as desired. $\blacksquare$

Theorem 2.4.5.

$$\begin{aligned} G_w(L/K) &\cong G(L_w/K_v) \\ I_w(L/K) &\cong I(L_w/K_v) \\ R_w(L/K) &\cong R(L_w/K_v) \end{aligned}$$

Proof. We give a map $\phi : G_w(L/K) \rightarrow G(L_w/K_v)$ as follows: given $\sigma \in G_w(L/K)$, it is Lipschitz as seen above, and so uniformly continuous. We consider the canonical composite $\sigma : L \rightarrow L \hookrightarrow L_w$ and since L_w is a complete metric space, we apply Theorem 2.3.1 to obtain the unique extension $\widehat{\sigma} : \overline{L} \rightarrow L_w$. However, since L is dense in L_w , we obtain an automorphism $\widehat{\sigma} : L_w \rightarrow L_w$. Further, for any $x = (x_n)_n + \mathcal{N}_K \in K_v$, we have $\widehat{\sigma}(x) = \lim \sigma x_n = \lim x_n = x$, since σ is identity on K . Therefore, $\widehat{\sigma}$ is a K_v -automorphism of L_w , i.e., $\widehat{\sigma} \in G(L_w/K_v)$. We define $\phi(\sigma) := \widehat{\sigma}$. Note that by the uniqueness of $\widehat{\sigma}$, the map ϕ is injective and it is clearly a homomorphism. We now prove surjectivity: let $\widehat{\tau} \in G(L_w/K_v)$ and let $\tau := \widehat{\tau}|_L$. Since L/K is a Galois extension, $\tau \in G(L/K)$. We need to show further that $w \circ \tau = w$ on L . For this, take any $x \in L$, then $(w \circ \tau)(x) = w(\tau x) = \widehat{w}(\widehat{\tau}((x)_n)) = (\widehat{w} \circ \widehat{\tau})((x)_n) = \widehat{w}((x)_n)$, by the uniqueness of the extended valuation $\widehat{w}$ in the local extension L_w/K_v , and since $\widehat{w}((x)_n) = \lim w(x) = w(x)$, we get $w \circ \tau = w$ on L . By the uniqueness of extension quoted in the lemma above, it also follows that $\phi(\tau) = \widehat{\tau}$ and we are done. Therefore, $\phi : G_w(L/K) \xrightarrow{\sim} G(L_w/K_v)$.

The proof of surjectivity, i.e., $\widehat{\tau} \in G(L_w/K_v) \implies \tau := \widehat{\tau}|_L \in G_w(L/K)$ follows mutatis mutandis in showing that $\widehat{\tau} \in I(L_w/K_v)$ (resp. $R(L_w/K_v)$) $\implies \tau := \widehat{\tau}|_L \in I_w(L/K)$ (resp. $R_w(L/K)$) which proves the bijectivity in all the cases and finishes the proof. $\blacksquare$

In view of the above theorem, we identify the decomposition subgroup $G_w(L/K)$ with $G(L_w/K_v)$ and similarly $I_w(L/K)$ with $I(L_w/K_v)$ and $R_w(L/K)$ with $R(L_w/K_v)$.

Definition 2.4.3. We define the **decomposition field** as the fixed field of G_w , denoted by $Z_w = Z_w(L/K) := \{x \in L : \sigma x = x \ \forall \sigma \in G_w\}$.

Theorem 2.4.6. 1. The restriction of w to Z_w , denoted by w_Z extends uniquely to L .

2. $Z_w = L \cap K_v$

2.4. GALOIS THEORY OF VALUATIONS

3. If v is nonarchimedean, then the extension Z_w/K is immediate, i.e., w_Z has the same residue field and value group as v .

Proof. 1. We consider the (Galois) extension L/Z_w where Z_w has the valuation w_Z . We know any two extensions w and w' are conjugate, hence $w' = w \circ \sigma$ for some $\sigma \in G(L/Z_w) = G_w(L/K) \implies w' = w$, as desired.

2. We show both inclusions: let $x \in Z_w$, i.e., $x \in L$ and $\sigma x = x \forall \sigma \in G_w(L/K)$. Since $G_w(L/K) \cong G(L_w/K_v)$, we get $\sigma x = x \forall \sigma \in G(L_w/K_v)$, i.e., $x \in K_v$, which proves $Z_w \subseteq L \cap K_v$. Conversely, for any $x \in L \cap K_v$, we have $x \in K_v \implies \sigma x = x \forall \sigma \in G(L_w/K_v) = G_w(L/K)$, i.e., $x \in L^{G_w} = Z_w$, as required.

3. We know from Theorem 1.1.8 that the extension K_v/K is immediate. Therefore, the intermediate extension Z_w/K of K_v/K is also immediate. ■

Remark 2.5. Note that the first part of the above theorem says once we choose an extension $w|v$, there is no further ambiguity above Z_w , i.e., since w_Z extends uniquely to L , it also extends uniquely to any subextension L/M . We will see the subextensions of L/K corresponding to the various subgroups of G_w mentioned above, and in all these cases, we will repeatedly use the fact that the valuation on Z_w extends uniquely.

Theorem 2.4.7. Let $G_w \backslash G$ denote the set of all right cosets $G_w \sigma$ and W_v denote the set of all extensions of v to L . Choosing a fixed extension w , we obtain a bijection $G_w \backslash G \rightarrow W_v : G_w \sigma \mapsto w \circ \sigma$. In particular, the number of extensions $g = |W_v|$ equals the index $|G/G_w|$.

Proof. Note that this map is injective because $w \circ \sigma = w \circ \sigma' \implies w = w \circ \sigma' \sigma^{-1} \implies \sigma' \sigma^{-1} \in G_w \implies G_w \sigma = G_w \sigma'$. Consider the transitive group action $G \curvearrowright W_v$ that we have seen before. Then, G_w is simply the stabiliser of w under this action. Further, since the action is transitive, the orbit of w is the whole of W_v . Therefore, by orbit-stabiliser theorem, we have $|G/G_w| = |W_v|$. Hence, the injective map $G_w \backslash G \rightarrow W_v$ is, in fact, a bijection. ■

In the case of an arbitrary separable extension, we have a similar result. Before stating it, let us prove the following general fact about group actions.

Lemma 2.4.4. *Let X be G -set and $H \leq G$ such that H acts trivially on X . Then, $\text{stab}_{G/H}(x) \cong \text{stab}_G(x)/H$.*

Proof. We give a map $\text{stab}_G(x) \rightarrow \text{stab}_{G/H}(x) : g \mapsto Hg$. Given any $Hg \in \text{stab}_{G/H}(x)$, we have $x = Hg \cdot x := gx$, i.e., $g \in \text{stab}_G(x)$, so the map is surjective. Further, its kernel is $\{g \in \text{stab}_G(x) : Hg = H\} = H$, therefore by First Isomorphism Theorem, we obtain $\text{stab}_{G/H}(x) \cong \text{stab}_G(x)/H$. $\blacksquare$

Theorem 2.4.8. *Let L/K be a separable extension embedded in some Galois extension N/K . Let w be a fixed extension of v to N , $G = G(N/K)$, $H = G(N/L)$, and $G_w = G_w(N/K)$. We have a bijection $G_w \backslash G/H \rightarrow W_v : G_w \sigma H \mapsto w \circ \sigma|_L$.*

Proof. As before, the map $G_w \backslash G/H \rightarrow W_v$ is injective. We again consider the transitive action $G \curvearrowright W_v$ and observe that this induces a transitive G/H -action on W_v because every $\sigma \in H$ is identity on L , hence $w \circ \sigma|_L = w|_L$. Further, we know from Galois theory that $G/H = G(N/K)/G(N/L) \cong G(L/K)$ via the restriction map, hence $\sigma H \cdot w = \sigma|_L \cdot w = w \circ \sigma|_L$. Consider now the orbit-stabiliser theorem: we have a bijection

$$W_v = \text{orb}_{G/H}(w) \xleftarrow{\text{bij.}} \frac{(G/H)}{\text{stab}_{G/H}(w)} \cong \frac{(G/H)}{(\text{stab}_G(w))/H} = G_w \backslash G/H$$

$$w \circ \sigma|_L = \sigma H \cdot w \longleftarrow (G/H)_w(\sigma H) \longleftarrow (G_w/H)(\sigma H) \longleftarrow G_w \sigma H$$

Lemma 2.4.5. *Consider the group of order 20 presented by $G = \langle \sigma, \tau : \sigma^5 = 1 = \tau^4, \tau \sigma \tau^{-1} = \sigma^2 \rangle = M \rtimes N$, where $M = \langle \tau \rangle$ and $N = \langle \sigma \rangle \cong G/M$. Then, $M \curvearrowright G/M$ has two orbits of sizes 4 and 1.*

Proof. We consider the action $M \curvearrowright N : \tau \cdot \sigma := \tau \sigma \tau^{-1} = \sigma^2$. Then, $\text{orb}(\tau) = \{\sigma, \sigma^2, \sigma^3, \sigma^4\}$ and $\text{orb}(1) = \{1\}$. We have $N = \langle \sigma \rangle \cong G/M$ by the isomorphism $\sigma \mapsto \sigma H$, and so $M \curvearrowright G/M$. $\blacksquare$

Lemma 2.4.6. *Let $(n, p) = 1$, then $\mathbb{Q}_p$ contains all n -th roots.*

Proof. Consider the polynomial $f(x) = x^n - b$ for an arbitrary b over $\mathbb{Z}_p$ and reduce it modulo p to obtain $\bar{f}(x) = x^n - b$ in $\mathbb{Z}_p/p\mathbb{Z}_p \cong \mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z}$. Since $(n, p) = 1$, there exists $a \in \mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z}$ such that $a^n = b$, hence we get $\bar{f}(x)$ has a root a . By Hensel's Lemma (the elementary version (2.1.5)), we may lift a to a root of f over $\mathbb{Z}_p$, i.e., there exists $\beta \in \mathbb{Z}_p$ such that $f(\beta) = 0 \implies \beta^n = b$, as desired. $\blacksquare$

2.4. GALOIS THEORY OF VALUATIONS

Example 2.1. We now illustrate Theorem 2.4.8 in full detail with an example: let $K = \mathbb{Q}$, $L = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt[5]{7})$ and $N = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt[5]{7}, \zeta_5)$ where ζ_5 is a primitive 5-th root of unity. For convenience, we denote $\alpha = \sqrt[5]{7}$ and $\zeta = \zeta_5$. Then, we have $G = G(N/K) = \text{Gal}(\mathbb{Q}(\alpha, \zeta)/\mathbb{Q})$, and $H = G(N/L) = \text{Gal}(\mathbb{Q}(\alpha, \zeta)/\mathbb{Q}(\alpha))$.

$$\begin{array}{c} N = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt[5]{7}, \zeta_5) \\ | \\ L = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt[5]{7}) \\ | \\ K = \mathbb{Q} \end{array}$$

Let us endow K with the 3-adic valuation v_3 and consider the set of extensions W_v of v_3 from K to L . As seen in Corollary 2.3.3.1, the number of elements in W_v correspond to the factorisation of $f(x) = x^5 - 7$ into irreducibles over $K_v = \mathbb{Q}_3$. Consider the polynomial $f(x)$ over $\mathbb{Z}_3$ and reduce it modulo 3 to obtain $\bar{f}(x) = x^5 - 1$ in $\mathbb{Z}_3/3\mathbb{Z}_3 \cong \mathbb{Z}/3\mathbb{Z}$, whence it follows $\bar{f}(x) = (x-1)(x^4 + x^3 + x^2 + x + 1)$, whence we obtain $f(x) = x^5 - 7 = (x - \beta)h(x)$, where $h(x)$ is an irreducible polynomial of degree 4 such that $\bar{h}(x) = x^4 + x^3 + x^2 + x + 1$ and β is as derived in the lemma above. This means that there are 2 extensions of v_3 from K to L . We fix w to be the extension corresponding to the irreducible factor $(x - \beta)$, i.e., $w = \bar{v}_3 \circ \tau$ where $\tau : L \hookrightarrow \overline{\mathbb{Q}_3}$ such that $\tau(\alpha) = \beta$ (cf. Remark 2.4). Alternatively, to see that there are two extensions, we can use Theorem 2.3.4 to conclude that $\mathbb{Q}(\alpha) \otimes_{\mathbb{Q}} \mathbb{Q}_3$ must be a product of local fields and the number of factors in this product gives the number of $w|v_3$. We have

$$\mathbb{Q}(\alpha) \otimes_{\mathbb{Q}} \mathbb{Q}_3 \cong \mathbb{Q}_3(\alpha) \cong \frac{\mathbb{Q}_3(x)}{(x^5 - 7)} \cong \frac{\mathbb{Q}_3(x)}{(x - \beta)h(x)} \cong \mathbb{Q}_3 \times L'_3,$$

where L'_3 is an extension of degree 4 over $\mathbb{Q}_3$, since $h(x)$ is irreducible. Thus, there are two valuations on L extending v_3 .

Now, note that in our example, $|G| = 20$ and $H \triangleleft G$ is isomorphic to $\mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}$, because $H = \text{Gal}(\mathbb{Q}(\alpha, \zeta)/\mathbb{Q}(\alpha)) \cong \text{Gal}(\mathbb{Q}(\zeta)/\mathbb{Q}) \cong (\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z})^\times$. Explicitly, H is generated by $(\zeta \mapsto \zeta^2)$. Further, $G_w(N/K) \cong G(N_w/K_v) = \text{Gal}(\mathbb{Q}_3(\alpha, \zeta)/\mathbb{Q}_3) = \text{Gal}(\mathbb{Q}_3(\zeta)/\mathbb{Q}_3)$ because $\mathbb{Q}_3$ already contains a 5-th root of 7, namely β . Therefore, $G_w = \text{Gal}(\mathbb{Q}_3(\zeta)/\mathbb{Q}_3) = \mathbb{Q}_3[x]/(x^4 + x^3 + x^2 + x + 1) \cong (\mathbb{Z}/5\mathbb{Z})^\times \cong \mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}$, since $x^4 + x^3 + x^2 + x + 1$ is irreducible over $\mathbb{Q}_3$, as seen earlier. Hence, we

2.4. GALOIS THEORY OF VALUATIONS

obtain $G_w \cong H$. Further, it is a fact from Galois theory that $\text{Gal}(x^5 - a)$ is the group described in Lemma 2.4.5. In our particular case, we have $M = G_w$ acting on $G/M \cong G/H$, whence we see that the orbits are precisely $\{1\}$ and $\{\bar{\sigma}, \bar{\sigma}^2, \bar{\sigma}^3, \bar{\sigma}^4\}$, where σ is the map $\alpha \mapsto \zeta\alpha$. These two cosets correspond bijectively to the two extensions of v to L .

Remark 2.6. Note that we can compute $\beta \in \mathbb{Z}_3$ from the above example up to desired precision using the fact that $\beta^5 = 7$ in $\mathbb{Z}_3 \iff \beta^5 \equiv 7 \pmod{3^n}$ for all $n \geq 1$ as follows: write $\beta = a_0 + a_1 3 + a_2 3^2 + \dots$, then $\beta \equiv 1 \pmod{3}$ and so $a_0 = 1$. Set $\beta = 1 + 3t$. Then $(1 + 3t)^5 = 1 + 5 \cdot 3t + 10 \cdot 9t^2 + \dots \equiv 1 + 15t \pmod{9} \implies 15t \equiv 6 \pmod{9} \implies 6t \equiv 6 \pmod{9} \implies t \equiv 1 \pmod{3}$, so $a_1 = 1$. Now write $\beta = 1 + 3 + 9u$. Then $(1 + 3 + 9u)^5 = (4 + 9u)^5 \equiv 4^5 + 5 \cdot 4^4 \cdot 9u \pmod{27} \equiv 25 + 18u \pmod{27} \implies 18u \equiv 9 \pmod{27} \implies 2u \equiv 1 \pmod{3} \implies u \equiv 2 \pmod{3}$. Hence, $a_2 = 2$ and $\beta = 1 + 3 + 2 \cdot 3^2 + 27y$. Proceeding similarly, we obtain $\beta = 1 + 3 + 2 \cdot 3^2 + 3^4 + 2 \cdot 3^5 + 2 \cdot 3^6 + 2 \cdot 3^7 + \dots \in \mathbb{Z}_3$ as the unique 3-adic integer satisfying $\beta^5 = 7$.

Lemma 2.4.7. *Let L/K be Galois and v be a nonarchimedean valuation on K with a nonarchimedean extension w to L . Then, there is a group homomorphism $G_w \rightarrow \text{Aut}_k(l)$ with kernel I_w and the residue class field extension l/k is normal. In particular, we may write $\text{Aut}_k(l) = G(l/k)$.*

Proof. We know that for any $\sigma \in G_w$, we have $w \circ \sigma = w$, implying $(w \circ \sigma)(x) \geq \iff w(x) \geq 0$, i.e., $\sigma \mathcal{O}_L = \mathcal{O}_L$ and $\sigma \mathfrak{p}_L = \mathfrak{p}_L$. Therefore, σ induces an automorphism $\bar{\sigma} : \mathcal{O}_L/\mathfrak{p}_L \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_L/\mathfrak{p}_L : x \bmod \mathfrak{p}_L \mapsto \sigma x \bmod \mathfrak{p}_L$ of the residue class field. Since σ fixes K pointwise, it fixes $\mathcal{O}_K$ pointwise as well, and hence $\bar{\sigma}$ fixes $k = \mathcal{O}_K/\mathfrak{p}_K$ pointwise. Hence, $\bar{\sigma} \in \text{Aut}_k(l)$. We consider the map $G_w \rightarrow \text{Aut}_k(l) : \sigma \mapsto \bar{\sigma}$ and this is a homomorphism since $\bar{\sigma}\bar{\sigma}'(\bar{x}) = \bar{\sigma}(\sigma'(x) \bmod \mathfrak{p}_L) = \sigma\sigma'(x) \bmod \mathfrak{p}_L = \overline{\sigma\sigma'}(\bar{x})$, as desired. Further, its kernel is precisely $\{\sigma \in G_w : \bar{\sigma} = \text{id}_l\} = \{\sigma \in G_w : \sigma x \equiv x \bmod \mathfrak{p}_L \text{ for all } x \in \mathcal{O}_L\} = I_w$.

To prove normality of l/k , we first assume L/K is finite. We first consider the case when L/K is finite. Note that since the extension Z_w/K is immediate, we have equality of the respective residue class fields $z_w = k$, hence there is no loss of generality in assuming $K = Z_w$ and then proving $l/z_w = l/k$ is normal. For this, we take an arbitrary $\bar{\theta} \in l$ and show its minimal polynomial $\bar{g}(x)$ splits into linear factors over l . Consider a lift $\theta \in \mathcal{O}_L$ and let f be its minimal polynomial over L ; in particular, $f \in \mathcal{O}_L[x]$ and then the reduction $\bar{f}$ has $\bar{\theta}$ as a root, which implies $\bar{g} \mid \bar{f}$. Since L/K is normal, f splits into linear factors over $\mathcal{O}_L$, therefore so does $\bar{f}$ over l ,

2.4. GALOIS THEORY OF VALUATIONS

and hence so does $\bar{g}$. In the case that L/K is infinite, l/k is the directed union of finite normal extensions as the theorem holds for finite extensions, and therefore, is itself normal.



Theorem 2.4.9. *Let L/K be Galois and v be a nonarchimedean valuation on K with a nonarchimedean extension w to L . Then, we have an exact sequence*

$$1 \rightarrow I_w \rightarrow G_w \rightarrow G(l/k) \rightarrow 1$$

Proof. We need only show $\phi : G_w \rightarrow G(l/k)$ is surjective. Note that $G_w(L/K) = G(L/Z_w)$, by definition, and $G(l/k) = G(l/z_w)$, hence it suffices to prove the surjectivity of $G(L/Z_w) \rightarrow G(l/z_w)$. Hence, as before, we may assume $K = Z_w$ which implies $G_w = G$ and that K is henselian. We first prove the theorem for a finite extension; let $\bar{\theta} \in l$ be a primitive element of the maximal separable subextension of l/k , then there is a canonical isomorphism $G(l/k) \xrightarrow{\sim} G(k(\bar{\theta})/k)$. Consider the minimal polynomial $\bar{g}(x)$ of $\bar{\theta}$ over k' and let $f(x)$ be the minimal polynomial of θ over K' , then $\bar{\sigma} \bar{\theta}$ is a root of $\bar{g}(x)$, and hence of $\bar{f}(x)$. Since K is henselian, we may lift $\bar{\theta}$ to a root θ' of f . Since both θ and θ' are roots of the same irreducible polynomial f , they are conjugate, i.e., $\theta' = \sigma\theta$ for some $\sigma \in G$. Since $\bar{\sigma}\theta = \bar{\theta}' = \bar{\sigma} \bar{\theta}$, we have $\phi(\bar{\sigma}) = \sigma$, as desired.

We now assume L/K is infinite and consider $G_w \xrightarrow{\phi} G(l/k)$. We claim that the image $\phi(G_w)$ is dense in $G(l/k)$; we prove this by showing that $\phi(G_w)$ intersects every basic open set. Let $\bar{\sigma}G(l/m)$, where m/k is finite Galois, be a neighborhood of an arbitrary (but fixed) $\bar{\sigma} \in G(l/k)$. Now, $z_w = k$ implies that m is an extension of z_w , hence there is a corresponding finite Galois subextension N/Z_w such that $n \supseteq m$. From the finite case, the map $G(N/Z_w) \rightarrow G(n/k)$ is surjective and hence the composite $G_w = G(L/Z_w) \rightarrow G(N/Z_w) \rightarrow G(n/k) \rightarrow G(m/k)$ is also surjective, since all the maps involved are surjections. Consider the restriction $\bar{\sigma}|_m \in G(m/k)$ and let its preimage be $\tau \in G_w$, i.e., under the map $\tau \mapsto \tau_N \mapsto \bar{\tau}_n \mapsto \bar{\tau}_m = \bar{\sigma}|_m$. Consider now $\phi(\tau) = \bar{\tau}$, then since $\bar{\tau}_m = \bar{\sigma}|_m$, it follows that $\phi(\tau) = \bar{\tau} \in \bar{\sigma}G(l/m)$, i.e., $\phi(G_w)$ intersects $\bar{\sigma}G(l/m)$, as desired. Thus, we have shown that $\phi(G_w)$ is dense in $G(l/k)$. Further note that $\phi(G_w)$ is the continuous image of a compact set, hence it is compact, and therefore closed. This implies $\phi(G_w) = \overline{\phi(G_w)} = G(l/k)$, proving surjectivity.



Definition 2.4.4. We define the *inertia field* as the fixed field of I_w , denoted by $T_w = T_w(L/K) := \{x \in L : \sigma x = x \ \forall \sigma \in I_w\}$.

Corollary 2.4.9.1. $G(T_w/Z_w) \cong G(l/k)$.

Proof. We have from Galois theory $G(T_w/Z_w) \cong \frac{G(L/Z_w)}{G(L/T_w)} = G_w/I_w \cong G(l/k)$, where the last isomorphism follows from the previous theorem. $\square$

Theorem 2.4.10. T_w/Z_w is the maximal unramified subextension of L/Z_w , when K is assumed to be henselian.

Proof. Since K is henselian, then $Z_w = K$ as $\text{Gal}(L/Z_w) = G_w = G(L/K)$. Let L^{unr}/K denote the maximal unramified subextension of L/K . Note that for any $\sigma \in G(L/K) = G_w$, σL^{unr} is also unramified over Z_w since we have $w((\sigma T)^\times) = w(\sigma L^{\text{unr} \times}) = (w \circ \sigma)(L^{\text{unr} \times}) = w(L^{\text{unr} \times}) = w(Z_w^\times)$. Therefore, for any $\sigma \in G(L/K) = G_w$, $\sigma L^{\text{unr}} \subset L^{\text{unr}}$, and hence L^{unr}/K is Galois and we know its residue field is $l^{\text{unr}} = l^{\text{sep}} \subset l$. Now, we have a surjection $G(L^{\text{unr}}/K) \twoheadrightarrow G(l^{\text{sep}}/k) = G(l^{\text{sep}}/k)$ by the previous theorem, and since L^{unr}/K is unramified, $|G(L^{\text{unr}}/K)| = [l^{\text{unr}} : k]$, which implies that $G(L^{\text{unr}}/K) \twoheadrightarrow G(l^{\text{sep}}/k)$ is an isomorphism. Recall from Galois theory that $G(L/L^{\text{unr}}) = \ker(G(L/K) \twoheadrightarrow G(L^{\text{unr}}/K))$, and since $G(L^{\text{unr}}/K) \cong G(l^{\text{sep}}/k)$, an element $\sigma \in G(L/K)$ induces identity on l^{sep} , i.e., on l , if and only if $\sigma \in G(L/L^{\text{unr}})$. Therefore, $I_w = G(L/L^{\text{unr}})$, which by the infinite Galois correspondence, implies equality of the fixed fields $T_w = L^{\text{unr}}$. $\square$

To remove the henselianity assumption above, we recall a few topological facts.

Lemma 2.4.8. 1. Let $Y \subseteq X$ be a metric subspace and let $\widehat{X}$ denote the completion of X . Then, $\widehat{Y} = \overline{Y}^{\widehat{X}}$.

2. Let $A \subseteq Y \subseteq X$ be topological subspaces, then $\overline{A}^X \cap Y = \overline{A}^Y$.

3. Let W be a finite dimensional subspace of a normed linear space V , then W is closed.

Proof. 1. This follows immediately from the fact that a subspace Y of a complete metric space $\widehat{X}$ is closed if and only if it is complete.

2. $\overline{A}^X \cap Y \supset \overline{A}^Y$ since $\overline{A}^X \cap Y$ is a closed set in Y containing A . On the other hand, $\overline{A}^Y$ is a closed set in Y , hence it is of the form $C \cap Y$ for a set C closed in X and since C contains A , it contains $\overline{A}^X$, therefore, $\overline{A}^Y = C \cap Y \supset \overline{A}^X \cap Y$, as desired.

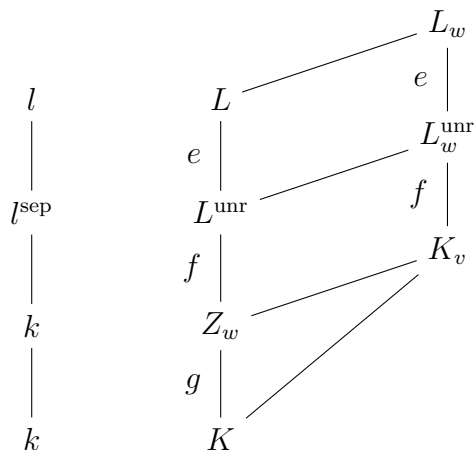
3. This is a standard result from functional analysis. ▣

Theorem 2.4.11. *Let $(K, v) \subseteq (E, w|_E) \subseteq (L, w)$ be a tower of valued fields, where all extensions have finite degree, and $K_v \subseteq \widehat{E} \subseteq L_w$ be the corresponding local tower. Then, $\widehat{E} \cap L = E$ and $\widehat{E} = EK_v$.*

Proof. We use the facts recalled above: by 1.), it follows that $\widehat{E} = \overline{E}^{L_w}$. Further, by 2.), we have $\overline{E}^{L_w} \cap L = \overline{E}^L$ and 3.) implies $E = \overline{E}^L$, therefore, we get $\widehat{E} \cap L = E$. For the second equality, note that $\widehat{E} \supset EK_v$ is obvious since $E \subset E_w$ and $K_v \subset E_w$. For the converse, note that EK_v is a finite dimensional vector space over the complete field K_v , hence it is complete. Moreover, it is a complete field containing E , hence it must contain E_w ▣

Theorem 2.4.12. *Let $(L, w)/(K, v)$ be a finite extension where $w|v$ is fixed and the fundamental equality holds for L/K . Then, $e(L/K) = e(L_w/K_v) = [L : L^{\text{unr}}]$ and $f(L/K) = f(L_w/K_v) = [L^{\text{unr}} : Z]$. In particular, an intermediate extension E/K is unramified over if and only if $\widehat{E}/K_v$ is unramified.*

Proof. Note that $e(L/K) = e(L_w/K_v)$ follows since the extensions K_v/K and L_w/L are immediate, because this implies $v(K^\times) \cong v(K_v^\times)$ and $w(L^\times) \cong w(L_w^\times)$ so $e(L/K) = (w(L^\times) : v(K^\times)) = (w(L_w^\times) : v(K_v^\times)) = e(L_w/K_v)$. Similarly, $f(L/K) = f(L_w/K_v)$. Now, consider the diagram of field extensions, where g denotes the number of extensions $w|v$, and observe that once we fix an extension w of v , we then have $e(L^{\text{unr}}/Z) = e(L^{\text{unr}}/K) = 1$ because L^{unr} is unramified (hence $e = 1$, by fundamental equality) and Z/K is immediate. Therefore,





We now tackle the general case and show it reduces to the henselian case.

Theorem 2.4.13 (Reduction to the henselian case). *T_w/Z_w is the maximal unramified subextension of L/Z_w , without assuming K is henselian.*

Proof. From the earlier proof, the theorem holds for the local extension L_w/K_v , whence $L_w^{\text{unr}} = \widehat{T_w}$, where L_w^{unr} is the maximal unramified subextension of $L_w/\widehat{Z_w} = L_w/K_v$. Further, we have $L_w^{\text{unr}} \cap L = L^{\text{unr}}$ by Theorem 2.4.11. Now, we have seen that an intermediate extension is unramified if and only if its corresponding local extension is unramified, hence given any extension $K \subseteq E \subseteq T_w$, we have that $\widehat{E}/K_v$ is unramified, hence $\widehat{E} \subset L_w^{\text{unr}}$, so intersecting both sides with L gives $E = \widehat{E} \cap L \subset L_w^{\text{unr}} \cap L = L^{\text{unr}}$, i.e., E/K is unramified. Conversely, given any unramified extension E/K , $\widehat{E}/K_v$ is unramified so $\widehat{E} \subseteq \widehat{T_w}$, thus intersecting with L again gives us $E \subset T_w$, and since E/K was arbitrary, this implies $L^{\text{unr}} \subseteq T_w$, as desired.



We now show that the ramification group R_w is the kernel of a canonical homomorphism.

Theorem 2.4.14. $R_w = \ker(I_w \xrightarrow{f} \chi(L/K))$, where $\chi(L/K) = \text{Hom}(\Delta/\Gamma, l^\times)$ where $\Delta = w(L^\times)$, $\Gamma = v(K^\times)$.

Proof. We define the map $f : I_w \rightarrow \chi(L/K)$ as follows: for any $\sigma \in I_w$, we define its image as $\chi_\sigma \in \text{Hom}(\Delta/\Gamma, l^\times)$ given by $\chi_\sigma(\bar{\delta}) = \sigma x/x$, where $x \in L^\times$ such that $w(x) = \delta$. To see that f is well-defined, we need to check two things: $\bar{\delta} = \bar{\delta}' \implies \sigma x/x \equiv \sigma x'/x' \pmod{\mathfrak{p}_L}$ and that $w(x) \equiv w(y) \pmod{p_L} \implies \sigma x/x \equiv \sigma y/y \pmod{\mathfrak{p}_L}$. For the former, let $w(x) \equiv w(x') \pmod{\Gamma}$, then $w(x') - w(x) = v(a)$ for some $a \in K^\times$, whence it follows $x' = xau$ for a unit $u \in O_L^\times$. Consider now $\frac{\sigma x'}{x'} = \frac{\sigma(xau)}{xau} = \frac{\sigma x}{x} \frac{\sigma u}{u}$, since $\sigma a = a$. Now, as $u \in O_L^\times$ and $\sigma \in I_w$, we have $\sigma u \equiv u \pmod{\mathfrak{p}_L}$, hence $\frac{\sigma x'}{x'} = \frac{\sigma x}{x}$. For the latter, let $w(x) \equiv w(y) \pmod{p_L}$ whence $x = uy$ for a unit $u \in O_L^\times$. Then, proceeding as before, $\frac{\sigma x}{x} = \frac{\sigma u}{u} \frac{\sigma y}{y} \equiv \frac{\sigma y}{y} \pmod{\mathfrak{p}_L}$ and thus f is well-defined. To check it is a homomorphism, we need to check that $f(\sigma_1 \circ \sigma_2) = f(\sigma_1)f(\sigma_2)$, i.e., for every $\bar{\delta} \in \Delta/\Gamma$, we have $\chi_{\sigma_1 \circ \sigma_2}(\bar{\delta}) = \chi_{\sigma_1}(\bar{\delta})\chi_{\sigma_2}(\bar{\delta})$. Let $w(x) = \delta$, then we evaluate $\chi_{\sigma_1 \circ \sigma_2}(\bar{\delta}) = \frac{(\sigma_1 \circ \sigma_2)(x)}{x} = \frac{\sigma_1(\sigma_2 x)}{\sigma_2 x} \frac{\sigma_2 x}{x}$. Now, as $\sigma \in I_w$, we have $x \equiv \sigma x$

$\text{mod } \mathfrak{p}_L \implies \frac{\sigma_1(\sigma_2 x)}{\sigma_2 x} \equiv \frac{\sigma_2 x}{x} \text{ mod } \mathfrak{p}_L$, whence it follows $\chi_{\sigma_1 \circ \sigma_1}(\bar{\delta}) = \frac{\sigma_1(\sigma_2 x)}{\sigma_2 x} \frac{\sigma_2 x}{x} \equiv \frac{\sigma_1 x}{x} \frac{\sigma_2 x}{x} \text{ mod } \mathfrak{p}_L = \chi_{\sigma_1}(\bar{\delta}) \chi_{\sigma_2}(\bar{\delta})$, as desired.

Consider now the kernel: $\ker f = \{\sigma \in I_w : \chi_\sigma = 1_l\}$, where 1_l denotes the constant map sending every element to the unity of l . Thus, $\ker f = \{\sigma \in I_w : \frac{\sigma x}{x} \equiv 1 \text{ mod } \mathfrak{p}_L\}$, which is, by definition, R_w . $\blacksquare$

Lemma 2.4.9. *Let F be a field of characteristic p and $x \in F^\times$ be of order n . Then, $(n, p) = 1$.*

Proof. Suppose not, i.e., p divides n so $n = pt$. Then, $0 = x^n - 1 = x^{pt} - 1 = (x^t)^p - 1 = (x^t - 1)^p$, implying $x^t - 1 = 0$, i.e., $x^t = 1$ but $t < n$, a contradiction. $\blacksquare$

Corollary 2.4.14.1. *If $\text{char}(k) = p$, and L/K finite, then $\chi(L/K)$ has order coprime to p .*

Proof. Suppose not, then by Cauchy's theorem, there is an element $g \in \chi(L/K)$ of order p . Thus, for any $\bar{\delta} \in \Delta/\Gamma$, we have $g(\bar{\delta}) = 1 \in l^\times$, i.e., p divides the order of $g(\bar{\delta})$. This contradicts the lemma above. $\blacksquare$

Lemma 2.4.10. *Let K be a henselian field and L be the splitting field of a polynomial f over K such that $l = k$ and $\bar{f}$ is separable over k . Then, K contains all the roots of f .*

Proof. Consider the equation $\bar{f}(x) = 0$. Since $l = k$, $\bar{f}(x) = \prod_{i=1}^{\deg(\bar{f})} (x - \bar{a}_i)$. Note that the separability of $\bar{f}$ implies that all $\bar{a}_i$ are simple roots. Hence, by Hensel's lemma, we may lift this equation to conclude that f splits into linear factors over K . Therefore, K contains all the roots of f . $\blacksquare$

Theorem 2.4.15. *R_w is the unique p -Sylow subgroup of I_w , where $p = \text{char}(l)$.*

Proof. We prove this assuming L/K is finite and K is henselian; the general case follows from this. We first show that R_w is a p -group, by way of contradiction. Suppose there is a prime $q \neq p$ such that q divides $|R_w|$, then by Cauchy's Theorem, R_w contains an element of order q , say σ . Let $K' := L^\sigma$ and k' be its residue field.

Claim: $k' = l$: Since $\sigma \in R_w \subseteq I_w$, we have $L^{I_w} \subset L^\sigma \implies T \subset K'$, which implies inclusion of the corresponding residue fields $t \subset k'$. We have seen earlier that $t = k^{\text{sep}} \subseteq l$, hence $k^{\text{sep}} \subset k'$, thus l/k' is purely inseparable. This further implies that l/k' has p -power degree, thus $[l : k'] = p^n$. Now, take any $\bar{\alpha} \in l$ and a

lift $\alpha \in \mathcal{O}_L \subset L$; we want to show $\alpha \in k'$. Consider the minimal polynomial $\bar{g}(x)$ of $\bar{\alpha}$ over k' and let $f(x)$ be the minimal polynomial of α over K' , then it is clear that $\bar{g}$ divides $\bar{f}$, say $\bar{f} = \bar{g}\bar{h}$. Since K is henselian, we map apply Hensel's lemma to lift this to $f = gh$, retaining degrees, but this contradicts the irreducibility of f . Hence, we must have $\bar{f} = \bar{g}^m$ for some $m \in \mathbb{N}$ and $\deg(f) = \deg(\bar{f})$. Now, as σ has order q , we must have $[L : K'] = q$, by the Galois correspondence. Further, $\deg(f) = [K'(\alpha) : K']$ must divide $[L : K']$, whence we conclude $\deg(f) = q$ or 1. If $\deg(f) = 1$, then $\deg(\bar{f}) = 1$ and so $\bar{\alpha} \in k'$ and we are done. If $\deg(f) = q$, then $\deg(\bar{f}) = q$ and thus $\deg(\bar{g})^m = m \deg(\bar{g}) = q$, i.e., either $m = 1$ and $\deg(\bar{g}) = q$ or $m = q$ and $\deg(\bar{g}) = 1$. If $\deg(\bar{g}) = 1$, then $\bar{\alpha} \in k'$ and we are done as before. If $\deg(\bar{g}) = q$, then $q = \deg(\bar{g}) = [k'(\bar{\alpha}) : k']$ divides $[l : k']$; this is a contradiction since $[l : k'] = p^n$. Therefore, in all cases, we obtain $\bar{\alpha} \in k'$, i.e, $k' = l$.

$$\begin{array}{c} L \\ | \\ T' \\ | \\ K' \\ | \\ T \\ | \\ K \end{array}$$

Claim: L/K' is tamely ramified: since the residue extension is trivial, it is ofcourse separable. We need to check $([L : T'], p) = 1$ where T' is the maximal unramified subextension of L/K' (note that here $K' = Z'_w$, due to the henselian assumption). Now, by definition we have $K' \subseteq T' \subseteq L$ and $[L : K'] = q$, therefore $[L : T']$ divides q hence $[L : T'] = 1$ or q . Hence $([L : T'], p) = 1$.

Further, observe that if $[L : T'] = 1$, then L/K' is unramified so $q = [L : K' = [l : k'] = 1]$ which is a contradiction, hence it must be the case that $[L : T'] = q$, implying $T' = K'$. By the characterization for tamely ramified extensions, we may write $L = T'(\alpha) = K'(\alpha)$ where $\alpha = \sqrt[q]{a}$ for some $a \in K'$. Now, $\alpha^q = a$ and $\sigma a = a$ imply $(\sigma(\alpha))^q = \sigma(\alpha^q) = \alpha^q = a$, i.e., $\sigma(\alpha)$ is a root of $x^q - a = 0$. Hence, $\sigma(\alpha) = \zeta \alpha$ for a primitive q -th root of unity $\zeta \in K'$. Note that K' contains the q -th roots of unity by virtue of Lemma 2.4.10, which holds since $K' \subseteq \text{SF}_{K'}(x^q - 1) \subseteq L$ and $k' = l$ imply that the residue field of $\text{SF}_{K'}(x^q - 1)$ is k . Now, since $\sigma \in R_w$, we have $\frac{\sigma \alpha}{\alpha} = \frac{\zeta \alpha}{\alpha} \equiv 1 \pmod{\mathfrak{p}_L}$, implying $\zeta \equiv 1 \pmod{\mathfrak{p}_L}$, i.e., $\zeta \in \mathfrak{p}_L$, which is

a contradiction since ζ is a unit. This contradiction proves that R_w is a p -group. Further, we have I_w/R_w is a subgroup of $\chi(L/K)$, which has order coprime to p , as seen earlier. Hence, I_w/R_w has order coprime to p , and this, along with the fact that R_w is normal in I_w , proves that R_w is the unique p -Sylow subgroup of I_w .

For the case when L/K is infinite, we have R_w is a profinite group. We wish to show it is a pro- p group. Suppose not, then there exists a finite Galois subgroup $G(L/M)$ containing an element σ of order $q \neq p$. As before, let $L^\sigma = K'$ and we have $T \subset K'$ as in the finite case. Proceeding exactly as above, then, yields a contradiction. Further, I_w/R_w is still a subgroup of $\chi(L/K)$, and if it has a finite Galois subgroup having an element of order divisible by p , then this contradicts the fact that finite order elements of $\chi(L/K)$ have order coprime to p .

In the general, non henselian, case, we pass to the localisation and conclude that $R_w(L/K) = R(L_w/K_v)$ is the unique p -Sylow subgroup of $I(L_w/K_v) = I_w(L/K)$. ■

Definition 2.4.5. We define the **ramification field** as the fixed field of R_w , denoted by $V_w = V_w(L/K) := \{x \in L : \sigma x = x \ \forall \sigma \in R_w\}$.

Theorem 2.4.16. V_w/Z_w is the maximal tamely ramified subextension of L/Z_w , i.e., $V_w = L^{\text{tr}}$.

Proof. We first prove this assuming K is henselian (hence $Z_w = K$). Now, V_w is the union of its finite Galois subextensions M/K . By Galois theory, $[V_w : K] = |I_w : R_w|$, which is coprime to p . Hence, $[M : K]$, which divides $[V_w : K]$, is also coprime to p . Therefore, V_w is the union of finite Galois subextensions M/K having degree coprime to p . Since L^{tr} has the property of having degree coprime to p , we conclude $L^{\text{tr}} \subseteq V_w$.

Further, $[M : L^{\text{unr}}]$, which divides $[M : K]$, is also coprime to p . Hence, M/K is tamely ramified if the residue field m/k is separable. To see this, take an arbitrary $\bar{\alpha} \in m$ and a lift $\alpha \in \mathcal{O}_m$. Consider the minimal polynomial $\bar{g}(x)$ of $\bar{\alpha}$ over k and let $f(x)$ be the minimal polynomial of α over K , then it follows, as seen earlier, that $\bar{f} = \bar{g}^m$ for some $m \in \mathbb{N}$ and $\deg(\bar{f}) = \deg(f) = [K(\alpha) : K]$, which divides $[M : K]$, is coprime to p . Hence, $\deg(\bar{g}) = n$ is coprime to p , whence $\deg(\bar{g}') = n - 1$. Therefore, by irreducibility of $\deg(\bar{g})$, we have $\gcd(\bar{g}, \bar{g}') = 1$, i.e., $\deg(\bar{g})$ is separable, hence $\bar{\alpha}$ is separable. This proves M/K is tamely ramified and hence V_w/K is tamely ramified, giving $V_w \subseteq L^{\text{tr}}$.

For the general case, let us pass to the localisation first. We then have $\widehat{V_w} = L_w^{\text{tr}}$, and intersecting both sides with L , we obtain $\widehat{V_w} \cap L = L_w^{\text{tr}} \cap L \implies V_w = K_v L^{\text{tr}} \cap L =$

L^{tr} , as desired. ■

Theorem 2.4.17. *Let L/K be Galois and v be a nonarchimedean valuation on K with a nonarchimedean extension w to L . Then, we have an exact sequence*

$$1 \rightarrow R_w \rightarrow I_w \rightarrow \chi(L/K) \rightarrow 1$$

Proof. We first prove the theorem for a finite extension with K henselian. We need only show the surjectivity of $I_w \rightarrow \chi(L/K)$, i.e., $I_w/R_w \cong \chi(L/K)$, for which we will show that $|I_w/R_w| = |\chi(L/K)|$. We know from Galois theory that $|I_w/R_w| = [V_w : T_w]$ and since $T_w = L^{\text{unr}}$, we have $f(T_w/K) = 1$. Further, as $v_w = l^{\text{sep}} = t_w$, we also have $f(V_w/T_w) = 1$. Thus, by fundamental equality, we get $[V_w : T_w] = e(V_w/T_w) = (w(V_w^\times) : w(T_w^\times))$. Let $\Delta = w(L^\times)$, then, from the theory of unramified extensions, it follows that $w(T_w^\times) = v(K^\times) := \Gamma$ and $w(V_w^\times)/w(T_w^\times) = \Delta^{(p)}/\Gamma$, where $\Delta^{(p)}$ is the subgroup of Δ consisting of all elements of order coprime to p .

Hence, $[V_w : T_w] = (w(V_w^*) : w(T_w^*)) = |\Delta^{(p)}/\Gamma|$. Since $l^\times$ has no elements of order divisible by p , we have $\chi(L/K) = \text{Hom}(\Delta/\Gamma, l^\times) = \text{Hom}(\Delta^{(p)}/\Gamma, l^\times)$. This follows since for any $f \in \text{Hom}(\Delta/\Gamma, l^\times)$, $f(a + \Gamma) \in l^\times \forall a \in \Delta$. Thus, $(f(a + \Gamma))^{p^t} \neq 1_{l^\times} \forall t \in \mathbb{N}$. Hence, $(f(a + \Gamma))^{p^t} = f((a + \Gamma)^{p^t}) = f(a^{p^t} + \Gamma) \neq 1_{l^\times}$, i.e., $a^{p^t} + \Gamma \neq 0 + \Gamma \forall t \in \mathbb{N}$, hence $a + \Gamma \in \Delta^{(p)}/\Gamma$; thus it suffices to take $\Delta^{(p)}/\Gamma$ as the domain of f . From the theory of tamely ramified extensions, we have that $V_w = T_w(\sqrt[p_1]{a_1}, \dots, \sqrt[p_r]{a_r})$, such that $(m_i, p) = 1$ and hence if $\Delta^{(p)}/\Gamma$ contains an element of order m , then there is a Galois subextension generated by radicals of degree m , say $T_w(\sqrt[p]{a})/T_w$. This shows that $\chi(L/K)$ is the Pontryagin dual of the group $\Delta^{(p)}/\Gamma$, whence it follows that $|I_w/R_w| = [V_w : T_w] = |\Delta^{(p)}/\Gamma| = |\chi(L/K)|$, and we are done. ■

References

- [EP05] Antonio J. Engler and Alexander Prestel. *Valued Fields*. 1st ed. Springer Monographs in Mathematics. Hardcover published 2005; softcover 2010; eBook 2005. Berlin, Heidelberg: Springer Berlin Heidelberg, 2005, pp. X, 208. ISBN: 978-3-540-24221-5. DOI: [10.1007/3-540-30035-X](https://doi.org/10.1007/3-540-30035-X).
- [Kum20] Pasupulati Sunil Kumar. “On ramification index of composition of complete discrete valuation fields”. In: *Proc. Math. Sci.* 130.1 (2020). URL: <https://link.springer.com/article/10.1007/s12044-020-00572-w>.
- [Mil] J. S. Milne. *Algebraic Number Theory*. <https://www.jmilne.org/math/CourseNotes/ANT.pdf>.
- [Neu99] Jürgen Neukirch. *Algebraic Number Theory*. 1st ed. Vol. 322. Grundlehren der mathematischen Wissenschaften. eBook published 2013. Berlin, Heidelberg: Springer Berlin Heidelberg, 1999. ISBN: 978-3-540-65399-8. DOI: [10.1007/978-3-662-03983-0](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-662-03983-0).
- [Rib99] P. Ribenboim. *The Theory of Classical Valuations*. Springer Monographs in Mathematics. Springer New York, 1999. ISBN: 9780387985251. URL: <https://books.google.co.in/books?id=kL1HpN1KPZsC>.
- [Ser80] Jean-Pierre Serre. *Local Fields*. 1st ed. Vol. 67. Graduate Texts in Mathematics. Originally published in French as *Corps locaux*. New York, NY: Springer New York, 1980. ISBN: 978-0-387-90424-5. DOI: [10.1007/978-1-4757-5673-9](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-1-4757-5673-9).